

# *The Scarlet Letter*

Nathaniel Hawthorne · 1850

Standard Ebooks edition (modernized spelling), based on the 1850 Ticknor, Reed and Fields text with the Preface to the Second Edition

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

**Common Core edition** (standards shown for this framework only)

26 chapter lessons plus 3 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 33 class days of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 7 weeks
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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*Cover: Caspar David Friedrich, Wanderer above the Sea of Fog (c. 1818). Public domain (Wikimedia Commons).*

# Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–26), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

**Edition:** The Scarlet Letter was published in Boston in March 1850; the second edition added Hawthorne's preface dated 30 March 1850. The reading text is the Standard Ebooks transcription, which modernizes some spellings (e.g. 'storybooks', 'rosebush'). It has 26 sections: the preface, 'The Customhouse' and Chapters I–XXIV. Cite chapter and paragraph from this edition.

**Content note for teachers:** Adultery (central but not depicted), public shaming, a threat to remove a child, self-harm by a guilty minister, a woman's suicidal thoughts, witchcraft accusation, and period language about Native people. See the chapter notes and the 988 safe-messaging script.

**Grades:** Grades 10–12 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Scaffolded-support track (grade-9 floor): students work from teacher-selected passages with scaffolds, sentence starters and partial-credit probes. **Weeks:** 7. **Class days:** 33 × 90 minutes (26 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

## Essential questions

- What does The Scarlet Letter suggest about sin and guilt?
- What does The Scarlet Letter suggest about public shame and private identity?
- What does The Scarlet Letter suggest about hypocrisy and truth?
- What does The Scarlet Letter suggest about nature and the individual against society?
- What does The Scarlet Letter suggest about women and independence?

## Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the novel in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.

- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the chapter quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

## Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

**Assessments:** Daily chapter quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
**Differentiation:** Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
**Materials:** Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Chapter lecture slides or script

## The 90-minute lesson

| # | Segment | Mode | Minutes | Clock |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Bell-ringer | You do | 8 | 0–8 |
| 2 | Vocabulary with etymology notes | I do | 10 | 8–18 |
| 3 | Background and context | I do | 10 | 18–28 |
| 4 | I do: modeled close reading | I do | 12 | 28–40 |
| 5 | We do: guided annotation | We do | 15 | 40–55 |
| 6 | You do: independent annotation | You do | 15 | 55–70 |
| 7 | Discussion | We do | 10 | 70–80 |
| 8 | Exit ticket / chapter quiz | You do | 7 | 80–87 |
| 9 | Closure | I do | 3 | 87–90 |
| | **Total** | | **90** | |

# Syllabus

| Week | Chapters | Lessons | Focus and activities | Assessment |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | *Introduction: author, context and reception*<br>Preface to the Second Edition (20-minute preview) and The Customhouse<br>The Customhouse (part 2)<br>I: The Prison-Door<br>II: The Marketplace | 5 × 90 min (450 min) | *sin and guilt*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Chapter quizzes in the app<br>• Introduction: author, context and reception<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |
| 2 | III: The Recognition<br>*Socratic seminar on sin and guilt*<br>IV: The Interview<br>V: Hester at Her Needle<br>VI: Pearl | 5 × 90 min (450 min) | *public shame and private identity*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Chapter quizzes in the app<br>• Socratic seminar on sin and guilt<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |
| 3 | VII: The Governor's Hall<br>VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister<br>IX: The Leech<br>X: The Leech and His Patient<br>XI: The Interior of a Heart | 5 × 90 min (450 min) | *hypocrisy and truth*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Chapter quizzes in the app<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |
| 4 | XII: The Minister's Vigil<br>XIII: Another View of Hester<br>*Socratic seminar on public shame and private identity*<br>XIV: Hester and the Physician<br>XV: Hester and Pearl | 5 × 90 min (450 min) | *nature and the individual against society*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Chapter quizzes in the app<br>• Socratic seminar on public shame and private identity<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |
| 5 | XVI: A Forest Walk<br>XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner | 5 × 90 min | *women and independence*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine<br>XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side<br>XX: The Minister in a Maze | (450 min) | background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Chapter quizzes in the app<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | |
| 6 | XXI: The New England Holiday<br>XXII: The Procession<br>XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter<br>*Socratic seminar on hypocrisy and truth*<br>XXIV: Conclusion | 5 × 90 min (450 min) | *sin and guilt*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Chapter quizzes in the app<br>• Socratic seminar on hypocrisy and truth<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |
| 7 | *Whole-book test (90 minutes)*<br>*Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework)*<br>*Final paper: peer review, revision and submission* | 3 × 90 min (270 min) | *public shame and private identity*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Chapter quizzes in the app<br>• Whole-book test (90 minutes)<br>• Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework)<br>• Final paper: peer review, revision and submission<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Whole-book test and final essay |

# Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

# Lesson 1: Introduction to The Scarlet Letter

**Objective:** Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Nathaniel Hawthorne's life or times connects to sin and guilt in “The Scarlet Letter”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (sin and guilt, public shame and private identity, hypocrisy and truth).

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2

## *Author biography*

Nathaniel Hawthorne was born in Salem, Massachusetts, on 4 July 1804; his ancestor John Hathorne was a judge in the Salem witch trials of 1692, a family history Hawthorne felt as a burden. He later changed the spelling of his surname to Hawthorne; why is uncertain, though many link it to his discomfort with his ancestors. After graduating from Bowdoin College in 1825 he spent years writing in near-seclusion in Salem, publishing Twice-Told Tales in 1837. He lived briefly at the utopian Brook Farm community, worked at the Salem Custom House, and achieved fame with The Scarlet Letter (1850) and The House of the Seven Gables (1851). He served as U.S. consul in Liverpool and died on 19 May 1864 in Plymouth, New Hampshire.

## *Historical and cultural context*

The novel is set in Puritan Boston in the 1640s, about twenty years after the founding of the Massachusetts Bay Colony (1630). The Puritan colony joined church and civil authority: magistrates punished moral offenses such as adultery publicly, and colonial laws allowed for punishments including whipping, the pillory and, in some periods, the wearing of letters. Real figures appear: Governor Richard Bellingham, the minister John Wilson, Mistress Ann Hibbins (executed for witchcraft in 1656) and Governor John Winthrop, whose death in 1649 coincides with the minister's vigil. Hawthorne wrote two centuries later, in 1849, after losing his post as surveyor of the Salem Custom House when the Whigs won the presidency; he writes of that dismissal in "The Customhouse."

## *Publication and reception, then and now*

Ticknor, Reed and Fields of Boston published The Scarlet Letter in March 1850, with "The Customhouse" as an introductory sketch. A second edition followed within weeks; Hawthorne's "Preface to the Second Edition" (dated 30 March 1850) refuses to change the sketch despite local anger. By Fields's own later account, he persuaded Hawthorne to publish the story as a separate volume rather than in a planned collection of tales.

**Then:** The book sold well quickly, and the first printing sold out within days. Reviewers praised its power and artistry; some religious critics, such as Arthur Cleveland Coxe, condemned it as an immoral book about adultery. Salem readers resented the satirical portraits of Custom House officers.

**Now:** The Scarlet Letter is among the most taught novels in American high schools and is usually called the first great American novel of psychological and moral analysis. It has been filmed several times (including a 1926 silent film with Lillian Gish and a 1995 film), retold and parodied, and the phrase "scarlet letter" has entered English for any public mark of shame. Modern readers discuss Hester as a feminist figure, the ethics of public shaming, and Hawthorne's own ambivalence toward his Puritan ancestors.

### *Overview (spoiler-free)*

In seventeenth-century Boston, a young woman named Hester Prynne stands on a scaffold holding a baby, with a scarlet "A" embroidered on her dress. She refuses to name the baby's father. The novel follows Hester, her daughter Pearl, the community that judges her, and two men whose connection to her the town does not know.

### *Main themes*

- sin and guilt: public sin (Hester) against hidden sin (Dimmesdale) and the sin of revenge (Chillingworth).
- public shame and private identity: the community's punishment and the self Hester makes inside and against it.
- hypocrisy and truth: "Be true! Be true! Be true!"
- nature and the individual against society: the forest's freedom against the town's law.
- women and independence: Hester's thoughts about the place of women, and her work as a counselor at the end.

### *Why it matters*

The Scarlet Letter asks how a community should treat wrongdoing, what shame does to people, and whether hiding the truth is worse than the original wrong. Students practice tracing a symbol that changes meaning, reading an ironic narrator, and arguing about questions that remain live: public shaming, gender and judgment, guilt and forgiveness.

Spoilers · teacher only

The father is the young, revered minister Arthur Dimmesdale. Hester's long-absent husband arrives the day she is shamed, takes the name Roger Chillingworth, and as a physician attaches himself to Dimmesdale, whose guilt is wasting him, and torments him. Seven years later Hester meets Dimmesdale in the forest and they plan to flee to Europe; Chillingworth books passage on the same ship. After his Election Sermon, Dimmesdale mounts the scaffold with Hester and Pearl, confesses, reveals something on his breast, and dies. Chillingworth dies within a year and leaves his fortune to Pearl, who goes abroad and marries. Hester later returns to Boston, wears the letter of her own will, counsels women, and is buried near Dimmesdale under one tombstone with the words "On a field, sable, the letter A, gules."

### *Lesson plan (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Before we open The Scarlet Letter: Think of a time a group judged someone in public (online or in person). Was the judgment fair? What did it do to the person? Write for five minutes.*
> **Prompt:** Before we open The Scarlet Letter: Think of a time a group judged someone in public (online or in person). Was the judgment fair? What did it do to the person? Write for five minutes.

**8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)**

Key literary terms for the unit.

*Puritan (an English Protestant who wanted to "purify" the Church of England; the founders of Massachusetts Bay); theocracy (government in which religious and civil authority are joined); adultery (sexual relations between a married person and someone other than their spouse); scaffold or pillory (a raised platform for public punishment); romance (Hawthorne's term for fiction allowed to mix the actual and the imaginary); symbol (an object that stands for ideas beyond itself); allegory (a story whose characters and events stand for ideas).*

**18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)**

Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).

*About the author. Nathaniel Hawthorne was born in Salem, Massachusetts, on 4 July 1804; his ancestor John Hathorne was a judge in the Salem witch trials of 1692, a family history Hawthorne felt as a burden. He later changed the spelling of his surname to Hawthorne; why is uncertain, though many link it to his discomfort with his ancestors. After graduating from Bowdoin College in 1825 he spent years writing in near-seclusion in Salem, publishing Twice-Told Tales in 1837. He lived briefly at the utopian Brook Farm community, worked at the Salem Custom House, and achieved fame with The Scarlet Letter (1850) and The House of the Seven Gables (1851). He served as U.S. consul in Liverpool and died on 19 May 1864 in Plymouth, New Hampshire. The world of the book. The novel is set in Puritan Boston in the 1640s, about twenty years after the founding of the Massachusetts Bay Colony (1630). The Puritan colony joined church and civil authority: magistrates punished moral offenses such as adultery publicly, and colonial laws allowed for punishments including whipping, the pillory and, in some periods, the wearing of letters. Real figures appear: Governor Richard Bellingham, the minister John Wilson, Mistress Ann Hibbins (executed for witchcraft in 1656) and Governor John Winthrop, whose death in 1649 coincides with the minister's vigil. Hawthorne wrote two centuries later, in 1849, after losing his post as surveyor of the Salem Custom House when the Whigs won the presidency; he writes of that dismissal in "The Customhouse." Publication and reception. Ticknor, Reed and Fields of Boston published The Scarlet Letter in March 1850, with "The Customhouse" as an introductory sketch. A second edition followed within weeks; Hawthorne's "Preface to the Second Edition" (dated 30 March 1850) refuses to change the sketch despite local anger. By Fields's own later account, he persuaded Hawthorne to publish the story as a separate volume rather than in a planned collection of tales. Then: The book sold well quickly, and the first printing sold out within days. Reviewers praised its power and artistry; some religious critics, such as Arthur Cleveland Coxe, condemned it as an immoral book about adultery. Salem readers resented the satirical portraits of Custom House officers. Now: The Scarlet Letter is among the most taught novels in American high schools and is usually called the first great American novel of psychological and moral analysis. It has been filmed several times (including a 1926 silent film with Lillian Gish and a 1995 film), retold and parodied, and the phrase "scarlet letter" has entered English for any public mark of shame. Modern readers discuss Hester as a feminist figure, the ethics of public shaming, and Hawthorne's own ambivalence toward his Puritan ancestors.*

**28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)**
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "On a field, sable, the letter A, gules" slowly and put it in my own words: The novel's last line describes the gravestone's emblem in the language of coats of arms: on a black field, the letter A in red. Next, craft. I notice Hawthorne uses heraldry, the formal code of noble family shields, for a mark that began as public shame. The strongest word is "sable": the heraldic word for black turns the darkness of her story into a noble color on a coat of arms. Then, effect. What does the heraldic description on the shared tombstone tell us about how Hester is remembered? My answer: The A has become a kind of family crest: the sign of disgrace now marks a life of endurance and dignity, so the ending leaves us with the letter transformed rather than erased.*

> *On a field, sable, the letter A, gules (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 13)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "On a field, sable, the letter A, gules" slowly and put it in my own words: The novel's last line describes the gravestone's emblem in the language of coats of arms: on a black field, the letter A in red. Next, craft. I notice Hawthorne uses heraldry, the formal code of noble family shields, for a mark that began as public shame. The strongest word is "sable": the heraldic word for black turns the darkness of her story into a noble color on a coat of arms. Then, effect. What does the heraldic description on the shared tombstone tell us about how Hester is remembered? My answer: The A has become a kind of family crest: the sign of disgrace now marks a life of endurance and dignity, so the ending leaves us with the letter transformed rather than erased.

**40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)**
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
*What the book is about (no spoilers): In seventeenth-century Boston, a young woman named Hester Prynne stands on a scaffold holding a baby, with a scarlet "A" embroidered on her dress. She refuses to name the baby's father. The novel follows Hester, her daughter Pearl, the community that judges her, and two men whose connection to her the town does not know. Themes to track: sin and guilt: public sin (Hester) against hidden sin (Dimmesdale) and the sin of revenge (Chillingworth). public shame and private identity: the community's punishment and the self Hester makes inside and against it. hypocrisy and truth: "Be true! Be true! Be true!" nature and the individual against society: the forest's freedom against the town's law. women and independence: Hester's thoughts about the place of women, and her work as a counselor at the end.*

**55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)**
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
*Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page "public shame and private identity": Prediction: the letter will change Hester more than the town expects. Question: who decides what the letter means?*
**Task:** Set up a reading journal for The Scarlet Letter: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
**Exemplar:** Theme page "public shame and private identity": Prediction: the letter will change Hester more than the town expects. Question: who decides what the letter means?

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.

*Why does The Scarlet Letter still matter? The Scarlet Letter asks how a community should treat wrongdoing, what shame does to people, and whether hiding the truth is worse than the original wrong. Students practice tracing a symbol that changes meaning, reading an ironic narrator, and arguing about questions that remain live: public shaming, gender and judgment, guilt and forgiveness.*

**Anchor question:** Why might The Scarlet Letter still be taught today?

**Facilitation:** The Scarlet Letter asks how a community should treat wrongdoing, what shame does to people, and whether hiding the truth is worse than the original wrong. Students practice tracing a symbol that changes meaning, reading an ironic narrator, and arguing about questions that remain live: public shaming, gender and judgment, guilt and forgiveness.

**80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)**

Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).

*Hawthorne wrote the novel in 1849–50, just after losing his job at the Salem Custom House, and he set it in 1640s Puritan Boston, where his own ancestors had been judges. Why might he look back two hundred years to tell this story? Answer: Accept answers such as: to examine the harsh Puritan judgment his family took part in; to question public shaming and hypocrisy; his anger at losing his post shows in "The Custom-House" introduction.*

**Exit ticket:** Hawthorne wrote the novel in 1849–50, just after losing his job at the Salem Custom House, and he set it in 1640s Puritan Boston, where his own ancestors had been judges. Why might he look back two hundred years to tell this story?

**Answer:** Accept answers such as: to examine the harsh Puritan judgment his family took part in; to question public shaming and hypocrisy; his anger at losing his post shows in "The Custom-House" introduction.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**

Preview the first reading.

*Tomorrow we begin reading: Preface to the Second Edition.*

**Teacher notes · sources:** Britannica, "Nathaniel Hawthorne" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Nathaniel-Hawthorne); The House of the Seven Gables, "Nathaniel Hawthorne" (https://7gables.org/nathaniel-hawthorne/); Britannica, "The Scarlet Letter" (https://www.britannica.com/topic/The-Scarlet-Letter-novel); Library of America, Nathaniel Hawthorne, Collected Novels (notes and chronology) (https://www.loa.org/books/41-collected-novels/); The Hawthorne in Salem website (Salem State University / Peabody Essex Museum), "The Custom House" (https://www.hawthorneinsalem.org/); Massachusetts Historical Society, Winthrop Papers and colonial records (https://www.masshist.org/); Arthur Cleveland Coxe, "The Writings of Hawthorne," Church Review, January 1851 (https://www.worldcat.org/)

**Flags (verify before teaching):**

- First-edition details (2,500 copies sold out in about ten days) are widely reported; check exact numbers before citing them.
- Whether Massachusetts Bay actually sentenced adulterers to wear a letter in the 1640s is not certain; a 1694 Massachusetts law and a 1658 Plymouth law prescribed letters. Present the letter as Hawthorne's use of colonial practice, not as a documented 1640s sentence.

- The claim that Hawthorne added the "w" to his surname to distance himself from his ancestors is common but not documented in his own words; present it as a widely held view.
- Fields's role in persuading Hawthorne to publish the story alone comes from Fields's later memoir (Yesterdays with Authors, 1872); treat it as his account.

**Critical voice:** "There never surely was a powerful, active, continually effective mind less round, more lop-sided, than that of NATHANIEL HAWTHORNE." (Anthony Trollope, novelist, *"The Genius of Nathaniel Hawthorne," North American Review 129 (September 1879), pp. 203-22, opening sentence*; public domain). Bell-ringer: is "lop-sided" an insult or a compliment here? Trollope argues the lopsidedness makes the art possible. *Objective:* Intro lesson: Hawthorne's temperament and reputation. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.9, SL.11-12.1

**Critical voice:** "In this beautiful and touching romance Hawthorne has produced something really worthy of the fine and deep genius which lies within him." (Edwin Percy Whipple (attrib.; the review is unsigned), critic, *Review of The Scarlet Letter, Graham's Magazine 36:5 (May 1850), "Review of New Books", review, paragraph 1*; public domain). Pair with Coxe's attack (Ch. XVII entry): the same book in the same year, praised and condemned. *Objective:* Intro lesson: reception at publication ("then"). *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.9

**Critical voice:** "It is densely dark, with a single spot of vivid colour in it; and it will probably long remain the most consistently gloomy of English novels of the first order." (Henry James, novelist and critic, *Hawthorne (English Men of Letters, 1879), Chapter V, Ch. V*; public domain). Image hunt: what is the "single spot of vivid colour"? Track red through the first three chapters. *Objective:* Intro lesson: tone and mood across the novel. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.9

## Lesson 2: Preface to the Second Edition

**Focus:** an author answering his critics

**Objective:** Students will identify at least 2 claims the author makes in “Preface to the Second Edition” and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, predict how each frames the reading that follows.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

In a short preface to the second edition, Hawthorne notes with mock surprise that his introductory sketch of the Salem Custom House has angered his neighbors. He says he has reread it, found nothing to change, and will republish it without altering a word.

**Background:** The first edition sold quickly in March 1850; Salem readers objected to Hawthorne's satirical portraits of Custom House officers, some of them recognizable.

**Significance:** The preface shows the author standing firm against a judging community, a quiet parallel to Hester.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Have you ever refused to apologize for something others found offensive? Why? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to public shame and private identity because....*
**Prompt:** Have you ever refused to apologize for something others found offensive? Why?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to public shame and private identity because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position.

**8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*The first edition sold quickly in March 1850; Salem readers objected to Hawthorne's satirical portraits of Custom House officers, some of them recognizable. The preface shows the author standing firm against a judging community, a quiet parallel to Hester. Tone / mood: Hawthorne answers Salem's anger with mock surprise and amusement, refusing to apologize. Irony: He calls his satirical sketch harmless and the outrage "unprecedented excitement," exaggerating to mock his critics. Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1).*

> **16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how tone / mood shapes an author answering his critics. Key takeaway: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position.*

Total: 20 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Tone / mood:** Hawthorne answers Salem's anger with mock surprise and amusement, refusing to apologize.
- **Irony:** He calls his satirical sketch harmless and the outrage "unprecedented excitement," exaggerating to mock his critics.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **public shame and private identity:** Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse."
- “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) Ironic exaggeration of the reaction.
- “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2) Hawthorne refuses to revise.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance.
**Evidence:** “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1)
**Reasoning:** He says the reaction "could hardly have been more violent" if he had burned down the Customhouse, then announces he will republish "without the change of a word."

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **republish** (verb) | publish again | *The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word.* | |
| **disclaims** (verb) | denies having (a motive or intention) | *As to enmity, or ill-feeling of any kind, personal or political, he utterly disclaims such motives.* | "disclaims": Origin of "disclaim": Anglo-Norman disclaimer. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/disclaim#Etymology) |
| **unprecedented** (adjective) | never having happened before | *Much to the author's surprise, and (if he may say so without additional offence) considerably to his amusement, he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him.* | |
| **cherish** (verb) | keep and nurse (a feeling) in one's heart | *It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse, and quenched its last smoking ember in the blood of a certain venerable personage, against whom he is supposed to cherish a peculiar malevolence.* | |
| **introductory** (adjective) | serving as an introduction to what follows | *Much to the author's surprise, and (if he may say so without additional offence) considerably to his amusement, he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him.* | "introductory": Origin: Late Latin intrōductōrius; earlier Latin intrōductus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/introductory#Etymology) |
| **malevolence** (noun) | the wish to do harm to others | *It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse, and quenched its last smoking ember in the blood of a certain venerable personage, against whom he is supposed to cherish a peculiar malevolence.* | "malevolence": Origin: Middle French malevolence; earlier Latin malevolentia ("malevolence"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/malevolence#Etymology) |
| **quenched** (verb) | put out (a fire) | *It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the* | "quenched": Origin of "quench": Old English cwenċan. (Liber et Libri origin |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | *Customhouse, and quenched its last smoking ember in the blood of a certain venerable personage, against whom he is supposed to cherish a peculiar malevolence.* | note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/quench#Etymology) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Have you ever refused to apologize for something others found offensive? Why?
2. Where does tone / mood appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with sin and guilt?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

**Literal / recall**

1. What does the author call the sketch? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter.
2. What has angered Salem readers? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Customhouse sketch
3. How does Hawthorne respond? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He republishes the sketch unchanged
4. What tone does the preface take? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Ironic and amused
5. What does he jokingly compare the outrage to? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Burning down the Customhouse
6. Where and when is the preface signed? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Salem, March 30, 1850
7. Retell the three most important events of "Preface to the Second Edition" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In a short preface to the second edition, Hawthorne notes with mock surprise that his introductory sketch of the Salem Custom House has angered his neighbors. He says he has reread it, found nothing to change, and will republish it without altering a word.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Preface to the Second Edition"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Preface to the Second Edition" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

10. Reread: “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word.” What does “republish” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: republish: publish again.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does the preface exaggerate the town's anger? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: To make the critics look ridiculous.
2. What does “Preface to the Second Edition” suggest about an author answering his critics? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The preface shows the author standing firm against a judging community, a quiet parallel to Hester.
3. Find one example of tone / mood in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.
4. How does the irony in this chapter shape what we understand about an author answering his critics? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse." On irony: He calls his satirical sketch harmless and the outrage "unprecedented excitement," exaggerating to mock his critics. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Much to the author’s surprise, and (if he may say so without additional offence) considerably to his amusement, he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The…”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Preface to the Second Edition”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: In a short preface to the second edition, Hawthorne notes with mock surprise that his introductory sketch of the Salem Custom House has angered his neighbors. He says he has reread it, found nothing to change, and will republish it without altering a word.
7. As the opening chapter, what does “Preface to the Second Edition” set up that the rest of The Scarlet Letter will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): Ironic exaggeration of the reaction. Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2): Hawthorne refuses to revise. Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Have you ever refused to apologize for something others found offensive? Why?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does point of view appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with sin and guilt? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse." Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Hawthorne right not to change a word? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned position weighing satire against fairness to real people.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): Ironic exaggeration of the reaction. Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The preface shows the author standing firm against a judging community, a quiet parallel to Hester.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2): Hawthorne refuses to revise. Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse." Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “Preface to the Second Edition” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about an author answering his critics? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): Ironic exaggeration of the reaction. Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Preface to the Second Edition”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2): Hawthorne refuses to revise. Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to public shame and private identity: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse." Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the tone / mood in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): Ironic exaggeration of the reaction. On tone / mood: Hawthorne answers Salem's anger with mock surprise and amusement, refusing

to apologize. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Preface to the Second Edition” treats an author answering his critics with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2): Hawthorne refuses to revise. Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “The Customhouse” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse." Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about an author answering his critics? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): Ironic exaggeration of the reaction. Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Point of view**: who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse, and quenched its last smoking ember in the blood of a certain venerable personage, against whom he is supposed to cherish a peculiar…”, what does “cherish” most nearly mean?

   A. without proper respect

   B. keep and nurse (a feeling) in one's heart

C. a showy fake or performer who tricks people

D. lack of clarity; blurriness

Key: B (keep and nurse (a feeling) in one's heart)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does he jokingly compare the outrage to?

   A. A witch trial

   B. A war

   C. A shipwreck

   D. Burning down the Customhouse

   Key: D (Burning down the Customhouse)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1: “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an _____ excitement in the respectable community immediately around him”

   Key: unprecedented

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the _____”

   Key: Customhouse

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What has angered Salem readers?

   A. The Customhouse sketch

   B. A sermon

   C. A newspaper article

   D. The novel's ending

   Key: A (The Customhouse sketch)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What tone does the preface take?

   A. Deeply sorrowful

   B. Angry and violent

   C. Ironic and amused

   D. Fearful

   Key: C (Ironic and amused)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Much to the author’s surprise, and (if he may say so without additional offence) considerably to his amusement, he finds that his sketch of official life, _____ to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community…” Word bank: unprecedented, introductory, disclaims, republish

   Key: introductory

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where and when is the preface signed?

   A. London, 1850

   B. Concord, 1849

   C. Salem, March 30, 1850

   D. Boston, 1640

   Key: C (Salem, March 30, 1850)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse, and quenched its last smoking ember in the blood of a certain venerable personage, against whom he is supposed to cherish a peculiar _____.” Word bank: disclaims, unprecedented, republish, malevolence

    Key: malevolence

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1)

    A. Nature's response.

    B. Why Hester names her Pearl.

    C. The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse."

    D. Why Hester returns.

    Key: C (The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse.")

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1)

    A. Hester's freedom.

    B. The harshest woman in the crowd.

    C. Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.

    D. Ironic exaggeration of the reaction.

    Key: D (Ironic exaggeration of the reaction.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Ironic exaggeration of the reaction.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2)

    A. One account of the revelation.

    B. His vow.

    C. Hawthorne refuses to revise.

    D. The townspeople's suspicion.

    Key: C (Hawthorne refuses to revise.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position.

    A. Sin and guilt

    B. Nature and the individual against society

    C. Hypocrisy and truth

    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: D (Public shame and private identity)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1).
    Sample answer: He says the reaction "could hardly have been more violent" if he had burned down the Customhouse, then announces he will republish "without the change of a word."
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Hawthorne right not to change a word? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned position weighing satire against fairness to real people.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2: “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his _____ sketch without the change of a word”
    Key: introductory
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Much to the author’s surprise, and (if he may say so without additional offence) considerably to his amusement, he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented…”, what does “unprecedented” most nearly mean?
    A. never having happened before
    B. took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering
    C. publicly condemned
    D. insulting and mocking

    Key: A (never having happened before)
19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Hawthorne respond?
    A. He rewrites the sketch
    B. He republishes the sketch unchanged
    C. He apologizes publicly
    D. He leaves Salem

    Key: B (He republishes the sketch unchanged)
20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word.”, what does “republish” most nearly mean?
    A. publish again
    B. is right or necessary for
    C. a slave; one bound to serve
    D. a title for a married woman of ordinary rank (Mrs.)

    Key: A (publish again)
21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse."
22. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does the preface exaggerate the town's anger?
    Sample answer: To make the critics look ridiculous.
23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Preface to the Second Edition”? He calls his satirical sketch harmless and the outrage "unprecedented excitement," exaggerating to mock his critics.
    A. Diction / vocabulary

B. Hyperbole

C. Tone / mood

D. Irony

Key: D (Irony)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Preface to the Second Edition”? Hawthorne answers Salem's anger with mock surprise and amusement, refusing to apologize.

A. Plot

B. Setting

C. Diction / vocabulary

D. Tone / mood

Key: D (Tone / mood)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from an earlier chapter to “Preface to the Second Edition”. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position.

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Preface to the Second Edition”?

A. Hester on the scaffold

B. An author answering his critics

C. The procession

D. Another view of Hester

Key: B (An author answering his critics)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Hawthorne refuses to revise.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: He says the reaction "could hardly have been more violent" if he had burned down the Customhouse, then announces he will republish "without the change of a word."

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “As to enmity, or ill-feeling of any kind, personal or political, he utterly disclaims such motives.”, what does “disclaims” most nearly mean?

A. denies having (a motive or intention)

B. long spears with an axe blade, carried by guards

C. in a way that cannot be held back

D. pure; not mixed with anything weaker

Key: A (denies having (a motive or intention))

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse, and _____ its last smoking ember in the blood of a certain venerable personage, against whom he is supposed to cherish a peculiar malevolence.” Word bank: quenched, republish, disclaims, unprecedented

Key: quenched

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him" (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse."
32. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does the author call the sketch?
    Sample answer: His sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter.
33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse" (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Ironic exaggeration of the reaction.

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 17, 1, 18, 19, 20, 4, 7, 3, 12, 21, 11, 22, 23, 24, 14, 25 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 7, 9, 20, 6, 2, 1, 11, 13, 26, 12, 22, 14, 27, 24, 28, 25 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 9, 5, 19, 29, 4, 11, 22, 13, 12, 10, 15, 27, 14, 23, 25, 28 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 30, 29, 7, 9, 11, 22, 13, 26, 10, 14, 24, 23, 27, 16, 31, 28 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 17, 7, 2, 12, 21, 11, 10, 24, 23, 27, 14, 15, 31, 16, 28, 25 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 7, 9, 32, 11, 21, 13, 12, 15, 14, 24, 23, 27, 28, 31, 16, 25 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 3, 4, 12, 21, 10, 11, 14, 15, 23, 27, 24, 25, 33, 31, 16, 28 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 7, 9, 11, 26, 13, 22, 24, 15, 14, 27, 23, 16, 25, 33, 31, 28 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 7, 9, 12, 21, 22, 26, 27, 23, 14, 15, 24, 16, 33, 28, 25, 31 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 30, 7, 26, 11, 21, 10, 23, 24, 14, 27, 15, 33, 25, 16, 31, 28 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Preface to the Second Edition," how does Hawthorne show an author answering his critics? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the tone / mood you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Preface to the Second Edition, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of an author answering his critics? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the tone / mood in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Preface to the Second Edition develops the idea of an author answering his critics. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of Preface to the Second Edition (where it begins, turns and ends) and its tone / mood shape the reader's understanding of an author answering his critics. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what Preface to the Second Edition suggests about an author answering his critics. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's tone / mood and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses tone / mood in Preface to the Second Edition to complicate the reader's understanding of an author answering his critics. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Preface to the Second Edition within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of an author answering his critics responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Preface to the Second Edition alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of an author answering his critics follows or bends those conventions, using the tone / mood as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Preface to the Second Edition and its treatment of an author answering his critics. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's tone / mood and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Preface to the Second Edition as evidence for a larger claim about an author answering his critics in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Preface to the Second Edition as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of an author answering his critics. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

*SAT-style questions*

1. *Much to the author's surprise, and (if he may say so without additional offence) considerably to his amusement, he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "unprecedented" most nearly mean?

   A. put out (a fire)

   B. the wish to do harm to others

   C. serving as an introduction to what follows

   D. never having happened before

2. *Much to the author's surprise, and (if he may say so without additional offence) considerably to his amusement, he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him. It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse, and quenched its last smoking ember in the blood of a certain venerable personage, against whom he is supposed to cherish a peculiar malevolence. As the public disapprobation would weigh very heavily on him, were he conscious of deserving it, the author begs leave to say, that he has carefully read over the introductory pages, with a purpose to alter or expunge whatever might be found amiss, and to make the best reparation in his power for the atrocities of which he has been adjudged guilty. But it appears to him, that the only remarkable features of the sketch are its frank and genuine good-humor, and the general accuracy with which he has conveyed his sincere impressions of the characters therein described. As to enmity, or ill-feeling of any kind, personal or political, he utterly disclaims such motives. The sketch might, perhaps, have been wholly omitted, without loss to the public, or detriment to the book; but, having undertaken to write it, he conceives that it could not have been done in a better or a kindlier spirit, nor, so far as his abilities availed, with a livelier effect of truth.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Preface to the Second Edition"?

   A. The leech

   B. The revelation

   C. Hester and the physician

   D. An author answering his critics

**SAT key:** 1. D (never having happened before); 2. D (An author answering his critics)

## Lesson 3: The Customhouse

**Focus:** the frame narrative and the found letter

**Objective:** Students will analyze how point of view develops in “The Customhouse” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

**Critical voice:** “Lockhart was a dense, substantial Briton, with a taste for the concrete, and Hawthorne was a thin New Englander, with a miasmatic conscience.” (Henry James, novelist and critic, *Hawthorne (English Men of Letters, 1879), Chapter V, Ch. V*; public domain). Discussion: where does Hawthorne's guilt about his Puritan ancestors (the judge, the persecutor) show in "The Custom-House"? *Objective:* Analyze "The Custom-House" sketch and Hawthorne's Puritan inheritance. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3, RL.11-12.9

**Content note (suicide (figurative remark)):** The narrator compares his good luck to that of someone who 'should entertain an idea of committing suicide' and survive; it is figurative. If students pick it up, use 'die by suicide' and point to support.
**Student preview:** Heads-up: this section includes suicide (figurative remark). Support is available if this is hard to read.
**Suggested language:** “What does this language show about the speaker?”
**Safe messaging:** Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

The narrator, close to Hawthorne himself, describes his three years as Surveyor of the Salem Custom House: the sleepy old officers, his Puritan ancestors who would scorn a 'writer of storybooks', and his discovery in an upper room of a faded scarlet cloth letter and the papers of a former surveyor, Jonathan Pue, telling Hester Prynne's story. When a change of administration costs him his post, he turns to writing the romance.

**Background:** Hawthorne was Surveyor of the Port of Salem from 1846 to 1849 and was removed after the Whig victory of 1848. Salem had been a great port; by the 1840s its trade had declined. His ancestor John Hathorne was a judge at the 1692 witch trials.

**Significance:** The frame presents the novel as edited history and defines romance as a meeting place of the Actual and the Imaginary.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Why might a writer pretend that a story is based on a real document he found? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to public shame and private identity because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this section includes suicide (figurative remark). Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.*
**Prompt:** Why might a writer pretend that a story is based on a real document he found?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to public shame and private identity because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks."

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: affrighting — frightening; dutiable — on which a customs tax must be paid; recreating — bringing back to life in the imagination; esoteric — belonging to a small, inner circle; ruddiness — a reddish glow. "affrighting": Origin of "affright": an English formation from a- + fright. "recreating": Origin of "recreate": Latin recreāre ("to restore"). "esoteric": Origin: Ancient Greek* ἐσωτερικός.
**Words:** affrighting: frightening · dutiable: on which a customs tax must be paid · recreating: bringing back to life in the imagination · esoteric: belonging to a small, inner circle · ruddiness: a reddish glow

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Hawthorne was Surveyor of the Port of Salem from 1846 to 1849 and was removed after the Whig victory of 1848. Salem had been a great port; by the 1840s its trade had declined. His ancestor John Hathorne was a judge at the 1692 witch trials. The frame presents the novel as edited history and defines romance as a meeting place of the Actual and the Imaginary. Point of view: A first-person narrator, close to Hawthorne himself, describes his years as surveyor and frames the novel as an edited old record. Characterization: Satirical sketches of the aged officers, especially the Inspector, whose only memories are of good dinners. Symbolism: The faded red cloth letter he "finds" in the upper story, which seems to burn when he lays it on his breast. Watch for the scarlet letter: Laid on his breast, the rag gives "a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat."*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator admits it is odd that, though he dislikes talking about himself, he has twice felt the urge to write autobiography for the public. Next, craft. I notice the long, hesitating sentence full of qualifications and dashes, the voice of a shy man explaining himself. The strongest word is "disinclined": it shows a writer who claims reluctance even as he begins to talk about himself at length. Then, effect. What does the narrator's opening tell us about why he is writing this introduction? My answer: The narrator's opening tells us he is writing this introduction to explain why his earlier sketch upset Salem and to show how he "found" the scarlet letter, so the romance feels like discovered history.*

> *It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside* *(The Customhouse, paragraph 1)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator admits it is odd that, though he dislikes talking about himself, he has twice felt the urge to write autobiography for the public. Next, craft. I notice the long, hesitating sentence full of qualifications and dashes, the voice of a shy man explaining himself. The strongest word is "disinclined": it shows a writer who claims reluctance even as he begins to talk about himself at length. Then, effect. What does the narrator's opening tell us about why he is writing this introduction? My answer: The narrator's opening tells us he is writing this introduction to explain why his earlier sketch upset Salem and to show how he "found" the scarlet letter, so the romance feels like discovered history.

**40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Hawthorne imagines his Puritan ancestors sneering at "a writer of storybooks." Expected link: pointOfView; Hawthorne's guilt about and distance from his ancestors. Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity? Expected: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." (His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.)*

> *A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be* *(The Customhouse, paragraph 9)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Hawthorne imagines his Puritan ancestors sneering at "a writer of storybooks." Expected link: pointOfView; Hawthorne's guilt about and distance from his ancestors.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to public shame and private identity?
**Expected answer:** Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." (His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.)

**50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the chapter for point of view, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the frame narrative and the found letter? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Customhouse develops the idea of the frame narrative and the found letter. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. When the text says "a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet" (The Customhouse, paragraph 44), it shows this directly. The narrator presents a real document and a real rag yet says the letter gave "a sensation not altogether physical," and defines his art as "a neutral territory" where "the Actual and the Imaginary may meet."*

**Task:** Annotate the chapter for point of view, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the frame narrative and the found letter? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Customhouse develops the idea of the frame narrative and the found letter. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. When the text says "a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet" (The Customhouse, paragraph 44), it shows this directly. The narrator presents a real document and a real rag yet says the letter gave "a sensation not altogether physical," and defines his art as "a neutral territory" where "the Actual and the Imaginary may meet."

**55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: Why might a writer pretend that a story is based on a real document he found? This is the longest and slowest section; assign excerpts (the ancestors, the discovery of the letter, the moonlight passage) rather than the whole.*

**Anchor question:** Why might a writer pretend that a story is based on a real document he found?

**Facilitation:** This is the longest and slowest section; assign excerpts (the ancestors, the discovery of the letter, the moonlight passage) rather than the whole.

**60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the frame narrative and the found letter? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. ("a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet", The Customhouse, paragraph 44). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the frame narrative and the found letter? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. ("a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet", The Customhouse, paragraph 44). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how point of view shapes the frame narrative and the found letter. Key takeaway: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks."*

Total: 70 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Point of view:** A first-person narrator, close to Hawthorne himself, describes his years as surveyor and frames the novel as an edited old record.
- **Characterization:** Satirical sketches of the aged officers, especially the Inspector, whose only memories are of good dinners.
- **Symbolism:** The faded red cloth letter he "finds" in the upper story, which seems to burn when he lays it on his breast.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **public shame and private identity:** Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks."

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the scarlet letter:** Laid on his breast, the rag gives "a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat."

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be" (The Customhouse, paragraph 9) His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.

- “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1) The opening, with its ironic self-presentation.
- “I experienced a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat” (The Customhouse, paragraph 39) The letter's mysterious power.
- “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44) Hawthorne's definition of romance.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination.
**Evidence:** “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44)
**Reasoning:** The narrator presents a real document and a real rag yet says the letter gave "a sensation not altogether physical," and defines his art as "a neutral territory" where "the Actual and the Imaginary may meet."

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **affrighting** (verb) | frightening | *Ghosts might enter here, without affrighting us.* | “affrighting”: Origin of “affright”: an English formation from a- + fright. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/affright#Etymology) |
| **dutiable** (adjective) | on which a customs tax must be paid | *The Customhouse marker imprinted it, with a stencil and black paint, on pepper-bags, and baskets of anatto, and cigar-boxes, and bales of all kinds of dutiable merchandise, in testimony that these commodities had paid the impost, and gone regularly through the office.* | |
| **recreating** (verb) | bringing back to life in the imagination | *There was one thing that much aided me in renewing and recreating the stalwart soldier of the Niagara frontier—the man of true and simple energy.* | “recreating”: Origin of “recreate”: Latin recreāre (“to restore”). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/recreate#Etymology) |
| **esoteric** (adjective) | belonging to a small, inner circle | *The merchants valued him not less than we, his esoteric friends.* | “esoteric”: Origin: Ancient Greek ἐσωτερικός. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/esoteric#Etymology) |
| **ruddiness** (noun) | a reddish glow | *It throws its unobtrusive tinge throughout the room, with a faint ruddiness upon the walls and ceiling, and a reflected gleam from the polish of the furniture.* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **lightsome** (adjective) | cheerful and light | *So, with lightsome hearts, and the happy consciousness of being usefully employed—in their own behalf, at least, if not for our beloved country—these good old gentlemen went through the various formalities of office.* | "lightsome": Origin: an English formation from light + -some. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/lightsome#Etymology) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Why might a writer pretend that a story is based on a real document he found?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with public shame and private identity?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

**Literal / recall**

1. What happens when he lays the letter on his breast? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He feels something like burning heat.
2. Where did the narrator work? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Salem Custom House
3. What did he find in the upper story? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A faded scarlet letter A and old papers
4. Whose papers tell the story? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Surveyor Pue's
5. What do his ancestors think a storyteller is? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Idle and worthless
6. Why does he leave the job? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A change of administration removes him
7. Retell the three most important events of "The Customhouse" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The narrator, close to Hawthorne himself, describes his three years as Surveyor of the Salem Custom House: the sleepy old officers, his Puritan ancestors who would scorn a 'writer of storybooks', and his discovery in an upper room of a faded scarlet cloth letter and the papers of a former surveyor, Jonathan Pue, telling Hester Prynne's story. When a change of administration costs him his post, he…
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "The Customhouse"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "The Customhouse" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

10. Reread: “Ghosts might enter here, without affrighting us.” What does “affrighting” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: affrighting: frightening.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does the narrator call the moonlit room a neutral territory? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: It is a space where the real and imaginary meet, like romance itself.
2. What does “The Customhouse” suggest about the frame narrative and the found letter? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The frame presents the novel as edited history and defines romance as a meeting place of the Actual and the Imaginary.
3. Find one example of point of view in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
4. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about the frame narrative and the found letter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9): His imagined ancestors' contempt for him. On symbolism: The faded red cloth letter he "finds" in the upper story, which seems to burn when he lays it on his breast. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “There was one thing that much aided me in renewing and recreating the stalwart soldier of the Niagara frontier—the man of true and simple energy.”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “The Customhouse”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The narrator, close to Hawthorne himself, describes his three years as Surveyor of the Salem Custom House: the sleepy old officers, his Puritan ancestors who would scorn a 'writer of storybooks', and his discovery in an upper room of a faded scarlet cloth letter and the papers of a former surveyor,…
7. How does “The Customhouse” build on “Preface to the Second Edition”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1): The opening, with its ironic self-presentation. Theme link: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “I experienced a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat” (The Customhouse, paragraph 39): The letter's mysterious power. On characterization: Satirical sketches of the aged officers, especially the Inspector, whose only memories are of good dinners. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might a writer pretend that a story is based on a real document he found?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with public shame and private identity? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44): Hawthorne's definition of romance. On characterization: Satirical sketches of the aged officers, especially the Inspector, whose only memories are of good dinners. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Does 'The Customhouse' help or hurt the novel? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view about the frame's purpose and pace.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9): His imagined ancestors' contempt for him. Theme link: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The frame presents the novel as edited history and defines romance as a meeting place of the Actual and the Imaginary.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1): The opening, with its ironic self-presentation. Theme link: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that

joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “I experienced a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat” (The Customhouse, paragraph 39): The letter's mysterious power. On characterization: Satirical sketches of the aged officers, especially the Inspector, whose only memories are of good dinners. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “The Customhouse” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the frame narrative and the found letter? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44): Hawthorne's definition of romance. On point of view: A first-person narrator, close to Hawthorne himself, describes his years as surveyor and frames the novel as an edited old record. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “The Customhouse”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9): His imagined ancestors' contempt for him. Theme link: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to hypocrisy and truth: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1): The opening, with its ironic self-presentation. Theme link: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the point of view in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “I experienced a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat” (The Customhouse, paragraph 39): The letter's mysterious power. On point of view: A first-person narrator, close to Hawthorne himself, describes his years as surveyor and frames the novel as an edited old record. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “The Customhouse” treats the frame narrative and the found letter with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK

4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44): Hawthorne's definition of romance. Theme link: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “I: The Prison-Door” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9): His imagined ancestors' contempt for him. Theme link: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the frame narrative and the found letter? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1): The opening, with its ironic self-presentation. Theme link: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whose papers tell the story?

   A. Governor Winthrop's

   B. Pearl's

   C. Dimmesdale's

   D. Surveyor Pue's

   Key: D (Surveyor Pue's)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It throws its unobtrusive tinge throughout the room, with a faint _____ upon the walls and ceiling, and a reflected gleam from the polish

of the furniture." Word bank: dutiable, ruddiness, affrighting, recreating

Key: ruddiness

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Customhouse, paragraph 1: "It is a little remarkable, that—though _____ to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside"

   Key: disinclined

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "The Customhouse marker imprinted it, with a stencil and black paint, on pepper-bags, and baskets of anatto, and cigar-boxes, and bales of all kinds of dutiable merchandise, in testimony that these commodities had paid…", what does "dutiable" most nearly mean?

   A. on which a customs tax must be paid

   B. a slave; one bound to serve

   C. prying and suspicious, like an investigator

   D. making glad

   Key: A (on which a customs tax must be paid)

5. [short · recall · DOK 1] What happens when he lays the letter on his breast?

   Sample answer: He feels something like burning heat.

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Ghosts might enter here, without affrighting us.", what does "affrighting" most nearly mean?

   A. a decorated panel on the front of a woman's bodice

   B. harmful

   C. focused together on one point

   D. frightening

   Key: D (frightening)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does he leave the job?

   A. A change of administration removes him

   B. He moves to England

   C. He is promoted

   D. He retires to farm

   Key: A (A change of administration removes him)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What do his ancestors think a storyteller is?

   A. Idle and worthless

   B. Heroic

   C. Holy

   D. Wealthy

   Key: A (Idle and worthless)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "So, with _____ hearts, and the happy consciousness of being usefully employed—in their own behalf, at least, if not for our beloved country—these good old gentlemen went through the various formalities of office." Word bank: lightsome, recreating, dutiable, affrighting

   Key: lightsome

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The opening, with its ironic self-presentation.
11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1)
    A. The opening, with its ironic self-presentation.
    B. Pearl's transformation.
    C. Pearl on the sunshine.
    D. Dimmesdale's double-edged plea.
    Key: A (The opening, with its ironic self-presentation.)
12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9)
    A. Anguish as his only truth.
    B. His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.
    C. The letter isolates Hester.
    D. First description of the letter.
    Key: B (His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.)
13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.
14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Customhouse”? A first-person narrator, close to Hawthorne himself, describes his years as surveyor and frames the novel as an edited old record.
    A. Theme
    B. Point of view
    C. Metaphor
    D. Characterization
    Key: B (Point of view)
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44).
    Sample answer: The narrator presents a real document and a real rag yet says the letter gave "a sensation not altogether physical," and defines his art as "a neutral territory" where "the Actual and the Imaginary may meet."
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The opening, with its ironic self-presentation.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “There was one thing that much aided me in renewing and recreating the stalwart soldier of the Niagara frontier—the man of true and simple energy.”, what does “recreating” most nearly mean?

    A. bringing back to life in the imagination

    B. strengthened; given new energy

    C. shut out from society and its protection

    D. splash (with water or mud)

    Key: A (bringing back to life in the imagination)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The merchants valued him not less than we, his esoteric friends.”, what does “esoteric” most nearly mean?

    A. a shield bearing a coat of arms

    B. based on guesswork

    C. belonging to a small, inner circle

    D. coldness

    Key: C (belonging to a small, inner circle)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Customhouse, paragraph 9: “A writer of _____! What kind of a business in life … may that be”

    Key: storybooks

20. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does the narrator call the moonlit room a neutral territory?

    Sample answer: It is a space where the real and imaginary meet, like romance itself.

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44)

    A. Anguish as his only truth.

    B. Hawthorne's definition of romance.

    C. Pearl's question.

    D. The cost of falseness.

    Key: B (Hawthorne's definition of romance.)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks."

    A. Nature and the individual against society

    B. Sin and guilt

    C. Public shame and private identity

    D. Hypocrisy and truth

    Key: C (Public shame and private identity)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Customhouse”? Satirical sketches of the aged officers, especially the Inspector, whose only memories are of good dinners.

    A. Imagery

    B. Characterization

    C. Allusion

D. Setting

Key: B (Characterization)

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Does 'The Customhouse' help or hurt the novel? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view about the frame's purpose and pace.
25. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “The Customhouse”?
    A. The child at the brook-side
    B. Hester and the physician
    C. The frame narrative and the found letter
    D. Conclusion

    Key: C (The frame narrative and the found letter)
26. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I experienced a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat” (The Customhouse, paragraph 39)
    A. His vow.
    B. Hester's change.
    C. Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.
    D. The letter's mysterious power.

    Key: D (The letter's mysterious power.)
27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “"The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: The narrator presents a real document and a real rag yet says the letter gave "a sensation not altogether physical," and defines his art as "a neutral territory" where "the Actual and the Imaginary may meet."
28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What did he find in the upper story?
    A. A faded scarlet letter A and old papers
    B. A portrait of Hester
    C. A sermon
    D. A treasure chest

    Key: A (A faded scarlet letter A and old papers)
29. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “I experienced a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat” (The Customhouse, paragraph 39). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The letter's mysterious power.
30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from an earlier chapter to “The Customhouse”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks."
31. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where did the narrator work?
    A. A Harvard library
    B. A newspaper office
    C. A Boston church
    D. The Salem Custom House

Key: D (The Salem Custom House)

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be" (The Customhouse, paragraph 9) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 2, 17, 8, 18, 4, 9, 19, 3, 20, 13, 21, 12, 22, 14, 23, 24 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 9, 4, 8, 2, 6, 18, 25, 26, 20, 11, 12, 22, 14, 23, 27, 16 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 2, 9, 4, 6, 28, 12, 21, 13, 10, 11, 22, 29, 14, 15, 16, 30 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 2, 31, 3, 18, 20, 25, 11, 21, 13, 14, 29, 22, 15, 30, 16, 32 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 2, 17, 3, 21, 25, 20, 13, 14, 29, 15, 23, 22, 30, 24, 27, 16 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 19, 4, 3, 12, 13, 26, 11, 15, 29, 23, 14, 22, 30, 24, 32, 27 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 2, 9, 10, 26, 20, 12, 14, 22, 15, 23, 29, 24, 32, 30, 27, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 2, 9, 25, 26, 20, 10, 14, 15, 22, 23, 29, 30, 32, 24, 16, 27 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 2, 9, 21, 20, 12, 13, 23, 14, 15, 22, 29, 16, 27, 24, 30, 32 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 2, 9, 26, 12, 13, 10, 23, 15, 29, 22, 14, 27, 30, 32, 24, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "The Customhouse," how does Hawthorne show the frame narrative and the found letter? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): In The Customhouse, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the frame narrative and the found letter? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): Analyze how The Customhouse develops the idea of the frame narrative and the found letter. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of The Customhouse (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's

understanding of the frame narrative and the found letter. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what The Customhouse suggests about the frame narrative and the found letter. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses point of view in The Customhouse to complicate the reader's understanding of the frame narrative and the found letter. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate The Customhouse within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the frame narrative and the found letter responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read The Customhouse alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the frame narrative and the found letter follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Customhouse and its treatment of the frame narrative and the found letter. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads The Customhouse as evidence for a larger claim about the frame narrative and the found letter in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads The Customhouse as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the frame narrative and the found letter. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *There was one thing that much aided me in renewing and recreating the stalwart soldier of the Niagara frontier—the man of true and simple energy.*

As used in the text, what does the word "recreating" most nearly mean?

A. belonging to a small, inner circle

B. bringing back to life in the imagination

C. a reddish glow

D. cheerful and light

2. *There was one thing that much aided me in renewing and recreating the stalwart soldier of the Niagara frontier—the man of true and simple energy. It was the recollection of those memorable words of his—"I'll try, Sir!"—spoken on the very verge of a desperate and heroic enterprise, and breathing the soul and spirit of New England hardihood, comprehending all perils, and encountering all. If, in our country, valor were rewarded by heraldic honor, this phrase—which it seems so easy to speak, but which only he, with such a task of danger and glory before him, has ever spoken—would be the best and fittest of all mottoes for the General's shield of arms.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "The Customhouse"?

A. The frame narrative and the found letter

B. The recognition

C. The procession

D. Hester on the scaffold

**SAT key:** 1. B (bringing back to life in the imagination); 2. A (The frame narrative and the found letter)

## Lesson 4: I: The Prison-Door

**Focus:** the prison door and the rose

**Objective:** Students will analyze how setting develops in “I: The Prison-Door” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

**Critical voice:** “_The Scarlet Letter_ isn't a pleasant, pretty romance. It is a sort of parable, an earthly story with a hellish meaning.” (D. H. Lawrence, novelist and poet, *Studies in Classic American Literature (1923), Ch. VII, "Nathaniel Hawthorne and 'The Scarlet Letter'", Ch. VII, opening*; public domain). Genre lens: test "parable" against the rose bush at the prison door. *Objective:* Analyze genre (romance vs. parable) from the opening chapter. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.5

Teacher only · spoilers

A crowd of bearded men and hooded women waits before the heavy, iron-studded door of the Boston prison. The narrator notes that every new colony soon needs a cemetery and a prison. Beside the door grows a wild rose-bush, which he offers to the reader as a symbol of some sweet moral blossom in a dark tale.

**Background:** Boston was founded in 1630; the story begins in the 1640s, when the prison was already one of the oldest buildings. Some legends linked the rose-bush to Anne Hutchinson, a religious dissenter banished in 1638.

**Significance:** The brief chapter frames the novel as a struggle between punishment and mercy.

### *Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Can any society be perfect? What does even an ideal community need? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to sin and guilt because....*
> **Prompt:** Can any society be perfect? What does even an ideal community need?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to sin and guilt because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: ironwork — iron parts or fittings; symbolize — stand as a sign or symbol of; intermixed — mixed together; timbered — built or reinforced with heavy wooden beams; inauspicious — suggesting bad luck to come; unpromising. "ironwork": Origin: an English formation from iron + -work. "symbolize": Origin: Middle French symboliser.*
**Words:** ironwork: iron parts or fittings · symbolize: stand as a sign or symbol of · intermixed: mixed together · timbered: built or reinforced with heavy wooden beams · inauspicious: suggesting bad luck to come; unpromising

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Boston was founded in 1630; the story begins in the 1640s, when the prison was already one of the oldest buildings. Some legends linked the rose-bush to Anne Hutchinson, a religious dissenter banished in 1638. The brief chapter frames the novel as a struggle between punishment and mercy. Setting: The prison door, "heavy oak," studded with iron, and the grass-plot of weeds before it in early Boston. Symbolism: The wild rose-bush beside the door, offered as "some sweet moral blossom." Foreshadowing: The narrator says the founders of every utopia soon need a cemetery and a prison. Watch for the rose-bush: Nature's possible kindness to the condemned.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it..." slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator says that whatever ideal society the founders imagined, they soon set aside land for a graveyard and a prison. Next, craft. I notice the irony of setting "Utopia of human virtue and happiness" against "cemetery" and "prison" in one sentence. The strongest word is "Utopia": it names the perfect society the Puritans hoped for, and the rest of the sentence undercuts it. Then, effect. Why does the narrator say every new colony first builds a cemetery and a prison? My answer: The narrator says every new colony first builds a cemetery and a prison because even a community built on virtue must deal with death and sin; this sets up the prison door Hester walks out of.*

> *The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical necessities to allot a portion of the virgin soil as a cemetery, and another portion as the site of a prison (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it…" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator says that whatever ideal society the founders imagined, they soon set aside land for a graveyard and a prison. Next, craft. I notice the irony of setting "Utopia of human virtue and happiness" against "cemetery" and "prison" in one sentence. The strongest word is "Utopia": it names the perfect society the Puritans hoped for, and the rest of the sentence undercuts it. Then, effect. Why does the narrator say every new colony first builds a cemetery and a prison? My answer: The narrator says every new colony first builds a cemetery and a prison because even a community built on virtue must deal with death and sin; this sets up the prison door Hester walks out of.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Even an ideal society plans for death and crime at once. Expected link: irony; the Puritans' utopia. Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt? Expected: The colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. (The prison as an image.)*

> *the black flower of civilized society, a prison (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Even an ideal society plans for death and crime at once. Expected link: irony; the Puritans' utopia.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to sin and guilt?
**Expected answer:** The colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. (The prison as an image.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the prison door and the rose? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how I: The Prison-Door develops the idea of the prison door and the rose. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. When the text says "the black flower of civilized society, a prison" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2), it shows this directly. The prison is "the black flower of civilized society," but beside it grows a rose-bush that may "symbolize some sweet moral blossom."*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the prison door and the rose? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how I: The Prison-Door develops the idea of the prison door and the rose. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. When the text says "the black flower of civilized society, a prison" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2), it shows this directly. The prison is "the black flower of civilized society," but beside it grows a rose-bush that may "symbolize some sweet moral blossom."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Can any society be perfect? What does even an ideal community need? Ask: is the narrator on the side of the prison or the rose? How can you tell?*
**Anchor question:** Can any society be perfect? What does even an ideal community need?
**Facilitation:** Ask: is the narrator on the side of the prison or the rose? How can you tell?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the prison door and the rose? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. (“the black flower of civilized society, a prison”, I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the prison door and the rose? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. (“the black flower of civilized society, a prison”, I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how setting shapes the prison door and the rose. Key takeaway: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Setting:** The prison door, "heavy oak," studded with iron, and the grass-plot of weeds before it in early Boston.
- **Symbolism:** The wild rose-bush beside the door, offered as "some sweet moral blossom."
- **Foreshadowing:** The narrator says the founders of every utopia soon need a cemetery and a prison.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **sin and guilt:** the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the rose-bush:** Nature's possible kindness to the condemned.

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical necessities to allot a portion of the virgin soil as a cemetery, and another portion as the site of a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2) The opening irony about utopias.
- “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2) The prison as an image.
- “It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 3) The rose-bush as hope.

### Model claim-evidence-reasoning

**Claim:** The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment.
**Evidence:** "the black flower of civilized society, a prison" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2)
**Reasoning:** The prison is "the black flower of civilized society," but beside it grows a rose-bush that may "symbolize some sweet moral blossom."

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **ironwork** (noun) | iron parts or fittings | *The rust on the ponderous ironwork of its oaken door looked more antique than anything else in the New World.* | "ironwork": Origin: an English formation from iron + -work. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/ironwork#Etymology) |
| **symbolize** (verb) | stand as a sign or symbol of | *It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow.* | "symbolize": Origin: Middle French symboliser. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/symbolize#Etymology) |
| **intermixed** (adjective) | mixed together | *A throng of bearded men, in sad-colored garments, and gray, steeple-crowned hats, intermixed with women, some wearing hoods and others bareheaded, was assembled in front of a wooden edifice, the door of which was heavily timbered with oak, and studded with iron spikes.* | |
| **timbered** (adjective) | built or reinforced with heavy wooden beams | *A throng of bearded men, in sad-colored garments, and gray, steeple-crowned hats, intermixed with women, some wearing hoods and others bareheaded, was assembled in front of a wooden edifice, the door of which was heavily timbered with oak, and studded with iron spikes.* | |
| **inauspicious** (adjective) | suggesting bad luck to come; unpromising | *Finding it so directly on the threshold of our narrative, which is now about to issue from that inauspicious portal, we could hardly do otherwise than pluck one of its flowers, and present it to the reader.* | |
| **pertains** (verb) | belongs or relates (to) | *Like all that pertains to crime, it seemed never to have known a youthful era.* | |
| **frailty** (noun) | moral weakness | *It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | *along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow.* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Can any society be perfect? What does even an ideal community need?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with hypocrisy and truth?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

**Literal / recall**

1. How is the prison door described? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Heavy oak, studded with iron spikes.
2. What stands before the crowd? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The prison door
3. What grows beside the door? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A wild rose-bush
4. According to the narrator, what do new colonies soon need? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A cemetery and a prison
5. Whose footsteps may the rose-bush have sprung from, the narrator says? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Anne Hutchinson's
6. What does the narrator hope the rose may symbolize? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Some sweet moral blossom
7. Retell the three most important events of "I: The Prison-Door" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A crowd of bearded men and hooded women waits before the heavy, iron-studded door of the Boston prison. The narrator notes that every new colony soon needs a cemetery and a prison. Beside the door grows a wild rose-bush, which he offers to the reader as a symbol of some sweet moral blossom in a dark tale.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "I: The Prison-Door"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "I: The Prison-Door" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "The rust on the ponderous ironwork of its oaken door looked more antique than anything else in the New World." What does "ironwork" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: ironwork: iron parts or fittings.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why mention Anne Hutchinson? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: She was a woman who defied Puritan authority, like Hester.
2. What does “I: The Prison-Door” suggest about the prison door and the rose? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The brief chapter frames the novel as a struggle between punishment and mercy.
3. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about the prison door and the rose? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: “The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical necessities to allot a portion o” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The opening irony about utopias. On symbolism: The wild rose-bush beside the door, offered as "some sweet moral blossom." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “A throng of bearded men, in sad-colored garments, and gray, steeple-crowned hats, intermixed with women, some wearing hoods and others bareheaded, was assembled in front of a…”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “I: The Prison-Door”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A crowd of bearded men and hooded women waits before the heavy, iron-studded door of the Boston prison. The narrator notes that every new colony soon needs a cemetery and a prison. Beside the door grows a wild rose-bush, which he offers to the reader as a symbol of some sweet moral blossom in a…
7. How does “I: The Prison-Door” build on “The Customhouse”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The prison as an image. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: “It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow” (I: The

Prison-Door, paragraph 3): The rose-bush as hope. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: "Can any society be perfect? What does even an ideal community need?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with hypocrisy and truth? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: "The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical necessities to allot a portion o" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The opening irony about utopias. On foreshadowing: The narrator says the founders of every utopia soon need a cemetery and a prison. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is the narrator on the side of the prison or the rose? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned reading with evidence from tone.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: "the black flower of civilized society, a prison" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The prison as an image. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "The brief chapter frames the novel as a struggle between punishment and mercy." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: "It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 3): The rose-bush as hope. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: "The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical necessities to allot a portion o" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The opening irony about utopias. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “I: The Prison-Door” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the prison door and the rose? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The prison as an image. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “I: The Prison-Door”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: “It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 3): The rose-bush as hope. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to nature and the individual against society: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: “The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical necessities to allot a portion o” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The opening irony about utopias. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The prison as an image. On setting: The prison door, "heavy oak," studded with iron, and the grass-plot of weeds before it in early Boston. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “I: The Prison-Door” treats the prison door and the rose with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: “It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 3): The rose-bush as hope. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “II: The Marketplace” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: “The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical necessities to allot a portion o” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The opening irony about utopias. On foreshadowing: The narrator says the founders of every utopia soon need a cemetery and a prison. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the prison door and the rose? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The prison as an image. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human _____ and sorrow.” Word bank: intermixed, ironwork, frailty, symbolize
   Key: frailty
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] According to the narrator, what do new colonies soon need?
   A. A school and a church
   B. A cemetery and a prison
   C. A market
   D. A fort

   Key: B (A cemetery and a prison)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The rust on the ponderous ironwork of its oaken door looked more antique than anything else in the New World.”, what does “ironwork” most nearly mean?
   A. lacking curiosity (here 'not incurious' means quite curious)
   B. too deep to be explored or understood
   C. iron parts or fittings
   D. the state of being guilty

Key: C (iron parts or fittings)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2: “The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical _____ to allot a portion of the virgin soil as a cemetery, and another portion as the site of a prison”

   Key: necessities

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “A throng of bearded men, in sad-colored garments, and gray, steeple-crowned hats, intermixed with women, some wearing hoods and others bareheaded, was assembled in front of a wooden edifice, the door of which was…”, what does “timbered” most nearly mean?

   A. an unhealthy gloominess of mind

   B. built or reinforced with heavy wooden beams

   C. nearness; closeness

   D. returned (a feeling or gesture)

   Key: B (built or reinforced with heavy wooden beams)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “A throng of bearded men, in sad-colored garments, and gray, steeple-crowned hats, intermixed with women, some wearing hoods and others bareheaded, was assembled in front of a wooden edifice, the door of which was…”, what does “intermixed” most nearly mean?

   A. unpredictable and odd

   B. gripping tightly

   C. mixed together

   D. an unhealthy gloominess of mind

   Key: C (mixed together)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What stands before the crowd?

   A. The governor's house

   B. The forest

   C. The prison door

   D. A church

   Key: C (The prison door)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow.”, what does “symbolize” most nearly mean?

   A. stand as a sign or symbol of

   B. lacking curiosity (here 'not incurious' means quite curious)

   C. nearness; being next to

   D. shakily, nervously

   Key: A (stand as a sign or symbol of)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Finding it so directly on the threshold of our narrative, which is now about to issue from that _____ portal, we could hardly do otherwise than pluck one of its flowers, and present it to the reader.” Word bank: ironwork, intermixed,

inauspicious, symbolize

Key: inauspicious

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The prison as an image.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical necessities to allot a portion of the virgin soil as a cemetery, and another portion as the…” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2)

    A. Pearl's reply.

    B. The townspeople's suspicion.

    C. The opening irony about utopias.

    D. The mirror in the armor.

    Key: C (The opening irony about utopias.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 3)

    A. Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing.

    B. The rose-bush as hope.

    C. Mistress Hibbins to Pearl.

    D. Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.

    Key: B (The rose-bush as hope.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “I: The Prison-Door”?

    A. The elf-child and the minister

    B. The prison door and the rose

    C. A flood of sunshine

    D. Hester on the scaffold

    Key: B (The prison door and the rose)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “I: The Prison-Door”? The wild rose-bush beside the door, offered as "some sweet moral blossom."

    A. Foreshadowing

    B. Symbolism

    C. Personification

    D. Irony

    Key: B (Symbolism)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2).

    Sample answer: The prison is "the black flower of civilized society," but beside it grows a rose-bush that may "symbolize some sweet moral blossom."

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: The prison is "the black flower of civilized society," but beside it grows a rose-bush that may "symbolize some sweet moral blossom."
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the narrator hope the rose may symbolize?
    A. Wealth
    B. Some sweet moral blossom
    C. Death
    D. War

    Key: B (Some sweet moral blossom)
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whose footsteps may the rose-bush have sprung from, the narrator says?
    A. Winthrop's
    B. Anne Hutchinson's
    C. Pearl's
    D. Hester's

    Key: B (Anne Hutchinson's)
19. [short · recall · DOK 1] How is the prison door described?
    Sample answer: Heavy oak, studded with iron spikes.
20. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Like all that _____ to crime, it seemed never to have known a youthful era.” Word bank: intermixed, symbolize, pertains, ironwork
    Key: pertains
21. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why mention Anne Hutchinson?
    Sample answer: She was a woman who defied Puritan authority, like Hester.
22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail.
    A. Hypocrisy and truth
    B. Sin and guilt
    C. Public shame and private identity
    D. Nature and the individual against society

    Key: B (Sin and guilt)
23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 3). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The rose-bush as hope.
24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The prison as an image.
25. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical necessities to allot a portion of the virgin soil as a cemetery, and…” (I: The Prison-

Door, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The opening irony about utopias.

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “I: The Prison-Door”? The prison door, "heavy oak," studded with iron, and the grass-plot of weeds before it in early Boston.

    A. Alliteration

    B. Setting

    C. Metaphor

    D. Plot

    Key: B (Setting)

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is the narrator on the side of the prison or the rose? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned reading with evidence from tone.

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2: “the black flower of _____ society, a prison”

    Key: civilized

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What grows beside the door?

    A. A lily

    B. Black weeds

    C. A wild rose-bush

    D. An oak tree

    Key: C (A wild rose-bush)

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how sin and guilt develops from an earlier chapter to “I: The Prison-Door”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 3: “It may serve, let us hope, to _____ some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow”

    Key: symbolize

32. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2)

    A. The prison as an image.

    B. The rose-bush as hope.

    C. Hawthorne refuses to revise.

    D. The opening irony about utopias.

    Key: A (The prison as an image.)

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical necessities to allot a portion of the virgin soil as a cemetery, and…” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The opening irony about utopias.

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 1, 9, 8, 17, 18, 19, 7, 20, 11, 10, 21, 12, 22, 23, 15, 24 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 20, 17, 19, 9, 5, 7, 25, 13, 12, 11, 21, 22, 26, 15, 27, 24 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 4, 28, 29, 9, 8, 11, 10, 25, 13, 21, 23, 14, 22, 26, 24, 30 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 6, 1, 19, 20, 21, 10, 13, 12, 11, 23, 15, 14, 22, 30, 16, 24 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 17, 31, 4, 25, 32, 13, 10, 14, 26, 15, 23, 22, 30, 16, 33, 27 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 9, 20, 5, 10, 13, 25, 32, 26, 14, 23, 15, 22, 30, 16, 33, 24 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 1, 9, 11, 10, 12, 25, 22, 26, 15, 14, 23, 33, 16, 24, 27, 30 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 9, 20, 32, 12, 21, 10, 26, 15, 14, 22, 23, 16, 33, 30, 27, 24 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 1, 9, 12, 10, 13, 11, 14, 15, 22, 23, 26, 16, 33, 30, 24, 27 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 9, 20, 13, 11, 21, 12, 26, 15, 23, 22, 14, 30, 24, 16, 33, 27 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “I: The Prison-Door,” how does Hawthorne show the prison door and the rose? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In I: The Prison-Door, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the prison door and the rose? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how I: The Prison-Door develops the idea of the prison door and the rose. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of I: The Prison-Door (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the prison door and the rose. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what I: The Prison-Door suggests about the prison door and the rose. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses setting in I: The Prison-Door to complicate the reader's understanding of the prison door and the rose. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate I: The Prison-Door within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the prison door and the rose responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read I: The Prison-Door alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the prison door and the rose follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to I: The Prison-Door and its treatment of the prison door and the rose. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads I: The Prison-Door as evidence for a larger claim about the prison door and the rose in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads I: The Prison-Door as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the prison door and the rose. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *A throng of bearded men, in sad-colored garments, and gray, steeple-crowned hats, intermixed with women, some wearing hoods and others bareheaded, was assembled in front of a wooden edifice, the door of which was heavily timbered with oak, and studded with iron spikes.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “intermixed” most nearly mean?

   A. mixed together

   B. suggesting bad luck to come; unpromising

   C. belongs or relates (to)

   D. moral weakness

2. *A throng of bearded men, in sad-colored garments, and gray, steeple-crowned hats, intermixed with women, some wearing hoods and others bareheaded, was assembled in front of a wooden edifice, the door of which was heavily timbered with oak, and studded with iron spikes.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "I: The Prison-Door"?

A. The prison door and the rose
B. The frame narrative and the found letter
C. The interior of a heart
D. The child at the brook-side

**SAT key:** 1. A (mixed together); 2. A (The prison door and the rose)

# Lesson 5: II: The Marketplace

**Focus:** Hester on the scaffold

**Objective:** Students will analyze how characterization develops in “II: The Marketplace” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

**Critical voice:** “You _must_ look through the surface of American art, and see the inner diabolism of the symbolic meaning. Otherwise it is all mere childishness.” (D. H. Lawrence, novelist and poet, *Studies in Classic American Literature (1923), Ch. VII, "Nathaniel Hawthorne and 'The Scarlet Letter'", Ch. VII*; public domain). Two-column notes: surface meaning / "inner" meaning of the A in Chapter II. *Objective:* Analyze symbolism on the scaffold in the market-place. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.4

**Content note (public shaming, adultery (implied), alcohol or drugs (mentioned)):** Hester is publicly shamed for adultery while holding her baby; women in the crowd call for branding or death. Keep focus on judgment and community; some students may have experienced public shaming online. This section mentions drinking or a drug (“…sex. They were her countrywomen; and the beef and ale of their native land, with a moral diet…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
**Student preview:** A woman is publicly shamed by a crowd in this chapter.
**Suggested language:** “Is the crowd's judgment justice or cruelty?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Hester Prynne leaves the prison carrying her three-month-old baby, with a scarlet A elaborately embroidered in gold thread on her dress. Harsh women in the crowd say she deserves branding or death. She stands on the scaffold for three hours, remembering her past in England and her marriage to an older scholar, and clutches the baby to her breast.

**Background:** Puritan Massachusetts punished moral offenses in public: whipping, the stocks and the pillory, sometimes letters sewn to clothing. Shame was meant to reform the sinner and warn the community.

**Significance:** Hester turns her badge of shame into a work of art and meets the crowd with dignity.

## *Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*What does it feel like to be stared at by a crowd that has already judged you? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to public shame and private identity because.... Content note before we start: A woman is publicly shamed by a crowd in this chapter.*
**Prompt:** What does it feel like to be stared at by a crowd that has already judged you?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to public shame and private identity because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: farthingale — a hooped frame worn under a skirt to make it stand out; goodwife — a title for a married woman of ordinary rank (Mrs.); rankles — keeps causing bitter pain; phantasmagoric — like a shifting series of dreamlike images; rotundity — fullness and roundness (here, of bold, loud speech). "rankles": Origin of "rankle": Old French rancler; earlier Latin dracunculus ("little serpent"). "rotundity": Origin: Latin rotunditas.*
**Words:** farthingale: a hooped frame worn under a skirt to make it stand out · goodwife: a title for a married woman of ordinary rank (Mrs.) · rankles: keeps causing bitter pain · phantasmagoric: like a shifting series of dreamlike images · rotundity: fullness and roundness (here, of bold, loud speech)

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Puritan Massachusetts punished moral offenses in public: whipping, the stocks and the pillory, sometimes letters sewn to clothing. Shame was meant to reform the sinner and warn the community. Hester turns her badge of shame into a work of art and meets the crowd with dignity. Characterization: Hester emerges with dignity, the letter "fantastically embroidered," refusing to shrink. Imagery: The crowd of hard-featured women, the scaffold, the baby blinking in the sunlight. Allusion: The narrator compares Hester with a picture of the Madonna, then reverses the comparison. Watch for the scarlet letter: "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold thread, appeared the letter A."*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared..." slowly and put it in my own words: On Hester's dress appears the letter A in fine red cloth, surrounded by elaborate embroidery and gold flourishes. Next, craft. I notice the long list of rich decorative details, which make the badge of shame look beautiful. The strongest word is "elaborate": it shows Hester has made her punishment into an artwork. Then, effect. Why is the letter described in such loving detail? My answer: The letter is described in such loving detail because Hester has turned the sign meant to shame her into a display of skill and defiance; the crowd is shocked that she will not look humbled.*

> *On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared…" slowly and put it in my own words: On Hester's dress appears the letter A in fine red cloth, surrounded by elaborate embroidery and gold flourishes. Next, craft. I notice the long list of rich decorative details, which make the badge of shame look beautiful. The strongest word is "elaborate": it shows Hester has made her punishment into an artwork. Then, effect. Why is the letter described in such loving detail? My answer: The letter is described in such loving detail because Hester has turned the sign meant to shame her into a display of skill and defiance; the crowd is shocked that she will not look humbled.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The harshest woman in the crowd. Look at the craft: The crowd of hard-featured women, the scaffold, the baby blinking in the sunlight. Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity? Expected: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. (The harshest woman in the crowd.)*

> *This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** The harshest woman in the crowd. Look at the craft: The crowd of hard-featured women, the scaffold, the baby blinking in the sunlight.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to public shame and private identity?
**Expected answer:** Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. (The harshest woman in the crowd.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Hester on the scaffold? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how II: The Marketplace develops the idea of Hester on the scaffold. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. When the text says “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. Instead of a plain badge she wears a letter with "fantastic flourishes of gold thread," and it has "the effect of a spell" that sets her "in a sphere by herself."*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Hester on the scaffold? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how II: The Marketplace develops the idea of Hester on the scaffold. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. When the text says “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. Instead of a plain badge she wears a letter with "fantastic flourishes of gold thread," and it has "the effect of a spell" that sets her "in a sphere by herself."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: What does it feel like to be stared at by a crowd that has already judged you? Compare the women in the crowd: the harsh "matrons" and the young wife who shows pity. Who is the narrator's voice closest to?*
**Anchor question:** What does it feel like to be stared at by a crowd that has already judged you?
**Facilitation:** Compare the women in the crowd: the harsh "matrons" and the young wife who shows pity. Who is the narrator's voice closest to?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Hester on the scaffold? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. ("It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself", II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Hester on the scaffold? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. ("It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself", II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes Hester on the scaffold. Key takeaway: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Hester emerges with dignity, the letter "fantastically embroidered," refusing to shrink.
- **Imagery:** The crowd of hard-featured women, the scaffold, the baby blinking in the sunlight.
- **Allusion:** The narrator compares Hester with a picture of the Madonna, then reverses the comparison.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **public shame and private identity:** Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the scarlet letter:** "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold thread, appeared the letter A."

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10) First description of the letter.
- "This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7) The harshest woman in the crowd.
- "It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11) The letter isolates Hester.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity.
**Evidence:** "It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11)
**Reasoning:** Instead of a plain badge she wears a letter with "fantastic flourishes of gold thread," and it has "the effect of a spell" that sets her "in a sphere by herself."

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **farthingale** (noun) | a hooped frame worn under a skirt to make it stand out | *The age had not so much refinement, that any sense of impropriety restrained the wearers of petticoat and farthingale from stepping forth into the public ways, and wedging their not unsubstantial persons, if occasion were, into the throng nearest to the scaffold at an execution.* | |
| **goodwife** (noun) | a title for a married woman of ordinary rank (Mrs.) | *"Mercy on us, goodwife," exclaimed a man in the crowd, "is there no virtue in woman, save what springs from a wholesome fear of the gallows?* | |
| **rankles** (verb) | keeps causing bitter pain | *In our nature, however, there is a provision, alike marvellous and merciful, that the sufferer should never know the intensity of what he endures by its present torture, but chiefly by the pang that rankles after it.* | "rankles": Origin of "rankle": Old French rancler; earlier Latin dracunculus ("little serpent"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/rankle#Etymology) |
| **phantasmagoric** (adjective) | like a shifting series of dreamlike images | *Possibly, it was an instinctive device of her spirit, to relieve itself, by the exhibition of these phantasmagoric forms, from the cruel weight and hardness of the reality.* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **rotundity** (noun) | fullness and roundness (here, of bold, loud speech) | *There was, moreover, a boldness and rotundity of speech among these matrons, as most of them seemed to be, that would startle us at the present day, whether in respect to its purport or its volume of tone.* | "rotundity": Origin: Latin rotunditas. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/rotundity#Etymology) |
| **transgressor** (noun) | a person who breaks a law or moral rule | *Meagre, indeed, and cold was the sympathy that a transgressor might look for, from such bystanders, at the scaffold.* | "transgressor": Origin: Anglo-Norman transgressour; earlier Latin transgressor. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/transgressor#Etymology) |
| **visaged** (adjective) | having a face of a certain kind | *Preceded by the beadle, and attended by an irregular procession of stern-browed men and unkindly visaged women, Hester Prynne set forth towards the place appointed for her punishment.* | "visaged": Origin: an English formation from visage + -ed. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/visaged#Etymology) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. What does it feel like to be stared at by a crowd that has already judged you?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature and the individual against society?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

**Literal / recall**

1. Where did Hester live before Boston? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In England and then Amsterdam, with her older husband.
2. What letter does Hester wear? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A
3. What does Hester carry? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Her baby
4. How is the letter made? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Embroidered in red with gold thread
5. What do the harshest women want? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A heavier punishment, even death
6. How long must Hester stand on the scaffold? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Three hours

7. Retell the three most important events of "II: The Marketplace" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hester Prynne leaves the prison carrying her three-month-old baby, with a scarlet A elaborately embroidered in gold thread on her dress. Harsh women in the crowd say she deserves branding or death. She stands on the scaffold for three hours, remembering her past in England and her marriage to an older scholar, and clutches the baby to her breast.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "II: The Marketplace"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "II: The Marketplace" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "The age had not so much refinement, that any sense of impropriety restrained the wearers of petticoat and farthingale from stepping forth into the public ways, and wedging their not unsubstantial persons, if occasion…" What does "farthingale" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: farthingale: a hooped frame worn under a skirt to make it stand out.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does the narrator compare Hester with the Madonna? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: To contrast a sacred image of motherhood with a sinner, and to stir sympathy.
2. What does "II: The Marketplace" suggest about Hester on the scaffold? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Hester turns her badge of shame into a work of art and meets the crowd with dignity.
3. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the imagery in this chapter shape what we understand about Hester on the scaffold? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10): First description of the letter. On imagery: The crowd of hard-featured women, the scaffold, the baby blinking in the sunlight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins ""Mercy on us, goodwife,"", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "II: The Marketplace", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Hester Prynne leaves the prison carrying her three-month-old baby, with a scarlet A elaborately embroidered in gold thread on her dress. Harsh women in the crowd say she deserves branding or death. She stands on the scaffold for three hours, remembering her past in England and her marriage to an…

7. How does “II: The Marketplace” build on “I: The Prison-Door”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7): The harshest woman in the crowd. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11): The letter isolates Hester. On characterization: Hester emerges with dignity, the letter "fantastically embroidered," refusing to shrink. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What does it feel like to be stared at by a crowd that has already judged you?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature and the individual against society? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10): First description of the letter. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is the crowd's judgment justice or cruelty? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned position using the women's speeches and the narrator's comments.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7): The harshest woman in the crowd. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Hester turns her badge of shame into a work of art and meets the crowd with dignity.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of

identity. Useful evidence: “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11): The letter isolates Hester. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10): First description of the letter. On characterization: Hester emerges with dignity, the letter "fantastically embroidered," refusing to shrink. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “II: The Marketplace” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about Hester on the scaffold? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7): The harshest woman in the crowd. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “II: The Marketplace”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11): The letter isolates Hester. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to women and independence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10): First description of the letter. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7): The harshest woman in the crowd. On characterization: Hester emerges with dignity, the letter "fantastically embroidered," refusing to shrink. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “II: The Marketplace” treats Hester on the scaffold with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11): The letter isolates Hester. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “III: The Recognition” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10): First description of the letter. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Hester on the scaffold? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7): The harshest woman in the crowd. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “There was, moreover, a boldness and _____ of speech among these matrons, as most of them seemed to be, that would startle us at the present day, whether in respect to its purport or its volume of tone.” Word bank: rotundity, farthingale,

goodwife, rankles

Key: rotundity

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10: "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, _____ with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A"

   Key: surrounded

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What letter does Hester wear?

   A. H

   B. S

   C. P

   D. A

   Key: D (A)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "The age had not so much refinement, that any sense of impropriety restrained the wearers of petticoat and farthingale from stepping forth into the public ways, and wedging their not unsubstantial persons, if occasion…", what does "farthingale" most nearly mean?

   A. a hooped frame worn under a skirt to make it stand out

   B. the system of coats of arms

   C. removed or done away with

   D. devilish

   Key: A (a hooped frame worn under a skirt to make it stand out)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Hester carry?

   A. A rose

   B. A candle

   C. A Bible

   D. Her baby

   Key: D (Her baby)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How is the letter made?

   A. Branded on her skin

   B. Carved in wood

   C. Painted on her door

   D. Embroidered in red with gold thread

   Key: D (Embroidered in red with gold thread)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What do the harshest women want?

   A. Her freedom

   B. Mercy

   C. A trial

   D. A heavier punishment, even death

   Key: D (A heavier punishment, even death)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “In our nature, however, there is a provision, alike marvellous and merciful, that the sufferer should never know the intensity of what he endures by its present torture, but chiefly by the pang that rankles after it.”, what does “rankles” most nearly mean?

    A. keeps causing bitter pain

    B. able to be measured or predicted

    C. lights up

    D. built or reinforced with heavy wooden beams

    Key: A (keeps causing bitter pain)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How long must Hester stand on the scaffold?

    A. A week

    B. Three hours

    C. Ten minutes

    D. One day

    Key: B (Three hours)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10)

    A. Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.

    B. The sexton's reading of the sign.

    C. First description of the letter.

    D. Nature's response.

    Key: C (First description of the letter.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7)

    A. Hester's defense.

    B. Chillingworth's defeat.

    C. Hester's plea.

    D. The harshest woman in the crowd.

    Key: D (The harshest woman in the crowd.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does the narrator compare Hester with the Madonna?

    Sample answer: To contrast a sacred image of motherhood with a sinner, and to stir sympathy.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: First description of the letter.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art.

    A. Public shame and private identity

    B. Hypocrisy and truth

    C. Nature and the individual against society

D. Sin and guilt

Key: A (Public shame and private identity)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: The letter isolates Hester.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: The harshest woman in the crowd.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Preceded by the beadle, and attended by an irregular procession of stern-browed men and unkindly _____ women, Hester Prynne set forth towards the place appointed for her punishment.” Word bank: farthingale, visaged, rankles, goodwife
Key: visaged

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7: “This woman has _____ shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it”
Key: brought

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Meagre, indeed, and cold was the sympathy that a _____ might look for, from such bystanders, at the scaffold.” Word bank: goodwife, farthingale, transgressor, rankles
Key: transgressor

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11: “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary _____ with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself”
Key: relations

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11)

A. The confession begins.

B. Pearl's question.

C. The letter isolates Hester.

D. The chapter's contrast.

Key: C (The letter isolates Hester.)

22. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The harshest woman in the crowd.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11).
Sample answer: Instead of a plain badge she wears a letter with "fantastic flourishes of gold thread," and it has "the effect of a spell" that sets her "in a sphere by herself."

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “II: The Marketplace”? Hester emerges with dignity, the letter "fantastically embroidered," refusing to shrink.
    A. Hyperbole
    B. Imagery
    C. Conflict
    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Instead of a plain badge she wears a letter with "fantastic flourishes of gold thread," and it has "the effect of a spell" that sets her "in a sphere by herself."

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Possibly, it was an instinctive device of her spirit, to relieve itself, by the exhibition of these phantasmagoric forms, from the cruel weight and hardness of the reality.”, what does “phantasmagoric” most nearly mean?
    A. serving as a symbol
    B. the act of committing (a crime)
    C. a slave; one bound to serve
    D. like a shifting series of dreamlike images

    Key: D (like a shifting series of dreamlike images)

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line ““Mercy on us, goodwife,” exclaimed a man in the crowd, “is there no virtue in woman, save what springs from a wholesome fear of the gallows?”, what does “goodwife” most nearly mean?
    A. promising solemnly
    B. coldness
    C. a title for a married woman of ordinary rank (Mrs.)
    D. not valued or loved

    Key: C (a title for a married woman of ordinary rank (Mrs.))

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “II: The Marketplace”?
    A. Hester on the scaffold
    B. The interview in prison
    C. The procession
    D. The minister in a maze

    Key: A (Hester on the scaffold)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: First description of the letter.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is the crowd's judgment justice or cruelty? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned position using the women's speeches and the narrator's comments.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in "II: The Marketplace"? The crowd of hard-featured women, the scaffold, the baby blinking in the sunlight.

    A. Personification

    B. Diction / vocabulary

    C. Imagery

    D. Setting

    Key: C (Imagery)

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from an earlier chapter to "II: The Marketplace". Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art.

33. [short · recall · DOK 1] Where did Hester live before Boston?

    Sample answer: In England and then Amsterdam, with her older husband.

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 1, 7, 17, 18, 19, 20, 2, 9, 21, 10, 12, 22, 15, 23, 24, 25 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 19, 5, 4, 26, 27, 1, 11, 10, 28, 12, 13, 15, 24, 14, 29, 30 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 26, 27, 18, 17, 1, 10, 28, 22, 13, 21, 24, 31, 23, 14, 30, 25 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 1, 19, 8, 3, 12, 13, 10, 11, 28, 24, 15, 23, 31, 29, 32, 16 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 19, 1, 33, 12, 11, 10, 13, 24, 31, 15, 23, 14, 29, 32, 30, 25 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 1, 19, 6, 21, 12, 11, 22, 15, 23, 24, 14, 31, 16, 30, 25, 32 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 1, 19, 21, 11, 12, 22, 14, 23, 15, 31, 24, 16, 25, 29, 30, 32 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 1, 19, 28, 21, 22, 10, 23, 14, 24, 15, 31, 32, 30, 25, 16, 29 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 1, 19, 13, 10, 28, 12, 14, 23, 24, 31, 15, 29, 25, 30, 16, 32 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 1, 19, 28, 10, 12, 21, 23, 15, 14, 24, 31, 30, 32, 25, 29, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "II: The Marketplace," how does Hawthorne show Hester on the scaffold? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In II: The Marketplace, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of Hester on the scaffold? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how II: The Marketplace develops the idea of Hester on the scaffold. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of II: The Marketplace (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Hester on the scaffold. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what II: The Marketplace suggests about Hester on the scaffold. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses characterization in II: The Marketplace to complicate the reader's understanding of Hester on the scaffold. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate II: The Marketplace within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of Hester on the scaffold responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read II: The Marketplace alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of Hester on the scaffold follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to II: The Marketplace and its treatment of Hester on the scaffold. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads II: The Marketplace as evidence for a larger claim about Hester on the scaffold in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads II: The Marketplace as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of Hester on the scaffold. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *In our nature, however, there is a provision, alike marvellous and merciful, that the sufferer should never know the intensity of what he endures by its present torture, but chiefly by the pang that rankles after it.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "rankles" most nearly mean?

   A. fullness and roundness (here, of bold, loud speech)

   B. keeps causing bitter pain

   C. having a face of a certain kind

   D. a person who breaks a law or moral rule

2. *"Mercy on us, goodwife," exclaimed a man in the crowd, "is there no virtue in woman, save what springs from a wholesome fear of the gallows? That is the hardest word yet! Hush, now, gossips! for the lock is turning in the prison-door, and here comes Mistress Prynne herself."*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "II: The Marketplace"?

   A. The prison door and the rose

   B. The minister in a maze

   C. Hester at her needle

   D. Hester on the scaffold

**SAT key:** 1. B (keeps causing bitter pain); 2. D (Hester on the scaffold)

# Lesson 6: III: The Recognition

**Focus:** the recognition

**Objective:** Students will analyze how irony develops in “III: The Recognition” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Hester sees a small, deformed stranger at the edge of the crowd, dressed partly in Native clothing; he recognizes her and signals her to be silent. He learns her story from a townsman. The Reverend John Wilson and the young minister Arthur Dimmesdale urge Hester to name the child's father. Dimmesdale pleads with emotion, but Hester refuses, and Wilson preaches on sin while she endures.

**Background:** Ministers and magistrates shared authority in the colony; Governor Bellingham presided, and John Wilson was a real minister of the First Church of Boston.

**Significance:** Dramatic irony runs through Dimmesdale's plea once the reader knows the truth.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Why might someone protect a person who has wronged them? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to hypocrisy and truth because....*
**Prompt:** Why might someone protect a person who has wronged them?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to hypocrisy and truth because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: behooves — is right or necessary for; meetinghouse — a Puritan building used for worship and town meetings; disarray — untidy mixture or confusion; skullcap — a small, close-fitting cap; halberds — long spears with an axe blade, carried by guards. “disarray”: Origin: Middle English disareyen (“to disarray”); earlier Old French desareer.*
**Words:** behooves: is right or necessary for · meetinghouse: a Puritan building used for worship and town meetings · disarray: untidy mixture or confusion · skullcap: a small, close-fitting cap · halberds: long spears with an axe blade, carried by guards

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Ministers and magistrates shared authority in the colony; Governor Bellingham presided, and John Wilson was a real minister of the First Church of Boston. Dramatic irony runs through Dimmesdale's plea once the reader knows the truth. Characterization: A deformed, learned stranger in the crowd recognizes Hester and signals her to be silent. Irony: Dimmesdale, urged to make Hester name her partner, pleads with her to do it. Conflict: Hester refuses: "I will not speak!" Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "object of severe and universal observation, the wearer of the scarlet letter was at length relieved, by discerning, on the outskirts of" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 1).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "Speak, woman ... Speak; and give your child a father" slowly and put it in my own words: Dimmesdale urges Hester to speak and name the father of her child. Next, craft. I notice the repeated command "Speak," spoken by the very man who is the father. The strongest word is "father": it is the word that names his own secret. Then, effect. What is Dimmesdale asking of Hester in public, and why is it ironic? My answer: In public, Dimmesdale asks Hester to name her partner, and it is ironic because he is that partner; he asks her to reveal what he is too weak to confess, and her silence protects him.*

> *Speak, woman ... Speak; and give your child a father (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father" slowly and put it in my own words: Dimmesdale urges Hester to speak and name the father of her child. Next, craft. I notice the repeated command "Speak," spoken by the very man who is the father. The strongest word is "father": it is the word that names his own secret. Then, effect. What is Dimmesdale asking of Hester in public, and why is it ironic? My answer: In public, Dimmesdale asks Hester to name her partner, and it is ironic because he is that partner; he asks her to reveal what he is too weak to confess, and her silence protects him.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Hester wishes she could bear "his agony, as well as mine," showing she protects the father. Expected link: dramatic irony and hypocrisy and truth. Ask: How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth? Expected: The man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. (Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.)*

> *Never… It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Hester wishes she could bear "his agony, as well as mine," showing she protects the father. Expected link: dramatic irony and hypocrisy and truth.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth?
**Expected answer:** The man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. (Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the recognition? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how III: The Recognition develops the idea of the recognition. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. When the text says “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26), it shows this directly. He says it is better to stand "beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame" than "to hide a guilty heart through life," and Hester answers "I will not speak!"*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the recognition? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how III: The Recognition develops the idea of the recognition. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. When the text says “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26), it shows this directly. He says it is better to stand "beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame" than "to hide a guilty heart through life," and Hester answers "I will not speak!"

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Why might someone protect a person who has wronged them? On a second reading, which lines change meaning once you know who the father is?*
**Anchor question:** Why might someone protect a person who has wronged them?
**Facilitation:** On a second reading, which lines change meaning once you know who the father is?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the recognition? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. ("for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hid", III: The Recognition, paragraph 26). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the recognition? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. ("for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hid", III: The Recognition, paragraph 26). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes the recognition. Key takeaway: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Characterization:** A deformed, learned stranger in the crowd recognizes Hester and signals her to be silent.
- **Irony:** Dimmesdale, urged to make Hester name her partner, pleads with her to do it.
- **Conflict:** Hester refuses: "I will not speak!"

### Themes and how they develop

- **hypocrisy and truth:** the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects.

### Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter:

"object of severe and universal observation, the wearer of the scarlet letter was at length relieved, by discerning, on the outskirts of" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 1).

- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: "in the quiet gleam of the fireside, in the happy shadow of a home, or beneath a matronly veil, at church. Dreadful" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 15).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31) Mr. Wilson presses Hester.
- "I will not speak" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32) Hester's refusal.
- "Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30) Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.
- "for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26) Dimmesdale's double-edged plea.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment.
**Evidence:** "for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26)
**Reasoning:** He says it is better to stand "beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame" than "to hide a guilty heart through life," and Hester answers "I will not speak!"

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **behooves** (verb) | is right or necessary for | *"It behooves him well, if he be still in life," responded the townsman.* | |
| **meetinghouse** (noun) | a Puritan building used for worship and town meetings | *It has already been noticed, that directly over the platform on which Hester Prynne stood was a kind of balcony, or open gallery, appended to the meetinghouse.* | |
| **disarray** (noun) | untidy mixture or confusion | *By the Indian's side, and evidently sustaining a companionship with him, stood a white man, clad in a strange disarray of civilized and savage costume.* | "disarray": Origin: Middle English disareyen ("to disarray"); earlier Old French desareer. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/disarray#Etymology) |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **skullcap** (noun) | a small, close-fitting cap | *There he stood, with a border of grizzled locks beneath his skullcap; while his gray eyes, accustomed to the shaded light of his study, were winking, like those of Hester's infant, in the unadulterated sunshine.* | |
| **halberds** (noun) | long spears with an axe blade, carried by guards | *Here, to witness the scene which we are describing, sat Governor Bellingham himself, with four sergeants about his chair, bearing halberds, as a guard of honor.* | |
| **remorselessly** (adverb) | without pity, without stopping | *In this state, the voice of the preacher thundered remorselessly, but unavailingly, upon her ears.* | |
| **unadulterated** (adjective) | pure; not mixed with anything weaker | *There he stood, with a border of grizzled locks beneath his skullcap; while his gray eyes, accustomed to the shaded light of his study, were winking, like those of Hester's infant, in the unadulterated sunshine.* | |
| **tremulously** (adverb) | shakily, nervously | *The young pastor's voice was tremulously sweet, rich, deep, and broken.* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Why might someone protect a person who has wronged them?
2. Where does irony appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with women and independence?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What does the townsman say about Hester's husband? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He was a learned man who sent her ahead and never arrived; he may be lost at sea.
2. Who recognizes Hester from the crowd? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A deformed stranger

3. What does the stranger signal? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Silence
4. Who pleads with Hester to name the father? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Dimmesdale
5. What is Hester's answer? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She will not speak
6. Where has the stranger been held? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In captivity among Native people
7. Retell the three most important events of "III: The Recognition" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hester sees a small, deformed stranger at the edge of the crowd, dressed partly in Native clothing; he recognizes her and signals her to be silent. He learns her story from a townsman. The Reverend John Wilson and the young minister Arthur Dimmesdale urge Hester to name the child's father. Dimmesdale pleads with emotion, but Hester refuses, and Wilson preaches on sin while she endures.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "III: The Recognition"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "III: The Recognition" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: ""It behooves him well, if he be still in life," responded the townsman." What does "behooves" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: behooves: is right or necessary for.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why is Dimmesdale's plea ironic? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: He is the father, urging her to name him while he hides.
2. What does "III: The Recognition" suggest about the recognition? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Dramatic irony runs through Dimmesdale's plea once the reader knows the truth.
3. Find one example of irony in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the recognition? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: "Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31): Mr. Wilson presses Hester. On characterization: A deformed, learned stranger in the crowd recognizes Hester and signals her to be silent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "From this intense consciousness of being the object of severe and universal observation, the wearer of the scarlet letter was at length relieved, by discerning, on the outskirts…", why

might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “III: The Recognition”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Hester sees a small, deformed stranger at the edge of the crowd, dressed partly in Native clothing; he recognizes her and signals her to be silent. He learns her story from a townsman. The Reverend John Wilson and the young minister Arthur Dimmesdale urge Hester to name the child's father.…
7. How does “III: The Recognition” build on “II: The Marketplace”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “I will not speak” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32): Hester's refusal. Theme link: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30): Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth. On characterization: A deformed, learned stranger in the crowd recognizes Hester and signals her to be silent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might someone protect a person who has wronged them?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with women and independence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26): Dimmesdale's double-edged plea. On conflict: Hester refuses: "I will not speak!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Hester's silence admirable or harmful? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view weighing loyalty against truth.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31): Mr. Wilson presses Hester. Theme link: the man who begs her to speak is the

man she protects. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Dramatic irony runs through Dimmesdale's plea once the reader knows the truth.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “I will not speak” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32): Hester's refusal. Theme link: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30): Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth. On characterization: A deformed, learned stranger in the crowd recognizes Hester and signals her to be silent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “III: The Recognition” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the recognition? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26): Dimmesdale's double-edged plea. Theme link: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “III: The Recognition”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31): Mr. Wilson presses Hester. Theme link: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to sin and guilt: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “I will not speak” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32): Hester's refusal. Theme link: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30): Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth. On irony: Dimmesdale, urged to make Hester name her partner, pleads with her to do it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “III: The Recognition” treats the recognition with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26): Dimmesdale's double-edged plea. Theme link: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “IV: The Interview” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31): Mr. Wilson presses Hester. Theme link: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the recognition? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “I will not speak” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32): Hester's refusal. Theme link: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from III: The Recognition, paragraph 31: “Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a _____”
   Key: father
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from III: The Recognition, paragraph 30: “Never … It is too deeply _____. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine”
   Key: branded
3. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does the townsman say about Hester's husband?
   Sample answer: He was a learned man who sent her ahead and never arrived; he may be lost at sea.
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line ““It behooves him well, if he be still in life,” responded the townsman.”, what does “behooves” most nearly mean?
   A. belonging to a small, inner circle
   B. is right or necessary for
   C. keeps causing bitter pain
   D. moral weakness
   Key: B (is right or necessary for)
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Here, to witness the scene which we are describing, sat Governor Bellingham himself, with four sergeants about his chair, bearing _____, as a guard of honor.” Word bank: disarray, meetinghouse, halberds, behooves
   Key: halberds
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who pleads with Hester to name the father?
   A. Chillingworth
   B. Pearl
   C. Dimmesdale
   D. The jailer
   Key: C (Dimmesdale)
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who recognizes Hester from the crowd?
   A. Mistress Hibbins
   B. Pearl
   C. Governor Bellingham
   D. A deformed stranger
   Key: D (A deformed stranger)
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where has the stranger been held?
   A. In England
   B. At sea only
   C. In prison
   D. In captivity among Native people
   Key: D (In captivity among Native people)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “By the Indian’s side, and evidently sustaining a companionship with him, stood a white man, clad in a strange disarray of civilized and savage costume.”, what does “disarray” most nearly mean?

    A. ran and skipped playfully

    B. a person who speaks for someone else

    C. untidy mixture or confusion

    D. a reddish glow

    Key: C (untidy mixture or confusion)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I will not speak” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Hester's refusal.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30)

    A. The sexton's unknowing irony.

    B. Hester's admission.

    C. The harshest woman in the crowd.

    D. Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.

    Key: D (Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Mr. Wilson presses Hester.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why is Dimmesdale's plea ironic?

    Sample answer: He is the father, urging her to name him while he hides.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “III: The Recognition”? A deformed, learned stranger in the crowd recognizes Hester and signals her to be silent.

    A. Simile

    B. Structure

    C. Metaphor

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The man who begs her to speak is the man she protects.

    A. Public shame and private identity

    B. Nature and the individual against society

    C. Sin and guilt

    D. Hypocrisy and truth

    Key: D (Hypocrisy and truth)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how hypocrisy and truth develops from an earlier chapter to “III: The Recognition”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “There he stood, with a border of grizzled locks beneath his skullcap; while his gray eyes, accustomed to the shaded light of his study, were winking, like those of Hester’s infant, in the _____ sunshine.” Word bank: meetinghouse, behooves, disarray, unadulterated

    Key: unadulterated

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the stranger signal?

    A. Danger

    B. Love

    C. Escape

    D. Silence

    Key: D (Silence)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “It has already been noticed, that directly over the platform on which Hester Prynne stood was a kind of balcony, or open gallery, appended to the meetinghouse.”, what does “meetinghouse” most nearly mean?

    A. put out (a fire)

    B. a poisonous plant

    C. holy, like a saint

    D. a Puritan building used for worship and town meetings

    Key: D (a Puritan building used for worship and town meetings)

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I will not speak” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32)

    A. Chillingworth's defeat.

    B. Pearl's question.

    C. Hester's refusal.

    D. Why Hester returns.

    Key: C (Hester's refusal.)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26)

    A. His vow.

    B. Pearl's transformation.

    C. Dimmesdale's double-edged plea.

    D. Pearl's reply.

    Key: C (Dimmesdale's double-edged plea.)

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31)

    A. The confession begins.

B. Mr. Wilson presses Hester.

C. Chillingworth on Hester's punishment.

D. Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing.

Key: B (Mr. Wilson presses Hester.)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26).
Sample answer: He says it is better to stand "beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame" than "to hide a guilty heart through life," and Hester answers "I will not speak!"

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “III: The Recognition”? Dimmesdale, urged to make Hester name her partner, pleads with her to do it.

A. Theme

B. Imagery

C. Point of view

D. Irony

Key: D (Irony)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
Sample answer: He says it is better to stand "beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame" than "to hide a guilty heart through life," and Hester answers "I will not speak!"

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “There he stood, with a border of grizzled locks beneath his skullcap; while his gray eyes, accustomed to the shaded light of his study, were winking, like those of Hester’s infant, in the unadulterated sunshine.”, what does “skullcap” most nearly mean?

A. a small, close-fitting cap

B. removed or done away with

C. playfully and imaginatively

D. shut out from society and its protection

Key: A (a small, close-fitting cap)

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from III: The Recognition, paragraph 26: “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy _____ of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life”
Key: pedestal

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “III: The Recognition”?

A. Conclusion

B. The procession

C. The leech

D. The recognition

Key: D (The recognition)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in "Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.
30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Mr. Wilson presses Hester.
31. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The young pastor's voice was _____ sweet, rich, deep, and broken." Word bank: tremulously, meetinghouse, behooves, disarray
    Key: tremulously
32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "I will not speak" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Hester's refusal.
33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Hester's silence admirable or harmful? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view weighing loyalty against truth.
34. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "In this state, the voice of the preacher thundered _____, but unavailingly, upon her ears." Word bank: remorselessly, disarray, behooves, meetinghouse
    Key: remorselessly

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 7, 8, 17, 18, 4, 5, 19, 1, 20, 12, 21, 22, 23, 24, 14, 25 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 8, 4, 26, 6, 27, 2, 11, 22, 13, 28, 21, 24, 29, 14, 16, 30 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 7, 31, 5, 6, 17, 22, 10, 13, 11, 12, 24, 29, 15, 14, 16, 32 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 5, 19, 31, 18, 20, 28, 12, 11, 22, 23, 24, 14, 29, 25, 33, 32 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 5, 34, 6, 13, 22, 20, 28, 15, 29, 23, 14, 24, 25, 16, 32, 33 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 5, 3, 17, 12, 11, 20, 22, 23, 24, 15, 29, 14, 30, 32, 16, 33 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 5, 34, 12, 10, 22, 11, 24, 29, 14, 15, 23, 30, 16, 33, 25, 32 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 17, 34, 13, 20, 10, 12, 23, 24, 29, 15, 14, 30, 33, 25, 16, 32 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 1, 5, 20, 10, 12, 28, 15, 29, 23, 14, 24, 32, 25, 30, 16, 33 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Graduate / PhD | 5, 34, 10, 22, 12, 13, 29, 14, 23, 15, 24, 32, 33, 30, 16, 25 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "III: The Recognition," how does Hawthorne show the recognition? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): In III: The Recognition, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the recognition? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): Analyze how III: The Recognition develops the idea of the recognition. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of III: The Recognition (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the recognition. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what III: The Recognition suggests about the recognition. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses irony in III: The Recognition to complicate the reader's understanding of the recognition. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate III: The Recognition within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the recognition responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read III: The Recognition alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the recognition follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to III: The Recognition and its treatment

of the recognition. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads III: The Recognition as evidence for a larger claim about the recognition in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads III: The Recognition as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the recognition. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *By the Indian's side, and evidently sustaining a companionship with him, stood a white man, clad in a strange disarray of civilized and savage costume.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "disarray" most nearly mean?

   A. shakily, nervously

   B. without pity, without stopping

   C. pure; not mixed with anything weaker

   D. untidy mixture or confusion

2. *From this intense consciousness of being the object of severe and universal observation, the wearer of the scarlet letter was at length relieved, by discerning, on the outskirts of the crowd, a figure which irresistibly took possession of her thoughts. An Indian, in his native garb, was standing there; but the red men were not so infrequent visitors of the English settlements, that one of them would have attracted any notice from Hester Prynne, at such a time; much less would he have excluded all other objects and ideas from her mind. By the Indian's side, and evidently sustaining a companionship with him, stood a white man, clad in a strange disarray of civilized and savage costume.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "III: The Recognition"?

   A. The child at the brook-side

   B. The interior of a heart

   C. The interview in prison

   D. The recognition

**SAT key:** 1. D (untidy mixture or confusion); 2. D (The recognition)

# Lesson 7: IV: The Interview

**Focus:** the interview in prison

**Objective:** Students will analyze how characterization develops in "IV: The Interview" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

**Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)):** This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…essons of my own, that were as old as Paracelsus. Drink it! It may be less soothing than a sinl…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
**Student preview:** This section mentions drinking or a drug.
**Suggested language:** "What does this detail add to the scene?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Back in prison Hester is frantic. The stranger, now calling himself Roger Chillingworth, a physician, calms the baby and Hester with medicines. He admits he wronged her by marrying her young, but vows to discover her lover. He makes her swear to keep his identity secret.

**Background:** Physicians were scarce in early Massachusetts; knowledge of herbs, including Native remedies, gave Chillingworth authority.

**Significance:** Chillingworth's calm, rational revenge begins here and will make him the novel's worst sinner.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Is revenge ever justified when you have also done wrong? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to sin and guilt because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.*
**Prompt:** Is revenge ever justified when you have also done wrong?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to sin and guilt because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: tossings — restless turning movements; trundle — (trundle-bed) a low bed on wheels kept under another bed; ligaments — bonds or ties connecting people; outskirt — outer edge or border; unclasp — open the fastening of. "ligaments": Origin of "ligament": Latin ligāmentum. "unclasp": Origin: an English formation from un- + clasp.*
**Words:** tossings: restless turning movements · trundle: (trundle-bed) a low bed on wheels kept under another bed · ligaments: bonds or ties connecting people · outskirt: outer edge or border · unclasp: open the fastening of

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Physicians were scarce in early Massachusetts; knowledge of herbs, including Native remedies, gave Chillingworth authority. Chillingworth's calm, rational revenge begins here and will make him the novel's worst sinner. Characterization: Chillingworth, now a physician, visits Hester in prison and calms Pearl with a draught. Foreshadowing: He vows to find the father: "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine!" Conflict: Husband and wife admit their mutual wrong; he extracts her promise of secrecy about his identity. Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "to the prison, Hester Prynne was found to be in a state of nervous excitement that demanded constant watchfulness, lest she should" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 1).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay" slowly and put it in my own words: Chillingworth tells Hester that he wronged her first by marrying her youth to his old age. Next, craft. I notice he contrasts "budding youth" with "my decay," images of spring and rot. The strongest word is "decay": it shows how he sees himself, old and withered beside her. Then, effect. What does Chillingworth admit about his own guilt? My answer: Chillingworth admits his own guilt in marrying Hester, young and unloving, when he was old and misshapen; the admission makes him seem reasonable but sets up his cold plan to punish her partner.*

> *Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay" slowly and put it in my own words: Chillingworth tells Hester that he wronged her first by marrying her youth to his old age. Next, craft. I notice he contrasts "budding youth" with "my decay," images of spring and rot. The strongest word is "decay": it shows how he sees himself, old and withered beside her. Then, effect. What does Chillingworth admit about his own guilt? My answer: Chillingworth admits his own guilt in marrying Hester, young and unloving, when he was old and misshapen; the admission makes him seem reasonable but sets up his cold plan to punish her partner.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: His vow. Look at the craft: He vows to find the father: "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine!" Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt? Expected: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. (His vow.)*

> *Sooner or later, he must needs be mine (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** His vow. Look at the craft: He vows to find the father: "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine!"
**Ask:** How does this line connect to sin and guilt?
**Expected answer:** Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. (His vow.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the interview in prison? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how IV: The Interview develops the idea of the interview in prison. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)*
*Exemplar: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. When the text says “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33), it shows this directly. He admits "Mine was the first wrong," yet vows that the unknown father "must needs be mine," and Hester can only ask whether he is "the Black Man that haunts the forest."*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the interview in prison? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how IV: The Interview develops the idea of the interview in prison. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. When the text says “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33), it shows this directly. He admits "Mine was the first wrong," yet vows that the unknown father "must needs be mine," and Hester can only ask whether he is "the Black Man that haunts the forest."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Is revenge ever justified when you have also done wrong? Ask: is Chillingworth a wronged husband with a right to anger, or a villain from the start?*
**Anchor question:** Is revenge ever justified when you have also done wrong?
**Facilitation:** Ask: is Chillingworth a wronged husband with a right to anger, or a villain from the start?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the interview in prison? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. (“Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us”, IV: The Interview, paragraph 33). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the interview in prison? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. (“Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us”, IV: The Interview, paragraph 33). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes the interview in prison. Key takeaway: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Chillingworth, now a physician, visits Hester in prison and calms Pearl with a draught.
- **Foreshadowing:** He vows to find the father: "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine!"
- **Conflict:** Husband and wife admit their mutual wrong; he extracts her promise of secrecy about his identity.

### Themes and how they develop

- **sin and guilt:** Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins.

### Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “to the prison, Hester Prynne was found to be in a state of nervous excitement that demanded constant watchfulness, lest she should” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: “Never, sayest thou?” rejoined he, with a smile of dark and self-relying intelligence. “Never know him! Believe me, Hester, there are” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20) Chillingworth admits his part.
- "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22) His vow.
- "Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33) Hester's fear of him.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling.
**Evidence:** "Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33)
**Reasoning:** He admits "Mine was the first wrong," yet vows that the unknown father "must needs be mine," and Hester can only ask whether he is "the Black Man that haunts the forest."

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **tossings** (noun) | restless turning movements | *The moans of the little patient subsided; its convulsive tossings gradually ceased; and, in a few moments, as is the custom of young children after relief from pain, it sank into a profound and dewy slumber.* | |
| **trundle** (adjective) | (trundle-bed) a low bed on wheels kept under another bed | *His first care was given to the child; whose cries, indeed, as she lay writhing on the trundle-bed, made it of peremptory necessity to postpone all other business to the task of soothing her.* | |
| **ligaments** (noun) | bonds or ties connecting people | *Here, on this wild outskirt of the earth, I shall pitch my tent; for, elsewhere a wanderer, and isolated from human interests, I find here a woman, a man, a child, amongst whom and myself there exist the closest ligaments.* | "ligaments": Origin of "ligament": Latin ligāmentum. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/ligament#Etymology) |
| **outskirt** (noun) | outer edge or border | *Here, on this wild outskirt of the earth, I shall pitch my tent; for, elsewhere a wanderer, and isolated from human interests, I find here a woman, a man, a child, amongst whom and myself there exist the closest ligaments.* | |
| **unclasp** (verb) | open the fastening of | | "unclasp": Origin: an English formation from un- + clasp. (Liber et Libri origin note, https:// |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | *He examined the infant carefully, and then proceeded to unclasp a leathern case, which he took from beneath his dress.* | en.wiktionary.org/wiki/unclasp#Etymology) |
| **philosophized** (verb) | reasoned about life in a thoughtful, abstract way | *Therefore, as a man who has not thought and philosophized in vain, I seek no vengeance, plot no evil against thee.* | |
| **sagamores** (noun) | chiefs of some Algonquian peoples of New England | *He was lodged in the prison, not as suspected of any offence, but as the most convenient and suitable mode of disposing of him, until the magistrates should have conferred with the Indian sagamores respecting his ransom.* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Is revenge ever justified when you have also done wrong?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with sin and guilt?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What does Chillingworth admit? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That he wronged her first by marrying her youth to his decay.
2. Who is the stranger? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hester's husband
3. What name does he take? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Roger Chillingworth
4. What does he give the baby? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A soothing draught
5. What does he make Hester promise? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To keep his identity secret
6. What does he vow? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To find her lover
7. Retell the three most important events of "IV: The Interview" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Back in prison Hester is frantic. The stranger, now calling himself Roger Chillingworth, a physician, calms the baby and Hester with medicines. He admits he wronged her by marrying her young, but vows to discover her lover. He makes her swear to keep his identity secret.

8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “IV: The Interview”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “IV: The Interview” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: “The moans of the little patient subsided; its convulsive tossings gradually ceased; and, in a few moments, as is the custom of young children after relief from pain, it sank into a profound and dewy slumber.” What does “tossings” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: tossings: restless turning movements.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does Hester fear his drink at first? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: She thinks he may poison her or the child.
2. What does “IV: The Interview” suggest about the interview in prison? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Chillingworth's calm, rational revenge begins here and will make him the novel's worst sinner.
3. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the foreshadowing in this chapter shape what we understand about the interview in prison? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20): Chillingworth admits his part. On foreshadowing: He vows to find the father: "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Closely following the jailer into the dismal apartment appeared that individual, of singular aspect, whose presence in the crowd had been of such deep interest to the wearer of…”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “IV: The Interview”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Back in prison Hester is frantic. The stranger, now calling himself Roger Chillingworth, a physician, calms the baby and Hester with medicines. He admits he wronged her by marrying her young, but vows to discover her lover. He makes her swear to keep his identity secret.
7. How does “IV: The Interview” build on “III: The Recognition”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Sooner or later, he must needs be mine” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22): His vow. Theme link: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his

revenge begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33): Hester's fear of him. On characterization: Chillingworth, now a physician, visits Hester in prison and calms Pearl with a draught. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is revenge ever justified when you have also done wrong?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with sin and guilt? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20): Chillingworth admits his part. On conflict: Husband and wife admit their mutual wrong; he extracts her promise of secrecy about his identity. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Who is more to blame for the broken marriage? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view using both speeches.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Sooner or later, he must needs be mine” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22): His vow. Theme link: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Chillingworth's calm, rational revenge begins here and will make him the novel's worst sinner.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33): Hester's fear of him. Theme link: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: "Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20): Chillingworth admits his part. On characterization: Chillingworth, now a physician, visits Hester in prison and calms Pearl with a draught. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of "IV: The Interview" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the interview in prison? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22): His vow. Theme link: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "IV: The Interview": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: "Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33): Hester's fear of him. Theme link: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to public shame and private identity: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: "Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20): Chillingworth admits his part. Theme link: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22): His vow. On characterization: Chillingworth, now a physician, visits Hester in prison and calms Pearl with a draught. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "IV: The Interview" treats the interview in prison with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his

revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33): Hester's fear of him. Theme link: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “V: Hester at Her Needle” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20): Chillingworth admits his part. On foreshadowing: He vows to find the father: "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the interview in prison? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Sooner or later, he must needs be mine” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22): His vow. Theme link: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What name does he take?

   A. John Wilson

   B. Richard Bellingham

   C. Arthur Dimmesdale

   D. Roger Chillingworth

   Key: D (Roger Chillingworth)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from IV: The Interview, paragraph 20: “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and _____ relation with my decay”

   Key: unnatural

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Therefore, as a man who has not thought and _____ in vain, I seek no vengeance, plot no evil against thee.” Word bank: philosophized, ligaments, tossings, trundle

   Key: philosophized

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does he vow?

   A. To become a minister

   B. To leave forever

   C. To find her lover

   D. To forgive everyone

   Key: C (To find her lover)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does he make Hester promise?

   A. To name the father

   B. To marry him again

   C. To leave Boston

   D. To keep his identity secret

   Key: D (To keep his identity secret)

6. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Chillingworth admit?

   Sample answer: That he wronged her first by marrying her youth to his decay.

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Here, on this wild outskirt of the earth, I shall pitch my tent; for, elsewhere a wanderer, and isolated from human interests, I find here a woman, a man, a child, amongst whom and myself there exist the closest…”, what does “outskirt” most nearly mean?

   A. lacking curiosity (here 'not incurious' means quite curious)

   B. outer edge or border

   C. serving as an introduction to what follows

   D. lights up

   Key: B (outer edge or border)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He was lodged in the prison, not as suspected of any offence, but as the most convenient and suitable mode of disposing of him, until the magistrates should have conferred with the Indian _____ respecting his ransom.” Word bank: sagamores, ligaments, tossings, trundle

   Key: sagamores

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who is the stranger?

   A. Dimmesdale's father

   B. Hester's husband

   C. A sailor

   D. The governor

   Key: B (Hester's husband)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “IV: The Interview”?

    A. The Governor's hall

    B. The New England holiday

    C. Hester at her needle

    D. The interview in prison

    Key: D (The interview in prison)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Chillingworth admits his part.
12. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Hester fear his drink at first?
    Sample answer: She thinks he may poison her or the child.
13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Sooner or later, he must needs be mine” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: His vow.
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Hester's fear of him.
15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins.
    A. Sin and guilt
    B. Nature and the individual against society
    C. Hypocrisy and truth
    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: A (Sin and guilt)
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how sin and guilt develops from an earlier chapter to “IV: The Interview”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins.
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Here, on this wild outskirt of the earth, I shall pitch my tent; for, elsewhere a wanderer, and isolated from human interests, I find here a woman, a man, a child, amongst whom and myself there exist the closest…”, what does “ligaments” most nearly mean?
    A. setting aside; declining to pursue
    B. a member of a minister's congregation
    C. bonds or ties connecting people
    D. harmful

    Key: C (bonds or ties connecting people)
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The moans of the little patient subsided; its convulsive tossings gradually ceased; and, in a few moments, as is the custom of young children after relief from pain, it sank into a profound and dewy slumber.”, what does “tossings” most nearly mean?
    A. fully satisfying
    B. raised to the level of a god; idolized
    C. restless turning movements
    D. open metal helmets worn by soldiers

    Key: C (restless turning movements)
19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from IV: The Interview, paragraph 33: “Art thou like the Black Man that _____ the forest round about us”
    Key: haunts

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20)

    A. Hester's answer.

    B. Chillingworth admits his part.

    C. Pearl's question.

    D. Hester's change.

    Key: B (Chillingworth admits his part.)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Sooner or later, he must needs be mine” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22)

    A. Hawthorne's definition of romance.

    B. The sexton's unknowing irony.

    C. His vow.

    D. Chillingworth's probing image.

    Key: C (His vow.)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “IV: The Interview”? Chillingworth, now a physician, visits Hester in prison and calms Pearl with a draught.

    A. Characterization

    B. Metaphor

    C. Irony

    D. Allusion

    Key: A (Characterization)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33).

    Sample answer: He admits "Mine was the first wrong," yet vows that the unknown father "must needs be mine," and Hester can only ask whether he is "the Black Man that haunts the forest."

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: He admits "Mine was the first wrong," yet vows that the unknown father "must needs be mine," and Hester can only ask whether he is "the Black Man that haunts the forest."

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He examined the infant carefully, and then proceeded to _____ a leathern case, which he took from beneath his dress.” Word bank: tossings, trundle, ligaments, unclasp

    Key: unclasp

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “His first care was given to the child; whose cries, indeed, as she lay writhing on the trundle-bed, made it of peremptory necessity to postpone all other business to the task of soothing her.”, what does “trundle” most nearly mean?

    A. (trundle-bed) a low bed on wheels kept under another bed

    B. a small, close-fitting cap

C. examining one's own thoughts and feelings

D. echoed

Key: A ((trundle-bed) a low bed on wheels kept under another bed)

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from IV: The Interview, paragraph 22: "_____ or later, he must needs be mine"

    Key: Sooner

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33)

    A. Dimmesdale to Hester.

    B. Pearl's question.

    C. Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing.

    D. Hester's fear of him.

    Key: D (Hester's fear of him.)

29. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in "IV: The Interview"? He vows to find the father: "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine!"

    A. Foreshadowing

    B. Alliteration

    C. Imagery

    D. Point of view

    Key: A (Foreshadowing)

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Who is more to blame for the broken marriage? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view using both speeches.

31. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does he give the baby?

    A. A blessing

    B. A rose

    C. A soothing draught

    D. A toy

    Key: C (A soothing draught)

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: His vow.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth admits his part.

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 4, 17, 9, 5, 18, 3, 6, 19, 13, 11, 20, 21, 22, 23, 14, 24 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| HS Sophomore | 25, 9, 26, 27, 5, 17, 12, 10, 21, 20, 28, 23, 29, 15, 16, 30 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 3, 31, 26, 27, 19, 11, 28, 21, 12, 13, 29, 14, 23, 15, 32, 24 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 25, 3, 26, 18, 10, 21, 11, 12, 20, 29, 14, 22, 15, 30, 32, 16 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 25, 3, 1, 11, 21, 28, 13, 14, 22, 15, 29, 23, 16, 32, 33, 24 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 2, 25, 4, 10, 28, 12, 21, 22, 15, 14, 29, 23, 16, 30, 33, 32 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 25, 3, 13, 11, 28, 12, 14, 29, 22, 23, 15, 24, 33, 32, 30, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 25, 3, 20, 11, 10, 13, 22, 29, 15, 14, 23, 30, 33, 24, 16, 32 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 25, 3, 13, 28, 10, 12, 22, 23, 29, 15, 14, 32, 16, 30, 24, 33 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 25, 3, 13, 21, 20, 28, 22, 15, 29, 23, 14, 16, 33, 32, 24, 30 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “IV: The Interview,” how does Hawthorne show the interview in prison? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In IV: The Interview, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the interview in prison? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how IV: The Interview develops the idea of the interview in prison. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of IV: The Interview (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the interview in prison. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what IV: The Interview suggests about the interview in prison. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses characterization in IV: The Interview to complicate the reader's understanding of the interview in prison. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate IV: The Interview within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the interview in prison responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read IV: The Interview alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the interview in prison follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to IV: The Interview and its treatment of the interview in prison. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads IV: The Interview as evidence for a larger claim about the interview in prison in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads IV: The Interview as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the interview in prison. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Here, on this wild outskirt of the earth, I shall pitch my tent; for, elsewhere a wanderer, and isolated from human interests, I find here a woman, a man, a child, amongst whom and myself there exist the closest ligaments.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “ligaments” most nearly mean?

   A. open the fastening of

   B. bonds or ties connecting people

   C. chiefs of some Algonquian peoples of New England

   D. reasoned about life in a thoughtful, abstract way

2. *Closely following the jailer into the dismal apartment appeared that individual, of singular aspect, whose presence in the crowd had been of such deep interest to the wearer of the scarlet letter. He was lodged in the prison, not as suspected of any offence, but as the most convenient and suitable mode of disposing of him, until the magistrates should have conferred with the Indian sagamores respecting his ransom. His name was*

*announced as Roger Chillingworth. The jailer, after ushering him into the room, remained a moment, marvelling at the comparative quiet that followed his entrance; for Hester Prynne had immediately become as still as death, although the child continued to moan.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "IV: The Interview"?

A. Hester and Pearl

B. The elf-child and the minister

C. The interview in prison

D. A flood of sunshine

**SAT key:** 1. B (bonds or ties connecting people); 2. C (The interview in prison)

# Lesson 8: V: Hester at Her Needle

**Focus:** Hester at her needle

**Objective:** Students will analyze how characterization develops in "V: Hester at Her Needle" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Released, Hester chooses to stay. She lives in a lonely cottage on the edge of town and supports herself and Pearl by needlework, which becomes fashionable for everything except wedding veils. She gives to the poor, who insult her. She feels the letter gives her a strange sense of hidden sin in others.

**Background:** Needlework was one of the few trades open to women. Puritan sumptuary laws limited fine dress, but officials wore rich ceremonial clothing.

**Significance:** Hester's penance is lonely and endless, yet the letter also gives her insight.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Why would someone stay in the place where they were shamed? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to public shame and private identity because....*
> **Prompt:** Why would someone stay in the place where they were shamed?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to public shame and private identity because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: emolument — payment for work; earnings; irrepressibly — in a way that cannot be held back; moulder — slowly decay into dust; contumaciously — stubbornly defying authority; emblematic — serving as a symbol. "emolument": Origin: Old French emolument; earlier Latin ēmolumentum. "emblematic": Origin: French emblématique.*
> **Words:** emolument: payment for work; earnings · irrepressibly: in a way that cannot be held back · moulder: slowly decay into dust · contumaciously: stubbornly defying authority · emblematic: serving as a symbol

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Needlework was one of the few trades open to women. Puritan sumptuary laws limited fine dress, but officials wore rich ceremonial clothing. Hester's penance is lonely and endless, yet the letter also gives her insight. Characterization: Released, Hester lives on the edge of town, earns her living by needlework and gives to the poor who insult her. Setting: The cottage on the shore, between town and forest. Imagery: The letter as a brand that gives her a "sympathetic knowledge of the hidden sin in other hearts." Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "if meant for no other purpose than to reveal the scarlet letter on her breast. Perhaps there was a more real torture" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 1).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment" slowly and put it in my own words: Hester tells herself that the place of her sin should be the place of her punishment. Next, craft. I notice the parallel "here... had been... here should be," which links crime and penance. The strongest word is "punishment": it shows she accepts suffering as a kind of duty. Then, effect. Why does Hester choose to stay in Boston? My answer: Hester stays to face her shame and, the narrator hints, to stay near Dimmesdale; her penance becomes a way of claiming her own life.*

> *Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment" slowly and put it in my own words: Hester tells herself that the place of her sin should be the place of her punishment. Next, craft. I notice the parallel "here... had been... here should be," which links crime and penance. The strongest word is "punishment": it shows she accepts suffering as a kind of duty. Then, effect. Why does Hester choose to stay in Boston? My answer: Hester stays to face her shame and, the narrator hints, to stay near Dimmesdale; her penance becomes a way of claiming her own life.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Hester's needlework is wanted everywhere except for bridal veils. Expected link: irony; the community uses her talent while shunning her. Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity? Expected: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. (The question the letter's "new sense" raises.)*

> *Had Hester sinned alone (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 10)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Hester's needlework is wanted everywhere except for bridal veils. Expected link: irony; the community uses her talent while shunning her.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to public shame and private identity?
**Expected answer:** Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. (The question the letter's "new sense" raises.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for characterization, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Hester at her needle? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how V: Hester at Her Needle develops the idea of Hester at her needle. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. When the text says “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3), it shows this directly. She stays because "here should be the scene of her earthly punishment," and feels the letter "had endowed her with a new sense" of hidden sin.*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for characterization, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Hester at her needle? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how V: Hester at Her Needle develops the idea of Hester at her needle. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. When the text says “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3), it shows this directly. She stays because "here should be the scene of her earthly punishment," and feels the letter "had endowed her with a new sense" of hidden sin.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Why would someone stay in the place where they were shamed? Ask: why doesn't Hester leave? List reasons the narrator gives and reasons he hints at.*
**Anchor question:** Why would someone stay in the place where they were shamed?
**Facilitation:** Ask: why doesn't Hester leave? List reasons the narrator gives and reasons he hints at.

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Hester at her needle? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. ("Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment", V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Hester at her needle? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. ("Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment", V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes Hester at her needle. Key takeaway: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Released, Hester lives on the edge of town, earns her living by needlework and gives to the poor who insult her.
- **Setting:** The cottage on the shore, between town and forest.
- **Imagery:** The letter as a brand that gives her a "sympathetic knowledge of the hidden sin in other hearts."

### Themes and how they develop

- **public shame and private identity:** Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance.

### Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "if meant for no other purpose than to reveal the scarlet letter on her breast. Perhaps there was a more real torture" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: "prison-door was thrown open, and she came

forth into the sunshine, which, falling on all alike, seemed, to her sick and morbid" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 1).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3) Why she stays.
- "she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11) The letter's "new sense."
- "more intolerable to a woman's heart than that which branded the brow of Cain" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 8) The biblical allusion: Hester's mark is worse than Cain's.
- "Had Hester sinned alone" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 10) The question the letter's "new sense" raises.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others.
**Evidence:** "Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3)
**Reasoning:** She stays because "here should be the scene of her earthly punishment," and feels the letter "had endowed her with a new sense" of hidden sin.

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **emolument** (noun) | payment for work; earnings | *Baby-linen—for babies then wore robes of state—afforded still another possibility of toil and emolument.* | "emolument": Origin: Old French emolument; earlier Latin ēmolumentum. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/emolument#Etymology) |
| **irrepressibly** (adverb) | in a way that cannot be held back | *Hester had schooled herself long and well; she never responded to these attacks, save by a flush of crimson that rose irrepressibly over her pale cheek, and again subsided into the depths of her bosom.* | |
| **moulder** (verb) | slowly decay into dust | *Her needlework was seen on the ruff of the Governor; military men wore it on their scarfs, and the minister on his band; it decked the baby's little cap; it was shut up, to be mildewed and moulder away, in the coffins of the dead.* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **contumaciously** (adverb) | stubbornly defying authority | *Again, a mystic sisterhood would contumaciously assert itself, as she met the sanctified frown of some matron, who, according to the rumor of all tongues, had kept cold snow within her bosom throughout life.* | |
| **emblematic** (adjective) | serving as a symbol | *In the array of funerals, too—whether for the apparel of the dead body, or to typify, by manifold emblematic devices of sable cloth and snowy lawn, the sorrow of the survivors—there was a frequent and characteristic demand for such labor as Hester Prynne could supply.* | "emblematic": Origin: French emblématique. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/emblematic#Etymology) |
| **ceremonials** (noun) | formal ceremonies | *Vanity, it may be, chose to mortify itself, by putting on, for ceremonials of pomp and state, the garments that had been wrought by her sinful hands.* | "ceremonials": Origin of "ceremonial": Latin caerimōniālis. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/ceremonial#Etymology) |
| **inquisitorial** (adjective) | prying and suspicious, like an investigator | *In this little, lonesome dwelling, with some slender means that she possessed, and by the license of the magistrates, who still kept an inquisitorial watch over her, Hester established herself, with her infant child.* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Why would someone stay in the place where they were shamed?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with public shame and private identity?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What does Hester dress herself in? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Coarse, plain clothing, with only the letter as ornament.
2. Where does Hester live? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A cottage on the edge of town

3. How does she earn a living? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Needlework
4. For what is her work never used? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Bridal veils
5. How do the poor treat her? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: They insult her
6. What new sense does the letter seem to give her? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Knowledge of hidden sin in others
7. Retell the three most important events of "V: Hester at Her Needle" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Released, Hester chooses to stay. She lives in a lonely cottage on the edge of town and supports herself and Pearl by needlework, which becomes fashionable for everything except wedding veils. She gives to the poor, who insult her. She feels the letter gives her a strange sense of hidden sin in others.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "V: Hester at Her Needle"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "V: Hester at Her Needle" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "Baby-linen—for babies then wore robes of state—afforded still another possibility of toil and emolument." What does "emolument" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: emolument: payment for work; earnings.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does Hester stay in Boston? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: To make it the scene of her penance, and because her lover is there.
2. What does "V: Hester at Her Needle" suggest about Hester at her needle? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Hester's penance is lonely and endless, yet the letter also gives her insight.
3. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the setting in this chapter shape what we understand about Hester at her needle? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: "Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3): Why she stays. On setting: The cottage on the shore, between town and forest. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "But sometimes, once in many days, or perchance in many months, she felt an eye—a human eye—upon the ignominious brand, that seemed to give a momentary relief, as if half of her…", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their

connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “V: Hester at Her Needle”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Released, Hester chooses to stay. She lives in a lonely cottage on the edge of town and supports herself and Pearl by needlework, which becomes fashionable for everything except wedding veils. She gives to the poor, who insult her. She feels the letter gives her a strange sense of hidden sin in…
7. How does “V: Hester at Her Needle” build on “IV: The Interview”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11): The letter's "new sense." Theme link: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “more intolerable to a woman’s heart than that which branded the brow of Cain” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 8): The biblical allusion: Hester's mark is worse than Cain's. On characterization: Released, Hester lives on the edge of town, earns her living by needlework and gives to the poor who insult her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why would someone stay in the place where they were shamed?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does symbolism appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with public shame and private identity? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “Had Hester sinned alone” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 10): The question the letter's "new sense" raises. Theme link: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is the letter working as the magistrates intended? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view with evidence from the chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3): Why she stays. Theme link:

Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Hester's penance is lonely and endless, yet the letter also gives her insight.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11): The letter's "new sense." Theme link: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “more intolerable to a woman’s heart than that which branded the brow of Cain” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 8): The biblical allusion: Hester's mark is worse than Cain's. On characterization: Released, Hester lives on the edge of town, earns her living by needlework and gives to the poor who insult her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “V: Hester at Her Needle” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about Hester at her needle? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “Had Hester sinned alone” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 10): The question the letter's "new sense" raises. Theme link: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “V: Hester at Her Needle”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3): Why she stays. Theme link: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to hypocrisy and truth: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11): The letter's "new sense." Theme link: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “more intolerable to a woman’s heart than that which branded the brow of Cain” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 8): The biblical allusion: Hester's mark is worse than Cain's. On characterization: Released, Hester lives on the edge of town, earns her living by needlework and gives to the poor who insult her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “V: Hester at Her Needle” treats Hester at her needle with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “Had Hester sinned alone” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 10): The question the letter's "new sense" raises. Theme link: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “VI: Pearl” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3): Why she stays. Theme link: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Hester at her needle? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11): The letter's "new sense." Theme link: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3: “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly _____”
   Key: punishment
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “In this little, lonesome dwelling, with some slender means that she possessed, and by the license of the magistrates, who still kept an _____ watch over her, Hester established herself, with her infant child.” Word bank: irrepressibly, inquisitorial, moulder, emolument
   Key: inquisitorial
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11: “she felt or _____, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense”
   Key: fancied
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “In the array of funerals, too—whether for the apparel of the dead body, or to typify, by manifold _____ devices of sable cloth and snowy lawn, the sorrow of the survivors—there was a frequent and characteristic demand for such labor as Hester Prynne could…” Word bank: emolument, emblematic, moulder, irrepressibly
   Key: emblematic
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Vanity, it may be, chose to mortify itself, by putting on, for _____ of pomp and state, the garments that had been wrought by her sinful hands.” Word bank: moulder, emolument, irrepressibly, ceremonials
   Key: ceremonials
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Again, a mystic sisterhood would contumaciously assert itself, as she met the sanctified frown of some matron, who, according to the rumor of all tongues, had kept cold snow within her bosom throughout life.”, what does “contumaciously” most nearly mean?
   A. taking a place or power wrongfully
   B. stubbornly defying authority
   C. sparkling
   D. keeps causing bitter pain
   Key: B (stubbornly defying authority)
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Baby-linen—for babies then wore robes of state—afforded still another possibility of toil and emolument.”, what does “emolument” most nearly mean?
   A. bordered or edged
   B. payment for work; earnings
   C. not revealed
   D. approaching and speaking to (someone)
   Key: B (payment for work; earnings)
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Hester live?
   A. In the forest
   B. On a ship
   C. A cottage on the edge of town
   D. The governor's mansion

Key: C (A cottage on the edge of town)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does she earn a living?

   A. Medicine

   B. Teaching

   C. Farming

   D. Needlework

   Key: D (Needlework)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “more intolerable to a woman’s heart than that which branded the brow of Cain” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 8)

    A. Hawthorne refuses to revise.

    B. The biblical allusion: Hester's mark is worse than Cain's.

    C. One account of the revelation.

    D. Pearl and the rose.

    Key: B (The biblical allusion: Hester's mark is worse than Cain's.)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The letter's "new sense."

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Why she stays.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Had Hester sinned alone” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 10)

    A. The question the letter's "new sense" raises.

    B. The shipmaster's news.

    C. The changed meaning of the letter.

    D. Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.

    Key: A (The question the letter's "new sense" raises.)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “more intolerable to a woman’s heart than that which branded the brow of Cain” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 8). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The biblical allusion: Hester's mark is worse than Cain's.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3).

    Sample answer: She stays because "here should be the scene of her earthly punishment," and feels the letter "had endowed her with a new sense" of hidden sin.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment” (V: Hester at Her Needle,

paragraph 3) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Why she stays.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Her needlework was seen on the ruff of the Governor; military men wore it on their scarfs, and the minister on his band; it decked the baby's little cap; it was shut up, to be mildewed and moulder away, in the coffins…", what does "moulder" most nearly mean?

    A. a complete change of appearance

    B. close, focused attention

    C. never having happened before

    D. slowly decay into dust

    Key: D (slowly decay into dust)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] For what is her work never used?

    A. Governors' robes

    B. Baby clothes

    C. Bridal veils

    D. Funerals

    Key: C (Bridal veils)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What new sense does the letter seem to give her?

    A. Second sight of the future

    B. A love of crowds

    C. The power to heal

    D. Knowledge of hidden sin in others

    Key: D (Knowledge of hidden sin in others)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Hester had schooled herself long and well; she never responded to these attacks, save by a flush of crimson that rose irrepressibly over her pale cheek, and again subsided into the depths of her bosom.", what does "irrepressibly" most nearly mean?

    A. a feeling of awe and dread

    B. in a way that cannot be held back

    C. carrying too heavy a load

    D. cheerful and light

    Key: B (in a way that cannot be held back)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Hester stay in Boston?

    Sample answer: To make it the scene of her penance, and because her lover is there.

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in "V: Hester at Her Needle"? Released, Hester lives on the edge of town, earns her living by needlework and gives to the poor who insult her.

    A. Foreshadowing

    B. Diction / vocabulary

    C. Symbolism

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “V: Hester at Her Needle”? The cottage on the shore, between town and forest.

    A. Foreshadowing

    B. Setting

    C. Metaphor

    D. Alliteration

    Key: B (Setting)

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from an earlier chapter to “V: Hester at Her Needle”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance.

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 8: “more _____ to a woman’s heart than that which branded the brow of Cain”

    Key: intolerable

26. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Hester dress herself in?

    Sample answer: Coarse, plain clothing, with only the letter as ornament.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How do the poor treat her?

    A. They thank her

    B. They insult her

    C. They avoid her gifts

    D. They protect her

    Key: B (They insult her)

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “V: Hester at Her Needle”?

    A. Hester at her needle

    B. Hester and Pearl

    C. The frame narrative and the found letter

    D. The New England holiday

    Key: A (Hester at her needle)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is the letter working as the magistrates intended? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view with evidence from the chapter.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The letter's "new sense."

31. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3)

    A. The town's suspicion.

    B. The rose-bush as hope.

    C. Why she stays.

    D. The narrator's qualification.

Key: C (Why she stays.)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance.

    A. Hypocrisy and truth

    B. Public shame and private identity

    C. Sin and guilt

    D. Nature and the individual against society

    Key: B (Public shame and private identity)

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: She stays because "here should be the scene of her earthly punishment," and feels the letter "had endowed her with a new sense" of hidden sin.

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11)

    A. Dimmesdale's telltale gesture.

    B. Hawthorne refuses to revise.

    C. The letter's "new sense."

    D. Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.

    Key: C (The letter's "new sense.")

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 17, 9, 8, 18, 5, 19, 20, 1, 11, 12, 21, 10, 22, 15, 23, 24 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 25, 4, 6, 1, 26, 27, 11, 12, 28, 21, 10, 23, 22, 14, 29, 30 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 25, 4, 6, 20, 18, 10, 11, 31, 21, 13, 23, 32, 14, 15, 30, 33 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 4, 27, 3, 18, 34, 21, 11, 12, 28, 15, 32, 22, 14, 30, 33, 16 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 4, 5, 27, 34, 21, 10, 11, 23, 32, 15, 14, 22, 29, 24, 33, 16 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 4, 25, 17, 13, 21, 10, 28, 22, 32, 23, 14, 15, 24, 33, 30, 29 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 4, 2, 34, 31, 13, 11, 14, 15, 23, 22, 32, 29, 24, 33, 16, 30 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 2, 4, 31, 12, 13, 10, 22, 15, 32, 23, 14, 30, 33, 29, 16, 24 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 4, 5, 28, 31, 34, 13, 22, 32, 23, 14, 15, 24, 29, 16, 33, 30 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 3, 4, 12, 31, 21, 34, 23, 32, 22, 15, 14, 29, 24, 33, 16, 30 | |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “V: Hester at Her Needle,” how does Hawthorne show Hester at her needle? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In V: Hester at Her Needle, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of Hester at her needle? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how V: Hester at Her Needle develops the idea of Hester at her needle. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of V: Hester at Her Needle (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Hester at her needle. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what V: Hester at Her Needle suggests about Hester at her needle. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses characterization in V: Hester at Her Needle to complicate the reader's understanding of Hester at her needle. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate V: Hester at Her Needle within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of Hester at her needle responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read V: Hester at Her Needle alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of Hester at her needle follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to V: Hester at Her Needle and its

treatment of Hester at her needle. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads V: Hester at Her Needle as evidence for a larger claim about Hester at her needle in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads V: Hester at Her Needle as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of Hester at her needle. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Her needlework was seen on the ruff of the Governor; military men wore it on their scarfs, and the minister on his band; it decked the baby's little cap; it was shut up, to be mildewed and moulder away, in the coffins of the dead.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "moulder" most nearly mean?

   A. prying and suspicious, like an investigator

   B. slowly decay into dust

   C. serving as a symbol

   D. formal ceremonies

2. *But sometimes, once in many days, or perchance in many months, she felt an eye—a human eye—upon the ignominious brand, that seemed to give a momentary relief, as if half of her agony were shared. The next instant, back it all rushed again, with still a deeper throb of pain; for, in that brief interval, she had sinned anew. Had Hester sinned alone?*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "V: Hester at Her Needle"?

   A. The physician probes the minister

   B. The recognition

   C. Hester at her needle

   D. Pearl

**SAT key:** 1. B (slowly decay into dust); 2. C (Hester at her needle)

# Lesson 9: VI: Pearl

**Focus:** Pearl

**Objective:** Students will analyze how characterization develops in “VI: Pearl” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

**Critical voice:** “Little Pearl is perhaps Hawthorne’s finest poetical creation, and is the very perfection of ideal impishness.” (Edwin Percy Whipple (attrib.; the review is unsigned), critic, *Review of The Scarlet Letter, Graham's Magazine 36:5 (May 1850), "Review of New Books", review*; public domain). Pair with Trollope's entry below: is Pearl a child or a symbol? *Objective:* Analyze Pearl's characterization. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3

**Critical voice:** “But Pearl is miraculous,--speaking, acting, and thinking like an elf,--and is therefore, I think, a drawback rather than an aid.” (Anthony Trollope, novelist, *"The Genius of Nathaniel Hawthorne," North American Review 129 (September 1879), pp. 203-22, section on Pearl*; public domain). Argument writing: defend Pearl against Trollope. ("thinking" appears as "think ing" on the source page because of a line-break artifact.) *Objective:* Evaluate whether Pearl works as a realistic child. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1

Teacher only · spoilers

Pearl grows into a beautiful, wild, clever child whom Hester dresses in rich crimson. She has no friends; other children taunt her. She is fascinated by the letter, throwing flowers at it. When Hester asks what she is, Pearl insists she has no Heavenly Father.

**Background:** Puritans believed children were born in sin and needed strict discipline; Hester's indulgence and Pearl's wildness break both rules.

**Significance:** Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the living form of the letter.

## *Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*What does a child's behavior reveal about how the child is raised? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to sin and guilt because....*
**Prompt:** What does a child's behavior reveal about how the child is raised?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to sin and guilt because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: imbibing — taking in, as if drinking; inalienable — unable to be taken away; flightiness — changeable, unsteady moodiness; calculable — able to be measured or predicted; guiltiness — the state of being guilty. "inalienable": Origin: French inaliénable. "calculable": Origin: an English formation from calculate + -able.*
**Words:** imbibing: taking in, as if drinking · inalienable: unable to be taken away · flightiness: changeable, unsteady moodiness · calculable: able to be measured or predicted · guiltiness: the state of being guilty

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Puritans believed children were born in sin and needed strict discipline; Hester's indulgence and Pearl's wildness break both rules. Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the living form of the letter. Characterization: Pearl is beautiful, wild, intelligent and ungovernable; Hester fears what she has passed on to her. Symbolism: Pearl is dressed in crimson and gold, "the scarlet letter in another form." Diction / vocabulary: Pearl is called an elf, an imp, an airy sprite: the town's vocabulary of the uncanny. Watch for Pearl: "Of great price," purchased with all Hester had; the letter endowed with life.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "But she named the infant "Pearl," as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother's only treasure" slowly and put it in my own words: Hester names her child Pearl because she was bought at great price, with everything Hester had. Next, craft. I notice the biblical echo of the "pearl of great price," something worth all one owns. The strongest word is "treasure": it shows the child is precious, not shameful, to her. Then, effect. Why does Hester name her daughter Pearl? My answer: The name turns the "sin" into her greatest value; Pearl is both Hester's punishment and her joy.*

> *But she named the infant "Pearl," as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother's only treasure (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "But she named the infant "Pearl," as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother's only treasure" slowly and put it in my own words: Hester names her child Pearl because she was bought at great price, with everything Hester had. Next, craft. I notice the biblical echo of the "pearl of great price," something worth all one owns. The strongest word is "treasure": it shows the child is precious, not shameful, to her. Then, effect. Why does Hester name her daughter Pearl? My answer: The name turns the "sin" into her greatest value; Pearl is both Hester's punishment and her joy.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Pearl's refusal of a heavenly father echoes the hidden earthly father. Expected link: symbolism; sin and guilt. Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt? Expected: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. (Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.)*

> *Thy Heavenly Father sent thee (VI: Pearl, paragraph 21)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Pearl's refusal of a heavenly father echoes the hidden earthly father. Expected link: symbolism; sin and guilt.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to sin and guilt?
**Expected answer:** Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. (Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for characterization, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Pearl? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how VI: Pearl develops the idea of Pearl. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. When the text says "But she named the infant "Pearl," as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother's only treasure" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. Hester names her Pearl "as being of great price,—purchased with all she had," yet asks in fear "Child, what art thou?", and Pearl insists "I have no Heavenly Father!"*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for characterization, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Pearl? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how VI: Pearl develops the idea of Pearl. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. When the text says "But she named the infant "Pearl," as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother's only treasure" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. Hester names her Pearl "as being of great price,—purchased with all she had," yet asks in fear "Child, what art thou?", and Pearl insists "I have no Heavenly Father!"

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: What does a child's behavior reveal about how the child is raised? Ask: is Pearl a realistic child, a symbol, or both? Find one sentence that supports each reading.*
**Anchor question:** What does a child's behavior reveal about how the child is raised?
**Facilitation:** Ask: is Pearl a realistic child, a symbol, or both? Find one sentence that supports each reading.

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Pearl? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. (“But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure”, VI: Pearl, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Pearl? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. (“But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure”, VI: Pearl, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes Pearl. Key takeaway: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Pearl is beautiful, wild, intelligent and ungovernable; Hester fears what she has passed on to her.
- **Symbolism:** Pearl is dressed in crimson and gold, "the scarlet letter in another form."
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Pearl is called an elf, an imp, an airy sprite: the town's vocabulary of the uncanny.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **sin and guilt:** Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **Pearl:** "Of great price," purchased with all Hester had; the letter endowed with life.

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1) Why Hester names her Pearl.
- “Child, what art thou” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13) Hester's question.
- “Thy Heavenly Father sent thee” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 21) Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.
- “I have no Heavenly Father” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 23) Pearl's reply.

### Model claim-evidence-reasoning

**Claim:** Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin.
**Evidence:** "But she named the infant "Pearl," as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother's only treasure" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1)
**Reasoning:** Hester names her Pearl "as being of great price,—purchased with all she had," yet asks in fear "Child, what art thou?", and Pearl insists "I have no Heavenly Father!"

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **imbibing** (verb) | taking in, as if drinking | *Hester could only account for the child's character—and even then most vaguely and imperfectly—by recalling what she herself had been, during that momentous period while Pearl was imbibing her soul from the spiritual world, and her bodily frame from its material of earth.* | |
| **inalienable** (adjective) | unable to be taken away | *All this enmity and passion had Pearl inherited, by inalienable right, out of Hester's heart.* | "inalienable": Origin: French inaliénable. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/inalienable#Etymology) |
| **flightiness** (noun) | changeable, unsteady moodiness | *She could recognize her wild, desperate, defiant mood, the flightiness of her temper, and even some of the very cloud-shapes of gloom and despondency that had brooded in her heart.* | |
| **calculable** (adjective) | able to be measured or predicted | *After testing both smiles and frowns, and proving that neither mode of treatment possessed any calculable influence, Hester was ultimately compelled to stand aside, and permit the child to be swayed by her own impulses.* | "calculable": Origin: an English formation from calculate + -able. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/calculable#Etymology) |
| **guiltiness** (noun) | the state of being guilty | *Day after day, she looked fearfully into the child's expanding nature, ever dreading to detect some dark and wild peculiarity, that should correspond with the guiltiness to which she owed her being.* | |
| **baffling** (adjective) | confusing; impossible to understand | *Heart-smitten at this bewildering and baffling spell, that so often came between herself and her sole treasure, whom she had bought so dear, and who was all her world,* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | *Hester sometimes burst into passionate tears.* | |
| **unsearchable** (adjective) | too deep to be explored or understood | *At last, her shot being all expended, the child stood still and gazed at Hester, with that little, laughing image of a fiend peeping out—or, whether it peeped or no, her mother so imagined it—from the unsearchable abyss of her black eyes.* | "unsearchable": Origin: an English formation from un- + searchable. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/unsearchable#Etymology) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. What does a child's behavior reveal about how the child is raised?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with hypocrisy and truth?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. How do the town's children treat Pearl? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: They gather to fling mud and insults; she fights back.
2. Why is she named Pearl? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She is of great price
3. How does Hester dress Pearl? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In rich, bright clothes
4. What does Pearl throw at the letter? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Wildflowers
5. Who taunts Pearl? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Puritan children
6. What does Pearl say about a Heavenly Father? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She has none
7. Retell the three most important events of "VI: Pearl" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Pearl grows into a beautiful, wild, clever child whom Hester dresses in rich crimson. She has no friends; other children taunt her. She is fascinated by the letter, throwing flowers at it. When Hester asks what she is, Pearl insists she has no Heavenly Father.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "VI: Pearl"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when does “VI: Pearl” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: “Hester could only account for the child’s character—and even then most vaguely and imperfectly—by recalling what she herself had been, during that momentous period while Pearl was imbibing her soul from the spiritual…” What does “imbibing” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: imbibing: taking in, as if drinking.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does Hester worry about Pearl? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: She fears the child inherited her passion and sin.
2. What does “VI: Pearl” suggest about Pearl? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the living form of the letter.
3. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about Pearl? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: “But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1): Why Hester names her Pearl. On symbolism: Pearl is dressed in crimson and gold, "the scarlet letter in another form." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “The truth was, that the little Puritans, being of the most intolerant brood that ever lived, had got a vague idea of something outlandish, unearthly, or at variance with ordinary…”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “VI: Pearl”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Pearl grows into a beautiful, wild, clever child whom Hester dresses in rich crimson. She has no friends; other children taunt her. She is fascinated by the letter, throwing flowers at it. When Hester asks what she is, Pearl insists she has no Heavenly Father.
7. How does “VI: Pearl” build on “V: Hester at Her Needle”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: “Child, what art thou” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13): Hester's question. Theme link: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: “Thy Heavenly Father sent thee” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 21): Hester's answer, which

Pearl rejects. On characterization: Pearl is beautiful, wild, intelligent and ungovernable; Hester fears what she has passed on to her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: "What does a child's behavior reveal about how the child is raised?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does diction / vocabulary appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with hypocrisy and truth? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: "I have no Heavenly Father" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 23): Pearl's reply. On diction / vocabulary: Pearl is called an elf, an imp, an airy sprite: the town's vocabulary of the uncanny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Pearl a realistic child or a symbol? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view with evidence for both.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: "But she named the infant "Pearl," as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother's only treasure" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1): Why Hester names her Pearl. Theme link: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the living form of the letter." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: "Child, what art thou" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13): Hester's question. Theme link: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: "Thy Heavenly Father sent thee" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 21): Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects. On characterization: Pearl is beautiful, wild, intelligent and ungovernable; Hester fears what she has passed on to her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Rewrite one moment of "VI: Pearl" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about Pearl? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: "I have no Heavenly Father" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 23): Pearl's reply. Theme link:

Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “VI: Pearl”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: “But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1): Why Hester names her Pearl. Theme link: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to nature and the individual against society: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: “Child, what art thou” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13): Hester's question. Theme link: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: “Thy Heavenly Father sent thee” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 21): Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects. On characterization: Pearl is beautiful, wild, intelligent and ungovernable; Hester fears what she has passed on to her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “VI: Pearl” treats Pearl with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: “I have no Heavenly Father” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 23): Pearl's reply. Theme link: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “VII: The Governor’s Hall” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: “But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1): Why Hester names her Pearl. Theme link: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Pearl? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: "Child, what art thou" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13): Hester's question. Theme link: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Heart-smitten at this bewildering and _____ spell, that so often came between herself and her sole treasure, whom she had bought so dear, and who was all her world, Hester sometimes burst into passionate tears." Word bank: flightiness, imbibing, baffling, inalienable

   Key: baffling

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "All this enmity and passion had Pearl inherited, by inalienable right, out of Hester's heart.", what does "inalienable" most nearly mean?

   A. not revealed

   B. lacking curiosity (here 'not incurious' means quite curious)

   C. in a sensible, knowing way

   D. unable to be taken away

   Key: D (unable to be taken away)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Day after day, she looked fearfully into the child's expanding nature, ever dreading to detect some dark and wild peculiarity, that should correspond with the _____ to which she owed her being." Word bank: inalienable, guiltiness, flightiness, imbibing

   Key: guiltiness

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Hester could only account for the child's character—and even then most vaguely and imperfectly—by recalling what she herself had been, during that momentous period while Pearl was imbibing her soul from the spiritual…", what does "imbibing" most nearly mean?

   A. dislike or distrust of people

   B. nearness; closeness

   C. taking in, as if drinking

   D. mixed together

   Key: C (taking in, as if drinking)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why is she named Pearl?

   A. She is of great price

   B. After a ship

   C. After her grandmother

   D. For her pale skin

Key: A (She is of great price)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “She could recognize her wild, desperate, defiant mood, the flightiness of her temper, and even some of the very cloud-shapes of gloom and despondency that had brooded in her heart.”, what does “flightiness” most nearly mean?
   A. changeable, unsteady moodiness
   B. that cannot be taken away or cancelled
   C. nearness; closeness
   D. damage (a reputation)

   Key: A (changeable, unsteady moodiness)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Pearl throw at the letter?
   A. Wildflowers
   B. Water
   C. Stones
   D. Mud

   Key: A (Wildflowers)

8. [short · recall · DOK 1] How do the town's children treat Pearl?
   Sample answer: They gather to fling mud and insults; she fights back.

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who taunts Pearl?
   A. Sailors
   B. Chillingworth
   C. The governor
   D. Puritan children

   Key: D (Puritan children)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Why Hester names her Pearl.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I have no Heavenly Father” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 23)
    A. The harshest woman in the crowd.
    B. Pearl's reply.
    C. Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.
    D. The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy.

    Key: B (Pearl's reply.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “VI: Pearl”?
    A. A flood of sunshine
    B. The minister in a maze
    C. Pearl
    D. The revelation

    Key: C (Pearl)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Child, what art thou” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Hester's question.
14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “VI: Pearl”? Pearl is dressed in crimson and gold, "the scarlet letter in another form."
    A. Symbolism
    B. Personification
    C. Tone / mood
    D. Imagery
    Key: A (Symbolism)
15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment.
    A. Sin and guilt
    B. Nature and the individual against society
    C. Public shame and private identity
    D. Hypocrisy and truth
    Key: A (Sin and guilt)
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Pearl a realistic child or a symbol? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view with evidence for both.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from VI: Pearl, paragraph 1: “But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—_____ with all she had—her mother’s only treasure”
    Key: purchased
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Pearl say about a Heavenly Father?
    A. She loves him
    B. She fears him
    C. She has met him
    D. She has none
    Key: D (She has none)
19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Hester dress Pearl?
    A. In black
    B. Like a boy
    C. In gray
    D. In rich, bright clothes
    Key: D (In rich, bright clothes)
20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Thy Heavenly Father sent thee” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 21)
    A. The rose-bush as hope.
    B. Chillingworth on Hester's punishment.
    C. Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.
    D. One account of the revelation.

Key: C (Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Child, what art thou” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13)

    A. The sexton's reading of the sign.

    B. Ironic exaggeration of the reaction.

    C. Hester's question.

    D. Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.

    Key: C (Hester's question.)

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1)

    A. The question the letter's "new sense" raises.

    B. Why Hester names her Pearl.

    C. Ironic exaggeration of the reaction.

    D. His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.

    Key: B (Why Hester names her Pearl.)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Thy Heavenly Father sent thee” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 21). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.

24. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Hester worry about Pearl?

    Sample answer: She fears the child inherited her passion and sin.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1).

    Sample answer: Hester names her Pearl "as being of great price,—purchased with all she had," yet asks in fear "Child, what art thou?", and Pearl insists "I have no Heavenly Father!"

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Hester names her Pearl "as being of great price,—purchased with all she had," yet asks in fear "Child, what art thou?", and Pearl insists "I have no Heavenly Father!"

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Child, what art thou” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Hester's question.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “After testing both smiles and frowns, and proving that neither mode of treatment possessed any calculable influence, Hester was ultimately compelled to stand aside, and permit the child to be swayed by her own impulses.”, what does “calculable” most nearly mean?

    A. shut out from society and its protection

    B. promising solemnly

    C. bonds or ties connecting people

    D. able to be measured or predicted

    Key: D (able to be measured or predicted)

29. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in "VI: Pearl"? Pearl is beautiful, wild, intelligent and ungovernable; Hester fears what she has passed on to her.

    A. Characterization

    B. Diction / vocabulary

    C. Irony

    D. Conflict

    Key: A (Characterization)

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "But she named the infant "Pearl," as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother's only treasure" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Why Hester names her Pearl.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how sin and guilt develops from an earlier chapter to "VI: Pearl". Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment.

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 17, 3, 2, 8, 5, 18, 19, 7, 12, 20, 21, 22, 23, 15, 14, 16 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 18, 2, 8, 19, 17, 1, 11, 21, 12, 13, 24, 15, 23, 25, 26, 27 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 3, 28, 6, 17, 4, 20, 10, 24, 13, 12, 25, 15, 29, 14, 30, 27 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 18, 1, 3, 5, 24, 10, 21, 13, 11, 23, 15, 14, 25, 16, 31, 26 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 17, 3, 7, 13, 21, 12, 11, 25, 14, 29, 15, 23, 26, 31, 16, 27 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 3, 1, 8, 21, 22, 20, 12, 15, 29, 25, 23, 14, 16, 26, 27, 31 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 3, 1, 22, 10, 13, 12, 14, 25, 29, 15, 23, 26, 16, 27, 31, 30 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 3, 1, 21, 12, 11, 22, 29, 15, 25, 23, 14, 27, 16, 26, 30, 31 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 3, 1, 24, 20, 11, 12, 15, 14, 29, 25, 23, 31, 30, 16, 26, 27 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 3, 1, 13, 24, 22, 20, 29, 25, 15, 14, 23, 31, 30, 26, 27, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "VI: Pearl," how does Hawthorne show Pearl? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In VI: Pearl, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of Pearl? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how VI: Pearl develops the idea of Pearl. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of VI: Pearl (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Pearl. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what VI: Pearl suggests about Pearl. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses characterization in VI: Pearl to complicate the reader's understanding of Pearl. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate VI: Pearl within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of Pearl responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read VI: Pearl alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of Pearl follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to VI: Pearl and its treatment of Pearl. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads VI: Pearl as evidence for a larger claim about Pearl in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads VI: Pearl as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of Pearl. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *She could recognize her wild, desperate, defiant mood, the flightiness of her temper, and even some of the very cloud-shapes of gloom and despondency that had brooded in her heart.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "flightiness" most nearly mean?

   A. confusing; impossible to understand
   B. too deep to be explored or understood
   C. the state of being guilty
   D. changeable, unsteady moodiness

2. *The truth was, that the little Puritans, being of the most intolerant brood that ever lived, had got a vague idea of something outlandish, unearthly, or at variance with ordinary fashions, in the mother and child; and therefore scorned them in their hearts, and not unfrequently reviled them with their tongues. Pearl felt the sentiment, and requited it with the bitterest hatred that can be supposed to rankle in a childish bosom. These outbreaks of a fierce temper had a kind of value, and even comfort, for her mother; because there was at least an intelligible earnestness in the mood, instead of the fitful caprice that so often thwarted her in the child's manifestations. It appalled her, nevertheless, to discern here, again, a shadowy reflection of the evil that had existed in herself. All this enmity and passion had Pearl inherited, by inalienable right, out of Hester's heart. Mother and daughter stood together in the same circle of seclusion from human society; and in the nature of the child seemed to be perpetuated those unquiet elements that had distracted Hester Prynne before Pearl's birth, but had since begun to be soothed away by the softening influences of maternity.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "VI: Pearl"?

   A. The minister's vigil
   B. Pearl
   C. The frame narrative and the found letter
   D. The forest walk

**SAT key:** 1. D (changeable, unsteady moodiness); 2. B (Pearl)

# Lesson 10: VII: The Governor’s Hall

**Focus:** the Governor's hall

**Objective:** Students will analyze how setting develops in “VII: The Governor’s Hall” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

**Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)):** This section mentions drinking or a drug (“…ve seen the frothy remnant of a recent draught of ale. On the wall hung a row of portraits, r…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
**Student preview:** This section mentions drinking or a drug.
**Suggested language:** “What does this detail add to the scene?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Hearing that the magistrates may take Pearl, Hester brings gloves to Governor Bellingham's mansion. In a polished breastplate she sees the letter grotesquely magnified. Pearl, dressed in scarlet, cries for a red rose in the garden.

**Background:** Bellingham was governor several times; the narrator notes the English gentleman's attempt to make an English garden in rough soil.

**Significance:** In authority's mirror the letter dominates who Hester is.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*How do people in power see those who are judged? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to public shame and private identity because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.*
**Prompt:** How do people in power see those who are judged?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to public shame and private identity because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: frontispiece — the decorated front of a building; frisked — ran and skipped playfully; humoring — going along with (someone) to keep them content; arraying — dressing in fine clothes; cabalistic — mysterious and magical-looking. "cabalistic": Origin: an English formation from cabalist + -ic.*
**Words:** frontispiece: the decorated front of a building · frisked: ran and skipped playfully · humoring: going along with (someone) to keep them content · arraying: dressing in fine clothes · cabalistic: mysterious and magical-looking

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Bellingham was governor several times; the narrator notes the English gentleman's attempt to make an English garden in rough soil. In authority's mirror the letter dominates who Hester is. Setting: Governor Bellingham's mansion, its glittering stucco and the convex breastplate that magnifies the letter. Symbolism: In the armor's curved mirror the scarlet letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions." Characterization: Bellingham's English garden fails: cabbages and pumpkin vines replace ornament. Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "went, one day, to the mansion of Governor Bellingham, with a pair of gloves, which she had fringed and embroidered to his" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 1).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" slowly and put it in my own words: In the governor's polished armor, the scarlet letter appears hugely exaggerated, the most prominent part of Hester's appearance. Next, craft. I notice the distortion: the curved armor makes the letter swallow her image. The strongest word is "exaggerated": it shows how her shame dominates how others see her. Then, effect. What does the reflection in the armor show? My answer: The armor reflects society's view: the letter has replaced her as a person; Hawthorne shows how a label can overshadow identity.*

> *the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" slowly and put it in my own words: In the governor's polished armor, the scarlet letter appears hugely exaggerated, the most prominent part of Hester's appearance. Next, craft. I notice the distortion: the curved armor makes the letter swallow her image. The strongest word is "exaggerated": it shows how her shame dominates how others see her. Then, effect. What does the reflection in the armor show? My answer: The armor reflects society's view: the letter has replaced her as a person; Hawthorne shows how a label can overshadow identity.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The letter grows huge in the mirror, as it does in the eyes of the magistrates. Expected link: symbolism; public shame. Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity? Expected: The letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. (Pearl's dress.)*

> *It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life* (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 4)

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** The letter grows huge in the mirror, as it does in the eyes of the magistrates. Expected link: symbolism; public shame.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to public shame and private identity?
**Expected answer:** The letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. (Pearl's dress.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the Governor's hall? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how VII: The Governor's Hall develops the idea of the Governor's hall. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. When the text says "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20), it shows this directly. In the breastplate the letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions," and Pearl herself is "the scarlet letter endowed with life!"*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the Governor's hall? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how VII: The Governor's Hall develops the idea of the Governor's hall. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. When the text says "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20), it shows this directly. In the breastplate the letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions," and Pearl herself is "the scarlet letter endowed with life!"

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: How do people in power see those who are judged? Ask: why does Hawthorne put the distorting mirror in the Governor's house, not elsewhere?*
**Anchor question:** How do people in power see those who are judged?
**Facilitation:** Ask: why does Hawthorne put the distorting mirror in the Governor's house, not elsewhere?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the Governor's hall? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. (“the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance”, VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the Governor's hall? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. (“the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance”, VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how setting shapes the Governor's hall. Key takeaway: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Setting:** Governor Bellingham's mansion, its glittering stucco and the convex breastplate that magnifies the letter.
- **Symbolism:** In the armor's curved mirror the scarlet letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions."
- **Characterization:** Bellingham's English garden fails: cabbages and pumpkin vines replace ornament.

### Themes and how they develop

- **public shame and private identity:** the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority.

### Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “went, one day, to the mansion of Governor Bellingham, with a pair of gloves, which she had fringed and embroidered to his” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: “of broken glass were plentifully intermixed; so that, when the sunshine fell aslant-wise over the front of the edifice, it glittered and” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 8).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20) The mirror in the armor.
- "It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 4) Pearl's dress.
- "Pearl, seeing the rosebushes, began to cry for a red rose" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 23) Pearl and the rose.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity.
**Evidence:** "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20)
**Reasoning:** In the breastplate the letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions," and Pearl herself is "the scarlet letter endowed with life!"

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **frontispiece** (noun) | the decorated front of a building | *Little Pearl—who was as greatly pleased with the gleaming armor as she had been with the glittering frontispiece of the house—spent some time looking into the polished mirror of the breastplate.* | |
| **frisked** (verb) | ran and skipped playfully | *Often, nevertheless, more from caprice than necessity, she demanded to be taken up in arms; but was soon as imperious to be set down again, and frisked onward before Hester on the grassy pathway, with many a harmless trip and tumble.* | |
| **humoring** (verb) | going along with (someone) to keep them content | *Hester looked, by way of humoring the child; and she saw that, owing to the peculiar effect of this convex mirror, the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance.* | |
| **arraying** (verb) | dressing in fine clothes | *Her mother, in contriving the child's garb, had allowed the gorgeous tendencies of her imagination their full play; arraying her in a crimson velvet tunic, of a peculiar cut, abundantly embroidered with fantasies and flourishes of gold-thread.* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **cabalistic** (adjective) | mysterious and magical-looking | *It was further decorated with strange and seemingly cabalistic figures and diagrams, suitable to the quaint taste of the age, which had been drawn in the stucco when newly laid on, and had now grown hard and durable, for the admiration of after times.* | "cabalistic": Origin: an English formation from cabalist + -ic. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/cabalistic#Etymology) |
| **offshoot** (noun) | something that grows out of something else | *There was fire in her and throughout her; she seemed the unpremeditated offshoot of a passionate moment.* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. How do people in power see those who are judged?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature and the individual against society?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

**Literal / recall**

1. Who owns the house? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Governor Bellingham.
2. Why does Hester go to the Governor's house? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To deliver gloves and keep Pearl
3. What magnifies the letter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A breastplate in a suit of armor
4. What does Pearl cry for? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A red rose
5. What grows in the Governor's garden? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Cabbages and pumpkins
6. What is Pearl's dress like? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The scarlet letter in another form
7. Retell the three most important events of "VII: The Governor's Hall" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hearing that the magistrates may take Pearl, Hester brings gloves to Governor Bellingham's mansion. In a polished breastplate she sees the letter grotesquely magnified. Pearl, dressed in scarlet, cries for a red rose in the garden.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "VII: The Governor's Hall"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when does “VII: The Governor’s Hall” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: “Little Pearl—who was as greatly pleased with the gleaming armor as she had been with the glittering frontispiece of the house—spent some time looking into the polished mirror of the breastplate.” What does “frontispiece” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: frontispiece: the decorated front of a building.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does the letter look gigantic in the armor? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: It reflects how authorities see only her sin.
2. What does “VII: The Governor’s Hall” suggest about the Governor's hall? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: In authority's mirror the letter dominates who Hester is.
3. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about the Governor's hall? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20): The mirror in the armor. On symbolism: In the armor's curved mirror the scarlet letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Hester looked, by way of humoring the child; and she saw that, owing to the peculiar effect of this convex mirror, the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic…”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “VII: The Governor’s Hall”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Hearing that the magistrates may take Pearl, Hester brings gloves to Governor Bellingham's mansion. In a polished breastplate she sees the letter grotesquely magnified. Pearl, dressed in scarlet, cries for a red rose in the garden.
7. How does “VII: The Governor’s Hall” build on “VI: Pearl”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 4): Pearl's dress. Theme link: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a

quoted line.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “Pearl, seeing the rosebushes, began to cry for a red rose” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 23): Pearl and the rose. On characterization: Bellingham's English garden fails: cabbages and pumpkin vines replace ornament. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “How do people in power see those who are judged?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature and the individual against society? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20): The mirror in the armor. On characterization: Bellingham's English garden fails: cabbages and pumpkin vines replace ornament. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Why does Hawthorne put the distorting mirror in the Governor's house? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view linking power and judgment.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 4): Pearl's dress. Theme link: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “In authority's mirror the letter dominates who Hester is.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “Pearl, seeing the rosebushes, began to cry for a red rose” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 23): Pearl and the rose. Theme link: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20): The mirror in the armor. On characterization: Bellingham's English garden fails: cabbages and pumpkin vines

replace ornament. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “VII: The Governor’s Hall” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the Governor's hall? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 4): Pearl's dress. Theme link: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “VII: The Governor’s Hall”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “Pearl, seeing the rosebushes, began to cry for a red rose” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 23): Pearl and the rose. Theme link: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to women and independence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20): The mirror in the armor. Theme link: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 4): Pearl's dress. On setting: Governor Bellingham's mansion, its glittering stucco and the convex breastplate that magnifies the letter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “VII: The Governor’s Hall” treats the Governor's hall with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “Pearl, seeing the rosebushes, began to cry for a red rose” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 23): Pearl and the rose. Theme link: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20): The mirror in the armor. Theme link: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the Governor's hall? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 4): Pearl's dress. Theme link: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Pearl cry for?
   A. Food
   B. A toy
   C. A red rose
   D. Her father

   Key: C (A red rose)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Her mother, in contriving the child’s garb, had allowed the gorgeous tendencies of her imagination their full play; arraying her in a crimson velvet tunic, of a peculiar cut, abundantly embroidered with fantasies and…”, what does “arraying” most nearly mean?
   A. dressing in fine clothes
   B. serving as an introduction to what follows
   C. strengthened; given new energy
   D. doorways; the entrance of a house

   Key: A (dressing in fine clothes)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What magnifies the letter?
   A. A breastplate in a suit of armor

B. A window

C. A mirror in church

D. A pool

Key: A (A breastplate in a suit of armor)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 23: "Pearl, seeing the _____, began to cry for a red rose"

   Key: rosebushes

5. [short · recall · DOK 1] Who owns the house?

   Sample answer: Governor Bellingham.

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 4: "It was the _____ letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life"

   Key: scarlet

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is Pearl's dress like?

   A. Black wool

   B. The scarlet letter in another form

   C. White linen

   D. Plain gray

   Key: B (The scarlet letter in another form)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20: "the scarlet letter was _____ in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance"

   Key: represented

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Hester looked, by way of humoring the child; and she saw that, owing to the peculiar effect of this convex mirror, the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most…", what does "humoring" most nearly mean?

   A. untidy mixture or confusion

   B. splash (with water or mud)

   C. sadly; mournfully

   D. going along with (someone) to keep them content

   Key: D (going along with (someone) to keep them content)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The mirror in the armor.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 4) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Pearl's dress.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 4)

    A. Pearl's dress.

B. The narrator's judgment.

C. Pearl's transformation.

D. The changed meaning of the letter.

Key: A (Pearl's dress.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does the letter look gigantic in the armor?
Sample answer: It reflects how authorities see only her sin.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “VII: The Governor’s Hall”? In the armor's curved mirror the scarlet letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions."

A. Symbolism

B. Theme

C. Diction / vocabulary

D. Metaphor

Key: A (Symbolism)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority.

A. Public shame and private identity

B. Sin and guilt

C. Nature and the individual against society

D. Hypocrisy and truth

Key: A (Public shame and private identity)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
Sample answer: In the breastplate the letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions," and Pearl herself is "the scarlet letter endowed with life!"

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Little Pearl—who was as greatly pleased with the gleaming armor as she had been with the glittering frontispiece of the house—spent some time looking into the polished mirror of the breastplate.”, what does “frontispiece” most nearly mean?

A. getting back; recovering

B. the decorated front of a building

C. something that flows out

D. a loud, ringing noise

Key: B (the decorated front of a building)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Often, nevertheless, more from caprice than necessity, she demanded to be taken up in arms; but was soon as imperious to be set down again, and frisked onward before Hester on the grassy pathway, with many a harmless…”, what does “frisked” most nearly mean?

A. focused together on one point

B. getting back; recovering

C. ran and skipped playfully

D. strengthened; given new energy

Key: C (ran and skipped playfully)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It was further decorated with strange and seemingly _____ figures and diagrams, suitable to the quaint taste of the age, which had been drawn in the stucco when newly laid on, and had now grown hard and durable, for the admiration of after times.” Word bank: humoring, frontispiece, frisked, cabalistic

    Key: cabalistic

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What grows in the Governor's garden?

    A. Nothing

    B. Only roses

    C. Vines of grapes

    D. Cabbages and pumpkins

    Key: D (Cabbages and pumpkins)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20)

    A. Hester's defense.

    B. Hester's answer.

    C. Hester casts off the letter.

    D. The mirror in the armor.

    Key: D (The mirror in the armor.)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “VII: The Governor’s Hall”? Governor Bellingham's mansion, its glittering stucco and the convex breastplate that magnifies the letter.

    A. Metaphor

    B. Theme

    C. Hyperbole

    D. Setting

    Key: D (Setting)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Pearl, seeing the rosebushes, began to cry for a red rose” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 23). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Pearl and the rose.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Why does Hawthorne put the distorting mirror in the Governor's house? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view linking power and judgment.

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “VII: The Governor’s Hall”?

    A. The forest walk

    B. The Governor's hall

    C. Another view of Hester

    D. The pastor and his parishioner

    Key: B (The Governor's hall)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20).

Sample answer: In the breastplate the letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions," and Pearl herself is "the scarlet letter endowed with life!"

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “There was fire in her and throughout her; she seemed the unpremeditated _____ of a passionate moment.” Word bank: frontispiece, humoring, offshoot, frisked

    Key: offshoot

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Pearl, seeing the rosebushes, began to cry for a red rose” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 23)

    A. The chapter's contrast.

    B. Pearl and the rose.

    C. Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.

    D. Pearl's question.

    Key: B (Pearl and the rose.)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The mirror in the armor.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Pearl's dress.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from an earlier chapter to “VII: The Governor’s Hall”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority.

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 5, 17, 8, 18, 19, 9, 4, 20, 12, 10, 11, 21, 22, 15, 23, 24 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 20, 19, 4, 17, 9, 5, 21, 25, 12, 10, 11, 26, 14, 15, 24, 16 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 27, 3, 18, 20, 4, 11, 21, 13, 28, 10, 22, 15, 23, 26, 29, 30 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 27, 3, 8, 9, 10, 21, 12, 13, 25, 22, 14, 15, 23, 31, 16, 24 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 19, 27, 9, 13, 12, 21, 25, 14, 15, 23, 26, 22, 31, 30, 24, 16 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 27, 19, 9, 10, 13, 11, 25, 14, 22, 23, 26, 15, 24, 29, 16, 30 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| | | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| College Sophomore | 27, 19, 21, 25, 13, 12, 15, 26, 22, 14, 23, 29, 31, 16, 30, 24 | |
| College Junior | 19, 27, 10, 25, 12, 28, 23, 22, 15, 26, 14, 31, 24, 16, 30, 29 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 19, 27, 10, 21, 12, 25, 14, 23, 26, 15, 22, 30, 16, 31, 24, 29 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 8, 19, 13, 28, 12, 21, 23, 22, 26, 14, 15, 31, 16, 30, 24, 29 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “VII: The Governor’s Hall,” how does Hawthorne show the Governor's hall? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In VII: The Governor’s Hall, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the Governor's hall? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how VII: The Governor’s Hall develops the idea of the Governor's hall. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of VII: The Governor’s Hall (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the Governor's hall. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what VII: The Governor’s Hall suggests about the Governor's hall. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses setting in VII: The Governor’s Hall to complicate the reader's understanding of the Governor's hall. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate VII: The Governor’s Hall within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the Governor's hall responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read VII: The Governor's Hall alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the Governor's hall follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to VII: The Governor's Hall and its treatment of the Governor's hall. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads VII: The Governor's Hall as evidence for a larger claim about the Governor's hall in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads VII: The Governor's Hall as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the Governor's hall. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Hester looked, by way of humoring the child; and she saw that, owing to the peculiar effect of this convex mirror, the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "humoring" most nearly mean?

   A. going along with (someone) to keep them content

   B. mysterious and magical-looking

   C. dressing in fine clothes

   D. something that grows out of something else

2. *Hester looked, by way of humoring the child; and she saw that, owing to the peculiar effect of this convex mirror, the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance. In truth, she seemed absolutely hidden behind it. Pearl pointed upward, also, at a similar picture in the headpiece; smiling at her mother, with the elfish intelligence that was so familiar an expression on her small physiognomy. That look of naughty merriment was likewise reflected in the mirror, with so much breadth and intensity of effect, that it made Hester Prynne feel as if it could not be the image of her own child, but of an imp who was seeking to mould itself into Pearl's shape.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "VII: The Governor's Hall"?

   A. The Governor's hall

   B. The minister in a maze

   C. The elf-child and the minister

   D. Hester and Pearl

**SAT key:** 1. A (going along with (someone) to keep them content); 2. A (The Governor's hall)

# Lesson 11: VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister

**Focus:** the elf-child and the minister

**Objective:** Students will analyze how conflict develops in "VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

**Content note (witchcraft, removal of a child):** Magistrates propose to take Pearl from her mother; Mistress Hibbins (a real woman later executed as a witch) invites Hester to the forest. Discuss fear of difference, not the occult.
**Student preview:** Authorities try to take a child from her mother.
**Suggested language:** "Who should decide how Pearl is raised?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Bellingham, Wilson, Dimmesdale and Chillingworth question Pearl, who says she was plucked from the rose-bush by the prison door. The magistrates move to take her; Hester appeals desperately to Dimmesdale, who argues the child is a blessing and a reminder of sin. Pearl takes his hand and lays her cheek against it, and he kisses her brow. Mistress Hibbins invites Hester to the forest; Hester says she would have gone if they had taken Pearl.

**Background:** Mistress Ann Hibbins, sister of Governor Bellingham, was executed as a witch in Boston in 1656.

**Significance:** Dimmesdale saves Pearl while hiding his claim to her.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Who should decide how a child is raised: parents or the community? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to sin and guilt because.... Content note before we start: Authorities try to take a child from her mother.*
**Prompt:** Who should decide how a child is raised: parents or the community?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to sin and guilt because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: sundering — breaking apart; separating; expatiating — speaking at length (about); grandfatherly — kindly, like a grandfather; indefeasible — that cannot be taken away or cancelled; inopportune — happening at a bad time. "expatiating": Origin of "expatiate": Latin expatior. "inopportune": Origin: Latin inopportūnus.*
**Words:** sundering: breaking apart; separating · expatiating: speaking at length (about) · grandfatherly: kindly, like a grandfather · indefeasible: that cannot be taken away or cancelled · inopportune: happening at a bad time

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Mistress Ann Hibbins, sister of Governor Bellingham, was executed as a witch in Boston in 1656. Dimmesdale saves Pearl while hiding his claim to her. Conflict: The magistrates propose to take Pearl from Hester; Hester appeals to Dimmesdale. Irony: Dimmesdale, the secret father, argues successfully that the child is a blessing and a reminder for her mother. Characterization: Pearl claims she was "plucked by her mother off the bush of wild roses." Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "Governor Bellingham, in a loose gown and easy cap—such as elderly gentlemen loved to endue" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 1).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less" slowly and put it in my own words: Hester insists God gave her the child, who is both her joy and her torment. Next, craft. I notice the balanced contrast "my happiness! — my torture." The strongest word is "torture": it is a strong word for a child, showing the pain mixed with her love. Then, effect. What does Hester mean when she calls Pearl both happiness and torture? My answer: Pearl keeps Hester alive and reminds her of her sin; Hester's plea persuades the leaders to let her keep her daughter.*

> *God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less" slowly and put it in my own words: Hester insists God gave her the child, who is both her joy and her torment. Next, craft. I notice the balanced contrast "my happiness! — my torture." The strongest word is "torture": it is a strong word for a child, showing the pain mixed with her love. Then, effect. What does Hester mean when she calls Pearl both happiness and torture? My answer: Pearl keeps Hester alive and reminds her of her sin; Hester's plea persuades the leaders to let her keep her daughter.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Hester demands Dimmesdale speak. Look at the craft: Dimmesdale, the secret father, argues successfully that the child is a blessing and a reminder for her mother. Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt? Expected: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. (Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.)*

> *Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Hester demands Dimmesdale speak. Look at the craft: Dimmesdale, the secret father, argues successfully that the child is a blessing and a reminder for her mother.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to sin and guilt?
**Expected answer:** Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. (Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for conflict, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the elf-child and the minister? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister develops the idea of the elf-child and the minister. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. When the text says “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22), it shows this directly. Hester calls on him, "thou knowest what is in my heart," and he argues for the child she calls "my happiness" and "my torture."*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for conflict, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the elf-child and the minister? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister develops the idea of the elf-child and the minister. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. When the text says “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22), it shows this directly. Hester calls on him, "thou knowest what is in my heart," and he argues for the child she calls "my happiness" and "my torture."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Who should decide how a child is raised: parents or the community? Ask: why does Dimmesdale win the argument? What does he risk by speaking?*
**Anchor question:** Who should decide how a child is raised: parents or the community?
**Facilitation:** Ask: why does Dimmesdale win the argument? What does he risk by speaking?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the elf-child and the minister? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. ("God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less", VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the elf-child and the minister? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. ("God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less", VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how conflict shapes the elf-child and the minister. Key takeaway: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Conflict:** The magistrates propose to take Pearl from Hester; Hester appeals to Dimmesdale.
- **Irony:** Dimmesdale, the secret father, argues successfully that the child is a blessing and a reminder for her mother.
- **Characterization:** Pearl claims she was "plucked by her mother off the bush of wild roses."

### Themes and how they develop

- **sin and guilt:** Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain.

### Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter:

"Governor Bellingham, in a loose gown and easy cap—such as elderly gentlemen loved to endue" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 1).

- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: "the great hall-window, found himself close to little Pearl. The shadow of the curtain fell on Hester Prynne, and partially concealed her" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 3).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22) Hester's plea.
- "Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24) Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.
- "this boon was meant, above all things else, to keep the mother's soul alive, and to preserve her from blacker depths of sin" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 30) Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her.
**Evidence:** "God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22)
**Reasoning:** Hester calls on him, "thou knowest what is in my heart," and he argues for the child she calls "my happiness" and "my torture."

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **sundering** (verb) | breaking apart; separating | *But here—if we suppose this interview betwixt Mistress Hibbins and Hester Prynne to be authentic, and not a parable—was already an illustration of the young minister's argument against sundering the relation of a fallen mother to the offspring of her frailty.* | |
| **expatiating** (verb) | speaking at length (about) | *Governor Bellingham, in a loose gown and easy cap—such as elderly gentlemen loved to endue themselves with, in their domestic privacy—walked foremost, and appeared to be showing off his estate, and expatiating on his projected improvements.* | "expatiating": Origin of "expatiate": Latin expatior. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/expatiate#Etymology) |
| **grandfatherly** (adjective) | kindly, like a grandfather | *Wilson, not a little astonished at this outbreak—for he was a grandfatherly sort of personage, and usually a vast favorite* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | *with children—essayed, however, to proceed with the examination.* | |
| **indefeasible** (adjective) | that cannot be taken away or cancelled | *Alone in the world, cast off by it, and with this sole treasure to keep her heart alive, she felt that she possessed indefeasible rights against the world, and was ready to defend them to the death.* | |
| **inopportune** (adjective) | happening at a bad time | *But that perversity which all children have more or less of, and of which little Pearl had a tenfold portion, now, at the most inopportune moment, took thorough possession of her, and closed her lips, or impelled her to speak words amiss.* | "inopportune": Origin: Latin **inopportūnus.** (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/inopportune#Etymology) |
| **mountebank** (noun) | a showy fake or performer who tricks people | *"I feared the woman had no better thought than to make a mountebank of her child!"* | "mountebank": Origin: Italian **montambanco.** (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/mountebank#Etymology) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Who should decide how a child is raised: parents or the community?
2. Where does conflict appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with women and independence?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What question does Wilson ask Pearl? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Who made her.
2. Where does Pearl say she came from? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The rose-bush by the prison door
3. Who argues that Hester should keep Pearl? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Dimmesdale
4. What does Pearl do to Dimmesdale? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Lays her cheek against his hand
5. What does Mistress Hibbins invite Hester to? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A meeting in the forest

6. What does Hester answer Mistress Hibbins? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She would have gone if they had taken Pearl
7. Retell the three most important events of "VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Bellingham, Wilson, Dimmesdale and Chillingworth question Pearl, who says she was plucked from the rose-bush by the prison door. The magistrates move to take her; Hester appeals desperately to Dimmesdale, who argues the child is a blessing and a reminder of sin. Pearl takes his hand and lays her cheek against it, and he kisses her brow. Mistress Hibbins invites Hester to the forest; Hester says…
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "But here—if we suppose this interview betwixt Mistress Hibbins and Hester Prynne to be authentic, and not a parable—was already an illustration of the young minister's argument against sundering the relation of a fallen…" What does "sundering" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: sundering: breaking apart; separating.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does Dimmesdale win the argument? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He speaks with feeling, as only the father could.
2. What does "VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister" suggest about the elf-child and the minister? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Dimmesdale saves Pearl while hiding his claim to her.
3. Find one example of conflict in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the irony in this chapter shape what we understand about the elf-child and the minister? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: "God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22): Hester's plea. On irony: Dimmesdale, the secret father, argues successfully that the child is a blessing and a reminder for her mother. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "The old minister seated himself in an armchair, and made an effort to draw Pearl betwixt his knees.", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Bellingham, Wilson, Dimmesdale and Chillingworth question Pearl, who says she was plucked from the rose-bush by the prison door. The magistrates move

to take her; Hester appeals desperately to Dimmesdale, who argues the child is a blessing and a reminder of sin. Pearl takes his hand and lays her…

7. How does “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister” build on “VII: The Governor’s Hall”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24): Hester demands Dimmesdale speak. Theme link: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “this boon was meant, above all things else, to keep the mother’s soul alive, and to preserve her from blacker depths of sin” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 30): Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing. On characterization: Pearl claims she was "plucked by her mother off the bush of wild roses." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Who should decide how a child is raised: parents or the community?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with women and independence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22): Hester's plea. On characterization: Pearl claims she was "plucked by her mother off the bush of wild roses." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Was Pearl saving Hester 'from Satan's snare,' as the narrator suggests? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24): Hester demands Dimmesdale speak. Theme link: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Dimmesdale saves Pearl while hiding his claim to her.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1,

RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “this boon was meant, above all things else, to keep the mother’s soul alive, and to preserve her from blacker depths of sin” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 30): Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing. Theme link: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22): Hester's plea. On characterization: Pearl claims she was "plucked by her mother off the bush of wild roses." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the elf-child and the minister? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24): Hester demands Dimmesdale speak. Theme link: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “this boon was meant, above all things else, to keep the mother’s soul alive, and to preserve her from blacker depths of sin” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 30): Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing. Theme link: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to sin and guilt: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22): Hester's plea. Theme link: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria

and evidence.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24): Hester demands Dimmesdale speak. On conflict: The magistrates propose to take Pearl from Hester; Hester appeals to Dimmesdale. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister” treats the elf-child and the minister with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “this boon was meant, above all things else, to keep the mother’s soul alive, and to preserve her from blacker depths of sin” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 30): Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing. Theme link: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “IX: The Leech” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22): Hester's plea. Theme link: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the elf-child and the minister? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24): Hester demands Dimmesdale speak. Theme link: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

*Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Wilson, not a little astonished at this outbreak—for he was a grandfatherly sort of personage, and usually a vast favorite with children—essayed, however, to proceed with the examination.", what does "grandfatherly" most nearly mean?

   A. kindly, like a grandfather

   B. a person who speaks for someone else

   C. raised to the level of a god; idolized

   D. payment for work; earnings

   Key: A (kindly, like a grandfather)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Pearl do to Dimmesdale?

   A. Ignores him

   B. Lays her cheek against his hand

   C. Bites him

   D. Throws a burr

   Key: B (Lays her cheek against his hand)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Governor Bellingham, in a loose gown and easy cap—such as elderly gentlemen loved to endue themselves with, in their domestic privacy—walked foremost, and appeared to be showing off his estate, and expatiating on his…", what does "expatiating" most nearly mean?

   A. lack of accountability to anyone

   B. a woman who founds something

   C. lights up

   D. speaking at length (about)

   Key: D (speaking at length (about))

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Mistress Hibbins invite Hester to?

   A. Church

   B. A feast

   C. A meeting in the forest

   D. A trial

   Key: C (A meeting in the forest)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 30: "this boon was meant, above all things else, to keep the mother's soul alive, and to _____ her from blacker depths of sin"

   Key: preserve

6. [short · recall · DOK 1] What question does Wilson ask Pearl?

   Sample answer: Who made her.

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Alone in the world, cast off by it, and with this sole treasure to keep her heart alive, she felt that she possessed indefeasible rights against the world, and was ready to defend them to the death.", what does "indefeasible" most nearly mean?

   A. inflicted (revenge or harm)

   B. that cannot be taken away or cancelled

C. bitter and corrupted

D. shrubs and small plants under forest trees

Key: B (that cannot be taken away or cancelled)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24: “Thou knowest—for thou hast _____ which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart”

Key: sympathies

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who argues that Hester should keep Pearl?

A. Bellingham

B. Wilson

C. Mistress Hibbins

D. Dimmesdale

Key: D (Dimmesdale)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24)

A. Hester's answer.

B. Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.

C. Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.

D. Pearl links the minister to the letter.

Key: C (Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister”?

A. Hester on the scaffold

B. Hester and Pearl

C. The elf-child and the minister

D. The interview in prison

Key: C (The elf-child and the minister)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Hester's plea.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22)

A. The confession begins.

B. The narrator's judgment.

C. Hester's plea.

D. The mirror in the armor.

Key: C (Hester's plea.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain.

A. Sin and guilt

B. Hypocrisy and truth

C. Public shame and private identity

D. Nature and the individual against society

Key: A (Sin and guilt)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “this boon was meant, above all things else, to keep the mother’s soul alive, and to preserve her from blacker depths of sin” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 30). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Was Pearl saving Hester 'from Satan's snare,' as the narrator suggests? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view.
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “But here—if we suppose this interview betwixt Mistress Hibbins and Hester Prynne to be authentic, and not a parable—was already an illustration of the young minister’s argument against sundering the relation of a fallen…”, what does “sundering” most nearly mean?

    A. calming

    B. a member of a minister's congregation

    C. breaking apart; separating

    D. removed or done away with

    Key: C (breaking apart; separating)
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Pearl say she came from?

    A. The rose-bush by the prison door

    B. Heaven

    C. The forest

    D. England

    Key: A (The rose-bush by the prison door)
19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22: “God gave me the child … She is my _____!—she is my torture, none the less”
    Key: happiness
20. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: ““I feared the woman had no better thought than to make a _____ of her child!”” Word bank: mountebank, expatiating, sundering, grandfatherly
    Key: mountebank
21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.
22. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Dimmesdale win the argument?
    Sample answer: He speaks with feeling, as only the father could.
23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22).
    Sample answer: Hester calls on him, "thou knowest what is in my heart," and he argues for the child she calls "my happiness" and "my torture."

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister”? The magistrates propose to take Pearl from Hester; Hester appeals to Dimmesdale.

    A. Conflict

    B. Tone / mood

    C. Structure

    D. Simile

    Key: A (Conflict)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister”? Dimmesdale, the secret father, argues successfully that the child is a blessing and a reminder for her mother.

    A. Irony

    B. Conflict

    C. Simile

    D. Structure

    Key: A (Irony)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Hester's plea.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how sin and guilt develops from an earlier chapter to “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Hester answer Mistress Hibbins?

    A. She will come tonight

    B. She laughs

    C. She reports her

    D. She would have gone if they had taken Pearl

    Key: D (She would have gone if they had taken Pearl)

30. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “this boon was meant, above all things else, to keep the mother’s soul alive, and to preserve her from blacker depths of sin” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 30)

    A. The sexton's reading of the sign.

    B. Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.

    C. The letter's failure as a punishment.

    D. Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing.

    Key: D (Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing.)

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Hester calls on him, "thou knowest what is in my heart," and he argues for the child she calls "my happiness" and "my torture."
32. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “But that perversity which all children have more or less of, and of which little Pearl had a tenfold portion, now, at the most _____ moment, took thorough possession of her, and closed her lips, or impelled her to speak words amiss.” Word bank: expatiating, inopportune, grandfatherly, sundering
    Key: inopportune

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 17, 7, 8, 18, 9, 19, 20, 3, 21, 13, 11, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 18, 5, 8, 3, 19, 1, 12, 10, 13, 11, 21, 24, 15, 14, 27, 28 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 29, 20, 7, 18, 19, 30, 11, 21, 13, 10, 14, 24, 23, 15, 16, 31 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 6, 5, 32, 18, 13, 10, 30, 21, 12, 14, 24, 15, 25, 28, 27, 16 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 20, 17, 32, 22, 21, 10, 30, 15, 14, 25, 24, 23, 31, 26, 27, 16 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 32, 20, 1, 12, 13, 22, 30, 24, 25, 14, 15, 23, 16, 27, 26, 31 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 32, 20, 22, 30, 12, 21, 14, 15, 24, 23, 25, 27, 26, 16, 28, 31 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 32, 20, 10, 13, 22, 11, 24, 25, 14, 23, 15, 31, 16, 28, 27, 26 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 32, 20, 13, 11, 10, 22, 25, 23, 24, 14, 15, 27, 28, 16, 31, 26 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 32, 20, 12, 11, 10, 21, 14, 23, 25, 24, 15, 27, 16, 31, 28, 26 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister,” how does Hawthorne show the elf-child and the minister? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the elf-child and the minister? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister develops the idea of the elf-child and the minister. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of the elf-child and the minister. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister suggests about the elf-child and the minister. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's conflict and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses conflict in VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister to complicate the reader's understanding of the elf-child and the minister. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the elf-child and the minister responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the elf-child and the minister follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister and its treatment of the elf-child and the minister. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's conflict and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister as evidence for a larger claim about the elf-child and the minister in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the elf-child and the minister.

Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Wilson, not a little astonished at this outbreak—for he was a grandfatherly sort of personage, and usually a vast favorite with children—essayed, however, to proceed with the examination.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "grandfatherly" most nearly mean?

   A. happening at a bad time

   B. that cannot be taken away or cancelled

   C. kindly, like a grandfather

   D. a showy fake or performer who tricks people

2. *The old minister seated himself in an armchair, and made an effort to draw Pearl betwixt his knees. But the child, unaccustomed to the touch or familiarity of any but her mother, escaped through the open window, and stood on the upper step, looking like a wild tropical bird, of rich plumage, ready to take flight into the upper air. Mr. Wilson, not a little astonished at this outbreak—for he was a grandfatherly sort of personage, and usually a vast favorite with children—essayed, however, to proceed with the examination.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister"?

   A. The elf-child and the minister

   B. Hester at her needle

   C. The prison door and the rose

   D. Hester and Pearl

**SAT key:** 1. C (kindly, like a grandfather); 2. A (The elf-child and the minister)

# Lesson 12: IX: The Leech

**Focus:** the leech

**Objective:** Students will analyze how characterization develops in “IX: The Leech” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Chillingworth settles in Boston as a physician and becomes the ailing Dimmesdale's doctor; at a hint from him, the two lodge in the same house beside the graveyard. Dimmesdale constantly presses his hand to his heart. Some townspeople begin to think the doctor's face has grown darker and that he is Satan's emissary.

**Background:** 'Leech' was an old word for a physician; leeches were also used to bleed patients.

**Significance:** Care becomes a disguise for revenge.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Can someone hurt you while seeming to help you? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to sin and guilt because....*
**Prompt:** Can someone hurt you while seeming to help you?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to sin and guilt because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: pilloried — publicly punished and shamed, as in the pillory; vilified — spoke of with harsh, abusive criticism; decried — publicly condemned; chirurgical — surgical (old form); religionist — a deeply religious person. “vilified”: Origin of “vilify”: Late Latin vīlificāre. “chirurgical”: Origin: Middle French cirurgical; earlier Medieval Latin chirurgicālis.*
**Words:** pilloried: publicly punished and shamed, as in the pillory · vilified: spoke of with harsh, abusive criticism · decried: publicly condemned · chirurgical: surgical (old form) · religionist: a deeply religious person

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*'Leech' was an old word for a physician; leeches were also used to bleed patients. Care becomes a disguise for revenge. Characterization: Chillingworth becomes the minister's physician and companion; his face grows darker. Foreshadowing: People begin to whisper that the physician is Satan's emissary. Imagery: Chillingworth is a "leech," a word for a doctor and a bloodsucker. Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "in the crowd that witnessed Hester Prynne's ignominious exposure, stood a man, elderly, travel-worn, who, just emerging from the perilous wilderness, beheld" (IX: The Leech, paragraph 1).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart" slowly and put it in my own words: Dimmesdale now constantly presses his hand over his heart. Next, craft. I notice the gesture is described as habit, not chance. The strongest word is "heart": it is where his secret guilt hides. Then, effect. What does Dimmesdale's habit reveal? My answer: Dimmesdale's habit of pressing his hand over his heart reveals the hidden guilt that is destroying him physically; the gesture marks the weakness Chillingworth will exploit.*

> *it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart" slowly and put it in my own words: Dimmesdale now constantly presses his hand over his heart. Next, craft. I notice the gesture is described as habit, not chance. The strongest word is "heart": it is where his secret guilt hides. Then, effect. What does Dimmesdale's habit reveal? My answer: Dimmesdale's habit of pressing his hand over his heart reveals the hidden guilt that is destroying him physically; the gesture marks the weakness Chillingworth will exploit.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The town imagines Chillingworth's fire "brought from the lower regions": the community senses evil it cannot name. Expected link: imagery; revenge as a hunt. Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt? Expected: The physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. (The townspeople's suspicion.)*

> *the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** The town imagines Chillingworth's fire "brought from the lower regions": the community senses evil it cannot name. Expected link: imagery; revenge as a hunt.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to sin and guilt?
**Expected answer:** The physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. (The townspeople's suspicion.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the chapter for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the leech? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how IX: The Leech develops the idea of the leech. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. When the text says “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7), it shows this directly. Dimmesdale's habit "to press his hand over his heart" draws the physician close, and the town comes to believe he is haunted by "Satan's emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth."*

**Task:** Annotate the chapter for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the leech? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how IX: The Leech develops the idea of the leech. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. When the text says “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7), it shows this directly. Dimmesdale's habit "to press his hand over his heart" draws the physician close, and the town comes to believe he is haunted by "Satan's emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: Can someone hurt you while seeming to help you? Ask: what are the two meanings of "leech," and why does Hawthorne choose the word?*

**Anchor question:** Can someone hurt you while seeming to help you?

**Facilitation:** Ask: what are the two meanings of "leech," and why does Hawthorne choose the word?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the leech? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. (“it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart”, IX: The Leech, paragraph 7). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*

**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the leech? Support it with one short quotation.

**Answer:** Model answer: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. (“it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart”, IX: The Leech, paragraph 7). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the leech. Key takeaway: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Chillingworth becomes the minister's physician and companion; his face grows darker.
- **Foreshadowing:** People begin to whisper that the physician is Satan's emissary.
- **Imagery:** Chillingworth is a "leech," a word for a doctor and a bloodsucker.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **sin and guilt:** the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “in the crowd that witnessed Hester Prynne’s ignominious exposure, stood a man, elderly, travel-worn, who, just emerging from the perilous wilderness, beheld” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: “interests would immediately spring up, and likewise a new purpose; dark, it is true, if not guilty, but of force enough to” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 1).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7) Dimmesdale's telltale gesture.
- “the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17) The townspeople's suspicion.
- “haunted either by Satan himself, or Satan’s emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 18) The town's suspicion.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The physician's care is a disguise for persecution.
**Evidence:** “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7)

**Reasoning:** Dimmesdale's habit "to press his hand over his heart" draws the physician close, and the town comes to believe he is haunted by "Satan's emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth."

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **pilloried** (verb) | publicly punished and shamed, as in the pillory | *He resolved not to be pilloried beside her on her pedestal of shame.* | |
| **vilified** (verb) | spoke of with harsh, abusive criticism | *Here the pale clergyman piled up his library, rich with parchment-bound folios of the Fathers, and the lore of Rabbis, and monkish erudition, of which the Protestant divines, even while they vilified and decried that class of writers, were yet constrained often to avail themselves.* | "vilified": Origin of "vilify": Late Latin vīlificāre. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/vilify#Etymology) |
| **decried** (verb) | publicly condemned | *Here the pale clergyman piled up his library, rich with parchment-bound folios of the Fathers, and the lore of Rabbis, and monkish erudition, of which the Protestant divines, even while they vilified and decried that class of writers, were yet constrained often to avail themselves.* | |
| **chirurgical** (adjective) | surgical (old form) | *Skilful men, of the medical and chirurgical profession, were of rare occurrence in the colony.* | "chirurgical": Origin: Middle French cirurgical; earlier Medieval Latin chirurgicālis. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/chirurgical#Etymology) |
| **religionist** (noun) | a deeply religious person | *Dimmesdale was a true priest, a true religionist, with the reverential sentiment largely developed, and an order of mind that impelled itself powerfully along the track of a creed, and wore its passage continually deeper with the lapse of time.* | |
| **parishioner** (noun) | a member of a minister's congregation | *This idea was countenanced by the strong interest which the physician ever manifested in the young clergyman; he attached himself to him as a parishioner, and sought to win a friendly regard and confidence from his naturally reserved sensibility.* | "parishioner": Origin: Old French paroissien. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/parishioner#Etymology) |
| **incurious** (adjective) | lacking curiosity (here 'not | *With such commodiousness of situation, these two learned persons sat themselves* | "incurious": Origin: Latin incūriōsus ("careless"). (Liber et Libri origin note, |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | incurious' means quite curious) | *down, each in his own domain, yet familiarly passing from one apartment to the other, and bestowing a mutual and not incurious inspection into one another's business.* | https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/incurious#Etymology) |
| **delving** (verb) | digging or searching deeply | *So Roger Chillingworth—the man of skill, the kind and friendly physician—strove to go deep into his patient's bosom, delving among his principles, prying into his recollections, and probing everything with a cautious touch, like a treasure-seeker in a dark cavern.* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Can someone hurt you while seeming to help you?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with sin and guilt?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

**Literal / recall**

1. Why are the parishioners glad of the doctor? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: They think Providence sent him to save their minister.
2. What profession does Chillingworth practice? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Physician
3. Where do the two men live? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In the same house by the graveyard
4. What gesture does Dimmesdale make? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Presses his hand over his heart
5. What do some townspeople suspect? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The doctor is Satan's agent
6. What two meanings does 'leech' have? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Doctor and bloodsucker
7. Retell the three most important events of "IX: The Leech" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Chillingworth settles in Boston as a physician and becomes the ailing Dimmesdale's doctor; at a hint from him, the two lodge in the same house beside the graveyard.

Dimmesdale constantly presses his hand to his heart. Some townspeople begin to think the doctor's face has grown darker and that he is Satan's emissary.

8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “IX: The Leech”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “IX: The Leech” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: “He resolved not to be pilloried beside her on her pedestal of shame.” What does “pilloried” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: pilloried: publicly punished and shamed, as in the pillory.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Hawthorne call the chapter 'The Leech'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Chillingworth heals and drains Dimmesdale at once.
2. What does “IX: The Leech” suggest about the leech? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Care becomes a disguise for revenge.
3. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the foreshadowing in this chapter shape what we understand about the leech? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7): Dimmesdale's telltale gesture. On foreshadowing: People begin to whisper that the physician is Satan's emissary. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “This idea was countenanced by the strong interest which the physician ever manifested in the young clergyman; he attached himself to him as a parishioner, and sought to win a…”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “IX: The Leech”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Chillingworth settles in Boston as a physician and becomes the ailing Dimmesdale's doctor; at a hint from him, the two lodge in the same house beside the graveyard. Dimmesdale constantly presses his hand to his heart. Some townspeople begin to think the doctor's face has grown darker and that he is…
7. How does “IX: The Leech” build on “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17): The townspeople's suspicion. Theme link: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's

secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “haunted either by Satan himself, or Satan’s emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 18): The town's suspicion. On characterization: Chillingworth becomes the minister's physician and companion; his face grows darker. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can someone hurt you while seeming to help you?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with sin and guilt? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7): Dimmesdale's telltale gesture. On imagery: Chillingworth is a "leech," a word for a doctor and a bloodsucker. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is the town's suspicion of Chillingworth wisdom or superstition? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17): The townspeople's suspicion. Theme link: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Care becomes a disguise for revenge.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “haunted either by Satan himself, or Satan’s emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 18): The town's suspicion. Theme link: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his

heart" (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7): Dimmesdale's telltale gesture. On characterization: Chillingworth becomes the minister's physician and companion; his face grows darker. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of "IX: The Leech" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the leech? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: "the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions" (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17): The townspeople's suspicion. Theme link: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "IX: The Leech": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: "haunted either by Satan himself, or Satan's emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth" (IX: The Leech, paragraph 18): The town's suspicion. Theme link: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to public shame and private identity: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: "it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart" (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7): Dimmesdale's telltale gesture. Theme link: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: "the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions" (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17): The townspeople's suspicion. On characterization: Chillingworth becomes the minister's physician and companion; his face grows darker. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "IX: The Leech" treats the leech with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: "haunted either by Satan himself, or Satan's emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth" (IX: The Leech, paragraph 18): The town's suspicion. Theme link: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “X: The Leech and His Patient” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7): Dimmesdale's telltale gesture. On foreshadowing: People begin to whisper that the physician is Satan's emissary. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the leech? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17): The townspeople's suspicion. Theme link: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What gesture does Dimmesdale make?
   A. Clenches his fists
   B. Folds his arms
   C. Covers his eyes
   D. Presses his hand over his heart

   Key: D (Presses his hand over his heart)
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Dimmesdale was a true priest, a true _____, with the reverential sentiment largely developed, and an order of mind that impelled itself powerfully along the track of a creed, and wore its passage continually deeper with the lapse of time.” Word bank: vilified, decried, religionist, pilloried
   Key: religionist
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “He resolved not to be pilloried beside her on her pedestal of shame.”, what does “pilloried” most nearly mean?
   A. long spears with an axe blade, carried by guards
   B. happening at a bad time
   C. publicly punished and shamed, as in the pillory
   D. a person who speaks for someone else

Key: C (publicly punished and shamed, as in the pillory)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What do some townspeople suspect?

   A. Hester is cured

   B. The doctor is a saint

   C. Dimmesdale is a witch

   D. The doctor is Satan's agent

   Key: D (The doctor is Satan's agent)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What two meanings does 'leech' have?

   A. Farmer and herb

   B. Thief and sailor

   C. Priest and judge

   D. Doctor and bloodsucker

   Key: D (Doctor and bloodsucker)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from IX: The Leech, paragraph 7: “it had now become a _____ habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart”

   Key: constant

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “This idea was countenanced by the strong interest which the physician ever manifested in the young clergyman; he attached himself to him as a _____, and sought to win a friendly regard and confidence from his naturally reserved sensibility.” Word bank: vilified, parishioner, decried, pilloried

   Key: parishioner

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Here the pale clergyman piled up his library, rich with parchment-bound folios of the Fathers, and the lore of Rabbis, and monkish erudition, of which the Protestant divines, even while they vilified and decried that…”, what does “decried” most nearly mean?

   A. an unhealthy gloominess of mind

   B. prying and suspicious, like an investigator

   C. publicly condemned

   D. the decorated front of a building

   Key: C (publicly condemned)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Here the pale clergyman piled up his library, rich with parchment-bound folios of the Fathers, and the lore of Rabbis, and monkish erudition, of which the Protestant divines, even while they vilified and decried that…”, what does “vilified” most nearly mean?

   A. spoke of with harsh, abusive criticism

   B. joking; fun

   C. not valued or loved

   D. payment for work; earnings

   Key: A (spoke of with harsh, abusive criticism)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Hawthorne call the chapter 'The Leech'?

    Sample answer: Chillingworth heals and drains Dimmesdale at once.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Dimmesdale's telltale gesture.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7)
    A. Pearl's question.
    B. Hester casts off the letter.
    C. Dimmesdale's telltale gesture.
    D. Anguish as his only truth.

    Key: C (Dimmesdale's telltale gesture.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “IX: The Leech”?
    A. The child at the brook-side
    B. The frame narrative and the found letter
    C. The leech
    D. The interview in prison

    Key: C (The leech)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “IX: The Leech”? Chillingworth becomes the minister's physician and companion; his face grows darker.
    A. Structure
    B. Theme
    C. Foreshadowing
    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “IX: The Leech”? People begin to whisper that the physician is Satan's emissary.
    A. Theme
    B. Foreshadowing
    C. Personification
    D. Metaphor

    Key: B (Foreshadowing)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The physician's care is a disguise for persecution.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Dimmesdale's habit "to press his hand over his heart" draws the physician close, and the town comes to believe he is haunted by "Satan's emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth."

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “So Roger Chillingworth—the man of skill, the kind and friendly physician—strove to go deep into his patient’s bosom, _____ among his principles, prying into his recollections, and probing everything with a cautious touch, like a treasure-seeker in a dark…” Word bank: vilified, delving, decried, pilloried
    Key: delving

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from IX: The Leech, paragraph 17: “the fire in his _____ had been brought from the lower regions”

    Key: laboratory

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from IX: The Leech, paragraph 18: “haunted either by Satan himself, or Satan’s emissary, in the guise of old Roger _____”

    Key: Chillingworth

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “With such commodiousness of situation, these two learned persons sat themselves down, each in his own domain, yet familiarly passing from one apartment to the other, and bestowing a mutual and not _____ inspection into one another’s business.” Word bank: incurious, pilloried, vilified, decried

    Key: incurious

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where do the two men live?

    A. In separate towns

    B. In the forest

    C. In the same house by the graveyard

    D. In the church

    Key: C (In the same house by the graveyard)

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17)

    A. The townspeople's suspicion.

    B. Why Hester returns.

    C. The letter at the brook's edge.

    D. Hester's refusal.

    Key: A (The townspeople's suspicion.)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret.

    A. Nature and the individual against society

    B. Sin and guilt

    C. Public shame and private identity

    D. Hypocrisy and truth

    Key: B (Sin and guilt)

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “haunted either by Satan himself, or Satan’s emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 18). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The town's suspicion.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7).

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale's habit "to press his hand over his heart" draws the physician close, and the town comes to believe he is haunted by "Satan's emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth."

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Skilful men, of the medical and chirurgical profession, were of rare occurrence in the colony.”, what does “chirurgical” most nearly mean?

    A. denies having (a motive or intention)

    B. playfully, in a teasing way

    C. surgical (old form)

    D. a sorcerer

    Key: C (surgical (old form))

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “haunted either by Satan himself, or Satan’s emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 18)

    A. Hester's promise.

    B. Hawthorne refuses to revise.

    C. Hester's question.

    D. The town's suspicion.

    Key: D (The town's suspicion.)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale's telltale gesture.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The townspeople's suspicion.

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What profession does Chillingworth practice?

    A. Merchant

    B. Soldier

    C. Physician

    D. Minister

    Key: C (Physician)

31. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The townspeople's suspicion.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how sin and guilt develops from an earlier chapter to “IX: The Leech”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is the town's suspicion of Chillingworth wisdom or superstition? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view.

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 4, 9, 17, 18, 19, 20, 2, 21, 10, 22, 12, 13, 23, 24, 25, 16 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| HS Sophomore | 4, 18, 26, 20, 7, 17, 27, 13, 11, 22, 12, 14, 23, 15, 28, 29 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 7, 30, 6, 26, 18, 13, 31, 12, 22, 10, 14, 15, 25, 24, 28, 16 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 19, 17, 20, 2, 13, 12, 10, 22, 11, 24, 15, 25, 14, 28, 32, 16 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 7, 5, 2, 12, 10, 13, 11, 23, 25, 24, 14, 15, 32, 16, 28, 33 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 2, 18, 8, 27, 11, 22, 12, 15, 25, 14, 24, 23, 16, 28, 33, 29 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 2, 7, 22, 10, 12, 11, 24, 25, 14, 15, 23, 28, 29, 16, 33, 32 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 17, 2, 12, 11, 22, 10, 24, 25, 23, 15, 14, 29, 16, 33, 32, 28 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 2, 7, 22, 31, 27, 13, 23, 24, 14, 15, 25, 32, 33, 29, 16, 28 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 2, 7, 12, 11, 13, 10, 15, 24, 25, 14, 23, 33, 16, 29, 32, 28 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “IX: The Leech,” how does Hawthorne show the leech? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In IX: The Leech, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the leech? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how IX: The Leech develops the idea of the leech. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of IX: The Leech (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the leech. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what IX: The Leech suggests about the leech. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses characterization in IX: The Leech to complicate the reader's understanding of the

leech. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate IX: The Leech within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the leech responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read IX: The Leech alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the leech follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to IX: The Leech and its treatment of the leech. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads IX: The Leech as evidence for a larger claim about the leech in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads IX: The Leech as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the leech. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Here the pale clergyman piled up his library, rich with parchment-bound folios of the Fathers, and the lore of Rabbis, and monkish erudition, of which the Protestant divines, even while they vilified and decried that class of writers, were yet constrained often to avail themselves.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “decried” most nearly mean?

   A. publicly condemned

   B. lacking curiosity (here 'not incurious' means quite curious)

   C. digging or searching deeply

   D. a member of a minister's congregation

2. *This idea was countenanced by the strong interest which the physician ever manifested in the young clergyman; he attached himself to him as a parishioner, and sought to win a friendly regard and confidence from his naturally reserved sensibility. He expressed great alarm at his pastor’s state of health, but was anxious to attempt the cure, and, if early undertaken, seemed not despondent of a favorable result. The elders, the deacons, the motherly dames, and the young and fair maidens, of Mr. Dimmesdale’s flock, were alike*

*importunate that he should make trial of the physician's frankly offered skill. Mr. Dimmesdale gently repelled their entreaties.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "IX: The Leech"?

A. The interview in prison

B. Hester at her needle

C. The leech

D. The frame narrative and the found letter

**SAT key:** 1. A (publicly condemned); 2. C (The leech)

# Lesson 13: X: The Leech and His Patient

**Focus:** the physician probes the minister

**Objective:** Students will analyze how structure develops in “X: The Leech and His Patient” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

**Critical voice:** “There is a strange fascination to a man of contemplative genius in the psychological details of a strange crime like that which forms the plot of the Scarlet Letter, and he is therefore apt to become, like Hawthorne, too painfully anatomical in his exhibition of them.” (Edwin Percy Whipple (attrib.; the review is unsigned), critic, *Review of The Scarlet Letter, Graham's Magazine 36:5 (May 1850), "Review of New Books", review*; public domain). Irony: Chillingworth is a physician who "anatomizes" the minister. Is Hawthorne doing the same to his characters? *Objective:* Analyze Chillingworth's psychological probing of Dimmesdale. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3

Teacher only · spoilers

Chillingworth digs ever deeper into Dimmesdale's mind. Over black weeds from an unmarked grave they argue about why some men never confess. Pearl, in the graveyard, throws a burr at the minister and calls the physician the Black Man. Later Chillingworth opens the sleeping minister's vestment, sees something on his breast, and reacts with wild joy.

**Background:** Puritans believed God sometimes revealed hidden sin through signs; Hawthorne plays with such 'types' and 'emblems'.

**Significance:** Chillingworth's search ends in near-certainty and a joy like Satan's.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *When should a person confess a secret wrong? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to hypocrisy and truth because....*
> **Prompt:** When should a person confess a secret wrong?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to hypocrisy and truth because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: bespatter — splash (with water or mud); palliate — make (a wrong) seem less serious; forebode — predict or sense (something) in advance; irreverently — without proper respect; morbidness — an unhealthy gloominess of mind. "morbidness": Origin: an English formation from morbid + -ness.*
**Words:** bespatter: splash (with water or mud) · palliate: make (a wrong) seem less serious · forebode: predict or sense (something) in advance · irreverently: without proper respect · morbidness: an unhealthy gloominess of mind

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Puritans believed God sometimes revealed hidden sin through signs; Hawthorne plays with such 'types' and 'emblems'. Chillingworth's search ends in near-certainty and a joy like Satan's. Structure: Under talk of weeds on an unmarked grave, the physician and the minister argue about whether hidden sinners should confess. Symbolism: Black weeds that "have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime." Foreshadowing: Chillingworth opens the sleeping minister's vestment and sees something that fills him with ghastly rapture. Watch for Pearl: She throws a burr at the minister and calls the physician the Black Man.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" slowly and put it in my own words: Chillingworth says the dark weeds grew from a buried heart to show an unconfessed crime. Next, craft. I notice the symbolic image of guilt growing from a grave. The strongest word is "unspoken": it points directly at secret sin. Then, effect. What does Chillingworth suggest with the black weeds? My answer: With the black weeds, Chillingworth suggests that hidden sin grows out of a buried heart and will show itself; he is testing Dimmesdale and putting pressure on the guilty minister.*

> *these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" slowly and put it in my own words: Chillingworth says the dark weeds grew from a buried heart to show an unconfessed crime. Next, craft. I notice the symbolic image of guilt growing from a grave. The strongest word is "unspoken": it points directly at secret sin. Then, effect. What does Chillingworth suggest with the black weeds? My answer: With the black weeds, Chillingworth suggests that hidden sin grows out of a buried heart and will show itself; he is testing Dimmesdale and putting pressure on the guilty minister.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Dimmesdale says Pearl has "the freedom of a broken law." Expected link: Pearl as the letter alive; the minister half-confessing. Ask: How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth? Expected: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. (Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.)*

> *None, save the freedom of a broken law (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Dimmesdale says Pearl has "the freedom of a broken law." Expected link: Pearl as the letter alive; the minister half-confessing.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth?
**Expected answer:** Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. (Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for structure, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the physician probes the minister? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how X: The Leech and His Patient develops the idea of the physician probes the minister. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)*
*Exemplar: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. When the text says “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10), it shows this directly. He describes weeds springing "out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" and insists "These men deceive themselves," and when he finally sees the minister's breast his joy differs from Satan's only by "the trait of wonder in it!"*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for structure, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the physician probes the minister? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how X: The Leech and His Patient develops the idea of the physician probes the minister. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. When the text says “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10), it shows this directly. He describes weeds springing "out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" and insists "These men deceive themselves," and when he finally sees the minister's breast his joy differs from Satan's only by "the trait of wonder in it!"

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: When should a person confess a secret wrong? Ask: who controls this conversation, and how can you tell?*
**Anchor question:** When should a person confess a secret wrong?
**Facilitation:** Ask: who controls this conversation, and how can you tell?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the physician probes the minister? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. ("these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime", X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the physician probes the minister? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. ("these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime", X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how structure shapes the physician probes the minister. Key takeaway: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Structure:** Under talk of weeds on an unmarked grave, the physician and the minister argue about whether hidden sinners should confess.
- **Symbolism:** Black weeds that "have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime."
- **Foreshadowing:** Chillingworth opens the sleeping minister's vestment and sees something that fills him with ghastly rapture.

### Themes and how they develop

- **hypocrisy and truth:** Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception.

### Symbols and motifs

- **Pearl:** She throws a burr at the minister and calls the physician the Black Man.

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10) Chillingworth's probing image.
- “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16) Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners.
- “None, save the freedom of a broken law” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21) Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.
- “But what distinguished the physician’s ecstasy from Satan’s was the trait of wonder in it” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 45) The end of the chapter.

### Model claim-evidence-reasoning

**Claim:** Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret.
**Evidence:** “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10)
**Reasoning:** He describes weeds springing "out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" and insists "These men deceive themselves," and when he finally sees the minister's breast his joy differs from Satan's only by "the trait of wonder in it!"

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **bespatter** (verb) | splash (with water or mud) | *“I saw her, the other day, bespatter the Governor himself with water, at the cattle-trough in Spring Lane.* | |
| **palliate** (verb) | make (a wrong) seem less serious | *The young clergyman, after a few hours of privacy, was sensible that the disorder of his nerves had hurried him into an unseemly outbreak of temper, which there had been nothing in the physician’s words to excuse or palliate.* | |
| **forebode** (verb) | predict or sense (something) in advance | *“There can be, if I forebode aright, no power, short of the Divine mercy, to disclose, whether by uttered words, or by type or emblem, the secrets that may be buried with a human heart.* | |
| **irreverently** (adverb) | without proper respect | *She now skipped irreverently from one grave to another; until, coming to the broad, flat, armorial tombstone of a* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | *departed worthy—perhaps of Isaac Johnson himself—she began to dance upon it.* | |
| **morbidness** (noun) | an unhealthy gloominess of mind | *Dimmesdale would perhaps have seen this individual's character more perfectly, if a certain morbidness, to which sick hearts are liable, had not rendered him suspicious of all mankind.* | "morbidness": Origin: an English formation from morbid + -ness. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/morbidness#Etymology) |
| **proffering** (verb) | offering | *He marvelled, indeed, at the violence with which he had thrust back the kind old man, when merely proffering the advice which it was his duty to bestow, and which the minister himself had expressly sought.* | |
| **griping** (verb) | gripping tightly | *"They mostly do," said the clergyman, griping hard at his breast as if afflicted with an importunate throb of pain.* | |
| **waiving** (verb) | setting aside; declining to pursue | *"It may be so," said the young clergyman, indifferently, as waiving a discussion that he considered irrelevant or unseasonable.* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. When should a person confess a secret wrong?
2. Where does structure appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with public shame and private identity?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What does Pearl call Chillingworth? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Black Man.
2. Where did the physician find the black weeds? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: On an unmarked grave
3. What does Dimmesdale say keeps some sinners silent? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Their nature and their zeal for good works
4. What does Pearl throw? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A burr

5. What does Chillingworth do while the minister sleeps? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Opens his vestment
6. How does Chillingworth react? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: With ghastly rapture
7. Retell the three most important events of "X: The Leech and His Patient" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Chillingworth digs ever deeper into Dimmesdale's mind. Over black weeds from an unmarked grave they argue about why some men never confess. Pearl, in the graveyard, throws a burr at the minister and calls the physician the Black Man. Later Chillingworth opens the sleeping minister's vestment, sees something on his breast, and reacts with wild joy.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "X: The Leech and His Patient"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "X: The Leech and His Patient" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: ""I saw her, the other day, bespatter the Governor himself with water, at the cattle-trough in Spring Lane." What does "bespatter" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: bespatter: splash (with water or mud).

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does the talk about weeds unsettle Dimmesdale? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: They suggest buried sin must come out.
2. What does "X: The Leech and His Patient" suggest about the physician probes the minister? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Chillingworth's search ends in near-certainty and a joy like Satan's.
3. Find one example of structure in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
4. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about the physician probes the minister? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: "these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10): Chillingworth's probing image. On symbolism: Black weeds that "have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Yet Mr.", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "X: The Leech and His Patient", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Chillingworth digs ever deeper into Dimmesdale's mind. Over black weeds from an unmarked grave they argue about why some men never confess. Pearl, in the

graveyard, throws a burr at the minister and calls the physician the Black Man. Later Chillingworth opens the sleeping minister's vestment, sees…

7. How does “X: The Leech and His Patient” build on “IX: The Leech”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16): Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners. On structure: Under talk of weeds on an unmarked grave, the physician and the minister argue about whether hidden sinners should confess. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “None, save the freedom of a broken law” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21): Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature. Theme link: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “When should a person confess a secret wrong?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with public shame and private identity? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “But what distinguished the physician’s ecstasy from Satan’s was the trait of wonder in it” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 45): The end of the chapter. On foreshadowing: Chillingworth opens the sleeping minister's vestment and sees something that fills him with ghastly rapture. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Why doesn't Hawthorne say what Chillingworth sees? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view about ambiguity.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10): Chillingworth's probing image. Theme link: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Chillingworth's search ends in near-certainty and a joy like Satan's.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2,

SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16): Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners. Theme link: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “None, save the freedom of a broken law” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21): Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature. Theme link: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “X: The Leech and His Patient” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the physician probes the minister? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “But what distinguished the physician’s ecstasy from Satan’s was the trait of wonder in it” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 45): The end of the chapter. Theme link: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “X: The Leech and His Patient”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10): Chillingworth's probing image. Theme link: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to hypocrisy and truth: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16): Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners. Theme link: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the structure in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “None, save the freedom of a broken law” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21): Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature. On structure: Under talk of weeds on an unmarked grave, the physician and the minister argue about whether hidden sinners should confess. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “X: The Leech and His Patient” treats the physician probes the minister with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “But what distinguished the physician’s ecstasy from Satan’s was the trait of wonder in it” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 45): The end of the chapter. Theme link: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “XI: The Interior of a Heart” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10): Chillingworth's probing image. On foreshadowing: Chillingworth opens the sleeping minister's vestment and sees something that fills him with ghastly rapture. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the physician probes the minister? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16): Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners. Theme link: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Structure:** look for how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21: “None, save the _____ of a broken law”
   Key: freedom
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line ““I saw her, the other day, bespatter the Governor himself with water, at the cattle-trough in Spring Lane.”, what does “bespatter” most nearly mean?
   A. forever, beyond death
   B. splash (with water or mud)
   C. stubbornly defying authority
   D. a reddish glow
   Key: B (splash (with water or mud))
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: ““It may be so,” said the young clergyman, indifferently, as _____ a discussion that he considered irrelevant or unseasonable.” Word bank: forebode, palliate, bespatter, waiving
   Key: waiving
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 45: “But what _____ the physician’s ecstasy from Satan’s was the trait of wonder in it”
   Key: distinguished
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10: “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make _____ an unspoken crime”
   Key: manifest
6. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Pearl call Chillingworth?
   Sample answer: The Black Man.
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The young clergyman, after a few hours of privacy, was sensible that the disorder of his nerves had hurried him into an unseemly outbreak of temper, which there had been nothing in the physician’s words to excuse or…”, what does “palliate” most nearly mean?
   A. not yet healed
   B. make (a wrong) seem less serious
   C. lack of modesty or tact
   D. one's deepest feelings
   Key: B (make (a wrong) seem less serious)
8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: ““They mostly do,” said the clergyman, _____ hard at his breast as if afflicted with an importunate throb of pain.” Word bank: griping, palliate, forebode, bespatter
   Key: griping
9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Chillingworth react?
   A. With pity
   B. With fear
   C. With ghastly rapture
   D. With sorrow
   Key: C (With ghastly rapture)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16)
    A. Hester to Pearl: town against forest.
    B. Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners.
    C. One account of the revelation.
    D. The letter's mysterious power.

    Key: B (Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “None, save the freedom of a broken law” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21)
    A. Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.
    B. The opening, with its ironic self-presentation.
    C. Hester's question.
    D. The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse."

    Key: A (Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “But what distinguished the physician’s ecstasy from Satan’s was the trait of wonder in it” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 45)
    A. The end of the chapter.
    B. Hester's freedom.
    C. His vow.
    D. Hester's appearance on the holiday.

    Key: A (The end of the chapter.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does the talk about weeds unsettle Dimmesdale?
    Sample answer: They suggest buried sin must come out.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “X: The Leech and His Patient”? Under talk of weeds on an unmarked grave, the physician and the minister argue about whether hidden sinners should confess.
    A. Simile
    B. Allusion
    C. Alliteration
    D. Structure

    Key: D (Structure)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “X: The Leech and His Patient”? Black weeds that "have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime."
    A. Symbolism
    B. Structure
    C. Irony
    D. Tone / mood

    Key: A (Symbolism)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage

that complicates it.

Sample answer: He describes weeds springing "out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" and insists "These men deceive themselves," and when he finally sees the minister's breast his joy differs from Satan's only by "the trait of wonder in it!"

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Chillingworth do while the minister sleeps?

    A. Opens his vestment

    B. Leaves the house

    C. Poisons him

    D. Prays

    Key: A (Opens his vestment)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He marvelled, indeed, at the violence with which he had thrust back the kind old man, when merely _____ the advice which it was his duty to bestow, and which the minister himself had expressly sought.” Word bank: proffering, forebode, bespatter, palliate

    Key: proffering

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Dimmesdale say keeps some sinners silent?

    A. Their nature and their zeal for good works

    B. Love of money

    C. Ignorance

    D. Fear of hell

    Key: A (Their nature and their zeal for good works)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where did the physician find the black weeds?

    A. In the forest

    B. In the garden

    C. On an unmarked grave

    D. By the sea

    Key: C (On an unmarked grave)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth's probing image.

22. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners.

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception.

    A. Public shame and private identity

    B. Nature and the individual against society

    C. Hypocrisy and truth

    D. Sin and guilt

Key: C (Hypocrisy and truth)

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10).
    Sample answer: He describes weeds springing "out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" and insists "These men deceive themselves," and when he finally sees the minister's breast his joy differs from Satan's only by "the trait of wonder in it!"

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “X: The Leech and His Patient”?
    A. The New England holiday
    B. The pastor and his parishioner
    C. The physician probes the minister
    D. The frame narrative and the found letter

    Key: C (The physician probes the minister)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “None, save the freedom of a broken law” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Chillingworth's probing image.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how hypocrisy and truth develops from an earlier chapter to “X: The Leech and His Patient”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception.

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “She now skipped irreverently from one grave to another; until, coming to the broad, flat, armorial tombstone of a departed worthy—perhaps of Isaac Johnson himself—she began to dance upon it.”, what does “irreverently” most nearly mean?
    A. took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering
    B. without proper respect
    C. doorways; the entrance of a house
    D. make more kind, gentle and human

    Key: B (without proper respect)

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Dimmesdale would perhaps have seen this individual’s character more perfectly, if a certain _____, to which sick hearts are liable, had not rendered him suspicious of all mankind.” Word bank: bespatter, morbidness, forebode, palliate
    Key: morbidness

31. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Pearl throw?
    A. A stone
    B. A burr
    C. A rose
    D. A shell

Key: B (A burr)

32. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10)

    A. The letter isolates Hester.

    B. Dimmesdale's telltale gesture.

    C. Chillingworth's probing image.

    D. Pearl's dress.

    Key: C (Chillingworth's probing image.)

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Why doesn't Hawthorne say what Chillingworth sees? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view about ambiguity.

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 1, 17, 2, 18, 7, 9, 19, 20, 11, 21, 10, 22, 23, 24, 14, 16 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 8, 19, 20, 18, 7, 9, 13, 12, 25, 10, 11, 23, 15, 26, 27, 28 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 29, 30, 3, 20, 31, 10, 32, 12, 21, 11, 24, 14, 15, 26, 33, 28 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 19, 1, 31, 4, 12, 11, 13, 32, 22, 15, 24, 14, 23, 28, 27, 16 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 30, 20, 1, 22, 12, 21, 13, 26, 15, 24, 23, 14, 27, 34, 33, 16 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 29, 1, 8, 12, 11, 22, 10, 24, 15, 23, 26, 14, 34, 16, 33, 28 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 30, 8, 11, 13, 10, 22, 15, 24, 26, 23, 14, 16, 33, 27, 28, 34 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 30, 18, 22, 13, 32, 11, 23, 24, 15, 14, 26, 16, 28, 33, 27, 34 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 30, 18, 21, 10, 13, 11, 15, 23, 14, 24, 26, 16, 33, 34, 28, 27 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 5, 30, 21, 11, 13, 22, 24, 26, 14, 23, 15, 16, 27, 28, 33, 34 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “X: The Leech and His Patient,” how does Hawthorne show the physician probes the minister? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In X: The Leech and His Patient, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the physician probes the minister? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how X: The Leech and His Patient develops the idea of the physician probes the minister. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of X: The Leech and His Patient (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of the physician probes the minister. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what X: The Leech and His Patient suggests about the physician probes the minister. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's structure and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses structure in X: The Leech and His Patient to complicate the reader's understanding of the physician probes the minister. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate X: The Leech and His Patient within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the physician probes the minister responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read X: The Leech and His Patient alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the physician probes the minister follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to X: The Leech and His Patient and its treatment of the physician probes the minister. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's structure and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads X: The Leech and His Patient as evidence for a larger claim about the physician probes the minister in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads X: The Leech and His Patient as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the physician probes the minister. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *"There can be, if I forebode aright, no power, short of the Divine mercy, to disclose, whether by uttered words, or by type or emblem, the secrets that may be buried with a human heart.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "forebode" most nearly mean?

   A. gripping tightly

   B. setting aside; declining to pursue

   C. offering

   D. predict or sense (something) in advance

2. *Yet Mr. Dimmesdale would perhaps have seen this individual's character more perfectly, if a certain morbidness, to which sick hearts are liable, had not rendered him suspicious of all mankind. Trusting no man as his friend, he could not recognize his enemy when the latter actually appeared. He therefore still kept up a familiar intercourse with him, daily receiving the old physician in his study; or visiting the laboratory, and, for recreation's sake, watching the processes by which weeds were converted into drugs of potency.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "X: The Leech and His Patient"?

   A. The frame narrative and the found letter

   B. The physician probes the minister

   C. Hester and Pearl

   D. The recognition

**SAT key:** 1. D (predict or sense (something) in advance); 2. B (The physician probes the minister)

# Lesson 14: XI: The Interior of a Heart

**Focus:** the interior of a heart

**Objective:** Students will analyze how irony develops in "XI: The Interior of a Heart" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

**Content note (self-harm):** Dimmesdale scourges himself, fasts and keeps sleepless vigils out of guilt. Treat this as self-harm with care: do not dwell on details, and remind students that support is available.
**Student preview:** A character hurts himself out of guilt. Support is available if this is hard to read.
**Suggested language:** "What is guilt doing to Dimmesdale?"
**Safe messaging:** Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Dimmesdale's suffering makes him a more powerful preacher; his people revere him more as he calls himself vile. He fasts, keeps vigils and scourges himself in a locked closet, sees visions, and cannot confess.

**Background:** Puritan ministers were the colony's intellectual leaders; fasting and self-examination were accepted disciplines, but self-scourging was associated with Catholic penance.

**Significance:** His vague confessions turn truth into a deeper lie.

## *Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Is admitting you are bad in general the same as confessing a specific wrong? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to hypocrisy and truth because.... Content note before we start: A character hurts himself out of guilt. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.*
**Prompt:** Is admitting you are bad in general the same as confessing a specific wrong?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to hypocrisy and truth because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: diabolic — devilish; introspection — examining one's own thoughts and feelings; reputations — what people generally think of someone; saintlike — holy, like a saint; attestation — proof or confirmation. "introspection": Origin: Latin intrōspectiō. "attestation": Origin: Middle French attestation; earlier Latin attestātiō.*
**Words:** diabolic: devilish · introspection: examining one's own thoughts and feelings · reputations: what people generally think of someone · saintlike: holy, like a saint · attestation: proof or confirmation

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Puritan ministers were the colony's intellectual leaders; fasting and self-examination were accepted disciplines, but self-scourging was associated with Catholic penance. His vague confessions turn truth into a deeper lie. Irony: The more Dimmesdale suffers, the more powerful his sermons and the more the people revere him. Characterization: He tells his congregation he is vile, and they hear humility. Imagery: Self-scourging, fasting and visions in the dark closet. Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "had previously been. The intellect of Roger Chillingworth had now a sufficiently plain path before it. It was not, indeed, precisely that" (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 1).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood" slowly and put it in my own words: Dimmesdale tells his congregation that he is a vile sinner, but they take his words as proof of his holy humility. Next, craft. I notice the paradox "spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood," which sets truth and lie side by side. The strongest word is "falsehood": it shows how a true statement, made vaguely, becomes a lie. Then, effect. Why does Dimmesdale's public confession make his guilt worse? My answer: Dimmesdale's public confession makes his guilt worse because he never names his sin, so the congregation thinks him even holier; each sermon deepens his self-hatred and his hypocrisy.*

> *He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood" slowly and put it in my own words: Dimmesdale tells his congregation that he is a vile sinner, but they take his words as proof of his holy humility. Next, craft. I notice the paradox "spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood," which sets truth and lie side by side. The strongest word is "falsehood": it shows how a true statement, made vaguely, becomes a lie. Then, effect. Why does Dimmesdale's public confession make his guilt worse? My answer: Dimmesdale's public confession makes his guilt worse because he never names his sin, so the congregation thinks him even holier; each sermon deepens his self-hatred and his hypocrisy.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The congregation reads his self-accusation as saintliness. Expected link: irony; hypocrisy and truth. Ask: How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth? Expected: His "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. (Anguish as his only truth.)*

> *The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** The congregation reads his self-accusation as saintliness. Expected link: irony; hypocrisy and truth.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth?
**Expected answer:** His "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. (Anguish as his only truth.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the interior of a heart? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XI: The Interior of a Heart develops the idea of the interior of a heart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. When the text says “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9), it shows this directly. Hawthorne says he "had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood," and that only "the anguish in his inmost soul" gives him "a real existence."*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the interior of a heart? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XI: The Interior of a Heart develops the idea of the interior of a heart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. When the text says “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9), it shows this directly. Hawthorne says he "had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood," and that only "the anguish in his inmost soul" gives him "a real existence."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Is admitting you are bad in general the same as confessing a specific wrong? Ask: is Dimmesdale a coward, a hypocrite, a victim, or all three?*
**Anchor question:** Is admitting you are bad in general the same as confessing a specific wrong?
**Facilitation:** Ask: is Dimmesdale a coward, a hypocrite, a victim, or all three?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the interior of a heart? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. ("The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul", XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the interior of a heart? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. ("The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul", XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how irony shapes the interior of a heart. Key takeaway: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Irony:** The more Dimmesdale suffers, the more powerful his sermons and the more the people revere him.
- **Characterization:** He tells his congregation he is vile, and they hear humility.
- **Imagery:** Self-scourging, fasting and visions in the dark closet.

### Themes and how they develop

- **hypocrisy and truth:** his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie.

### Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "had previously been. The intellect of Roger Chillingworth had now a sufficiently plain path before it. It was not, indeed, precisely that" (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: "to him, the Pitiless, to him, the Unforgiving! All that dark treasure to be lavished on the very man, to whom nothing" (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 1).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood" (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7) The core of his hypocrisy.
- "It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his" (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9) The cost of falseness.
- "The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul" (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9) Anguish as his only truth.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence.
**Evidence:** "The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul" (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9)
**Reasoning:** Hawthorne says he "had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood," and that only "the anguish in his inmost soul" gives him "a real existence."

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **diabolic** (adjective) | devilish | *Now it was a herd of diabolic shapes, that grinned and mocked at the pale minister, and beckoned him away with them; now a group of shining angels, who flew upward heavily, as sorrow-laden, but grew more ethereal as they rose.* | |
| **introspection** (noun) | examining one's own thoughts and feelings | *He thus typified the constant introspection wherewith he tortured, but could not purify, himself.* | "introspection": Origin: Latin intrōspectiō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/introspection#Etymology) |
| **reputations** (noun) | what people generally think of someone | *His fame, though still on its upward slope, already overshadowed the soberer reputations of his fellow-clergymen, eminent as several of them were.* | |
| **saintlike** (adjective) | holy, like a saint | *Now came the dead friends of his youth, and his white-bearded father, with a saintlike frown, and his mother, turning her face away as she passed by.* | |
| **attestation** (noun) | proof or confirmation | *These fathers, otherwise so apostolic, lacked Heaven's last and rarest attestation of their office, the Tongue of Flame.* | "attestation": Origin: Middle French attestation; earlier Latin attestātiō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https:// |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | en.wiktionary.org/wiki/attestation#Etymology) |
| **wreaked** (verb) | inflicted (revenge or harm) | *Calm, gentle, passionless, as he appeared, there was yet, we fear, a quiet depth of malice, hitherto latent, but active now, in this unfortunate old man, which led him to imagine a more intimate revenge than any mortal had ever wreaked upon an enemy.* | |
| **infecting** (verb) | spreading disease or corruption into | *Dimmesdale, conscious that the poison of one morbid spot was infecting his heart's entire substance, attributed all his presentiments to no other cause.* | "infecting": Origin of "infect": Middle French infect; earlier Latin infectus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/infect#Etymology) |
| **mouthpiece** (noun) | a person who speaks for someone else | *They fancied him the mouthpiece of Heaven's messages of wisdom, and rebuke, and love.* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Is admitting you are bad in general the same as confessing a specific wrong?
2. Where does irony appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with hypocrisy and truth?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What does he do in his vigils? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He sits up at night, sometimes looking at his face in a mirror by lamplight.
2. What makes Dimmesdale's sermons powerful? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His own suffering
3. How do his people react when he calls himself vile? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: They revere him more
4. What does he use on himself in the closet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A scourge
5. What does he see in his visions? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Figures including his parents and Hester

6. Why can he not confess? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He lacks the courage
7. Retell the three most important events of "XI: The Interior of a Heart" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Dimmesdale's suffering makes him a more powerful preacher; his people revere him more as he calls himself vile. He fasts, keeps vigils and scourges himself in a locked closet, sees visions, and cannot confess.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XI: The Interior of a Heart"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XI: The Interior of a Heart" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "Now it was a herd of diabolic shapes, that grinned and mocked at the pale minister, and beckoned him away with them; now a group of shining angels, who flew upward heavily, as sorrow-laden, but grew more ethereal as…" What does "diabolic" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: diabolic: devilish.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why is his vague confession worse than silence? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: It wins praise and hides the truth.
2. What does "XI: The Interior of a Heart" suggest about the interior of a heart? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: His vague confessions turn truth into a deeper lie.
3. Find one example of irony in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the interior of a heart? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: "He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood" (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7): The core of his hypocrisy. On characterization: He tells his congregation he is vile, and they hear humility. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "After the incident last described, the intercourse between the clergyman and the physician, though externally the same, was really of another character than it had previously been.", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "XI: The Interior of a Heart", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Dimmesdale's suffering makes him a more powerful preacher; his people revere him more as he calls himself vile. He fasts, keeps vigils and scourges himself in a locked closet, sees visions, and cannot confess.

7. How does “XI: The Interior of a Heart” build on “X: The Leech and His Patient”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9): The cost of falseness. Theme link: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9): Anguish as his only truth. On characterization: He tells his congregation he is vile, and they hear humility. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is admitting you are bad in general the same as confessing a specific wrong?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with hypocrisy and truth? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7): The core of his hypocrisy. On imagery: Self-scourging, fasting and visions in the dark closet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Dimmesdale a hypocrite or a victim? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9): The cost of falseness. Theme link: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “His vague confessions turn truth into a deeper lie.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9): Anguish as his only

truth. Theme link: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7): The core of his hypocrisy. On characterization: He tells his congregation he is vile, and they hear humility. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “XI: The Interior of a Heart” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the interior of a heart? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9): The cost of falseness. Theme link: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “XI: The Interior of a Heart”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9): Anguish as his only truth. Theme link: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to nature and the individual against society: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7): The core of his hypocrisy. Theme link: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9): The cost of falseness. On irony: The more Dimmesdale suffers, the more powerful his sermons and the more the people revere him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XI: The Interior of a Heart” treats the interior of a heart with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9): Anguish as his only truth. Theme link: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “XII: The Minister’s Vigil” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7): The core of his hypocrisy. Theme link: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the interior of a heart? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9): The cost of falseness. Theme link: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7: “He had spoken the very truth, and _____ it into the veriest falsehood”
   Key: transformed
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Now came the dead friends of his youth, and his white-bearded father, with a saintlike frown, and his mother, turning her face away as she passed by.”, what does “saintlike” most nearly mean?
   A. open the fastening of
   B. returned (a feeling or gesture)
   C. holy, like a saint
   D. a poisonous plant

Key: C (holy, like a saint)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why can he not confess?

   A. He forgets

   B. He lacks the courage

   C. He is innocent

   D. He is forbidden

   Key: B (He lacks the courage)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does he see in his visions?

   A. The devil only

   B. Heaven

   C. Figures including his parents and Hester

   D. The sea

   Key: C (Figures including his parents and Hester)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9: "It is the _____ misery of a life so false as his"

   Key: unspeakable

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "His fame, though still on its upward slope, already overshadowed the soberer reputations of his fellow-clergymen, eminent as several of them were.", what does "reputations" most nearly mean?

   A. bringing back to life in the imagination

   B. open the fastening of

   C. what people generally think of someone

   D. kindly, like a grandfather

   Key: C (what people generally think of someone)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does he use on himself in the closet?

   A. A sword

   B. A rope

   C. Fire

   D. A scourge

   Key: D (A scourge)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "These fathers, otherwise so apostolic, lacked Heaven's last and rarest _____ of their office, the Tongue of Flame." Word bank: introspection, reputations, diabolic, attestation

   Key: attestation

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Dimmesdale, conscious that the poison of one morbid spot was _____ his heart's entire substance, attributed all his presentiments to no other cause." Word bank: reputations, introspection, diabolic, infecting

   Key: infecting

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The cost of falseness.
11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7)
    A. The town's suspicion.
    B. The letter's mysterious power.
    C. The core of his hypocrisy.
    D. The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse."

    Key: C (The core of his hypocrisy.)
12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The core of his hypocrisy.
13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “XI: The Interior of a Heart”?
    A. A flood of sunshine
    B. The minister's vigil
    C. The pastor and his parishioner
    D. The interior of a heart

    Key: D (The interior of a heart)
14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XI: The Interior of a Heart”? He tells his congregation he is vile, and they hear humility.
    A. Simile
    B. Imagery
    C. Characterization
    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: C (Characterization)
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9).
    Sample answer: Hawthorne says he "had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood," and that only "the anguish in his inmost soul" gives him "a real existence."
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The cost of falseness.
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How do his people react when he calls himself vile?
    A. They laugh
    B. They revere him more
    C. They expel him
    D. They investigate

Key: B (They revere him more)

18. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does he do in his vigils?

    Sample answer: He sits up at night, sometimes looking at his face in a mirror by lamplight.

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “He thus typified the constant introspection wherewith he tortured, but could not purify, himself.”, what does “introspection” most nearly mean?

    A. happening at a bad time

    B. examining one's own thoughts and feelings

    C. spoke of with harsh, abusive criticism

    D. in a way that cannot be held back

    Key: B (examining one's own thoughts and feelings)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What makes Dimmesdale's sermons powerful?

    A. His own suffering

    B. His wealth

    C. His loud voice

    D. His fame in Oxford

    Key: A (His own suffering)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9)

    A. Pearl links the minister to the letter.

    B. The cost of falseness.

    C. Why Hester returns.

    D. Hester's promise.

    Key: B (The cost of falseness.)

22. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why is his vague confession worse than silence?

    Sample answer: It wins praise and hides the truth.

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? His "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie.

    A. Nature and the individual against society

    B. Public shame and private identity

    C. Sin and guilt

    D. Hypocrisy and truth

    Key: D (Hypocrisy and truth)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XI: The Interior of a Heart”? The more Dimmesdale suffers, the more powerful his sermons and the more the people revere him.

    A. Irony

    B. Structure

    C. Characterization

    D. Simile

    Key: A (Irony)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Hawthorne says he "had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood," and that only "the anguish in his inmost soul" gives him "a real existence."

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Calm, gentle, passionless, as he appeared, there was yet, we fear, a quiet depth of malice, hitherto latent, but active now, in this unfortunate old man, which led him to imagine a more intimate revenge than any mortal had ever _____ upon an enemy.” Word bank: introspection, diabolic, wreaked, reputations
    Key: wreaked

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “They fancied him the _____ of Heaven’s messages of wisdom, and rebuke, and love.” Word bank: reputations, diabolic, mouthpiece, introspection
    Key: mouthpiece

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9)

    A. Why she stays.

    B. Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.

    C. Anguish as his only truth.

    D. Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.

    Key: C (Anguish as his only truth.)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Anguish as his only truth.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Dimmesdale a hypocrite or a victim? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view.

31. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Now it was a herd of diabolic shapes, that grinned and mocked at the pale minister, and beckoned him away with them; now a group of shining angels, who flew upward heavily, as sorrow-laden, but grew more ethereal as…”, what does “diabolic” most nearly mean?

    A. being a sign of

    B. bonds or ties connecting people

    C. predict or sense (something) in advance

    D. devilish

    Key: D (devilish)

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The core of his hypocrisy.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how hypocrisy and truth develops from an earlier chapter to “XI: The Interior of a Heart”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie.

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 2, 17, 7, 18, 19, 9, 20, 8, 21, 22, 10, 13, 23, 24, 15, 25 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 26, 5, 18, 19, 20, 27, 22, 13, 12, 28, 21, 29, 24, 23, 16, 30 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 31, 27, 26, 5, 4, 12, 10, 22, 11, 28, 24, 14, 29, 15, 16, 32 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 9, 2, 27, 18, 22, 12, 21, 28, 10, 15, 23, 24, 14, 33, 25, 30 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 1, 8, 4, 12, 21, 10, 13, 24, 14, 15, 23, 29, 30, 33, 16, 32 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 27, 20, 5, 21, 28, 12, 10, 29, 23, 14, 15, 24, 33, 25, 16, 32 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 8, 26, 21, 22, 28, 11, 23, 15, 24, 29, 14, 25, 16, 30, 33, 32 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 8, 1, 22, 13, 21, 28, 15, 14, 23, 29, 24, 16, 30, 25, 32, 33 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 8, 26, 13, 28, 22, 12, 24, 15, 23, 29, 14, 32, 33, 25, 30, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 8, 26, 10, 22, 13, 21, 15, 14, 29, 23, 24, 32, 33, 16, 25, 30 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "XI: The Interior of a Heart," how does Hawthorne show the interior of a heart? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): In XI: The Interior of a Heart, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the interior of a heart? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XI: The Interior of a Heart develops the idea of the interior of a heart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XI: The Interior of a Heart (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's

understanding of the interior of a heart. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XI: The Interior of a Heart suggests about the interior of a heart. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses irony in XI: The Interior of a Heart to complicate the reader's understanding of the interior of a heart. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XI: The Interior of a Heart within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the interior of a heart responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XI: The Interior of a Heart alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the interior of a heart follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XI: The Interior of a Heart and its treatment of the interior of a heart. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XI: The Interior of a Heart as evidence for a larger claim about the interior of a heart in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XI: The Interior of a Heart as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the interior of a heart. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *His fame, though still on its upward slope, already overshadowed the soberer reputations of his fellow-clergymen, eminent as several of them were.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “reputations” most nearly mean?

   A. what people generally think of someone

   B. inflicted (revenge or harm)

C. spreading disease or corruption into

D. a person who speaks for someone else

2. *After the incident last described, the intercourse between the clergyman and the physician, though externally the same, was really of another character than it had previously been. The intellect of Roger Chillingworth had now a sufficiently plain path before it. It was not, indeed, precisely that which he had laid out for himself to tread. Calm, gentle, passionless, as he appeared, there was yet, we fear, a quiet depth of malice, hitherto latent, but active now, in this unfortunate old man, which led him to imagine a more intimate revenge than any mortal had ever wreaked upon an enemy. To make himself the one trusted friend, to whom should be confided all the fear, the remorse, the agony, the ineffectual repentance, the backward rush of sinful thoughts, expelled in vain! All that guilty sorrow, hidden from the world, whose great heart would have pitied and forgiven, to be revealed to him, the Pitiless, to him, the Unforgiving! All that dark treasure to be lavished on the very man, to whom nothing else could so adequately pay the debt of vengeance!*

Which choice best states a central concern of "XI: The Interior of a Heart"?

A. The interior of a heart

B. The frame narrative and the found letter

C. Conclusion

D. The elf-child and the minister

**SAT key:** 1. A (what people generally think of someone); 2. A (The interior of a heart)

# Lesson 15: XII: The Minister's Vigil

**Focus:** the minister's vigil

**Objective:** Students will analyze how setting develops in "XII: The Minister's Vigil" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

**Critical voice:** "In _The Scarlet Letter_ there is a great deal of symbolism; there is, I think, too much. It is overdone at times, and becomes mechanical; it ceases to be impressive, and grazes triviality." (Henry James, novelist and critic, *Hawthorne (English Men of Letters, 1879), Chapter V, Ch. V*; public domain). Debate: is the A in the sky the novel's worst moment (James) or its boldest? *Objective:* Evaluate the meteor and symbolism in the minister's vigil. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5

Teacher only · spoilers

One May midnight, Dimmesdale climbs the scaffold and shrieks; nobody wakes except Governor Bellingham and Mistress Hibbins, who see nothing. Hester and Pearl, returning from Governor Winthrop's deathbed, join him hand in hand. Pearl asks if he will stand with them at noon; he says no. A meteor lights the sky in the shape of an A, and Chillingworth is seen watching. Next day the sexton returns the minister's glove and reports the A in the sky means Angel.

**Background:** John Winthrop, the colony's first governor, died in March 1649; Hawthorne sets his death on the night of the vigil.

**Significance:** A secret confession in darkness changes nothing.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Does confessing in private count if no one sees? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to public shame and private identity because....*
> **Prompt:** Does confessing in private count if no one sees?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to public shame and private identity because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: thresholds — doorways; the entrance of a house; betokening — being a sign of; awfulness — a feeling of awe and dread; scurrilous — insulting and mocking; distorting — changing the true shape or meaning. "thresholds": Origin of "threshold": Old English þrescold ("doorsill"). "awfulness": Origin: an English formation from awful + -ness. "scurrilous": Origin: Latin scurrīlis ("buffoon-like").*
**Words:** thresholds: doorways; the entrance of a house · betokening: being a sign of · awfulness: a feeling of awe and dread · scurrilous: insulting and mocking · distorting: changing the true shape or meaning

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*John Winthrop, the colony's first governor, died in March 1649; Hawthorne sets his death on the night of the vigil. A secret confession in darkness changes nothing. Setting: Midnight in May; Dimmesdale stands on the scaffold where Hester stood seven years before. Symbolism: A meteor draws a great red "A" across the sky; the town reads it as "Angel" for Governor Winthrop. Irony: Pearl asks him to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and he will not. Watch for the scaffold: The three stand together in the dark, "an electric chain."*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide" slowly and put it in my own words: On the midnight scaffold, Pearl asks whether he will stand there with her mother and her at noon tomorrow. Next, craft. I notice the simple child's question, which demands in daylight what he will only do in the dark. The strongest word is "noontide": it means full noon, when the whole town would see them together. Then, effect. What is Pearl really asking Dimmesdale to do? My answer: Pearl asks for public acknowledgment; when Dimmesdale refuses and says "not tomorrow," the scene shows his fear and sets up his final confession on the same scaffold in daylight.*

> *Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide* *(XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 21)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide" slowly and put it in my own words: On the midnight scaffold, Pearl asks whether he will stand there with her mother and her at noon tomorrow. Next, craft. I notice the simple child's question, which demands in daylight what he will only do in the dark. The strongest word is "noontide": it means full noon, when the whole town would see them together. Then, effect. What is Pearl really asking Dimmesdale to do? My answer: Pearl asks for public acknowledgment; when Dimmesdale refuses and says "not tomorrow," the scene shows his fear and sets up his final confession on the same scaffold in daylight.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The returned glove and the sexton's line about "a pure hand" are dramatic irony. Expected link: irony and symbolism. Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity? Expected: A private, unseen confession that changes nothing. (The sexton's unknowing irony.)*

> *A pure hand needs no glove to cover it (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 49)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** The returned glove and the sexton's line about "a pure hand" are dramatic irony. Expected link: irony and symbolism.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to public shame and private identity?
**Expected answer:** A private, unseen confession that changes nothing. (The sexton's unknowing irony.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the minister's vigil? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XII: The Minister's Vigil develops the idea of the minister's vigil. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. When the text says "Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 21), it shows this directly. He refuses Pearl's request to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and the town reads the red letter as "Angel" while the sexton praises "a pure hand."*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the minister's vigil? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XII: The Minister's Vigil develops the idea of the minister's vigil. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. When the text says "Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 21), it shows this directly. He refuses Pearl's request to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and the town reads the red letter as "Angel" while the sexton praises "a pure hand."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Does confessing in private count if no one sees? Have students map the novel's three scaffold scenes and compare who stands there, when and who sees.*
**Anchor question:** Does confessing in private count if no one sees?
**Facilitation:** Have students map the novel's three scaffold scenes and compare who stands there, when and who sees.

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the minister's vigil? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. ("Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide", XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 21). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the minister's vigil? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. ("Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide", XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 21). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how setting shapes the minister's vigil. Key takeaway: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Setting:** Midnight in May; Dimmesdale stands on the scaffold where Hester stood seven years before.
- **Symbolism:** A meteor draws a great red "A" across the sky; the town reads it as "Angel" for Governor Winthrop.
- **Irony:** Pearl asks him to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and he will not.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **public shame and private identity:** a private, unseen confession that changes nothing.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the scaffold:** The three stand together in the dark, "an electric chain."

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 21) Pearl's question.
- "the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 51) The sexton's reading of the sign.
- "A pure hand needs no glove to cover it" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 49) The sexton's unknowing irony.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness.
**Evidence:** "Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 21)
**Reasoning:** He refuses Pearl's request to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and the town reads the red letter as "Angel" while the sexton praises "a pure hand."

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **thresholds** (noun) | doorways; the entrance of a house | *All people, in a word, would come stumbling over their thresholds, and turning up their amazed and horror-stricken visages around the scaffold.* | "thresholds": Origin of "threshold": Old English þrescold ("doorsill"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/threshold#Etymology) |
| **betokening** (verb) | being a sign of | *The belief was a favorite one with our forefathers, as betokening that their infant commonwealth was under a celestial guardianship of peculiar intimacy and strictness.* | |
| **awfulness** (noun) | a feeling of awe and dread | *It showed the familiar scene of the street, with the distinctness of midday, but also with the awfulness that is always imparted to familiar objects by an unaccustomed light.* | "awfulness": Origin: an English formation from awful + -ness. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/awfulness#Etymology) |
| **scurrilous** (adjective) | insulting and mocking | *Satan dropped it there, I take it, intending a scurrilous jest against your reverence.* | "scurrilous": Origin: Latin scurrīlis ("buffoon-like"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/scurrilous#Etymology) |
| **distorting** (adjective) | changing the true shape or meaning | *Oftener, however, its credibility rested on the faith of some lonely eyewitness, who beheld the wonder through the colored, magnifying, and distorting medium of his imagination, and shaped it more distinctly in his afterthought.* | |
| **meteoric** (adjective) | having to do with meteors or bright objects in the sky | *Nothing was more common, in those days, than to interpret all meteoric appearances, and other natural phenomena, that occurred with less regularity than the rise and set of sun and moon, as so many revelations from a supernatural source.* | |
| **credibility** (noun) | the quality of being believable | *Oftener, however, its credibility rested on the faith of some lonely eyewitness, who beheld the wonder through the colored, magnifying, and distorting medium of his* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | *imagination, and shaped it more distinctly in his afterthought.* | |
| **chilliness** (noun) | coldness | *He felt his limbs growing stiff with the unaccustomed chilliness of the night, and doubted whether he should be able to descend the steps of the scaffold.* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Does confessing in private count if no one sees?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature and the individual against society?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

**Literal / recall**

1. Whose deathbed has Hester come from? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Governor Winthrop's.
2. Where does Dimmesdale stand at midnight? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: On the scaffold
3. Who joins him? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hester and Pearl
4. What does Pearl ask? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Will he stand with them at noon tomorrow
5. What appears in the sky? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A red letter A
6. What does the town say the A means? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Angel
7. Retell the three most important events of "XII: The Minister's Vigil" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: One May midnight, Dimmesdale climbs the scaffold and shrieks; nobody wakes except Governor Bellingham and Mistress Hibbins, who see nothing. Hester and Pearl, returning from Governor Winthrop's deathbed, join him hand in hand. Pearl asks if he will stand with them at noon; he says no. A meteor lights the sky in the shape of an A, and Chillingworth is seen watching. Next day the sexton returns the…
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XII: The Minister's Vigil"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XII: The Minister's Vigil" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

10. Reread: “All people, in a word, would come stumbling over their thresholds, and turning up their amazed and horror-stricken visages around the scaffold.” What does “thresholds” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: thresholds: doorways; the entrance of a house.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why is the sexton's 'A pure hand needs no glove' ironic? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Dimmesdale's hand is not pure.
2. What does “XII: The Minister’s Vigil” suggest about the minister's vigil? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A secret confession in darkness changes nothing.
3. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about the minister's vigil? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21): Pearl's question. On symbolism: A meteor draws a great red "A" across the sky; the town reads it as "Angel" for Governor Winthrop. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins ““It was found,””, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “XII: The Minister’s Vigil”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: One May midnight, Dimmesdale climbs the scaffold and shrieks; nobody wakes except Governor Bellingham and Mistress Hibbins, who see nothing. Hester and Pearl, returning from Governor Winthrop's deathbed, join him hand in hand. Pearl asks if he will stand with them at noon; he says no. A meteor…
7. How does “XII: The Minister’s Vigil” build on “XI: The Interior of a Heart”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 51): The sexton's reading of the sign. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “A pure hand needs no glove to cover it” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 49): The

sexton's unknowing irony. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Does confessing in private count if no one sees?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature and the individual against society? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21): Pearl's question. On irony: Pearl asks him to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and he will not. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Compare the vigil with the first scaffold scene. What has changed? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned comparison.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 51): The sexton's reading of the sign. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “A secret confession in darkness changes nothing.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “A pure hand needs no glove to cover it” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 49): The sexton's unknowing irony. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21): Pearl's question. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Rewrite one moment of “XII: The Minister’s Vigil” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the minister's vigil? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness.

Useful evidence: “the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 51): The sexton's reading of the sign. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “XII: The Minister’s Vigil”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “A pure hand needs no glove to cover it” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 49): The sexton's unknowing irony. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to women and independence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21): Pearl's question. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 51): The sexton's reading of the sign. On setting: Midnight in May; Dimmesdale stands on the scaffold where Hester stood seven years before. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XII: The Minister’s Vigil” treats the minister's vigil with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “A pure hand needs no glove to cover it” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 49): The sexton's unknowing irony. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “XIII: Another View of Hester” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21): Pearl's question. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing.

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the minister's vigil? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: "the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 51): The sexton's reading of the sign. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the town say the A means?
    A. Angel
    B. Adultery
    C. Able
    D. Arthur

    Key: A (Angel)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Oftener, however, its credibility rested on the faith of some lonely eyewitness, who beheld the wonder through the colored, magnifying, and _____ medium of his imagination, and shaped it more distinctly in his afterthought." Word bank: thresholds, awfulness, distorting, betokening
    Key: distorting

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "The belief was a favorite one with our forefathers, as betokening that their infant commonwealth was under a celestial guardianship of peculiar intimacy and strictness.", what does "betokening" most nearly mean?
    A. removed or done away with
    B. being a sign of
    C. a hooped frame worn under a skirt to make it stand out
    D. not saved from sin

    Key: B (being a sign of)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 21: "Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, _____ noontide"
    Key: tomorrow

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Satan dropped it there, I take it, intending a scurrilous jest against your reverence.”, what does “scurrilous” most nearly mean?

   A. acts of care or service

   B. bold, reckless lawbreakers

   C. insulting and mocking

   D. restlessness; uneasiness

   Key: C (insulting and mocking)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Pearl ask?

   A. Is he her father

   B. Can she go home

   C. Why is he there

   D. Will he stand with them at noon tomorrow

   Key: D (Will he stand with them at noon tomorrow)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Dimmesdale stand at midnight?

   A. In the forest

   B. On the scaffold

   C. In the pulpit

   D. On a ship

   Key: B (On the scaffold)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 51: “the letter A, which we _____ to stand for Angel”

   Key: interpret

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Oftener, however, its _____ rested on the faith of some lonely eyewitness, who beheld the wonder through the colored, magnifying, and distorting medium of his imagination, and shaped it more distinctly in his afterthought.” Word bank: awfulness, credibility, betokening, thresholds

   Key: credibility

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why is the sexton's 'A pure hand needs no glove' ironic?

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale's hand is not pure.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Pearl's question.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21)

    A. Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.

    B. The letter's mysterious power.

    C. Hester's refusal.

    D. Pearl's question.

    Key: D (Pearl's question.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “A pure hand needs no glove to cover it” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 49)

    A. Dimmesdale's verdict.

    B. Chillingworth's smile.

    C. The sexton's unknowing irony.

    D. Hester's plea.

    Key: C (The sexton's unknowing irony.)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “A pure hand needs no glove to cover it” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 49). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The sexton's unknowing irony.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XII: The Minister’s Vigil”? A meteor draws a great red "A" across the sky; the town reads it as "Angel" for Governor Winthrop.

    A. Simile

    B. Structure

    C. Symbolism

    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: C (Symbolism)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Pearl's question.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What appears in the sky?

    A. A red letter A

    B. An eclipse

    C. A comet shaped like a rose

    D. A cross

    Key: A (A red letter A)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Nothing was more common, in those days, than to interpret all _____ appearances, and other natural phenomena, that occurred with less regularity than the rise and set of sun and moon, as so many revelations from a supernatural source.” Word bank: betokening, awfulness, thresholds, meteoric

    Key: meteoric

19. [short · recall · DOK 1] Whose deathbed has Hester come from?

    Sample answer: Governor Winthrop's.

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 51)

    A. His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.

    B. The narrator's qualification.

    C. Dimmesdale's verdict.

    D. The sexton's reading of the sign.

Key: D (The sexton's reading of the sign.)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 51) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The sexton's reading of the sign.

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XII: The Minister’s Vigil”? Midnight in May; Dimmesdale stands on the scaffold where Hester stood seven years before.
    A. Alliteration
    B. Theme
    C. Setting
    D. Foreshadowing

    Key: C (Setting)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21).
Sample answer: He refuses Pearl's request to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and the town reads the red letter as "Angel" while the sexton praises "a pure hand."

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He felt his limbs growing stiff with the unaccustomed _____ of the night, and doubted whether he should be able to descend the steps of the scaffold.” Word bank: chilliness, awfulness, betokening, thresholds
Key: chilliness

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “All people, in a word, would come stumbling over their thresholds, and turning up their amazed and horror-stricken visages around the scaffold.”, what does “thresholds” most nearly mean?
    A. make (a wrong) seem less serious
    B. breaking apart; separating
    C. on which a customs tax must be paid
    D. doorways; the entrance of a house

    Key: D (doorways; the entrance of a house)

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “It showed the familiar scene of the street, with the distinctness of midday, but also with the awfulness that is always imparted to familiar objects by an unaccustomed light.”, what does “awfulness” most nearly mean?
    A. a shield bearing a coat of arms
    B. a feeling of awe and dread
    C. removed or done away with
    D. shakily, nervously

    Key: B (a feeling of awe and dread)

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “XII: The Minister’s Vigil”?
    A. The prison door and the rose
    B. The Governor's hall
    C. The forest walk
    D. The minister's vigil

Key: D (The minister's vigil)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: He refuses Pearl's request to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and the town reads the red letter as "Angel" while the sexton praises "a pure hand."
29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 51) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The sexton's reading of the sign.
30. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who joins him?
    A. Wilson
    B. Hester and Pearl
    C. Bellingham
    D. Chillingworth

    Key: B (Hester and Pearl)
31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? A private, unseen confession that changes nothing.
    A. Sin and guilt
    B. Hypocrisy and truth
    C. Public shame and private identity
    D. Nature and the individual against society

    Key: C (Public shame and private identity)
32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from an earlier chapter to “XII: The Minister’s Vigil”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing.
33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Compare the vigil with the first scaffold scene. What has changed? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned comparison.

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 2, 5, 17, 4, 1, 18, 6, 19, 11, 20, 13, 21, 22, 15, 23, 16 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 24, 25, 18, 26, 7, 5, 20, 13, 27, 10, 21, 14, 22, 15, 28, 29 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 25, 8, 2, 30, 18, 21, 13, 10, 20, 11, 23, 15, 22, 31, 32, 29 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 9, 1, 18, 26, 21, 20, 27, 13, 11, 31, 15, 22, 23, 33, 29, 32 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 2, 18, 19, 11, 10, 21, 27, 22, 14, 15, 23, 31, 16, 32, 33, 29 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 4, 8, 2, 13, 20, 11, 10, 22, 31, 15, 14, 23, 33, 29, 16, 32 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| College Sophomore | 18, 2, 13, 27, 12, 20, 22, 15, 14, 23, 31, 29, 16, 33, 32, 28 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 2, 8, 21, 12, 13, 11, 14, 22, 23, 31, 15, 16, 33, 28, 32, 29 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 2, 18, 10, 11, 27, 12, 15, 31, 22, 23, 14, 33, 28, 32, 29, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 2, 18, 27, 10, 20, 13, 23, 22, 14, 31, 15, 28, 33, 32, 29, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “XII: The Minister’s Vigil,” how does Hawthorne show the minister's vigil? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XII: The Minister’s Vigil, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the minister's vigil? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XII: The Minister’s Vigil develops the idea of the minister's vigil. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XII: The Minister’s Vigil (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the minister's vigil. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XII: The Minister’s Vigil suggests about the minister's vigil. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses setting in XII: The Minister’s Vigil to complicate the reader's understanding of the minister's vigil. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XII: The Minister’s Vigil within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the minister's vigil responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XII: The Minister's Vigil alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the minister's vigil follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XII: The Minister's Vigil and its treatment of the minister's vigil. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XII: The Minister's Vigil as evidence for a larger claim about the minister's vigil in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XII: The Minister's Vigil as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the minister's vigil. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *It showed the familiar scene of the street, with the distinctness of midday, but also with the awfulness that is always imparted to familiar objects by an unaccustomed light.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "awfulness" most nearly mean?

   A. a feeling of awe and dread

   B. coldness

   C. the quality of being believable

   D. having to do with meteors or bright objects in the sky

2. *"It was found," said the sexton, "this morning, on the scaffold where evildoers are set up to public shame. Satan dropped it there, I take it, intending a scurrilous jest against your reverence. But, indeed, he was blind and foolish, as he ever and always is. A pure hand needs no glove to cover it!"*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "XII: The Minister's Vigil"?

   A. Pearl

   B. The minister's vigil

   C. Hester on the scaffold

   D. An author answering his critics

**SAT key:** 1. A (a feeling of awe and dread); 2. B (The minister's vigil)

# Lesson 16: XIII: Another View of Hester

**Focus:** another view of Hester

**Objective:** Students will analyze how characterization develops in “XIII: Another View of Hester” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

**Critical voice:** “Hester Prynne is the great nemesis of woman. She is the KNOWING Ligeia risen diabolic from the grave.” (D. H. Lawrence, novelist and poet, *Studies in Classic American Literature (1923), Ch. VII, "Nathaniel Hawthorne and 'The Scarlet Letter'", Ch. VII*; public domain). Context note: Ligeia is Poe's heroine who returns from death. Discuss how Lawrence's hostile reading contrasts with the feminist readings of Hester. (Lawrence's tone is deliberately provocative; frame it for students before reading.) *Objective:* Analyze Hester's transformation and her power. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3

**Content note (suicidal thoughts, thoughts of harming a child):** Hester sometimes wonders whether to send Pearl to heaven and go herself to whatever future Eternal Justice provides. Use the safe-messaging script; focus on her isolation and on the change in her thinking.
**Student preview:** A character has thoughts about death. Support is available if this is hard to read.
**Suggested language:** “What has isolation done to Hester's thinking?”
**Safe messaging:** Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Seven years have passed. Hester has become a sister of mercy, nursing the sick; many now say her A means Able. Yet her life has turned to thought: she questions the whole position of women and has dark thoughts. Shocked at Dimmesdale's state, she resolves to help him against her husband.

**Background:** Hester's thoughts recall nineteenth-century debates about women's rights (the Seneca Falls convention was in 1848) and Hawthorne's acquaintance with Margaret Fuller.

**Significance:** The letter changes meaning in the town but has not made Hester penitent.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Can a symbol mean different things to different people? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to women and independence because.... Content note before we start: A character has thoughts about death. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.*
**Prompt:** Can a symbol mean different things to different people?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to women and independence because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: obviated — removed or done away with; retrieving — getting back; recovering; acquiescing — accepting something without protest; tampering — interfering in a harmful way; transfiguration — a complete change of appearance. "acquiescing": Origin of "acquiesce": Middle French acquiescer; earlier Latin acquiescō. "transfiguration": Origin: Old French transfiguracion; earlier Latin transfigūrātio.*
**Words:** obviated: removed or done away with · retrieving: getting back; recovering · acquiescing: accepting something without protest · tampering: interfering in a harmful way · transfiguration: a complete change of appearance

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Hester's thoughts recall nineteenth-century debates about women's rights (the Seneca Falls convention was in 1848) and Hawthorne's acquaintance with Margaret Fuller. The letter changes meaning in the town but has not made Hester penitent. Characterization: Seven years on, Hester is a sister of mercy; many say the A means "Able." Theme: Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women. Irony: The letter has made her free in thought while it has not made her penitent: "The scarlet letter had not done its office." Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "intellectual faculties retained their pristine strength, or had perhaps acquired a morbid energy, which disease only could have given them. With her" (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 1).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "The scarlet letter had not done its office" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator says the letter has not done its office. Next, craft. I notice the official word "office," as if the letter were a public servant. The strongest word is "office": it means duty, so the letter failed its purpose. Then, effect. Why hasn't the scarlet letter worked as intended? My answer: The scarlet letter hasn't worked as intended because it was meant to shame Hester into repentance, but it has made her independent and questioning instead.*

> *The scarlet letter had not done its office (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "The scarlet letter had not done its office" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator says the letter has not done its office. Next, craft. I notice the official word "office," as if the letter were a public servant. The strongest word is "office": it means duty, so the letter failed its purpose. Then, effect. Why hasn't the scarlet letter worked as intended? My answer: The scarlet letter hasn't worked as intended because it was meant to shame Hester into repentance, but it has made her independent and questioning instead.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The A now means Able to many townsfolk. Expected link: symbolism; public shame and private identity. Ask: How does this line connect to women and independence? Expected: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. (The changed meaning of the letter.)*

> *They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman's strength (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** The A now means Able to many townsfolk. Expected link: symbolism; public shame and private identity.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to women and independence?
**Expected answer:** Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. (The changed meaning of the letter.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the chapter for characterization, theme (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about another view of Hester? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XIII: Another View of Hester develops the idea of another view of Hester. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. When the text says “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10), it shows this directly. People say "it meant Able," yet Hawthorne admits "The scarlet letter had not done its office," because Hester's life "had turned … to thought."*

**Task:** Annotate the chapter for characterization, theme (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about another view of Hester? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XIII: Another View of Hester develops the idea of another view of Hester. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. When the text says “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10), it shows this directly. People say "it meant Able," yet Hawthorne admits "The scarlet letter had not done its office," because Hester's life "had turned … to thought."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: Can a symbol mean different things to different people? Ask: what does Hester think about the position of women? Does the narrator approve?*

**Anchor question:** Can a symbol mean different things to different people?

**Facilitation:** Ask: what does Hester think about the position of women? Does the narrator approve?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about another view of Hester? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. (“The scarlet letter had not done its office”, XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*

**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about another view of Hester? Support it with one short quotation.

**Answer:** Model answer: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. (“The scarlet letter had not done its office”, XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes another view of Hester. Key takeaway: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Seven years on, Hester is a sister of mercy; many say the A means "Able."
- **Theme:** Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women.
- **Irony:** The letter has made her free in thought while it has not made her penitent: "The scarlet letter had not done its office."

**Themes and how they develop**

- **women and independence:** Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “intellectual faculties retained their pristine strength, or had perhaps acquired a morbid energy, which disease only could have given them. With her” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: “had shown him where to set his foot, while the light of earth was fast becoming dim, and ere the light of” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3) The changed meaning of the letter.
- “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10) The letter's failure as a punishment.
- “her life had turned, in a great measure, from passion and feeling, to thought” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7) Hester's change.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

> **Claim:** The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment.
> **Evidence:** “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10)

**Reasoning:** People say "it meant Able," yet Hawthorne admits "The scarlet letter had not done its office," because Hester's life "had turned ... to thought."

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **obviated** (verb) | removed or done away with | *Finally, all other difficulties being obviated, woman cannot take advantage of these preliminary reforms, until she herself shall have undergone a still mightier change; in which, perhaps, the ethereal essence, wherein she has her truest life, will be found to have evaporated.* | |
| **retrieving** (verb) | getting back; recovering | *Standing alone in the world—alone, as to any dependence on society, and with little Pearl to be guided and protected—alone, and hopeless of retrieving her position, even had she not scorned to consider it desirable—she cast away the fragments of a broken chain.* | |
| **acquiescing** (verb) | accepting something without protest | *Her only justification lay in the fact, that she had been able to discern no method of rescuing him from a blacker ruin than had overwhelmed herself, except by acquiescing in Roger Chillingworth's scheme of disguise.* | "acquiescing": Origin of "acquiesce": Middle French acquiescer; earlier Latin acquiescō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/acquiesce#Etymology) |
| **tampering** (verb) | interfering in a harmful way | *A secret enemy had been continually by his side, under the semblance of a friend and helper, and had availed himself of the opportunities thus afforded for tampering with the delicate springs of Mr.* | |
| **transfiguration** (noun) | a complete change of appearance | *She who has once been woman, and ceased to be so, might at any moment become a woman again if there were only the magic touch to effect the transfiguration.* | "transfiguration": Origin: Old French transfiguracion; earlier Latin transfigūrātio. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/transfiguration#Etymology) |
| **wellspring** (noun) | a source that never runs dry | *In such emergencies, Hester's nature showed itself warm and rich; a wellspring of human tenderness,* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | *unfailing to every real demand, and inexhaustible by the largest.* | |
| **foundress** (noun) | a woman who founds something | *Then, she might have come down to us in history, hand in hand with Ann Hutchinson, as the foundress of a religious sect.* | |
| **stigmatized** (verb) | marked out as shameful | *She assumed a freedom of speculation, then common enough on the other side of the Atlantic, but which our forefathers, had they known it, would have held to be a deadlier crime than that stigmatized by the scarlet letter.* | |
| **concoct** (verb) | make by mixing ingredients | *One afternoon, walking with Pearl in a retired part of the peninsula, she beheld the old physician, with a basket on one arm, and a staff in the other hand, stooping along the ground, in quest of roots and herbs to concoct his medicines withal.* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Can a symbol mean different things to different people?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with women and independence?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What has happened to Hester's appearance? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Her beauty has turned cold and severe; her hair is hidden.
2. How many years have passed? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Seven
3. What do many people say the A means now? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Able
4. What does Hester do for the town? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Nurses the sick and helps the poor

5. What does Hester question? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The position of women
6. What does she decide? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To help Dimmesdale against Chillingworth
7. Retell the three most important events of "XIII: Another View of Hester" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Seven years have passed. Hester has become a sister of mercy, nursing the sick; many now say her A means Able. Yet her life has turned to thought: she questions the whole position of women and has dark thoughts. Shocked at Dimmesdale's state, she resolves to help him against her husband.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XIII: Another View of Hester"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XIII: Another View of Hester" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "Finally, all other difficulties being obviated, woman cannot take advantage of these preliminary reforms, until she herself shall have undergone a still mightier change; in which, perhaps, the ethereal essence, wherein…" What does "obviated" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: obviated: removed or done away with.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why has the letter 'not done its office'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: It made her think freely, not repent.
2. What does "XIII: Another View of Hester" suggest about another view of Hester? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The letter changes meaning in the town but has not made Hester penitent.
3. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the theme in this chapter shape what we understand about another view of Hester? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: "They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman's strength" (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3): The changed meaning of the letter. On theme: Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "In fine, Hester Prynne resolved to meet her former husband, and do what might be in her power for the rescue of the victim on whom he had so evidently set his grip.", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “XIII: Another View of Hester”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Seven years have passed. Hester has become a sister of mercy, nursing the sick; many now say her A means Able. Yet her life has turned to thought: she questions the whole position of women and has dark thoughts. Shocked at Dimmesdale's state, she resolves to help him against her husband.
7. How does “XIII: Another View of Hester” build on “XII: The Minister’s Vigil”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10): The letter's failure as a punishment. Theme link: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “her life had turned, in a great measure, from passion and feeling, to thought” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7): Hester's change. On characterization: Seven years on, Hester is a sister of mercy; many say the A means "Able." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can a symbol mean different things to different people?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with women and independence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3): The changed meaning of the letter. On irony: The letter has made her free in thought while it has not made her penitent: "The scarlet letter had not done its office." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Does the narrator approve of Hester's thoughts about women? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10): The letter's failure as a punishment. On theme: Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The letter changes meaning in the town but has not made Hester penitent.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “her life had turned, in a great measure, from passion and feeling, to thought” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7): Hester's change. On theme: Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3): The changed meaning of the letter. On characterization: Seven years on, Hester is a sister of mercy; many say the A means "Able." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Rewrite one moment of “XIII: Another View of Hester” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about another view of Hester? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10): The letter's failure as a punishment. Theme link: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “XIII: Another View of Hester”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “her life had turned, in a great measure, from passion and feeling, to thought” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7): Hester's change. On theme: Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this chapter to sin and guilt: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3): The changed meaning of the letter. On theme: Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10): The letter's failure as a punishment. On characterization: Seven years on, Hester is a sister of mercy; many say the A means "Able." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “XIII: Another View of Hester” treats another view of Hester with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “her life had turned, in a great measure, from passion and feeling, to thought” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7): Hester's change. On theme: Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “XIV: Hester and the Physician” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3): The changed meaning of the letter. Theme link: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about another view of Hester? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10): The letter's failure as a punishment. On theme: Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How many years have passed?

   A. Twenty

B. One

C. Two

D. Seven

Key: D (Seven)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Standing alone in the world—alone, as to any dependence on society, and with little Pearl to be guided and protected—alone, and hopeless of retrieving her position, even had she not scorned to consider it desirable—she…", what does "retrieving" most nearly mean?

   A. a person who speaks for someone else

   B. lack of modesty or tact

   C. spreading disease or corruption into

   D. getting back; recovering

   Key: D (getting back; recovering)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "A secret enemy had been continually by his side, under the semblance of a friend and helper, and had availed himself of the opportunities thus afforded for tampering with the delicate springs of Mr.", what does "tampering" most nearly mean?

   A. stand as a sign or symbol of

   B. splash (with water or mud)

   C. interfering in a harmful way

   D. slowly decay into dust

   Key: C (interfering in a harmful way)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Then, she might have come down to us in history, hand in hand with Ann Hutchinson, as the _____ of a religious sect." Word bank: obviated, retrieving, foundress, acquiescing

   Key: foundress

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Her only justification lay in the fact, that she had been able to discern no method of rescuing him from a blacker ruin than had overwhelmed herself, except by acquiescing in Roger Chillingworth's scheme of disguise.", what does "acquiescing" most nearly mean?

   A. accepting something without protest

   B. sadly; mournfully

   C. the system of coats of arms

   D. focused together on one point

   Key: A (accepting something without protest)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "In such emergencies, Hester's nature showed itself warm and rich; a _____ of human tenderness, unfailing to every real demand, and inexhaustible by the largest." Word bank: acquiescing, retrieving, wellspring, obviated

   Key: wellspring

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What do many people say the A means now?

   A. Angel

   B. Adultery

   C. Alone

D. Able

Key: D (Able)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Finally, all other difficulties being obviated, woman cannot take advantage of these preliminary reforms, until she herself shall have undergone a still mightier change; in which, perhaps, the ethereal essence, wherein…”, what does “obviated” most nearly mean?

   A. (trundle-bed) a low bed on wheels kept under another bed

   B. removed or done away with

   C. a deeply religious person

   D. stand as a sign or symbol of

   Key: B (removed or done away with)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “She who has once been woman, and ceased to be so, might at any moment become a woman again if there were only the magic touch to effect the _____.” Word bank: obviated, retrieving, transfiguration, acquiescing

   Key: transfiguration

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “her life had turned, in a great measure, from passion and feeling, to thought” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7)

    A. Hawthorne's definition of romance.

    B. Hester's fear of him.

    C. Nature's response.

    D. Hester's change.

    Key: D (Hester's change.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “XIII: Another View of Hester”?

    A. The procession

    B. Another view of Hester

    C. The recognition

    D. The frame narrative and the found letter

    Key: B (Another view of Hester)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3)

    A. His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.

    B. Pearl's transformation.

    C. The changed meaning of the letter.

    D. Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing.

    Key: C (The changed meaning of the letter.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The letter's failure as a punishment.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10).

Sample answer: People say "it meant Able," yet Hawthorne admits "The scarlet letter had not done its office," because Hester's life "had turned ... to thought."

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XIII: Another View of Hester”? Seven years on, Hester is a sister of mercy; many say the A means "Able."

    A. Simile

    B. Metaphor

    C. Characterization

    D. Personification

    Key: C (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The letter's failure as a punishment.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10: “The _____ letter had not done its office”

    Key: scarlet

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7: “her life had turned, in a great _____, from passion and feeling, to thought”

    Key: measure

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “She assumed a freedom of speculation, then common enough on the other side of the Atlantic, but which our forefathers, had they known it, would have held to be a deadlier crime than that _____ by the scarlet letter.” Word bank: stigmatized, retrieving, obviated, acquiescing

    Key: stigmatized

20. [short · recall · DOK 1] What has happened to Hester's appearance?

    Sample answer: Her beauty has turned cold and severe; her hair is hidden.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Hester question?

    A. The king's power

    B. The Bible's language

    C. The position of women

    D. Her love for Pearl

    Key: C (The position of women)

22. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The changed meaning of the letter.

23. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why has the letter 'not done its office'?

    Sample answer: It made her think freely, not repent.

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women.

    A. Sin and guilt

B. Hypocrisy and truth

C. Women and independence

D. Public shame and private identity

Key: C (Women and independence)

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “her life had turned, in a great measure, from passion and feeling, to thought” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Hester's change.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how women and independence develops from an earlier chapter to “XIII: Another View of Hester”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women.

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10)

    A. The letter's failure as a punishment.

    B. Pearl's dress.

    C. The rose-bush as hope.

    D. Why she stays.

    Key: A (The letter's failure as a punishment.)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The changed meaning of the letter.

29. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XIII: Another View of Hester”? Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women.

    A. Characterization

    B. Theme

    C. Hyperbole

    D. Imagery

    Key: B (Theme)

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Does the narrator approve of Hester's thoughts about women? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3: “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s _____”

    Key: strength

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: People say "it meant Able," yet Hawthorne admits "The scarlet letter had not done its office," because Hester's life "had turned ... to thought."

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 17, 9, 18, 6, 19, 2, 20, 21, 22, 11, 10, 23, 24, 25, 14, 26 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 19, 21, 8, 6, 17, 4, 27, 10, 23, 11, 13, 24, 15, 14, 28, 16 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 6, 3, 1, 9, 7, 27, 23, 12, 11, 13, 25, 14, 15, 29, 26, 30 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 3, 19, 9, 1, 13, 10, 27, 22, 11, 24, 15, 25, 14, 28, 30, 16 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 9, 31, 8, 23, 12, 10, 13, 24, 29, 25, 14, 15, 30, 32, 16, 26 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 18, 9, 20, 11, 13, 27, 10, 25, 14, 24, 29, 15, 30, 16, 32, 26 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 9, 6, 10, 23, 13, 27, 25, 15, 24, 29, 14, 26, 28, 32, 30, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 19, 9, 12, 13, 10, 23, 15, 29, 25, 14, 24, 26, 28, 32, 30, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 4, 9, 13, 23, 12, 22, 24, 29, 25, 15, 14, 26, 28, 16, 32, 30 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 19, 9, 11, 13, 22, 12, 14, 29, 24, 15, 25, 32, 16, 28, 26, 30 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “XIII: Another View of Hester,” how does Hawthorne show another view of Hester? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XIII: Another View of Hester, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of another view of Hester? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XIII: Another View of Hester develops the idea of another view of Hester. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XIII: Another View of Hester (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of another view of Hester. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XIII: Another View of Hester suggests about another view of Hester. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses characterization in XIII: Another View of Hester to complicate the reader's understanding of another view of Hester. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XIII: Another View of Hester within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of another view of Hester responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XIII: Another View of Hester alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of another view of Hester follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XIII: Another View of Hester and its treatment of another view of Hester. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XIII: Another View of Hester as evidence for a larger claim about another view of Hester in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XIII: Another View of Hester as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of another view of Hester. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Her only justification lay in the fact, that she had been able to discern no method of rescuing him from a blacker ruin than had overwhelmed herself, except by acquiescing in Roger Chillingworth's scheme of disguise.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "acquiescing" most nearly mean?

   A. marked out as shameful

   B. make by mixing ingredients

   C. a woman who founds something

   D. accepting something without protest

2. *In fine, Hester Prynne resolved to meet her former husband, and do what might be in her power for the rescue of the victim on whom he had so evidently set his grip. The occasion was not long to seek. One afternoon, walking with Pearl in a retired part of the peninsula, she beheld the old physician, with a basket on one arm, and a staff in the other hand, stooping along the ground, in quest of roots and herbs to concoct his medicines withal.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "XIII: Another View of Hester"?

A. Another view of Hester

B. The elf-child and the minister

C. The minister in a maze

D. The recognition

**SAT key:** 1. D (accepting something without protest); 2. A (Another view of Hester)

# Lesson 17: XIV: Hester and the Physician

**Focus:** Hester and the physician

**Objective:** Students will analyze how characterization develops in “XIV: Hester and the Physician” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

On the shore Hester confronts Chillingworth, who has grown darker and fiendish. She asks him to stop tormenting the minister and says she will reveal his identity. He admits he has become a fiend but says he cannot pardon; it is all 'a dark necessity'.

**Background:** Calvinist belief in predestination held that God had decided who would be saved; Chillingworth uses fate to excuse himself.

**Significance:** Revenge has destroyed the avenger.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Can a person be changed by hate? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to sin and guilt because....*
> **Prompt:** Can a person be changed by hate?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to sin and guilt because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: propinquity — nearness; closeness; gloated — took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering; pledging — promising solemnly; usurping — taking a place or power wrongfully; heartstrings — one's deepest feelings.*
> *“usurping”: Origin of “usurp”: Old French usurper; earlier Latin ūsūrpō.*
> **Words:** propinquity: nearness; closeness · gloated: took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering · pledging: promising solemnly · usurping: taking a place or power wrongfully · heartstrings: one's deepest feelings

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Calvinist belief in predestination held that God had decided who would be saved; Chillingworth uses fate to excuse himself. Revenge has destroyed the avenger. Characterization: Chillingworth has transformed himself into a devil by undertaking a devil's office. Conflict: Hester tells him she will reveal his identity to Dimmesdale. Theme: Chillingworth accepts fate: "It is not granted me to pardon." Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "yonder gatherer of herbs. So the child flew away like a bird, and, making bare her small white feet, went pattering along" (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 1).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "I have left thee to the scarlet letter" slowly and put it in my own words: Refusing to plead with Chillingworth, Hester tells him she leaves him to the scarlet letter. Next, craft. I notice she speaks of the letter as if it were a judge who will deal with him, the way people say "I leave you to God." The strongest word is "letter": the symbol of her own punishment becomes, in her words, the power that will judge him too. Then, effect. Why does Hester leave Chillingworth "to the scarlet letter"? My answer: Hester means that the letter's lesson, the cost of hidden sin, applies to him; his secret revenge has made him guiltier than she is, and she will no longer beg him for mercy.*

> *I have left thee to the scarlet letter (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "I have left thee to the scarlet letter" slowly and put it in my own words: Refusing to plead with Chillingworth, Hester tells him she leaves him to the scarlet letter. Next, craft. I notice she speaks of the letter as if it were a judge who will deal with him, the way people say "I leave you to God." The strongest word is "letter": the symbol of her own punishment becomes, in her words, the power that will judge him too. Then, effect. Why does Hester leave Chillingworth "to the scarlet letter"? My answer: Hester means that the letter's lesson, the cost of hidden sin, applies to him; his secret revenge has made him guiltier than she is, and she will no longer beg him for mercy.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Chillingworth sees himself as a fiend and blames others. Expected link: characterization; the sin of revenge. Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt? Expected: Revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. (The narrator's judgment.)*

> *old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil's office (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Chillingworth sees himself as a fiend and blames others. Expected link: characterization; the sin of revenge.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to sin and guilt?
**Expected answer:** Revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. (The narrator's judgment.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the chapter for characterization, conflict (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Hester and the physician? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XIV: Hester and the Physician develops the idea of Hester and the physician. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)*

*Exemplar: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. When the text says “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32), it shows this directly. The narrator calls him evidence of "man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil," and he himself asks "A fiend! Who made me so?" yet says "It is not granted me to pardon."*

**Task:** Annotate the chapter for characterization, conflict (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Hester and the physician? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XIV: Hester and the Physician develops the idea of Hester and the physician. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

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**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: Can a person be changed by hate? Ask: does Chillingworth have any freedom left? Does he believe he does?*

**Anchor question:** Can a person be changed by hate?

**Facilitation:** Ask: does Chillingworth have any freedom left? Does he believe he does?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Hester and the physician? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. (“Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon”, XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*

**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Hester and the physician? Support it with one short quotation.

**Answer:** Model answer: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. (“Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon”, XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Hester and the physician. Key takeaway: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Chillingworth has transformed himself into a devil by undertaking a devil's office.
- **Conflict:** Hester tells him she will reveal his identity to Dimmesdale.
- **Theme:** Chillingworth accepts fate: "It is not granted me to pardon."

**Themes and how they develop**

- **sin and guilt:** revenge has made a wise man into a fiend.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “yonder gatherer of herbs. So the child flew away like a bird, and, making bare her small white feet, went pattering along” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: “in. Forth peeped at her, out of the pool, with dark, glistening curls around her head, and an elf-smile in her eyes” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 1).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil’s office” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8) The narrator's judgment.
- “I have left thee to the scarlet letter” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25) Chillingworth on Hester's punishment.
- “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32) Chillingworth's refusal.
- “A fiend! Who made me so” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 23) His self-recognition.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim.
**Evidence:** “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32)

**Reasoning:** The narrator calls him evidence of "man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil," and he himself asks "A fiend! Who made me so?" yet says "It is not granted me to pardon."

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **propinquity** (noun) | nearness; closeness | *But it was the constant shadow of my presence!—the closest propinquity of the man whom he had most vilely wronged!—and who had grown to exist only by this perpetual poison of the direst revenge!* | |
| **gloated** (verb) | took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering | *This unhappy person had effected such a transformation, by devoting himself, for seven years, to the constant analysis of a heart full of torture, and deriving his enjoyment thence, and adding fuel to those fiery tortures which he analyzed and gloated over.* | |
| **pledging** (verb) | promising solemnly | *Yet it was not without heavy misgivings that I thus bound myself; for, having cast off all duty towards other human beings, there remained a duty towards him; and something whispered me that I was betraying it, in pledging myself to keep your counsel.* | |
| **usurping** (verb) | taking a place or power wrongfully | *The unfortunate physician, while uttering these words, lifted his hands with a look of horror, as if he had beheld some frightful shape, which he could not recognize, usurping the place of his own image in a glass.* | “usurping”: Origin of “usurp”: Old French usurper; earlier Latin ūsūrpō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/usurp#Etymology) |
| **heartstrings** (noun) | one's deepest feelings | *He knew, by some spiritual sense—for the Creator never made another being so sensitive as this—he knew that no friendly hand was pulling at his heartstrings, and that an eye was looking curiously into him, which sought only evil, and found it.* | |
| **derisively** (adverb) | mockingly | *It seemed to be his wish and purpose to mask this expression with a smile; but the latter played him false, and flickered over his visage so derisively, that the spectator could see his blackness all the better for it.* | |
| **gatherer** (noun) | someone who collects (here, herbs) | *Hester bade little Pearl run down to the margin of the water, and play with the shells and tangled seaweed, until she should have talked awhile with yonder gatherer of herbs.* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **perpetration** (noun) | the act of committing (a crime) | *But for my aid, his life would have burned away in torments, within the first two years after the perpetration of his crime and thine.* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Can a person be changed by hate?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with sin and guilt?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

**Literal / recall**

1. What did the magistrates discuss about the letter? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Letting Hester take it off.
2. Where do Hester and Chillingworth meet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: By the shore
3. What does Hester say she will do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Reveal his identity to Dimmesdale
4. What has Chillingworth become? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A fiend
5. What does he say he cannot do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Pardon
6. What does Pearl do meanwhile? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Plays by the water
7. Retell the three most important events of "XIV: Hester and the Physician" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: On the shore Hester confronts Chillingworth, who has grown darker and fiendish. She asks him to stop tormenting the minister and says she will reveal his identity. He admits he has become a fiend but says he cannot pardon; it is all 'a dark necessity'.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XIV: Hester and the Physician"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XIV: Hester and the Physician" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "But it was the constant shadow of my presence!—the closest propinquity of the man whom he had most vilely wronged!—and who had grown to exist only by this perpetual poison of the direst revenge!" What does "propinquity" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: propinquity: nearness; closeness.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Hester feel responsible for Chillingworth? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: She married him without love.
2. What does "XIV: Hester and the Physician" suggest about Hester and the physician? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Revenge has destroyed the avenger.
3. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the conflict in this chapter shape what we understand about Hester and the physician? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: "old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil's office" (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8): The narrator's judgment. On conflict: Hester tells him she will reveal his identity to Dimmesdale. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "In a word, old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a…", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "XIV: Hester and the Physician", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: On the shore Hester confronts Chillingworth, who has grown darker and fiendish. She asks him to stop tormenting the minister and says she will reveal his identity. He admits he has become a fiend but says he cannot pardon; it is all 'a dark necessity'.
7. How does "XIV: Hester and the Physician" build on "XIII: Another View of Hester"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: "I have left thee to the scarlet letter" (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25): Chillingworth on Hester's punishment. Theme link: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: "Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon" (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32): Chillingworth's refusal. On characterization: Chillingworth has transformed himself into a devil by undertaking a devil's office. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can a person be changed by hate?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with sin and guilt? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “A fiend! Who made me so” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 23): His self-recognition. On theme: Chillingworth accepts fate: "It is not granted me to pardon." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Chillingworth free to forgive? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil’s office” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8): The narrator's judgment. On theme: Chillingworth accepts fate: "It is not granted me to pardon." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Revenge has destroyed the avenger.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “I have left thee to the scarlet letter” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25): Chillingworth on Hester's punishment. On theme: Chillingworth accepts fate: "It is not granted me to pardon." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32): Chillingworth's refusal. On characterization: Chillingworth has transformed himself into a devil by undertaking a devil's office. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Rewrite one moment of “XIV: Hester and the Physician” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about Hester and the physician? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “A fiend! Who made me so” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 23): His

self-recognition. Theme link: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “XIV: Hester and the Physician”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil’s office” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8): The narrator's judgment. On theme: Chillingworth accepts fate: "It is not granted me to pardon." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to public shame and private identity: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “I have left thee to the scarlet letter” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25): Chillingworth on Hester's punishment. On theme: Chillingworth accepts fate: "It is not granted me to pardon." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32): Chillingworth's refusal. On characterization: Chillingworth has transformed himself into a devil by undertaking a devil's office. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XIV: Hester and the Physician” treats Hester and the physician with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “A fiend! Who made me so” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 23): His self-recognition. On theme: Chillingworth accepts fate: "It is not granted me to pardon." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “XV: Hester and Pearl” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil’s office” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8): The narrator's judgment. Theme link: revenge has made a

wise man into a fiend. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Hester and the physician? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “I have left thee to the scarlet letter” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25): Chillingworth on Hester's punishment. On theme: Chillingworth accepts fate: "It is not granted me to pardon." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “This unhappy person had effected such a transformation, by devoting himself, for seven years, to the constant analysis of a heart full of torture, and deriving his enjoyment thence, and adding fuel to those fiery…”, what does “gloated” most nearly mean?
    A. interfering in a harmful way
    B. formal ceremonies
    C. took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering
    D. lacking curiosity (here 'not incurious' means quite curious)

    Key: C (took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “But for my aid, his life would have burned away in torments, within the first two years after the _____ of his crime and thine.” Word bank: gloated, pledging, propinquity, perpetration
    Key: perpetration

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “But it was the constant shadow of my presence!—the closest propinquity of the man whom he had most vilely wronged!—and who had grown to exist only by this perpetual poison of the direst revenge!”, what does “propinquity” most nearly mean?
    A. a complete change of appearance
    B. put out (a fire)
    C. happening at a bad time
    D. nearness; closeness

    Key: D (nearness; closeness)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does he say he cannot do?
    A. Read
    B. Leave

C. Sleep

D. Pardon

Key: D (Pardon)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What has Chillingworth become?

   A. A sailor

   B. A fiend

   C. A minister

   D. A saint

   Key: B (A fiend)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8: “old Roger _____ was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil’s office”

   Key: Chillingworth

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He knew, by some spiritual sense—for the Creator never made another being so sensitive as this—he knew that no friendly hand was pulling at his _____, and that an eye was looking curiously into him, which sought only evil, and found it.” Word bank: heartstrings, pledging, gloated, propinquity

   Key: heartstrings

8. [short · recall · DOK 1] What did the magistrates discuss about the letter?

   Sample answer: Letting Hester take it off.

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Hester bade little Pearl run down to the margin of the water, and play with the shells and tangled seaweed, until she should have talked awhile with yonder _____ of herbs.” Word bank: gloated, gatherer, propinquity, pledging

   Key: gatherer

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil’s office” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The narrator's judgment.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “XIV: Hester and the Physician”?

    A. Hester and the physician

    B. The prison door and the rose

    C. The pastor and his parishioner

    D. The procession

    Key: A (Hester and the physician)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil’s office” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8)

    A. The shipmaster's news.

    B. Why Hester names her Pearl.

    C. The narrator's judgment.

D. The biblical allusion: Hester's mark is worse than Cain's.

Key: C (The narrator's judgment.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I have left thee to the scarlet letter” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Chillingworth on Hester's punishment.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XIV: Hester and the Physician”? Hester tells him she will reveal his identity to Dimmesdale.

    A. Theme

    B. Irony

    C. Tone / mood

    D. Conflict

    Key: D (Conflict)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32).
    Sample answer: The narrator calls him evidence of "man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil," and he himself asks "A fiend! Who made me so?" yet says "It is not granted me to pardon."

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how sin and guilt develops from an earlier chapter to “XIV: Hester and the Physician”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Yet it was not without heavy misgivings that I thus bound myself; for, having cast off all duty towards other human beings, there remained a duty towards him; and something whispered me that I was betraying it, in…”, what does “pledging” most nearly mean?

    A. digging or searching deeply

    B. put out (a fire)

    C. promising solemnly

    D. insistently, in a troubling way

    Key: C (promising solemnly)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Pearl do meanwhile?

    A. Sleeps

    B. Prays

    C. Plays by the water

    D. Visits the minister

    Key: C (Plays by the water)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The unfortunate physician, while uttering these words, lifted his hands with a look of horror, as if he had beheld some frightful shape, which he could not recognize, usurping the place of his own image in a glass.”, what does “usurping” most nearly mean?

    A. playfully, in a teasing way

    B. drooping and withering

    C. taking a place or power wrongfully

D. sadly; mournfully

Key: C (taking a place or power wrongfully)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where do Hester and Chillingworth meet?

    A. By the shore

    B. In church

    C. In the forest

    D. In prison

    Key: A (By the shore)

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32: “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not _____ me to pardon”

    Key: granted

22. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Hester feel responsible for Chillingworth?

    Sample answer: She married him without love.

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32)

    A. Chillingworth's refusal.

    B. Hester's question.

    C. Hester's admission.

    D. The narrator's qualification.

    Key: A (Chillingworth's refusal.)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XIV: Hester and the Physician”? Chillingworth has transformed himself into a devil by undertaking a devil's office.

    A. Conflict

    B. Setting

    C. Characterization

    D. Theme

    Key: C (Characterization)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The narrator calls him evidence of "man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil," and he himself asks "A fiend! Who made me so?" yet says "It is not granted me to pardon."

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Hester say she will do?

    A. Confess publicly

    B. Reveal his identity to Dimmesdale

    C. Leave Boston

    D. Kill him

    Key: B (Reveal his identity to Dimmesdale)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth's refusal.

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Revenge has made a wise man into a fiend.

    A. Hypocrisy and truth

    B. Nature and the individual against society

    C. Sin and guilt

    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: C (Sin and guilt)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil's office" (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The narrator's judgment.

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "It seemed to be his wish and purpose to mask this expression with a smile; but the latter played him false, and flickered over his visage so _____, that the spectator could see his blackness all the better for it." Word bank: gloated, pledging, derisively, propinquity

    Key: derisively

31. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "I have left thee to the scarlet letter" (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25)

    A. The rose-bush as hope.

    B. Chillingworth on Hester's punishment.

    C. Hawthorne's definition of romance.

    D. Hester's refusal.

    Key: B (Chillingworth on Hester's punishment.)

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "I have left thee to the scarlet letter" (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth on Hester's punishment.

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "A fiend! Who made me so" (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 23)

    A. Anguish as his only truth.

    B. His self-recognition.

    C. The confession begins.

    D. Pearl links the minister to the letter.

    Key: B (His self-recognition.)

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Chillingworth free to forgive? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view.

35. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25: "I have left thee to the _____ letter"

    Key: scarlet

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 4, 1, 9, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 12, 22, 23, 11, 15, 14, 24, 25 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 1, 7, 9, 26, 4, 6, 10, 13, 23, 12, 22, 27, 24, 28, 25, 29 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 7, 30, 3, 4, 20, 10, 12, 13, 23, 31, 24, 15, 14, 27, 32, 25 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 7, 30, 17, 18, 31, 12, 33, 11, 22, 15, 24, 14, 28, 16, 34, 29 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 30, 7, 5, 22, 13, 11, 31, 28, 14, 24, 27, 15, 25, 29, 34, 16 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 18, 9, 35, 33, 10, 11, 23, 24, 14, 28, 15, 27, 29, 32, 16, 25 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 7, 35, 10, 12, 23, 11, 14, 28, 24, 15, 27, 16, 25, 29, 32, 34 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 7, 30, 23, 33, 22, 11, 15, 27, 24, 28, 14, 34, 32, 29, 25, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 7, 30, 33, 22, 10, 12, 15, 24, 28, 14, 27, 16, 25, 29, 34, 32 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 7, 30, 10, 12, 31, 13, 27, 15, 14, 24, 28, 32, 34, 25, 29, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “XIV: Hester and the Physician,” how does Hawthorne show Hester and the physician? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XIV: Hester and the Physician, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of Hester and the physician? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XIV: Hester and the Physician develops the idea of Hester and the physician. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XIV: Hester and the Physician (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the

reader's understanding of Hester and the physician. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XIV: Hester and the Physician suggests about Hester and the physician. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses characterization in XIV: Hester and the Physician to complicate the reader's understanding of Hester and the physician. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XIV: Hester and the Physician within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of Hester and the physician responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XIV: Hester and the Physician alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of Hester and the physician follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XIV: Hester and the Physician and its treatment of Hester and the physician. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XIV: Hester and the Physician as evidence for a larger claim about Hester and the physician in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XIV: Hester and the Physician as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of Hester and the physician. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Yet it was not without heavy misgivings that I thus bound myself; for, having cast off all duty towards other human beings, there remained a duty towards him; and something whispered me that I was betraying it, in pledging myself to keep your counsel.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “pledging” most nearly mean?

   A. the act of committing (a crime)

B. mockingly

C. promising solemnly

D. someone who collects (here, herbs)

2. *In a word, old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil's office. This unhappy person had effected such a transformation, by devoting himself, for seven years, to the constant analysis of a heart full of torture, and deriving his enjoyment thence, and adding fuel to those fiery tortures which he analyzed and gloated over.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "XIV: Hester and the Physician"?

A. Hester at her needle

B. Conclusion

C. Hester and the physician

D. The pastor and his parishioner

**SAT key:** 1. C (promising solemnly); 2. C (Hester and the physician)

# Lesson 18: XV: Hester and Pearl

**Focus:** Hester and Pearl

**Objective:** Students will analyze how characterization develops in "XV: Hester and Pearl" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Hester admits to herself that she hates Chillingworth. Pearl makes a green letter A of eelgrass on her own breast and asks what the scarlet letter means and why the minister keeps his hand over his heart. Hester, for the first time, lies to her.

**Background:** Hester has never lied to the magistrates; her lie to Pearl shows how the secret is spreading.

**Significance:** Pearl insists on the truth the adults hide.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Should parents always tell their children the truth? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to hypocrisy and truth because....*
**Prompt:** Should parents always tell their children the truth?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to hypocrisy and truth because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hester's first lie to Pearl.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: nightshade — a poisonous plant; reciprocated — returned (a feeling or gesture); sedulous — careful and hard-working; fancifully — playfully and imaginatively; deleterious — harmful. "reciprocated": Origin of "reciprocate": possibly Latin recīprocātus.*
**Words:** nightshade: a poisonous plant · reciprocated: returned (a feeling or gesture) · sedulous: careful and hard-working · fancifully: playfully and imaginatively · deleterious: harmful

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Hester has never lied to the magistrates; her lie to Pearl shows how the secret is spreading. Pearl insists on the truth the adults hide. Characterization: Hester admits to herself that she hates Chillingworth. Symbolism: Pearl makes a green "A" of seaweed on her own breast. Conflict: Pearl asks why the minister keeps his hand over his heart; Hester lies for the first time. Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "So Roger Chillingworth—a deformed old figure, with a face that haunted men's memories longer" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 1).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean" slowly and put it in my own words: Pearl asks her mother what the letter means and why the minister keeps his hand over his heart. Next, craft. I notice the child's direct, repeated question breaks into the adults' silence. The strongest word is "mean": Pearl treats the letter as a riddle with an answer, not as a fixed shame. Then, effect. Why does Pearl keep asking what the scarlet letter means? My answer: Pearl presses toward the truth Hester will not say; her question links the letter to Dimmesdale's hidden guilt and keeps the secret from resting.*

> *Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean* (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29)

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean" slowly and put it in my own words: Pearl asks her mother what the letter means and why the minister keeps his hand over his heart. Next, craft. I notice the child's direct, repeated question breaks into the adults' silence. The strongest word is "mean": Pearl treats the letter as a riddle with an answer, not as a fixed shame. Then, effect. Why does Pearl keep asking what the scarlet letter means? My answer: Pearl presses toward the truth Hester will not say; her question links the letter to Dimmesdale's hidden guilt and keeps the secret from resting.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Hester's "Yes, I hate him!" shows her bitterness. Expected link: characterization; sin and guilt. Ask: How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth? Expected: Hester's first lie to Pearl. (Hester's admission.)*

> *Yes, I hate him* (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4)

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Hester's "Yes, I hate him!" shows her bitterness. Expected link: characterization; sin and guilt.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth?
**Expected answer:** Hester's first lie to Pearl. (Hester's admission.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for characterization, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Hester and Pearl? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XV: Hester and Pearl develops the idea of Hester and Pearl. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. When the text says "Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29), it shows this directly. She asks "what does the scarlet letter mean?" and "why does the minister keep his hand over his heart?", and Hester, who has never lied, evades her.*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for characterization, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Hester and Pearl? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XV: Hester and Pearl develops the idea of Hester and Pearl. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. When the text says "Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29), it shows this directly. She asks "what does the scarlet letter mean?" and "why does the minister keep his hand over his heart?", and Hester, who has never lied, evades her.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Should parents always tell their children the truth? Ask: why does Hester lie to Pearl here, when she would not lie to the magistrates?*
**Anchor question:** Should parents always tell their children the truth?
**Facilitation:** Ask: why does Hester lie to Pearl here, when she would not lie to the magistrates?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Hester and Pearl? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. ("Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean", XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Hester and Pearl? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. ("Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean", XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes Hester and Pearl. Key takeaway: Hester's first lie to Pearl.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Hester admits to herself that she hates Chillingworth.
- **Symbolism:** Pearl makes a green "A" of seaweed on her own breast.
- **Conflict:** Pearl asks why the minister keeps his hand over his heart; Hester lies for the first time.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **hypocrisy and truth:** Hester's first lie to Pearl.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “So Roger Chillingworth—a deformed old figure, with a face that haunted men’s memories longer” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: “was there, as it rather seemed, a circle of ominous shadow moving along with his deformity, whichever way he turned himself? And” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 1).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “Yes, I hate him” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4) Hester's admission.
- “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29) Pearl's question.
- “and why does the minister keep his hand over his heart” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19) Pearl links the minister to the letter.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Pearl presses the truth that adults hide.
**Evidence:** “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29)
**Reasoning:** She asks "what does the scarlet letter mean?" and "why does the minister keep his hand over his heart?", and Hester, who has never lied, evades her.

## *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **nightshade** (noun) | a poisonous plant | *Would he not suddenly sink into the earth, leaving a barren and blasted spot, where, in due course of time, would be seen deadly nightshade, dogwood, henbane, and* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | *whatever else of vegetable wickedness the climate could produce, all flourishing with hideous luxuriance?* | |
| **reciprocated** (verb) | returned (a feeling or gesture) | *She deemed it her crime most to be repented of, that she had ever endured, and reciprocated, the lukewarm grasp of his hand, and had suffered the smile of her lips and eyes to mingle and melt into his own.* | "reciprocated": Origin of "reciprocate": possibly Latin recīprocātus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/reciprocate#Etymology) |
| **sedulous** (adjective) | careful and hard-working | *She wondered what sort of herbs they were, which the old man was so sedulous to gather.* | |
| **fancifully** (adverb) | playfully and imaginatively | *At first, as already told, she had flirted fancifully with her own image in a pool of water, beckoning the phantom forth, and—as it declined to venture—seeking a passage for herself into its sphere of impalpable earth and unattainable sky.* | |
| **deleterious** (adjective) | harmful | *Or might it suffice him, that every wholesome growth should be converted into something deleterious and malignant at his touch?* | |
| **intelligently** (adverb) | in a sensible, knowing way | *The thought occurred to Hester, that the child might really be seeking to approach her with childlike confidence, and doing what she could, and as intelligently as she knew how, to establish a meeting-point of sympathy.* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Should parents always tell their children the truth?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with public shame and private identity?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. What does Hester threaten when Pearl keeps asking? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To shut her in the dark closet.
2. What does Hester admit? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She hates Chillingworth
3. What does Pearl make of seaweed? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A letter A
4. What does Pearl ask? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Why the minister keeps his hand over his heart
5. How does Hester answer? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She lies or evades
6. What color is Pearl's A? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Green
7. Retell the three most important events of "XV: Hester and Pearl" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hester admits to herself that she hates Chillingworth. Pearl makes a green letter A of eelgrass on her own breast and asks what the scarlet letter means and why the minister keeps his hand over his heart. Hester, for the first time, lies to her.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XV: Hester and Pearl"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XV: Hester and Pearl" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "Would he not suddenly sink into the earth, leaving a barren and blasted spot, where, in due course of time, would be seen deadly nightshade, dogwood, henbane, and whatever else of vegetable wickedness the climate could…" What does "nightshade" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: nightshade: a poisonous plant.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Hester lie? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: She fears the truth will hurt Pearl or Dimmesdale.
2. What does "XV: Hester and Pearl" suggest about Hester and Pearl? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Pearl insists on the truth the adults hide.
3. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about Hester and Pearl? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: "Yes, I hate him" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4): Hester's admission. On symbolism: Pearl makes a

green "A" of seaweed on her own breast. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Let men tremble to win the hand of woman, unless they win along with it the utmost passion of her heart!”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “XV: Hester and Pearl”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Hester admits to herself that she hates Chillingworth. Pearl makes a green letter A of eelgrass on her own breast and asks what the scarlet letter means and why the minister keeps his hand over his heart. Hester, for the first time, lies to her.
7. How does “XV: Hester and Pearl” build on “XIV: Hester and the Physician”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29): Pearl's question. Theme link: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “and why does the minister keep his hand over his heart” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19): Pearl links the minister to the letter. On characterization: Hester admits to herself that she hates Chillingworth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Should parents always tell their children the truth?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with public shame and private identity? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “Yes, I hate him” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4): Hester's admission. On conflict: Pearl asks why the minister keeps his hand over his heart; Hester lies for the first time. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Hester's lie justified? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29): Pearl's question. Theme link: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Pearl insists on the truth the adults hide.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “and why does the minister keep his hand over his heart” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19): Pearl links the minister to the letter. Theme link: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “Yes, I hate him” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4): Hester's admission. On characterization: Hester admits to herself that she hates Chillingworth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “XV: Hester and Pearl” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about Hester and Pearl? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29): Pearl's question. Theme link: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “XV: Hester and Pearl”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “and why does the minister keep his hand over his heart” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19): Pearl links the minister to the letter. Theme link: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to hypocrisy and truth: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “Yes, I hate him” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4): Hester's admission. Theme link: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29): Pearl's question. On characterization: Hester admits to herself that she hates Chillingworth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XV: Hester and Pearl” treats Hester and Pearl with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “and why does the minister keep his hand over his heart” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19): Pearl links the minister to the letter. Theme link: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “XVI: A Forest Walk” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “Yes, I hate him” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4): Hester's admission. Theme link: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Hester and Pearl? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29): Pearl's question. Theme link: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Hester threaten when Pearl keeps asking?
   Sample answer: To shut her in the dark closet.
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29: “Mother … what does the _____ letter mean”
   Key: scarlet
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Hester admit?
   A. She is sorry
   B. She wants to leave
   C. She hates Chillingworth
   D. She loves Chillingworth
   Key: C (She hates Chillingworth)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Pearl ask?
   A. Who the governor is

B. Why the minister keeps his hand over his heart

C. Where her father lives

D. Why the sky is red

Key: B (Why the minister keeps his hand over his heart)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “At first, as already told, she had flirted fancifully with her own image in a pool of water, beckoning the phantom forth, and—as it declined to venture—seeking a passage for herself into its sphere of impalpable earth…”, what does “fancifully” most nearly mean?

   A. a reddish glow

   B. playfully and imaginatively

   C. never having happened before

   D. accepting something without protest

   Key: B (playfully and imaginatively)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “She deemed it her crime most to be repented of, that she had ever endured, and reciprocated, the lukewarm grasp of his hand, and had suffered the smile of her lips and eyes to mingle and melt into his own.”, what does “reciprocated” most nearly mean?

   A. lively and bold

   B. built or reinforced with heavy wooden beams

   C. spoke of with harsh, abusive criticism

   D. returned (a feeling or gesture)

   Key: D (returned (a feeling or gesture))

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Would he not suddenly sink into the earth, leaving a barren and blasted spot, where, in due course of time, would be seen deadly nightshade, dogwood, henbane, and whatever else of vegetable wickedness the climate could…”, what does “nightshade” most nearly mean?

   A. the quality of being believable

   B. changing the true shape or meaning

   C. a poisonous plant

   D. changeable, unsteady moodiness

   Key: C (a poisonous plant)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The thought occurred to Hester, that the child might really be seeking to approach her with childlike confidence, and doing what she could, and as _____ as she knew how, to establish a meeting-point of sympathy.” Word bank: sedulous, intelligently, reciprocated, nightshade

   Key: intelligently

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What color is Pearl's A?

   A. Gold

   B. Black

   C. Green

   D. Red

   Key: C (Green)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Yes, I hate him” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4)

    A. The rose-bush as hope.

    B. Hester's admission.

    C. Why Hester names her Pearl.

    D. Hester's freedom.

    Key: B (Hester's admission.)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Pearl's question.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Yes, I hate him” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Hester's admission.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “XV: Hester and Pearl”?

    A. The prison door and the rose

    B. Pearl

    C. The leech

    D. Hester and Pearl

    Key: D (Hester and Pearl)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XV: Hester and Pearl”? Hester admits to herself that she hates Chillingworth.

    A. Allusion

    B. Characterization

    C. Foreshadowing

    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: B (Characterization)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hester's first lie to Pearl.

    A. Sin and guilt

    B. Nature and the individual against society

    C. Hypocrisy and truth

    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: C (Hypocrisy and truth)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Yes, I hate him” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Hester's admission.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19: “and why does the _____ keep his hand over his heart”

    Key: minister

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Or might it suffice him, that every wholesome growth should be converted into something _____ and malignant at his touch?” Word bank: reciprocated, sedulous, deleterious, nightshade

    Key: deleterious

19. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Hester lie?

    Sample answer: She fears the truth will hurt Pearl or Dimmesdale.

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “and why does the minister keep his hand over his heart” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19)

    A. Pearl links the minister to the letter.

    B. The sexton's unknowing irony.

    C. Dimmesdale to Hester.

    D. Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.

    Key: A (Pearl links the minister to the letter.)

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XV: Hester and Pearl”? Pearl makes a green "A" of seaweed on her own breast.

    A. Plot

    B. Theme

    C. Irony

    D. Symbolism

    Key: D (Symbolism)

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how hypocrisy and truth develops from an earlier chapter to “XV: Hester and Pearl”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Hester's first lie to Pearl.

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Hester answer?

    A. She leaves

    B. She tells the truth

    C. She lies or evades

    D. She laughs

    Key: C (She lies or evades)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29)

    A. Mistress Hibbins to Pearl.

    B. Pearl's question.

    C. The confession begins.

    D. The town's suspicion.

    Key: B (Pearl's question.)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Pearl presses the truth that adults hide.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: She asks "what does the scarlet letter mean?" and "why does the minister keep his hand over his heart?", and Hester, who has never lied, evades her.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Pearl's question.
27. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29).
    Sample answer: She asks "what does the scarlet letter mean?" and "why does the minister keep his hand over his heart?", and Hester, who has never lied, evades her.
28. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in "and why does the minister keep his hand over his heart" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Pearl links the minister to the letter.
29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Hester's lie justified? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view.
30. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Pearl make of seaweed?
    A. A rose
    B. A letter A
    C. A crown
    D. A boat

    Key: B (A letter A)

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 17, 6, 1, 4, 18, 9, 2, 3, 13, 10, 19, 20, 15, 21, 14, 22 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 5, 2, 23, 18, 7, 8, 10, 19, 13, 24, 20, 21, 14, 15, 25, 26 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 17, 3, 9, 8, 18, 10, 20, 13, 12, 11, 14, 27, 28, 15, 16, 25 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 23, 5, 18, 2, 20, 11, 24, 12, 19, 15, 21, 27, 28, 29, 26, 22 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 17, 7, 8, 13, 19, 10, 20, 28, 15, 21, 27, 14, 29, 25, 22, 26 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 18, 8, 30, 24, 20, 12, 11, 27, 21, 28, 14, 15, 25, 16, 29, 26 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 18, 2, 20, 13, 11, 19, 28, 27, 15, 21, 14, 25, 16, 26, 22, 29 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 18, 8, 24, 20, 19, 12, 14, 27, 21, 28, 15, 22, 26, 29, 25, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 18, 8, 11, 13, 24, 19, 14, 28, 15, 21, 27, 25, 26, 16, 22, 29 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 18, 8, 19, 10, 11, 13, 14, 15, 28, 21, 27, 22, 16, 29, 25, 26 | |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "XV: Hester and Pearl," how does Hawthorne show Hester and Pearl? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XV: Hester and Pearl, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of Hester and Pearl? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XV: Hester and Pearl develops the idea of Hester and Pearl. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XV: Hester and Pearl (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Hester and Pearl. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XV: Hester and Pearl suggests about Hester and Pearl. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses characterization in XV: Hester and Pearl to complicate the reader's understanding of Hester and Pearl. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XV: Hester and Pearl within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of Hester and Pearl responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XV: Hester and Pearl alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of Hester and Pearl follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XV: Hester and Pearl and its treatment

of Hester and Pearl. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XV: Hester and Pearl as evidence for a larger claim about Hester and Pearl in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XV: Hester and Pearl as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of Hester and Pearl. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *She wondered what sort of herbs they were, which the old man was so sedulous to gather.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “sedulous” most nearly mean?

   A. careful and hard-working

   B. in a sensible, knowing way

   C. playfully and imaginatively

   D. harmful

2. *Let men tremble to win the hand of woman, unless they win along with it the utmost passion of her heart! Else it may be their miserable fortune, as it was Roger Chillingworth’s, when some mightier touch than their own may have awakened all her sensibilities, to be reproached even for the calm content, the marble image of happiness, which they will have imposed upon her as the warm reality. But Hester ought long ago to have done with this injustice. What did it betoken? Had seven long years, under the torture of the scarlet letter, inflicted so much of misery, and wrought out no repentance?*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “XV: Hester and Pearl”?

   A. Hester and Pearl

   B. The pastor and his parishioner

   C. The interview in prison

   D. Hester at her needle

**SAT key:** 1. A (careful and hard-working); 2. A (Hester and Pearl)

# Lesson 19: XVI: A Forest Walk

**Focus:** the forest walk

**Objective:** Students will analyze how setting develops in "XVI: A Forest Walk" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Hester waits in the forest for Dimmesdale. Sunlight flickers around Pearl but flees from Hester. Pearl asks about the Black Man; Hester says she met him once, and the letter is his mark. The brook babbles but tells no secrets.

**Background:** Puritans saw the forest as the devil's ground, where witches met the Black Man.

**Significance:** The forest offers freedom but Hester brings the letter's shadow into it.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Is nature a place of freedom or danger? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to nature and the individual against society because....*
> **Prompt:** Is nature a place of freedom or danger?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to nature and the individual against society because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the forest as a world outside Puritan law.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: scintillating — sparkling; straggled — wandered in a scattered, irregular way; humanize — make more kind, gentle and human; pensiveness — deep, sad thoughtfulness; mischievously — playfully, in a teasing way. "mischievously": Origin of "mischievous": Anglo-Norman meschevous.*
> **Words:** scintillating: sparkling · straggled: wandered in a scattered, irregular way · humanize: make more kind, gentle and human · pensiveness: deep, sad thoughtfulness · mischievously: playfully, in a teasing way

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Puritans saw the forest as the devil's ground, where witches met the Black Man. The forest offers freedom but Hester brings the letter's shadow into it. Setting: The forest path, dark and wild, with sunshine that flees from Hester. Symbolism: Sunlight plays around Pearl but vanishes as Hester reaches for it. Foreshadowing: Pearl asks about the Black Man and whether Hester's letter is his mark. Watch for light and darkness: "Mother, the sunshine does not love you."*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" slowly and put it in my own words: In the forest, Pearl says the sunlight runs from her mother because of something on her breast. Next, craft. I notice the childlike personification of sunshine as a creature that loves or avoids people. The strongest word is "sunshine": it stands for joy and grace, which seem to flee the letter. Then, effect. What is Pearl suggesting when she says the sunshine does not love Hester? My answer: Pearl voices what the town believes, that the letter cuts Hester off from happiness; the moment prepares for Hester throwing the letter off and the sun pouring in.*

> *Mother … the sunshine does not love you* (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4)

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" slowly and put it in my own words: In the forest, Pearl says the sunlight runs from her mother because of something on her breast. Next, craft. I notice the childlike personification of sunshine as a creature that loves or avoids people. The strongest word is "sunshine": it stands for joy and grace, which seem to flee the letter. Then, effect. What is Pearl suggesting when she says the sunshine does not love Hester? My answer: Pearl voices what the town believes, that the letter cuts Hester off from happiness; the moment prepares for Hester throwing the letter off and the sun pouring in.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Hester admits the letter as the Black Man's mark. Expected link: symbolism; forest and town. Ask: How does this line connect to nature and the individual against society? Expected: The forest as a world outside Puritan law. (Hester's answer.)*

> *Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark* (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22)

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Hester admits the letter as the Black Man's mark. Expected link: symbolism; forest and town.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to nature and the individual against society?
**Expected answer:** The forest as a world outside Puritan law. (Hester's answer.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the forest walk? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XVI: A Forest Walk develops the idea of the forest walk. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. When the text says "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4), it shows this directly. Pearl says "the sunshine does not love you," and Hester tells her "This scarlet letter is his mark!"*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the forest walk? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XVI: A Forest Walk develops the idea of the forest walk. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. When the text says "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4), it shows this directly. Pearl says "the sunshine does not love you," and Hester tells her "This scarlet letter is his mark!"

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Is nature a place of freedom or danger? Ask: what does the brook, which tells no secret, have in common with Dimmesdale?*
**Anchor question:** Is nature a place of freedom or danger?
**Facilitation:** Ask: what does the brook, which tells no secret, have in common with Dimmesdale?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the forest walk? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. ("Mother … the sunshine does not love you", XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the forest walk? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. ("Mother … the sunshine does not love you", XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how setting shapes the forest walk. Key takeaway: the forest as a world outside Puritan law.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Setting:** The forest path, dark and wild, with sunshine that flees from Hester.
- **Symbolism:** Sunlight plays around Pearl but vanishes as Hester reaches for it.
- **Foreshadowing:** Pearl asks about the Black Man and whether Hester's letter is his mark.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **nature and the individual against society:** the forest as a world outside Puritan law.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and darkness:** "Mother, the sunshine does not love you."

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4) Pearl's observation.
- "Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22) Hester's answer.
- "It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4) Pearl on the sunshine.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it.
**Evidence:** "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4)
**Reasoning:** Pearl says "the sunshine does not love you," and Hester tells her "This scarlet letter is his mark!"

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **scintillating** (verb) | sparkling | *Pearl set forth, at a great pace, and, as Hester smiled to perceive, did actually catch the sunshine, and stood laughing in the midst of it, all brightened by its splendor, and scintillating with the vivacity excited by rapid motion.* | |
| **straggled** (verb) | wandered in a scattered, irregular way | *It straggled onward into the mystery of the primeval forest.* | |
| **humanize** (verb) | make more kind, gentle and human | *She wanted—what some people want throughout life—a grief that should* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | *deeply touch her, and thus humanize and make her capable of sympathy.* | |
| **pensiveness** (noun) | deep, sad thoughtfulness | *The sportive sunlight—feebly sportive, at best, in the predominant pensiveness of the day and scene—withdrew itself as they came nigh, and left the spots where it had danced the drearier, because they had hoped to find them bright.* | |
| **mischievously** (adverb) | playfully, in a teasing way | *"O, a story about the Black Man," answered Pearl, taking hold of her mother's gown, and looking up, half earnestly, half mischievously, into her face.* | "mischievously": Origin of "mischievous": Anglo-Norman meschevous. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/mischievous#Etymology) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Is nature a place of freedom or danger?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with hypocrisy and truth?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. Where is Dimmesdale coming from? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A visit to the Apostle Eliot among the Native converts.
2. Where does Hester wait? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In the forest
3. What avoids Hester? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Sunshine
4. Who is the Black Man? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The devil of local legend
5. What does Hester call the letter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Black Man's mark
6. What does the brook do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Babbles but tells no secret
7. Retell the three most important events of "XVI: A Forest Walk" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hester waits in the forest for Dimmesdale. Sunlight

flickers around Pearl but flees from Hester. Pearl asks about the Black Man; Hester says she met him once, and the letter is his mark. The brook babbles but tells no secrets.

8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XVI: A Forest Walk"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XVI: A Forest Walk" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "Pearl set forth, at a great pace, and, as Hester smiled to perceive, did actually catch the sunshine, and stood laughing in the midst of it, all brightened by its splendor, and scintillating with the vivacity excited by…" What does "scintillating" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: scintillating: sparkling.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the sunshine avoid Hester? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Something on her bosom, the letter, keeps it away.
2. What does "XVI: A Forest Walk" suggest about the forest walk? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The forest offers freedom but Hester brings the letter's shadow into it.
3. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about the forest walk? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4): Pearl's observation. On symbolism: Sunlight plays around Pearl but vanishes as Hester reaches for it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Pearl set forth, at a great pace, and, as Hester smiled to perceive, did actually catch the sunshine, and stood laughing in the midst of it, all brightened by its splendor, and…", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "XVI: A Forest Walk", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Hester waits in the forest for Dimmesdale. Sunlight flickers around Pearl but flees from Hester. Pearl asks about the Black Man; Hester says she met him once, and the letter is his mark. The brook babbles but tells no secrets.
7. How does "XVI: A Forest Walk" build on "XV: Hester and Pearl"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: "Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22): Hester's answer. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan

law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: “It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4): Pearl on the sunshine. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is nature a place of freedom or danger?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with hypocrisy and truth? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4): Pearl's observation. On foreshadowing: Pearl asks about the Black Man and whether Hester's letter is his mark. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is the forest good or evil in the novel? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22): Hester's answer. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The forest offers freedom but Hester brings the letter's shadow into it.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: “It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4): Pearl on the sunshine. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk,

paragraph 4): Pearl's observation. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of "XVI: A Forest Walk" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the forest walk? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: "Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22): Hester's answer. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "XVI: A Forest Walk": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: "It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4): Pearl on the sunshine. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to nature and the individual against society: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4): Pearl's observation. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: "Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22): Hester's answer. On setting: The forest path, dark and wild, with sunshine that flees from Hester. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "XVI: A Forest Walk" treats the forest walk with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: "It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4): Pearl on the sunshine. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner" will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4): Pearl's observation. On foreshadowing: Pearl asks about the Black Man and whether Hester's letter is his mark. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the forest walk? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: "Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22): Hester's answer. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "The sportive sunlight—feebly sportive, at best, in the predominant pensiveness of the day and scene—withdrew itself as they came nigh, and left the spots where it had danced the drearier, because they had hoped to find…", what does "pensiveness" most nearly mean?
   A. promising solemnly
   B. a poisonous plant
   C. restless turning movements
   D. deep, sad thoughtfulness

   Key: D (deep, sad thoughtfulness)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the brook do?
   A. Freezes
   B. Babbles but tells no secret
   C. Dries up
   D. Floods

   Key: B (Babbles but tells no secret)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "It straggled onward into the mystery of the primeval forest.", what does "straggled" most nearly mean?
   A. fully satisfying

B. carrying too heavy a load

C. strengthened; given new energy

D. wandered in a scattered, irregular way

Key: D (wandered in a scattered, irregular way)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who is the Black Man?

   A. A minister

   B. The devil of local legend

   C. Chillingworth's servant

   D. A sailor

   Key: B (The devil of local legend)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22: “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This _____ letter is his mark”

   Key: scarlet

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: ““O, a story about the Black Man,” answered Pearl, taking hold of her mother’s gown, and looking up, half earnestly, half _____, into her face.”

   Word bank: straggled, humanize, scintillating, mischievously

   Key: mischievously

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What avoids Hester?

   A. Sunshine

   B. The brook

   C. Pearl

   D. Birds

   Key: A (Sunshine)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Pearl set forth, at a great pace, and, as Hester smiled to perceive, did actually catch the sunshine, and stood laughing in the midst of it, all brightened by its splendor, and scintillating with the vivacity excited by…”, what does “scintillating” most nearly mean?

   A. sparkling

   B. the quality of being believable

   C. serving as an introduction to what follows

   D. a complete change of appearance

   Key: A (sparkling)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4: “Mother … the _____ does not love you”

   Key: sunshine

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does the sunshine avoid Hester?

    Sample answer: Something on her bosom, the letter, keeps it away.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4)

    A. Hester to Pearl: town against forest.

    B. Pearl on the sunshine.

C. The rose-bush as hope.

D. The prison as an image.

Key: B (Pearl on the sunshine.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22)

A. Hester's fear of him.

B. Hester's answer.

C. The letter isolates Hester.

D. Anguish as his only truth.

Key: B (Hester's answer.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “XVI: A Forest Walk”?

A. The forest walk

B. The physician probes the minister

C. The prison door and the rose

D. The pastor and his parishioner

Key: A (The forest walk)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The forest as a world outside Puritan law.

A. Hypocrisy and truth

B. Public shame and private identity

C. Sin and guilt

D. Nature and the individual against society

Key: D (Nature and the individual against society)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Pearl on the sunshine.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Hester's answer.

17. [short · recall · DOK 1] Where is Dimmesdale coming from?

Sample answer: A visit to the Apostle Eliot among the Native converts.

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4: “It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of _____ on your bosom”

Key: something

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Hester wait?

A. In the forest

B. At home

C. By the scaffold

D. At church

Key: A (In the forest)

20. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Hester's answer.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XVI: A Forest Walk”? Sunlight plays around Pearl but vanishes as Hester reaches for it.

    A. Simile

    B. Symbolism

    C. Metaphor

    D. Structure

    Key: B (Symbolism)

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Hester call the letter?

    A. A gift

    B. Her shame alone

    C. The Black Man's mark

    D. An angel's sign

    Key: C (The Black Man's mark)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “She wanted—what some people want throughout life—a grief that should deeply touch her, and thus humanize and make her capable of sympathy.”, what does “humanize” most nearly mean?

    A. bordered or edged

    B. make more kind, gentle and human

    C. lacking curiosity (here 'not incurious' means quite curious)

    D. built or reinforced with heavy wooden beams

    Key: B (make more kind, gentle and human)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4)

    A. Hester's freedom.

    B. Pearl's observation.

    C. Hawthorne refuses to revise.

    D. Nature's response.

    Key: B (Pearl's observation.)

25. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Pearl's observation.

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XVI: A Forest Walk”? The forest path, dark and wild, with sunshine that flees from Hester.

    A. Personification

B. Conflict

C. Setting

D. Structure

Key: C (Setting)

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Pearl's observation.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is the forest good or evil in the novel? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view.

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4).
    Sample answer: Pearl says "the sunshine does not love you," and Hester tells her "This scarlet letter is his mark!"

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how nature and the individual against society develops from an earlier chapter to “XVI: A Forest Walk”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: the forest as a world outside Puritan law.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Pearl says "the sunshine does not love you," and Hester tells her "This scarlet letter is his mark!"

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 6, 2, 8, 17, 18, 9, 4, 19, 13, 12, 10, 20, 14, 15, 21, 16 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 18, 17, 22, 3, 6, 23, 20, 24, 25, 10, 13, 15, 26, 21, 27, 28 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 6, 7, 19, 18, 2, 11, 25, 12, 10, 24, 21, 29, 15, 14, 30, 28 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 1, 5, 4, 18, 13, 25, 10, 20, 12, 26, 29, 21, 15, 31, 30, 16 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 18, 6, 8, 24, 11, 20, 12, 26, 14, 15, 21, 29, 28, 30, 31, 16 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 6, 9, 19, 11, 20, 25, 24, 15, 14, 26, 29, 21, 16, 30, 31, 27 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 6, 9, 20, 10, 24, 11, 29, 26, 21, 15, 14, 28, 30, 27, 16, 31 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 6, 9, 24, 10, 13, 20, 21, 15, 26, 14, 29, 28, 27, 31, 30, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 6, 9, 10, 12, 20, 13, 15, 29, 26, 21, 14, 28, 31, 16, 27, 30 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 9, 6, 11, 25, 12, 20, 15, 21, 14, 26, 29, 30, 28, 31, 27, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “XVI: A Forest Walk,” how does Hawthorne show the forest walk? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XVI: A Forest Walk, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the forest walk? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XVI: A Forest Walk develops the idea of the forest walk. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XVI: A Forest Walk (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the forest walk. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XVI: A Forest Walk suggests about the forest walk. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses setting in XVI: A Forest Walk to complicate the reader's understanding of the forest walk. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XVI: A Forest Walk within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the forest walk responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XVI: A Forest Walk alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the forest walk follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XVI: A Forest Walk and its treatment of the forest walk. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XVI: A Forest Walk as evidence for a larger claim about the forest walk in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XVI: A Forest Walk as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the forest walk. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial

approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Pearl set forth, at a great pace, and, as Hester smiled to perceive, did actually catch the sunshine, and stood laughing in the midst of it, all brightened by its splendor, and scintillating with the vivacity excited by rapid motion.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "scintillating" most nearly mean?

   A. deep, sad thoughtfulness
   B. make more kind, gentle and human
   C. sparkling
   D. playfully, in a teasing way

2. *Pearl set forth, at a great pace, and, as Hester smiled to perceive, did actually catch the sunshine, and stood laughing in the midst of it, all brightened by its splendor, and scintillating with the vivacity excited by rapid motion. The light lingered about the lonely child, as if glad of such a playmate, until her mother had drawn almost nigh enough to step into the magic circle too.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "XVI: A Forest Walk"?

   A. The minister's vigil
   B. An author answering his critics
   C. Hester on the scaffold
   D. The forest walk

**SAT key:** 1. C (sparkling); 2. D (The forest walk)

# Lesson 20: XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner

**Focus:** the pastor and his parishioner

**Objective:** Students will analyze how conflict develops in “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

**Critical voice:** “The "Vicar of Wakefield" is sometimes coarsely virtuous, but "the Scarlet Letter" is delicately immoral.” (Arthur Cleveland Coxe, clergyman and critic, *"The Writings of Hawthorne," Church Review (January 1851), pp. 489-511 (excerpt), excerpt*; public domain). Seminar: "What we did had a consecration of its own." Does the novel endorse Hester's claim, as Coxe fears? *Objective:* Evaluate the moral argument of the forest scene. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.2, SL.11-12.1

Teacher only · spoilers

Hester and Dimmesdale meet like ghosts. He tells her of his torment; she reveals that Chillingworth is her husband. He is horrified, then forgives her, saying the old man's revenge is blacker than their sin. Hester urges him to flee with her to Europe and promises he will not go alone.

**Background:** Ships sailed regularly between Boston and Bristol; escape to Europe was realistic.

**Significance:** The lovers reframe their sin as less than revenge.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Is one sin worse than another? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to sin and guilt because....*
**Prompt:** Is one sin worse than another?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to sin and guilt because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: a hierarchy of sins.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: satiating — fully satisfying; misanthropy — dislike or distrust of people; invigorated — strengthened; given new energy; dolefully — sadly; mournfully; contiguity — nearness; being next to. “misanthropy”: Origin: Ancient Greek μισανθρωπία. “dolefully”: Origin of “doleful”: an English formation from dole + -ful. “contiguity”: Origin: French contiguïté; earlier Late Latin contiguitās.*
**Words:** satiating: fully satisfying · misanthropy: dislike or distrust of people · invigorated: strengthened; given new energy · dolefully: sadly; mournfully · contiguity: nearness; being next to

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Ships sailed regularly between Boston and Bristol; escape to Europe was realistic. The lovers reframe their sin as less than revenge. Conflict: Hester tells Dimmesdale that Chillingworth is her husband; he is horrified, then forgives her. Characterization: Dimmesdale's despair; Hester's strength: "Thou shalt not go alone!" Theme: They insist their sin was less than Chillingworth's: "What we did had a consecration of its own." Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “Gathering himself quickly up, he stood more erect, like a man taken by surprise in a mood to which he was” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 4).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” slowly and put it in my own words: Hester tells Dimmesdale that what they did had a holiness of its own, which they both felt and said. Next, craft. I notice the religious word "consecration" used for the act the Puritans call sin. The strongest word is “consecration”: it means a making holy, so she defends their love in the town's own sacred language. Then, effect. What does Hester claim about her love for Dimmesdale? My answer: Hester claims that her love for Dimmesdale had a consecration of its own, which the Puritan verdict cannot cancel; her years of isolation have made her think for herself, which frightens and tempts him.*

> *What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” slowly and put it in my own words: Hester tells Dimmesdale that what they did had a holiness of its own, which they both felt and said. Next, craft. I notice the religious word "consecration" used for the act the Puritans call sin. The strongest word is “consecration”: it means a making holy, so she defends their love in the town's own sacred language. Then, effect. What does Hester claim about her love for Dimmesdale? My answer: Hester claims that her love for Dimmesdale had a consecration of its own, which the Puritan verdict cannot cancel; her years of isolation have made her think for herself, which frightens and tempts him.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The lovers judge Chillingworth's sin worse than theirs. Expected link: theme; sin and guilt. Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt? Expected: A hierarchy of sins. (Dimmesdale's verdict.)*

> *That old man's revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** The lovers judge Chillingworth's sin worse than theirs. Expected link: theme; sin and guilt.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to sin and guilt?
**Expected answer:** A hierarchy of sins. (Dimmesdale's verdict.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the pastor and his parishioner? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner develops the idea of the pastor and his parishioner. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. When the text says "That old man's revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31), it shows this directly. Dimmesdale calls Chillingworth's revenge "blacker than my sin" because it "violated … the sanctity of a human heart," and Hester insists "What we did had a consecration of its own."*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the pastor and his parishioner? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner develops the idea of the pastor and his parishioner. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. When the text says "That old man's revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31), it shows this directly. Dimmesdale calls Chillingworth's revenge "blacker than my sin" because it "violated … the sanctity of a human heart," and Hester insists "What we did had a consecration of its own."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Is one sin worse than another? Ask: do you agree with Dimmesdale's ranking of sins? Is he being honest or making excuses?*
**Anchor question:** Is one sin worse than another?
**Facilitation:** Ask: do you agree with Dimmesdale's ranking of sins? Is he being honest or making excuses?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the pastor and his parishioner? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. ("That old man's revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart", XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the pastor and his parishioner? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. ("That old man's revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart", XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how conflict shapes the pastor and his parishioner. Key takeaway: a hierarchy of sins.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Conflict:** Hester tells Dimmesdale that Chillingworth is her husband; he is horrified, then forgives her.
- **Characterization:** Dimmesdale's despair; Hester's strength: "Thou shalt not go alone!"
- **Theme:** They insist their sin was less than Chillingworth's: "What we did had a consecration of its own."

### Themes and how they develop

- **sin and guilt:** a hierarchy of sins.

### Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "Gathering himself quickly up, he stood more erect, like a man taken by surprise in a mood to which he was" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 4).

- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: "he knew not whether it were a woman or a shadow. It may be, that his pathway through life was haunted thus" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 4).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32) Hester's defense.
- "That old man's revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31) Dimmesdale's verdict.
- "Thou shalt not go alone" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 56) Hester's promise.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin.
**Evidence:** "That old man's revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31)
**Reasoning:** Dimmesdale calls Chillingworth's revenge "blacker than my sin" because it "violated ... the sanctity of a human heart," and Hester insists "What we did had a consecration of its own."

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **satiating** (verb) | fully satisfying | *He will doubtless seek other means of satiating his dark passion."* | |
| **misanthropy** (noun) | dislike or distrust of people | *There had been a period when Hester was less alive to this consideration; or, perhaps, in the misanthropy of her own trouble, she left the minister to bear what she might picture to herself as a more tolerable doom.* | "misanthropy": Origin: Ancient Greek μισανθρωπία. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/misanthropy#Etymology) |
| **invigorated** (verb) | strengthened; given new energy | *But of late, since the night of his vigil, all her sympathies towards him had been both softened and invigorated.* | |
| **dolefully** (adverb) | sadly; mournfully | *The boughs were tossing heavily above their heads; while one solemn old tree groaned dolefully to another, as if telling the sad story of the pair that sat beneath, or constrained to forebode evil to come.* | "dolefully": Origin of "doleful": an English formation from dole + -ful. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/doleful#Etymology) |
| **contiguity** (noun) | nearness; being next to | *The very contiguity of his enemy, beneath whatever mask the latter might conceal himself, was enough to disturb* | "contiguity": Origin: French contiguïté; earlier Late Latin contiguitās. (Liber et Libri origin note, https:// |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | *the magnetic sphere of a being so sensitive as Arthur Dimmesdale.* | en.wiktionary.org/wiki/contiguity#Etymology) |
| **indelicacy** (noun) | lack of modesty or tact | *And the shame!—the indelicacy!—the horrible ugliness of this exposure of a sick and guilty heart to the very eye that would gloat over it!* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Is one sin worse than another?
2. Where does conflict appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature and the individual against society?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

**Literal / recall**

1. What does Hester say their act had? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A consecration of its own.
2. What does Hester reveal? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Chillingworth is her husband
3. How does Dimmesdale react first? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: With horror and anger
4. Whose sin does Dimmesdale call blacker? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Chillingworth's
5. What does Hester suggest? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Fleeing to Europe
6. What does Hester promise? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He shall not go alone
7. Retell the three most important events of "XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hester and Dimmesdale meet like ghosts. He tells her of his torment; she reveals that Chillingworth is her husband. He is horrified, then forgives her, saying the old man's revenge is blacker than their sin. Hester urges him to flee with her to Europe and promises he will not go alone.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

10. Reread: “He will doubtless seek other means of satiating his dark passion.”” What does “satiating” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: satiating: fully satisfying.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does Dimmesdale say he cannot flee alone? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He lacks the strength.
2. What does “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner” suggest about the pastor and his parishioner? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The lovers reframe their sin as less than revenge.
3. Find one example of conflict in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the pastor and his parishioner? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32): Hester's defense. On characterization: Dimmesdale's despair; Hester's strength: "Thou shalt not go alone!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins ““I might have known it,””, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Hester and Dimmesdale meet like ghosts. He tells her of his torment; she reveals that Chillingworth is her husband. He is horrified, then forgives her, saying the old man's revenge is blacker than their sin. Hester urges him to flee with her to Europe and promises he will not go alone.
7. How does “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner” build on “XVI: A Forest Walk”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31): Dimmesdale's verdict. Theme link: a hierarchy of sins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “Thou shalt not go alone” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 56): Hester's promise. On characterization: Dimmesdale's despair; Hester's strength: "Thou shalt not go alone!" Credit

any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is one sin worse than another?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature and the individual against society? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32): Hester's defense. On theme: They insist their sin was less than Chillingworth's: "What we did had a consecration of its own." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Do you agree with Dimmesdale's ranking of sins? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31): Dimmesdale's verdict. On theme: They insist their sin was less than Chillingworth's: "What we did had a consecration of its own." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The lovers reframe their sin as less than revenge.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “Thou shalt not go alone” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 56): Hester's promise. On theme: They insist their sin was less than Chillingworth's: "What we did had a consecration of its own." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32): Hester's defense. On characterization: Dimmesdale's despair; Hester's strength: "Thou shalt not go alone!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Rewrite one moment of “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the pastor and his parishioner? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin.

Useful evidence: “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31): Dimmesdale's verdict. Theme link: a hierarchy of sins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “Thou shalt not go alone” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 56): Hester's promise. On theme: They insist their sin was less than Chillingworth's: "What we did had a consecration of its own." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to women and independence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32): Hester's defense. On theme: They insist their sin was less than Chillingworth's: "What we did had a consecration of its own." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31): Dimmesdale's verdict. On conflict: Hester tells Dimmesdale that Chillingworth is her husband; he is horrified, then forgives her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner” treats the pastor and his parishioner with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “Thou shalt not go alone” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 56): Hester's promise. On theme: They insist their sin was less than Chillingworth's: "What we did had a consecration of its own." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32): Hester's defense. Theme link: a hierarchy of sins.

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the pastor and his parishioner? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31): Dimmesdale's verdict. On theme: They insist their sin was less than Chillingworth's: "What we did had a consecration of its own." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Hester suggest?

    A. Fleeing to Europe

    B. Confessing

    C. Killing Chillingworth

    D. Going to the governor

    Key: A (Fleeing to Europe)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31: “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has _____, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart”

    Key: violated

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Dimmesdale react first?

    A. With laughter

    B. With horror and anger

    C. With silence

    D. With joy

    Key: B (With horror and anger)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “And the shame!—the _____!—the horrible ugliness of this exposure of a sick and guilty heart to the very eye that would gloat over it!” Word bank: invigorated, misanthropy, indelicacy, satiating

    Key: indelicacy

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The boughs were tossing heavily above their heads; while one solemn old tree groaned dolefully to another, as if telling the sad story of the pair that sat beneath, or constrained to forebode evil to come.”, what does “dolefully” most nearly mean?

   A. examining one's own thoughts and feelings

   B. approaching and speaking to (someone)

   C. make more kind, gentle and human

   D. sadly; mournfully

   Key: D (sadly; mournfully)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The very _____ of his enemy, beneath whatever mask the latter might conceal himself, was enough to disturb the magnetic sphere of a being so sensitive as Arthur Dimmesdale.” Word bank: invigorated, satiating, misanthropy, contiguity

   Key: contiguity

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32: “What we did had a _____ of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other”

   Key: consecration

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “He will doubtless seek other means of satiating his dark passion.””, what does “satiating” most nearly mean?

   A. a feeling of awe and dread

   B. a member of a minister's congregation

   C. the system of coats of arms

   D. fully satisfying

   Key: D (fully satisfying)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whose sin does Dimmesdale call blacker?

   A. The town's

   B. Chillingworth's

   C. Hester's

   D. His own

   Key: B (Chillingworth's)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Hester's defense.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31)

    A. Hester's admission.

    B. Hester casts off the letter.

    C. Dimmesdale's verdict.

    D. Hester's change.

    Key: C (Dimmesdale's verdict.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Dimmesdale say he cannot flee alone?
    Sample answer: He lacks the strength.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Dimmesdale's verdict.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner”? Hester tells Dimmesdale that Chillingworth is her husband; he is horrified, then forgives her.

    A. Point of view
    B. Conflict
    C. Theme
    D. Simile

    Key: B (Conflict)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Thou shalt not go alone” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 56). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Hester's promise.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Dimmesdale's verdict.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “There had been a period when Hester was less alive to this consideration; or, perhaps, in the misanthropy of her own trouble, she left the minister to bear what she might picture to herself as a more tolerable doom.”, what does “misanthropy” most nearly mean?

    A. close, focused attention
    B. dislike or distrust of people
    C. lack of clarity; blurriness
    D. harmful

    Key: B (dislike or distrust of people)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Hester reveal?

    A. Chillingworth is her husband
    B. She is leaving
    C. Pearl is ill
    D. She will confess

    Key: A (Chillingworth is her husband)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Hester promise?

    A. He shall not go alone
    B. She will pray
    C. She will remarry
    D. She will stay

    Key: A (He shall not go alone)

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32)

    A. Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.

    B. The townspeople's suspicion.

    C. Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.

    D. Hester's defense.

    Key: D (Hester's defense.)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner”?

    A. The leech

    B. The pastor and his parishioner

    C. The revelation

    D. Hester and the physician

    Key: B (The pastor and his parishioner)

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31).

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale calls Chillingworth's revenge "blacker than my sin" because it "violated ... the sanctity of a human heart," and Hester insists "What we did had a consecration of its own."

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner”? Dimmesdale's despair; Hester's strength: "Thou shalt not go alone!"

    A. Characterization

    B. Setting

    C. Structure

    D. Point of view

    Key: A (Characterization)

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how sin and guilt develops from an earlier chapter to “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: a hierarchy of sins.

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Hester's defense.

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Thou shalt not go alone” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 56)

    A. Pearl and the rose.

    B. The opening, with its ironic self-presentation.

    C. Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter.

    D. Hester's promise.

    Key: D (Hester's promise.)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? A hierarchy of sins.

    A. Nature and the individual against society

    B. Public shame and private identity

    C. Hypocrisy and truth

    D. Sin and guilt

    Key: D (Sin and guilt)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Do you agree with Dimmesdale's ranking of sins? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Dimmesdale calls Chillingworth's revenge "blacker than my sin" because it "violated ... the sanctity of a human heart," and Hester insists "What we did had a consecration of its own."

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 17, 5, 18, 2, 1, 7, 19, 8, 12, 20, 11, 21, 22, 23, 15, 24 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 6, 4, 5, 17, 9, 18, 10, 20, 12, 13, 21, 23, 14, 22, 24, 25 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 2, 6, 3, 8, 9, 11, 12, 26, 20, 21, 23, 22, 14, 27, 24, 28 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 4, 2, 7, 9, 26, 13, 21, 10, 11, 27, 23, 22, 14, 28, 24, 25 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 6, 4, 3, 11, 20, 10, 21, 27, 23, 15, 14, 22, 28, 16, 24, 25 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 6, 4, 9, 26, 21, 11, 13, 22, 15, 27, 23, 14, 25, 24, 16, 28 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 6, 4, 26, 11, 12, 20, 15, 27, 23, 14, 22, 16, 24, 25, 29, 28 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 4, 6, 13, 21, 20, 11, 23, 14, 15, 22, 27, 28, 24, 25, 29, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 6, 4, 26, 21, 20, 12, 23, 14, 22, 27, 15, 28, 29, 24, 25, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 6, 4, 21, 26, 12, 10, 22, 23, 14, 15, 27, 28, 29, 24, 25, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner,” how does Hawthorne show the pastor and his parishioner? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the pastor and his parishioner? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner develops the idea of the pastor and his parishioner. Make a precise claim, support it with at least

three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of the pastor and his parishioner. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner suggests about the pastor and his parishioner. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses conflict in XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner to complicate the reader's understanding of the pastor and his parishioner. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the pastor and his parishioner responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the pastor and his parishioner follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner and its treatment of the pastor and his parishioner. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner as evidence for a larger claim about the pastor and his parishioner in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the pastor and his parishioner. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *But of late, since the night of his vigil, all her sympathies towards him had been both softened and invigorated.*

As used in the text, what does the word "invigorated" most nearly mean?

A. sadly; mournfully

B. lack of modesty or tact

C. nearness; being next to

D. strengthened; given new energy

2. *"I might have known it," murmured he. "I did know it! Was not the secret told me, in the natural recoil of my heart, at the first sight of him, and as often as I have seen him since? Why did I not understand? O Hester Prynne, thou little, little knowest all the horror of this thing! And the shame!—the indelicacy!—the horrible ugliness of this exposure of a sick and guilty heart to the very eye that would gloat over it! Woman, woman, thou art accountable for this! I cannot forgive thee!"*

Which choice best states a central concern of "XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner"?

A. The revelation

B. The minister in a maze

C. The pastor and his parishioner

D. Pearl

**SAT key:** 1. D (strengthened; given new energy); 2. C (The pastor and his parishioner)

# Lesson 21: XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine

**Focus:** a flood of sunshine

**Objective:** Students will analyze how symbolism develops in "XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Dimmesdale decides to flee. Hester unfastens the letter and throws it toward the brook, lets down her hair, and sunshine floods the forest. The narrator warns that she has wandered in a moral wilderness. Hester calls Pearl to meet her father.

**Background:** Hawthorne had lived at Brook Farm, a utopian community, and knew Transcendentalist celebrations of nature.

**Significance:** Freedom in the forest is beautiful but the narrator doubts it.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Can you leave your past behind? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to nature and the individual against society because....*
**Prompt:** Can you leave your past behind?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to nature and the individual against society because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: nature responds to their happiness.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: transmuting — changing into something else; clucked — made the clicking sound a hen makes; gladdening — making glad; effluence — something that flows out; outlawed — shut out from society and its protection. "transmuting": Origin of "transmute": Latin trānsmūtāre. "effluence": Origin: French effluence; earlier Latin effluentia.*
**Words:** transmuting: changing into something else · clucked: made the clicking sound a hen makes · gladdening: making glad · effluence: something that flows out · outlawed: shut out from society and its protection

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Hawthorne had lived at Brook Farm, a utopian community, and knew Transcendentalist celebrations of nature. Freedom in the forest is beautiful but the narrator doubts it. Symbolism: Hester throws away the letter and lets down her hair; sunshine floods the forest. Imagery: "A flood of sunshine" bursts through the trees. Characterization: Hester's radical freedom: "The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free." Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "Arthur Dimmesdale gazed into Hester's face with a look in which hope and joy shone out, indeed, but with" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 1).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves" slowly and put it in my own words: Hester unfastens the scarlet letter and throws it away among the dead leaves. Next, craft. I notice the careful steps of undoing the clasp, then a sudden throw, like shedding a weight. The strongest word is "withered": the dead leaves suggest the letter belongs with what is past and dying. Then, effect. What does Hester's act in the forest mean? My answer: In the forest, outside the town's law, Hester frees herself for a moment; the sunshine that follows shows how much the letter had darkened her life.*

> *she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves" slowly and put it in my own words: Hester unfastens the scarlet letter and throws it away among the dead leaves. Next, craft. I notice the careful steps of undoing the clasp, then a sudden throw, like shedding a weight. The strongest word is "withered": the dead leaves suggest the letter belongs with what is past and dying. Then, effect. What does Hester's act in the forest mean? My answer: In the forest, outside the town's law, Hester frees herself for a moment; the sunshine that follows shows how much the letter had darkened her life.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Nature, "never subjugated by human law," celebrates them. Expected link: setting; nature and society. Ask: How does this line connect to nature and the individual against society? Expected: Nature responds to their happiness. (Nature's response.)*

> *Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Nature, "never subjugated by human law," celebrates them. Expected link: setting; nature and society.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to nature and the individual against society?
**Expected answer:** Nature responds to their happiness. (Nature's response.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the chapter for symbolism, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about a flood of sunshine? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine develops the idea of a flood of sunshine. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. When the text says "Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13), it shows this directly. Nature shows "sympathy" with "these two spirits," yet Hester has "wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness."*

**Task:** Annotate the chapter for symbolism, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about a flood of sunshine? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine develops the idea of a flood of sunshine. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. When the text says “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13), it shows this directly. Nature shows "sympathy" with "these two spirits," yet Hester has "wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: Can you leave your past behind? Ask: is the narrator celebrating or warning? Find words that point each way.*

**Anchor question:** Can you leave your past behind?

**Facilitation:** Ask: is the narrator celebrating or warning? Find words that point each way.

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about a flood of sunshine? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. ("Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these tw", XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about a flood of sunshine? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. ("Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these tw", XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how symbolism shapes a flood of sunshine. Key takeaway: nature responds to their happiness.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Symbolism:** Hester throws away the letter and lets down her hair; sunshine floods the forest.
- **Imagery:** "A flood of sunshine" bursts through the trees.
- **Characterization:** Hester's radical freedom: "The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free."

### Themes and how they develop

- **nature and the individual against society:** nature responds to their happiness.

### Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "Arthur Dimmesdale gazed into Hester's face with a look in which hope and joy shone out, indeed, but with" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: "as intricate and shadowy, as the untamed forest, amid the gloom of which they were now holding a colloquy that was to" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11) Hester casts off the letter.
- "Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13) Nature's response.
- "The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2) Hester's freedom.
- "She had wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2) The narrator's qualification.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom.
**Evidence:** "Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13)
**Reasoning:** Nature shows "sympathy" with "these two spirits," yet Hester has "wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness."

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **transmuting** (verb) | changing into something else | *All at once, as with a sudden smile of heaven, forth burst the sunshine, pouring a very flood into the obscure forest, gladdening each green leaf, transmuting the yellow fallen ones to gold, and gleaming adown the gray trunks of the solemn trees.* | "transmuting": Origin of "transmute": Latin trānsmūtāre. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/transmute#Etymology) |
| **clucked** (verb) | made the clicking sound a hen makes | *A partridge, indeed, with a brood of ten behind her, ran forward threateningly, but soon repented of her fierceness, and clucked to her young ones not to be afraid.* | |
| **gladdening** (verb) | making glad | *All at once, as with a sudden smile of heaven, forth burst the sunshine, pouring a very flood into the obscure forest, gladdening each green leaf, transmuting the yellow fallen ones to gold, and gleaming adown the gray trunks of the solemn trees.* | |
| **effluence** (noun) | something that flows out | *And, as if the gloom of the earth and sky had been but the effluence of these two mortal hearts, it vanished with their sorrow.* | "effluence": Origin: French effluence; earlier Latin effluentia. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/effluence#Etymology) |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **outlawed** (verb) | shut out from society and its protection | *But Hester Prynne, with a mind of native courage and activity, and for so long a period not merely estranged, but outlawed, from society, had habituated herself to such latitude of speculation as was altogether foreign to the clergyman.* | |
| **margined** (adjective) | bordered or edged | *And she was gentler here than in the grassy-margined streets of the settlement, or in her mother's cottage.* | |
| **unhealed** (adjective) | not yet healed | *As a man who had once sinned, but who kept his conscience all alive and painfully sensitive by the fretting of an unhealed wound, he might have been supposed safer within the line of virtue than if he had never sinned at all.* | |
| **unredeemed** (adjective) | not saved from sin | *It was the exhilarating effect—upon a prisoner just escaped from the dungeon of his own heart—of breathing the wild, free atmosphere of an unredeemed, unchristianized, lawless region.* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Can you leave your past behind?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with women and independence?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. Where does the letter land? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: On the edge of the brook.
2. What does Hester throw away? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The scarlet letter
3. What happens when she does? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Sunshine floods the forest

4. What does Hester do with her hair? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Lets it down
5. What does Dimmesdale decide? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To flee
6. Whom does Hester call? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Pearl
7. Retell the three most important events of "XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Dimmesdale decides to flee. Hester unfastens the letter and throws it toward the brook, lets down her hair, and sunshine floods the forest. The narrator warns that she has wandered in a moral wilderness. Hester calls Pearl to meet her father.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "All at once, as with a sudden smile of heaven, forth burst the sunshine, pouring a very flood into the obscure forest, gladdening each green leaf, transmuting the yellow fallen ones to gold, and gleaming adown the gray…" What does "transmuting" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: transmuting: changing into something else.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does nature 'sympathize' with them? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: The forest is outside human law.
2. What does "XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine" suggest about a flood of sunshine? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Freedom in the forest is beautiful but the narrator doubts it.
3. Find one example of symbolism in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
4. How does the imagery in this chapter shape what we understand about a flood of sunshine? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: "she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11): Hester casts off the letter. On imagery: "A flood of sunshine" bursts through the trees. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "The decision once made, a glow of strange enjoyment threw its flickering brightness over the trouble of his breast.", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Dimmesdale decides to flee. Hester unfastens the letter and throws it toward the brook, lets down her hair, and sunshine floods the forest. The narrator warns that she has wandered in a moral wilderness. Hester calls Pearl to meet her father.
7. How does “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine” build on “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13): Nature's response. Theme link: nature responds to their happiness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2): Hester's freedom. On characterization: Hester's radical freedom: "The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can you leave your past behind?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with women and independence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “She had wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2): The narrator's qualification. On characterization: Hester's radical freedom: "The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is the narrator celebrating or warning? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11): Hester casts off the letter. Theme link: nature responds to their happiness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Freedom in the forest is beautiful but the narrator doubts it.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1,

RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13): Nature's response. Theme link: nature responds to their happiness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2): Hester's freedom. On characterization: Hester's radical freedom: "The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a flood of sunshine? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “She had wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2): The narrator's qualification. Theme link: nature responds to their happiness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11): Hester casts off the letter. Theme link: nature responds to their happiness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to sin and guilt: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13): Nature's response. Theme link: nature responds to their happiness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the symbolism in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2): Hester's freedom. On symbolism: Hester throws away the letter and lets down her hair; sunshine floods the forest. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine” treats a flood of sunshine with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “She had wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2): The narrator's qualification. Theme link: nature responds to their happiness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11): Hester casts off the letter. Theme link: nature responds to their happiness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a flood of sunshine? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13): Nature's response. Theme link: nature responds to their happiness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “And, as if the gloom of the earth and sky had been but the effluence of these two mortal hearts, it vanished with their sorrow.”, what does “effluence” most nearly mean?
   A. something that flows out
   B. prying and suspicious, like an investigator

C. taking in, as if drinking

D. predict or sense (something) in advance

Key: A (something that flows out)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2: "She had wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral _____"

Key: wilderness

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2: "The _____ of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free"

Key: tendency

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "A partridge, indeed, with a brood of ten behind her, ran forward threateningly, but soon repented of her fierceness, and clucked to her young ones not to be afraid.", what does "clucked" most nearly mean?

A. mockingly

B. belonging to a small, inner circle

C. someone who collects (here, herbs)

D. made the clicking sound a hen makes

Key: D (made the clicking sound a hen makes)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens when she does?

A. A storm begins

B. It rains

C. Sunshine floods the forest

D. Night falls

Key: C (Sunshine floods the forest)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "It was the exhilarating effect—upon a prisoner just escaped from the dungeon of his own heart—of breathing the wild, free atmosphere of an _____, unchristianized, lawless region." Word bank: gladdening, clucked, transmuting, unredeemed

Key: unredeemed

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Dimmesdale decide?

A. To confess

B. To flee

C. To die

D. To stay

Key: B (To flee)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whom does Hester call?

A. Wilson

B. Pearl

C. Chillingworth

D. Mistress Hibbins

Key: B (Pearl)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11: “she undid the clasp that _____ the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves”

    Key: fastened

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Nature's response.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2)

    A. Hester's freedom.

    B. The prison as an image.

    C. Pearl's reply.

    D. Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.

    Key: A (Hester's freedom.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11)

    A. Hester to Pearl: town against forest.

    B. Hester casts off the letter.

    C. Hester's plea.

    D. Hawthorne's definition of romance.

    Key: B (Hester casts off the letter.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13)

    A. Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.

    B. Nature's response.

    C. The opening irony about utopias.

    D. The sexton's unknowing irony.

    Key: B (Nature's response.)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13).

    Sample answer: Nature shows "sympathy" with "these two spirits," yet Hester has "wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness."

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine”? Hester throws away the letter and lets down her hair; sunshine floods the forest.

    A. Simile

B. Imagery

C. Foreshadowing

D. Symbolism

Key: D (Symbolism)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how nature and the individual against society develops from an earlier chapter to “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: nature responds to their happiness.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “And she was gentler here than in the grassy-_____ streets of the settlement, or in her mother’s cottage.” Word bank: clucked, gladdening, transmuting, margined
    Key: margined

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “But Hester Prynne, with a mind of native courage and activity, and for so long a period not merely estranged, but _____, from society, had habituated herself to such latitude of speculation as was altogether foreign to the clergyman.” Word bank: transmuting, clucked, outlawed, gladdening
    Key: outlawed

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “As a man who had once sinned, but who kept his conscience all alive and painfully sensitive by the fretting of an _____ wound, he might have been supposed safer within the line of virtue than if he had never sinned at all.” Word bank: transmuting, gladdening, clucked, unhealed
    Key: unhealed

20. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does nature 'sympathize' with them?
    Sample answer: The forest is outside human law.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine”? "A flood of sunshine" bursts through the trees.

    A. Theme

    B. Simile

    C. Symbolism

    D. Imagery

    Key: D (Imagery)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Nature responds to their happiness.

    A. Hypocrisy and truth

    B. Nature and the individual against society

    C. Sin and guilt

    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: B (Nature and the individual against society)

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13) shape its meaning? Consider

a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Nature's response.

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13: “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never _____ by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits”

    Key: subjugated

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Hester do with her hair?

    A. Lets it down

    B. Cuts it

    C. Covers it

    D. Braids it

    Key: A (Lets it down)

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Hester throw away?

    A. A ring

    B. Her cap only

    C. A Bible

    D. The scarlet letter

    Key: D (The scarlet letter)

27. [short · recall · DOK 1] Where does the letter land?

    Sample answer: On the edge of the brook.

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine”?

    A. The minister's vigil

    B. The child at the brook-side

    C. A flood of sunshine

    D. The interior of a heart

    Key: C (A flood of sunshine)

29. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Hester casts off the letter.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is the narrator celebrating or warning? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view.

31. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “She had wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2)

    A. Pearl's transformation.

    B. The narrator's judgment.

    C. His self-recognition.

    D. The narrator's qualification.

    Key: D (The narrator's qualification.)

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Hester's freedom.
33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Nature shows "sympathy" with "these two spirits," yet Hester has "wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness."
34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Hester casts off the letter.

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 3, 7, 17, 18, 5, 4, 19, 1, 13, 12, 20, 10, 21, 14, 22, 23 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 6, 24, 25, 26, 27, 2, 28, 11, 20, 29, 13, 14, 22, 15, 30, 16 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 17, 24, 9, 2, 19, 12, 10, 13, 31, 11, 15, 14, 22, 21, 16, 30 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 18, 17, 25, 1, 31, 11, 12, 13, 29, 15, 32, 21, 22, 30, 23, 33 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 18, 26, 24, 20, 28, 10, 11, 32, 21, 15, 14, 22, 23, 34, 30, 33 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 3, 18, 25, 11, 10, 29, 31, 32, 22, 15, 21, 14, 23, 30, 16, 34 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 18, 17, 12, 20, 11, 13, 21, 15, 22, 14, 32, 30, 33, 34, 16, 23 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 17, 18, 28, 10, 13, 29, 21, 15, 22, 32, 14, 30, 16, 33, 34, 23 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 24, 18, 28, 20, 11, 13, 32, 21, 22, 14, 15, 33, 30, 23, 16, 34 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 19, 18, 28, 10, 31, 29, 21, 22, 32, 15, 14, 23, 30, 34, 33, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine,” how does Hawthorne show a flood of sunshine? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of a flood of sunshine? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the symbolism in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine develops the idea of a flood of sunshine. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine (where it begins, turns and ends) and its symbolism shape the reader's understanding of a flood of sunshine. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine suggests about a flood of sunshine. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's symbolism and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses symbolism in XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine to complicate the reader's understanding of a flood of sunshine. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of a flood of sunshine responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of a flood of sunshine follows or bends those conventions, using the symbolism as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine and its treatment of a flood of sunshine. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's symbolism and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine as evidence for a larger claim about a flood of sunshine in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of a flood of sunshine. Position your

reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *All at once, as with a sudden smile of heaven, forth burst the sunshine, pouring a very flood into the obscure forest, gladdening each green leaf, transmuting the yellow fallen ones to gold, and gleaming adown the gray trunks of the solemn trees.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "gladdening" most nearly mean?

   A. making glad
   B. not saved from sin
   C. bordered or edged
   D. not yet healed

2. *The decision once made, a glow of strange enjoyment threw its flickering brightness over the trouble of his breast. It was the exhilarating effect—upon a prisoner just escaped from the dungeon of his own heart—of breathing the wild, free atmosphere of an unredeemed, unchristianized, lawless region. His spirit rose, as it were, with a bound, and attained a nearer prospect of the sky, than throughout all the misery which had kept him grovelling on the earth. Of a deeply religious temperament, there was inevitably a tinge of the devotional in his mood.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine"?

   A. The interior of a heart
   B. The minister in a maze
   C. An author answering his critics
   D. A flood of sunshine

**SAT key:** 1. A (making glad); 2. D (A flood of sunshine)

# Lesson 22: XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side

**Focus:** the child at the brook-side

**Objective:** Students will analyze how symbolism develops in “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

**Critical voice:** “Hester was scared only of one result of her sin: Pearl. Pearl, the scarlet letter incarnate.” (D. H. Lawrence, novelist and poet, *Studies in Classic American Literature (1923), Ch. VII, "Nathaniel Hawthorne and 'The Scarlet Letter'", Ch. VII*; public domain). Close reading: why will Pearl not cross the brook until Hester puts the letter back on? *Objective:* Analyze Pearl at the brook-side as the letter made flesh. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3

Teacher only · spoilers

Pearl stops across the brook and will not come. She points at Hester's breast and screams until Hester picks up the letter and fastens it again and hides her hair. Pearl then kisses her and the letter. She asks whether the minister will walk with them into town and washes off his kiss in the brook.

**Background:** Folk belief held that spirits could not cross running water; Dimmesdale wonders whether Pearl is such a spirit.

**Significance:** Pearl demands that the truth be visible.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Why might a child resist a big change in her family? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to public shame and private identity because....*
**Prompt:** Why might a child resist a big change in her family?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to public shame and private identity because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: freakish — unpredictable and odd; accosting — approaching and speaking to (someone); pacifying — calming; encouragingly — in a way that gives hope or confidence; overburdened — carrying too heavy a load. “accosting”: Origin of “accost”: Middle French accoster; earlier Old French acoster (“to stand beside”). “pacifying”: Origin of “pacify”: Middle French pacifier.*
**Words:** freakish: unpredictable and odd · accosting: approaching and speaking to (someone) · pacifying: calming · encouragingly: in a way that gives hope or confidence · overburdened: carrying too heavy a load

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Folk belief held that spirits could not cross running water; Dimmesdale wonders whether Pearl is such a spirit. Pearl demands that the truth be visible. Characterization: Pearl refuses to cross the brook until Hester puts the letter back. Symbolism: The brook as a boundary between Pearl and her mother; Pearl's reflection in the pool. Conflict: Pearl washes off the minister's kiss. Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "wood, they could not have become her better. She is a splendid child! But I know whose brow she has" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 1).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it" slowly and put it in my own words: The discarded letter lies so close to the stream that its gold embroidery is reflected in the water. Next, craft. I notice the reflection doubles the symbol, so throwing it away has not made it disappear. The strongest word is "reflected": the letter is still visible even after Hester throws it off. Then, effect. Why does the letter's reflection in the brook matter? My answer: The letter's reflection in the brook matters because Pearl refuses to come to her mother until Hester puts the letter back on; it shows that the past cannot simply be thrown away.*

> *there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it*
> *(XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it" slowly and put it in my own words: The discarded letter lies so close to the stream that its gold embroidery is reflected in the water. Next, craft. I notice the reflection doubles the symbol, so throwing it away has not made it disappear. The strongest word is "reflected": the letter is still visible even after Hester throws it off. Then, effect. Why does the letter's reflection in the brook matter? My answer: The letter's reflection in the brook matters because Pearl refuses to come to her mother until Hester puts the letter back on; it shows that the past cannot simply be thrown away.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Pearl's question. Look at the craft: The brook as a boundary between Pearl and her mother; Pearl's reflection in the pool. Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity? Expected: The letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. (Pearl's question.)*

> *Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Pearl's question. Look at the craft: The brook as a boundary between Pearl and her mother; Pearl's reflection in the pool.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to public shame and private identity?
**Expected answer:** The letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. (Pearl's question.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for characterization, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the child at the brook-side? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side develops the idea of the child at the brook-side. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Pearl demands that the truth be public. When the text says "Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33), it shows this directly. She refuses to come until Hester restores the letter and asks whether the minister will go "hand in hand, we three together, into the town."*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for characterization, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the child at the brook-side? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side develops the idea of the child at the brook-side. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Pearl demands that the truth be public. When the text says "Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33), it shows this directly. She refuses to come until Hester restores the letter and asks whether the minister will go "hand in hand, we three together, into the town."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Why might a child resist a big change in her family? Ask: why does Pearl reject her mother without the letter?*
**Anchor question:** Why might a child resist a big change in her family?
**Facilitation:** Ask: why does Pearl reject her mother without the letter?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the child at the brook-side? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Pearl demands that the truth be public. ("Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town", XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the child at the brook-side? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Pearl demands that the truth be public. ("Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town", XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes the child at the brook-side. Key takeaway: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Pearl refuses to cross the brook until Hester puts the letter back.
- **Symbolism:** The brook as a boundary between Pearl and her mother; Pearl's reflection in the pool.
- **Conflict:** Pearl washes off the minister's kiss.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **public shame and private identity:** the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "wood, they could not have become her better. She is a splendid child! But I know whose brow she has" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: "the forest-gloom; herself, meanwhile, all glorified with a ray of sunshine, that was attracted thitherward as by a certain sympathy. In the" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 8).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21) The letter at the brook's edge.

- "Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33) Pearl's question.
- "Come thou and take it up" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 23) Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Pearl demands that the truth be public.
**Evidence:** "Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33)
**Reasoning:** She refuses to come until Hester restores the letter and asks whether the minister will go "hand in hand, we three together, into the town."

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **freakish** (adjective) | unpredictable and odd | *But, whether influenced by the jealousy that seems instinctive with every petted child towards a dangerous rival, or from whatever caprice of her freakish nature, Pearl would show no favor to the clergyman.* | |
| **accosting** (verb) | approaching and speaking to (someone) | *"Let her see nothing strange—no passion nor eagerness—in thy way of accosting her," whispered Hester.* | "accosting": Origin of "accost": Middle French accoster; earlier Old French acoster ("to stand beside"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/accost#Etymology) |
| **pacifying** (verb) | calming | *"I pray you," answered the minister, "if thou hast any means of pacifying the child, do it forthwith!* | "pacifying": Origin of "pacify": Middle French pacifier. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/pacify#Etymology) |
| **encouragingly** (adverb) | in a way that gives hope or confidence | *"Come, dearest child!" said Hester, encouragingly, and stretching out both her arms.* | |
| **overburdened** (adjective) | carrying too heavy a load | *And the melancholy brook would add this other tale to the mystery with which its little heart was already overburdened, and whereof it still kept up a murmuring babble, with not a whit more cheerfulness of tone than for ages heretofore.* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **cankered** (adjective) | bitter and corrupted | *Save it were the cankered wrath of an old witch, like Mistress Hibbins," added he, attempting to smile, "I know nothing that I would not sooner encounter than this passion in a child.* | "cankered": Origin: an English formation from canker + -ed. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/cankered#Etymology) |
| **immortally** (adverb) | forever, beyond death | *Be the foregone evil what it might, how could they doubt that their earthly lives and future destinies were conjoined, when they beheld at once the material union, and the spiritual idea, in whom they met, and were to dwell immortally together?* | |
| **reverberated** (verb) | echoed | *She accompanied this wild outbreak with piercing shrieks, which the woods reverberated on all sides; so that, alone as she was in her childish and unreasonable wrath, it seemed as if a hidden multitude were lending her their sympathy and encouragement.* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Why might a child resist a big change in her family?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with sin and guilt?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What does Pearl say after Hester puts the letter back? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Now thou art my mother indeed.
2. Where does Pearl stop? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Across the brook
3. What does Pearl point at? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hester's breast, where the letter was
4. What does Hester do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Puts the letter back on
5. What does Pearl wash off? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The minister's kiss

6. What does Pearl ask about the minister? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Will he walk with them into town
7. Retell the three most important events of "XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Pearl stops across the brook and will not come. She points at Hester's breast and screams until Hester picks up the letter and fastens it again and hides her hair. Pearl then kisses her and the letter. She asks whether the minister will walk with them into town and washes off his kiss in the brook.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "But, whether influenced by the jealousy that seems instinctive with every petted child towards a dangerous rival, or from whatever caprice of her freakish nature, Pearl would show no favor to the clergyman." What does "freakish" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: freakish: unpredictable and odd.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does Pearl reject the minister? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: He will not acknowledge them in public.
2. What does "XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side" suggest about the child at the brook-side? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Pearl demands that the truth be visible.
3. Find one example of symbolism in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
4. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the child at the brook-side? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: "there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21): The letter at the brook's edge. On characterization: Pearl refuses to cross the brook until Hester puts the letter back. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins ""Let her see nothing strange—no passion nor eagerness—in thy way of accosting her,"", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Pearl stops across the brook and will not come. She points at Hester's breast and screams until Hester picks up the letter and fastens it again and hides her hair. Pearl then kisses her and the letter. She asks whether the minister will walk with them into town and washes off his kiss in the brook.

7. How does “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side” build on “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33): Pearl's question. Theme link: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “Come thou and take it up” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 23): Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter. On characterization: Pearl refuses to cross the brook until Hester puts the letter back. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might a child resist a big change in her family?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with sin and guilt? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21): The letter at the brook's edge. On conflict: Pearl washes off the minister's kiss. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Pearl a moral guide in this scene? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33): Pearl's question. Theme link: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Pearl demands that the truth be visible.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “Come thou and take it up” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 23): Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter. Theme link: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21): The letter at the brook's edge. On characterization: Pearl refuses to cross the brook until Hester puts the letter back. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the child at the brook-side? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33): Pearl's question. Theme link: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “Come thou and take it up” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 23): Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter. Theme link: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to public shame and private identity: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21): The letter at the brook's edge. Theme link: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the symbolism in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33): Pearl's question. On symbolism: The brook as a boundary between Pearl and her mother; Pearl's reflection in the pool. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side” treats the child at the brook-side with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “Come thou and take it up” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 23): Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter. Theme link: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “XX: The Minister in a Maze” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21): The letter at the brook's edge. Theme link: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the child at the brook-side? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33): Pearl's question. Theme link: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line ““Let her see nothing strange—no passion nor eagerness—in thy way of accosting her,” whispered Hester.”, what does “accosting” most nearly mean?
   A. taking in, as if drinking
   B. ships that roam the seas
   C. slowly decay into dust
   D. approaching and speaking to (someone)

   Key: D (approaching and speaking to (someone))
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “And the melancholy brook would add this other tale to the mystery with which its little heart was already _____, and whereof it still kept up a murmuring babble, with not a whit more cheerfulness of tone than for ages heretofore.” Word bank:

overburdened, pacifying, freakish, accosting

Key: overburdened

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Pearl ask about the minister?

   A. Will he walk with them into town

   B. Where he lives

   C. Who he is

   D. Is he ill

   Key: A (Will he walk with them into town)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Pearl stop?

   A. By the scaffold

   B. In the town

   C. Across the brook

   D. At the door

   Key: C (Across the brook)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Be the foregone evil what it might, how could they doubt that their earthly lives and future destinies were conjoined, when they beheld at once the material union, and the spiritual idea, in whom they met, and were to dwell _____ together?”

   Word bank: immortally, freakish, pacifying, accosting

   Key: immortally

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “She accompanied this wild outbreak with piercing shrieks, which the woods _____ on all sides; so that, alone as she was in her childish and unreasonable wrath, it seemed as if a hidden multitude were lending her their sympathy and encouragement.” Word bank: accosting, reverberated, pacifying, freakish

   Key: reverberated

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Pearl point at?

   A. The minister's face

   B. The sky

   C. The forest

   D. Hester's breast, where the letter was

   Key: D (Hester's breast, where the letter was)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33: “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three _____, into the town”

   Key: together

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line ““Come, dearest child!” said Hester, encouragingly, and stretching out both her arms.”, what does “encouragingly” most nearly mean?

   A. a complete change of appearance

   B. inflicted (revenge or harm)

   C. setting aside; declining to pursue

   D. in a way that gives hope or confidence

   Key: D (in a way that gives hope or confidence)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33)
    A. Hester's refusal.
    B. Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.
    C. The harshest woman in the crowd.
    D. Pearl's question.

    Key: D (Pearl's question.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Come thou and take it up” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 23)
    A. Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter.
    B. The opening irony about utopias.
    C. The sexton's unknowing irony.
    D. Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.

    Key: A (Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21)
    A. Pearl on the sunshine.
    B. Dimmesdale's verdict.
    C. The letter at the brook's edge.
    D. The townspeople's suspicion.

    Key: C (The letter at the brook's edge.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Pearl reject the minister?

    Sample answer: He will not acknowledge them in public.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side”? Pearl refuses to cross the brook until Hester puts the letter back.
    A. Structure
    B. Characterization
    C. Setting
    D. Plot

    Key: B (Characterization)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side”? The brook as a boundary between Pearl and her mother; Pearl's reflection in the pool.
    A. Metaphor
    B. Personification
    C. Symbolism
    D. Conflict

    Key: C (Symbolism)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from an earlier chapter to “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child.
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line ““I pray you,” answered the minister, “if thou hast any means of pacifying the child, do it forthwith!”, what does “pacifying” most nearly mean?
    A. calming
    B. (trundle-bed) a low bed on wheels kept under another bed
    C. in a way that cannot be held back
    D. iron parts or fittings

    Key: A (calming)
18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21: “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold _____ was reflected in it”
    Key: embroidery
19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Pearl wash off?
    A. Blood
    B. Mud
    C. Her mother's tears
    D. The minister's kiss

    Key: D (The minister's kiss)
20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side”?
    A. The recognition
    B. The child at the brook-side
    C. The pastor and his parishioner
    D. The interview in prison

    Key: B (The child at the brook-side)
21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The letter at the brook's edge.
22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Come thou and take it up” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 23). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter.
23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child.
    A. Hypocrisy and truth
    B. Sin and guilt
    C. Nature and the individual against society
    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: D (Public shame and private identity)

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The letter at the brook's edge.

25. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Pearl's question.

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33).
    Sample answer: She refuses to come until Hester restores the letter and asks whether the minister will go "hand in hand, we three together, into the town."

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Pearl's question.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Hester do?
    A. Leaves Pearl
    B. Throws the letter in
    C. Puts the letter back on
    D. Carries her across
    Key: C (Puts the letter back on)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Pearl a moral guide in this scene? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: "Pearl demands that the truth be public." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: She refuses to come until Hester restores the letter and asks whether the minister will go "hand in hand, we three together, into the town."

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Save it were the _____ wrath of an old witch, like Mistress Hibbins," added he, attempting to smile, "I know nothing that I would not sooner encounter than this passion in a child." Word bank: freakish, accosting, cankered, pacifying
    Key: cankered

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 7, 17, 9, 18, 19, 4, 2, 3, 20, 13, 21, 12, 22, 14, 23, 24 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 7, 4, 6, 18, 8, 1, 13, 12, 11, 25, 20, 15, 14, 26, 27, 24 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 2, 3, 7, 6, 28, 25, 11, 10, 20, 21, 26, 22, 14, 15, 16, 24 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| HS Senior | 2, 7, 19, 8, 21, 25, 20, 10, 11, 15, 26, 14, 22, 16, 24, 27 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 6, 3, 5, 25, 12, 21, 13, 14, 22, 26, 23, 15, 29, 24, 30, 16 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 2, 1, 8, 20, 21, 12, 25, 15, 14, 26, 22, 23, 30, 27, 24, 29 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 2, 31, 25, 12, 21, 20, 14, 22, 23, 15, 26, 27, 16, 29, 30, 24 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 2, 31, 13, 12, 21, 10, 22, 15, 26, 14, 23, 27, 16, 24, 30, 29 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 31, 2, 25, 10, 11, 20, 23, 15, 14, 26, 22, 24, 27, 30, 29, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 2, 31, 25, 20, 12, 11, 22, 15, 26, 23, 14, 29, 27, 30, 24, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side," how does Hawthorne show the child at the brook-side? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the child at the brook-side? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the symbolism in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side develops the idea of the child at the brook-side. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side (where it begins, turns and ends) and its symbolism shape the reader's understanding of the child at the brook-side. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side suggests about the child at the brook-side. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's symbolism and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses symbolism in XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side to complicate the reader's

understanding of the child at the brook-side. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the child at the brook-side responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the child at the brook-side follows or bends those conventions, using the symbolism as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side and its treatment of the child at the brook-side. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's symbolism and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side as evidence for a larger claim about the child at the brook-side in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the child at the brook-side. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *“I pray you,” answered the minister, “if thou hast any means of pacifying the child, do it forthwith!*

   As used in the text, what does the word “pacifying” most nearly mean?

   A. bitter and corrupted

   B. forever, beyond death

   C. echoed

   D. calming

2. *“Let her see nothing strange—no passion nor eagerness—in thy way of accosting her,” whispered Hester. “Our Pearl is a fitful and fantastic little elf, sometimes. Especially, she is seldom tolerant of emotion, when she does not fully comprehend the why and wherefore. But the child hath strong affections! She loves me, and will love thee!”*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side”?

   A. The elf-child and the minister

   B. The procession

   C. The pastor and his parishioner

D. The child at the brook-side

**SAT key:** 1. D (calming); 2. D (The child at the brook-side)

# Lesson 23: XX: The Minister in a Maze

**Focus:** the minister in a maze

**Objective:** Students will analyze how characterization develops in "XX: The Minister in a Maze" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

**Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)):** This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…lf this freak, as unworthy of his cloth, he met a drunken seaman, one of the ship's crew from the…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
**Student preview:** This section mentions drinking or a drug.
**Suggested language:** "What does this detail add to the scene?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Walking home, Dimmesdale feels transformed and tempted to wicked acts: to argue blasphemy with a deacon, shock an old widow, corrupt a young maiden, teach children bad words and swear with a sailor. Mistress Hibbins hints that he has met the devil. He refuses Chillingworth's medicine, burns his sermon and writes a new Election Sermon all night.

**Background:** The Election Sermon was a major annual sermon preached when a new governor took office.

**Significance:** Planned hypocrisy loosens all his restraint.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*What happens when someone decides to break a big rule? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to hypocrisy and truth because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.*
**Prompt:** What happens when someone decides to break a big rule?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to hypocrisy and truth because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the double face.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: tapestried — hung with tapestries; irresponsibility — lack of accountability to anyone; underbrush — shrubs and small plants under forest trees; comport — fit together; agree; importunately — insistently, in a troubling way. “tapestried”: Origin: an English formation from tapestry + -ed. “irresponsibility”: Origin: an English formation from ir- + responsibility. “comport”: Origin: Old French comporter; earlier Latin comportare (“to bring together”).*
**Words:** tapestried: hung with tapestries · irresponsibility: lack of accountability to anyone · underbrush: shrubs and small plants under forest trees · comport: fit together; agree · importunately: insistently, in a troubling way

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*The Election Sermon was a major annual sermon preached when a new governor took office. Planned hypocrisy loosens all his restraint. Characterization: Returning to town, Dimmesdale is tempted to blasphemy, to corrupt a young maiden and to curse. Irony: He feels a new energy and writes the Election Sermon with fervor. Theme: "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true." Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “in advance of Hester Prynne and little Pearl, he threw a backward glance; half expecting that he should discover only some faintly” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 1).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as..." slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator says no one can show one face to himself and another to the crowd for long without becoming confused about which is true. Next, craft. I notice the general, proverb-like statement, which applies to Dimmesdale without naming him. The strongest word is "bewildered": it means confused and lost, the state of a man who has lived a lie too long. Then, effect. What warning does the narrator give about double lives? My answer: The narrator warns that no one can wear one face to himself and another to the crowd without losing track of which is true; Dimmesdale's double life is destroying his sense of who he is.*

> *No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as…" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator says no one can show one face to himself and another to the crowd for long without becoming confused about which is true. Next, craft. I notice the general, proverb-like statement, which applies to Dimmesdale without naming him. The strongest word is "bewildered": it means confused and lost, the state of a man who has lived a lie too long. Then, effect. What warning does the narrator give about double lives? My answer: The narrator warns that no one can wear one face to himself and another to the crowd without losing track of which is true; Dimmesdale's double life is destroying his sense of who he is.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. Look at the craft: He feels a new energy and writes the Election Sermon with fervor. Ask: How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth? Expected: The double face. (Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.)*

> *Did I make a contract with him in the forest (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. Look at the craft: He feels a new energy and writes the Election Sermon with fervor.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth?
**Expected answer:** The double face. (Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the chapter for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the minister in a maze? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XX: The Minister in a Maze develops the idea of the minister in a maze. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. When the text says “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10), it shows this directly. He wonders whether he made "a contract with him in the forest," and the narrator warns that no man can "wear one face to himself and another to the multitude" without losing the true one.*

**Task:** Annotate the chapter for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the minister in a maze? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XX: The Minister in a Maze develops the idea of the minister in a maze. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. When the text says “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10), it shows this directly. He wonders whether he made "a contract with him in the forest," and the narrator warns that no man can "wear one face to himself and another to the multitude" without losing the true one.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: What happens when someone decides to break a big rule? Ask: what are Dimmesdale's temptations on the way home, and why does Hawthorne make them almost comic?*

**Anchor question:** What happens when someone decides to break a big rule?

**Facilitation:** Ask: what are Dimmesdale's temptations on the way home, and why does Hawthorne make them almost comic?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the minister in a maze? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. (“Did I make a contract with him in the forest”, XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*

**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the minister in a maze? Support it with one short quotation.

**Answer:** Model answer: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. (“Did I make a contract with him in the forest”, XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the minister in a maze. Key takeaway: the double face.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Returning to town, Dimmesdale is tempted to blasphemy, to corrupt a young maiden and to curse.
- **Irony:** He feels a new energy and writes the Election Sermon with fervor.
- **Theme:** "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true."

**Themes and how they develop**

- **hypocrisy and truth:** the double face.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “in advance of Hester Prynne and little Pearl, he threw a backward glance; half expecting that he should discover only some faintly” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: “hope, that was to assume brighter substance as life grew dark around her, and which would gild the utter gloom with final” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 8).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3) The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy.
- “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10) Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.
- “Have I then sold myself … to the fiend” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16) Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints.
**Evidence:** “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10)

**Reasoning:** He wonders whether he made "a contract with him in the forest," and the narrator warns that no man can "wear one face to himself and another to the multitude" without losing the true one.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **tapestried** (adjective) | hung with tapestries | *He entered the accustomed room, and looked around him on its books, its windows, its fireplace, and the tapestried comfort of the walls, with the same perception of strangeness that had haunted him throughout his walk from the forest-dell into the town, and thitherward.* | “tapestried”: Origin: an English formation from tapestry + -ed. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/tapestried#Etymology) |
| **irresponsibility** (noun) | lack of accountability to anyone | *In furtherance of this choice, it so happened that a ship lay in the harbor; one of those questionable cruisers, frequent at that day, which, without being absolutely outlaws of the deep, yet roamed over its surface with a remarkable irresponsibility of character.* | “irresponsibility”: Origin: an English formation from ir- + responsibility. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/irresponsibility#Etymology) |
| **underbrush** (noun) | shrubs and small plants under forest trees | *But he leaped across the plashy places, thrust himself through the clinging underbrush, climbed the ascent, plunged into the hollow, and overcame, in short, all the difficulties of the track, with an unweariable activity that astonished him.* | |
| **comport** (verb) | fit together; agree | *Never was there a more beautiful example of how the majesty of age and wisdom may comport with the obeisance and respect enjoined upon it, as from a lower social rank, and inferior order of endowment, towards a higher.* | “comport”: Origin: Old French comporter; earlier Latin comportare (“to bring together”). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/comport#Etymology) |
| **importunately** (adverb) | insistently, in a troubling way | *Not the less, however, came this importunately obtrusive sense of change.* | |
| **cruisers** (noun) | ships that roam the seas | *In furtherance of this choice, it so happened that a ship lay in the harbor; one of those questionable cruisers, frequent at that day, which, without being absolutely outlaws of* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | *the deep, yet roamed over its surface with a remarkable irresponsibility of character.* | |
| **indistinctness** (noun) | lack of clarity; blurriness | *In order to free his mind from this indistinctness and duplicity of impression, which vexed it with a strange disquietude, he recalled and more thoroughly defined the plans which Hester and himself had sketched for their departure.* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. What happens when someone decides to break a big rule?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with public shame and private identity?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. When is the ship due to sail? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: On the fourth day, after the Election Sermon.
2. How does Dimmesdale feel on the way home? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Transformed and tempted
3. Whom does he want to shock? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A deacon, a widow and a young maiden
4. Who hints he met the devil? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Mistress Hibbins
5. What does he refuse? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Chillingworth's medicine
6. What does he write? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A new Election Sermon
7. Retell the three most important events of "XX: The Minister in a Maze" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Walking home, Dimmesdale feels transformed and tempted to wicked acts: to argue blasphemy with a deacon, shock an old widow, corrupt a young maiden, teach children bad words and swear with a sailor. Mistress Hibbins hints that he has met the devil. He refuses Chillingworth's medicine, burns his sermon and writes a new Election Sermon all night.

8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “XX: The Minister in a Maze”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “XX: The Minister in a Maze” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: “He entered the accustomed room, and looked around him on its books, its windows, its fireplace, and the tapestried comfort of the walls, with the same perception of strangeness that had haunted him throughout his walk…” What does “tapestried” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: tapestried: hung with tapestries.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why is Dimmesdale glad the ship sails after the sermon? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He can preach and leave with his reputation intact.
2. What does “XX: The Minister in a Maze” suggest about the minister in a maze? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Planned hypocrisy loosens all his restraint.
3. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the irony in this chapter shape what we understand about the minister in a maze? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3): The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. On irony: He feels a new energy and writes the Election Sermon with fervor. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “As the minister departed, in advance of Hester Prynne and little Pearl, he threw a backward glance; half expecting that he should discover only some faintly traced features or…”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “XX: The Minister in a Maze”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Walking home, Dimmesdale feels transformed and tempted to wicked acts: to argue blasphemy with a deacon, shock an old widow, corrupt a young maiden, teach children bad words and swear with a sailor. Mistress Hibbins hints that he has met the devil. He refuses Chillingworth's medicine, burns his…
7. How does “XX: The Minister in a Maze” build on “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze,

paragraph 10): Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. Theme link: the double face. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “Have I then sold myself … to the fiend” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16): Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins. On characterization: Returning to town, Dimmesdale is tempted to blasphemy, to corrupt a young maiden and to curse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “What happens when someone decides to break a big rule?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with public shame and private identity? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3): The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. On theme: "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Can anyone wear two faces without losing the true one? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10): Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. On theme: "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Planned hypocrisy loosens all his restraint.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “Have I then sold myself … to the fiend” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16): Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins. On theme: "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3): The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. On characterization: Returning to town, Dimmesdale is tempted to blasphemy, to corrupt a young maiden and to curse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “XX: The Minister in a Maze” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the minister in a maze? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10): Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. Theme link: the double face. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “XX: The Minister in a Maze”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “Have I then sold myself … to the fiend” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16): Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins. On theme: "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to hypocrisy and truth: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3): The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. On theme: "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10): Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. On characterization: Returning to town, Dimmesdale is

tempted to blasphemy, to corrupt a young maiden and to curse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XX: The Minister in a Maze” treats the minister in a maze with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “Have I then sold myself … to the fiend” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16): Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins. On theme: "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “XXI: The New England Holiday” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3): The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. Theme link: the double face. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the minister in a maze? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10): Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. On theme: "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Not the less, however, came this _____ obtrusive sense of change.” Word bank: importunately, tapestried, irresponsibility, underbrush
   Key: importunately
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16: “Have I then sold _____ … to the fiend”
   Key: myself

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10: "Did I make a _____ with him in the forest"

   Key: contract

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who hints he met the devil?

   A. Wilson

   B. Pearl

   C. Mistress Hibbins

   D. Chillingworth

   Key: C (Mistress Hibbins)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "In furtherance of this choice, it so happened that a ship lay in the harbor; one of those questionable cruisers, frequent at that day, which, without being absolutely outlaws of the deep, yet roamed over its surface…", what does "irresponsibility" most nearly mean?

   A. reasoned about life in a thoughtful, abstract way

   B. lack of accountability to anyone

   C. not yet healed

   D. prying and suspicious, like an investigator

   Key: B (lack of accountability to anyone)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whom does he want to shock?

   A. Hester

   B. Pearl

   C. A deacon, a widow and a young maiden

   D. The governor

   Key: C (A deacon, a widow and a young maiden)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3: "No man, for any _____ period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true"

   Key: considerable

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "In order to free his mind from this _____ and duplicity of impression, which vexed it with a strange disquietude, he recalled and more thoroughly defined the plans which Hester and himself had sketched for their departure." Word bank: tapestried, underbrush, indistinctness, irresponsibility

   Key: indistinctness

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does he write?

   A. A new Election Sermon

   B. A confession

   C. A letter to Hester

   D. A will

   Key: A (A new Election Sermon)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why is Dimmesdale glad the ship sails after the sermon?

    Sample answer: He can preach and leave with his reputation intact.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10)

    A. First description of the letter.

    B. The opening, with its ironic self-presentation.

    C. Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.

    D. Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.

    Key: D (Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The double face.

    A. Nature and the individual against society

    B. Sin and guilt

    C. Public shame and private identity

    D. Hypocrisy and truth

    Key: D (Hypocrisy and truth)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XX: The Minister in a Maze”? He feels a new energy and writes the Election Sermon with fervor.

    A. Tone / mood

    B. Structure

    C. Characterization

    D. Irony

    Key: D (Irony)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Can anyone wear two faces without losing the true one? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “In furtherance of this choice, it so happened that a ship lay in the harbor; one of those questionable _____, frequent at that day, which, without being absolutely outlaws of the deep, yet roamed over its surface with a remarkable irresponsibility of…” Word bank: cruisers, underbrush, irresponsibility, tapestried

    Key: cruisers

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does he refuse?

    A. Sleep

    B. Chillingworth's medicine

    C. Food

    D. The sermon

Key: B (Chillingworth's medicine)

19. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “XX: The Minister in a Maze”?

    A. The frame narrative and the found letter

    B. The pastor and his parishioner

    C. The minister in a maze

    D. Conclusion

    Key: C (The minister in a maze)

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3)

    A. Hester's admission.

    B. Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.

    C. Pearl's question.

    D. The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy.

    Key: D (The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy.)

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XX: The Minister in a Maze”? Returning to town, Dimmesdale is tempted to blasphemy, to corrupt a young maiden and to curse.

    A. Hyperbole

    B. Plot

    C. Characterization

    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: C (Characterization)

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10).

    Sample answer: He wonders whether he made "a contract with him in the forest," and the narrator warns that no man can "wear one face to himself and another to the multitude" without losing the true one.

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: He wonders whether he made "a contract with him in the forest," and the narrator warns that no man can "wear one face to himself and another to the multitude" without losing the true one.

24. [short · recall · DOK 1] When is the ship due to sail?

    Sample answer: On the fourth day, after the Election Sermon.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “He entered the accustomed room, and looked around him on its books, its windows, its fireplace, and the tapestried comfort of the walls, with the same perception of strangeness that had haunted him throughout his walk…”, what does “tapestried” most nearly mean?

    A. the act of committing (a crime)

    B. denies having (a motive or intention)

    C. hung with tapestries

    D. having a face of a certain kind

Key: C (hung with tapestries)

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Have I then sold myself … to the fiend” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16)

    A. The letter isolates Hester.

    B. Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.

    C. Dimmesdale's telltale gesture.

    D. The cost of falseness.

    Key: B (Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Have I then sold myself … to the fiend” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how hypocrisy and truth develops from an earlier chapter to “XX: The Minister in a Maze”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: the double face.

31. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Dimmesdale feel on the way home?

    A. Transformed and tempted

    B. Sick and weak

    C. Bored

    D. Calm

    Key: A (Transformed and tempted)

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 17, 9, 5, 8, 4, 18, 3, 7, 12, 19, 20, 10, 14, 21, 22, 23 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 17, 24, 4, 1, 6, 25, 26, 20, 19, 11, 10, 27, 14, 21, 28, 29 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 8, 5, 7, 24, 6, 12, 20, 19, 11, 10, 21, 14, 22, 15, 29, 23 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 1, 24, 5, 3, 13, 10, 26, 20, 12, 21, 27, 22, 15, 28, 29, 30 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 1, 17, 9, 19, 12, 26, 13, 27, 21, 15, 14, 22, 28, 29, 23, 16 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 1, 31, 8, 20, 19, 26, 12, 21, 22, 27, 15, 14, 16, 23, 30, 29 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 1, 3, 19, 11, 20, 13, 27, 15, 22, 21, 14, 23, 29, 30, 16, 28 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| College Junior | 1, 17, 10, 20, 12, 11, 22, 15, 21, 27, 14, 29, 28, 23, 30, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 1, 17, 19, 13, 12, 26, 14, 21, 15, 27, 22, 28, 23, 16, 29, 30 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 1, 17, 12, 11, 19, 26, 27, 21, 22, 14, 15, 28, 30, 16, 23, 29 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "XX: The Minister in a Maze," how does Hawthorne show the minister in a maze? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XX: The Minister in a Maze, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the minister in a maze? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XX: The Minister in a Maze develops the idea of the minister in a maze. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XX: The Minister in a Maze (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the minister in a maze. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XX: The Minister in a Maze suggests about the minister in a maze. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses characterization in XX: The Minister in a Maze to complicate the reader's understanding of the minister in a maze. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XX: The Minister in a Maze within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the minister in a maze responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XX: The Minister in a Maze alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the minister in a maze follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XX: The Minister in a Maze and its treatment of the minister in a maze. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XX: The Minister in a Maze as evidence for a larger claim about the minister in a maze in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XX: The Minister in a Maze as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the minister in a maze. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *But he leaped across the plashy places, thrust himself through the clinging underbrush, climbed the ascent, plunged into the hollow, and overcame, in short, all the difficulties of the track, with an unweariable activity that astonished him.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “underbrush” most nearly mean?

   A. ships that roam the seas

   B. lack of clarity; blurriness

   C. insistently, in a troubling way

   D. shrubs and small plants under forest trees

2. *As the minister departed, in advance of Hester Prynne and little Pearl, he threw a backward glance; half expecting that he should discover only some faintly traced features or outline of the mother and the child, slowly fading into the twilight of the woods. So great a vicissitude in his life could not at once be received as real. But there was Hester, clad in her gray robe, still standing beside the tree-trunk, which some blast had overthrown a long antiquity ago, and which time had ever since been covering with moss, so that these two fated ones, with earth’s heaviest burden on them, might there sit down together, and find a single hour’s rest and solace. And there was Pearl, too, lightly dancing from the margin of the brook—now that the intrusive third person was gone—and taking her old place by her mother’s side. So the minister had not fallen asleep and dreamed!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “XX: The Minister in a Maze”?

   A. Another view of Hester

   B. The minister in a maze

   C. Hester on the scaffold

   D. The frame narrative and the found letter

**SAT key:** 1. D (shrubs and small plants under forest trees); 2. B (The minister in a maze)

# Lesson 24: XXI: The New England Holiday

**Focus:** the New England holiday

**Objective:** Students will analyze how setting develops in "XXI: The New England Holiday" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

**Content note (period depictions of Native people, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)):** The holiday crowd includes Native people described as 'savage' in period language. Name the language and discuss whose point of view it reflects. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…s of womanhood had been perpetually flavored? The wine of life, henceforth to be presented to…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
**Student preview:** The narrator describes Native people in outdated, prejudiced language.
**Suggested language:** "How does the narrator's language reflect his time?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Election Day brings a festive crowd: Native people, sailors and townsfolk. Hester's face is calm, as if this were the last day of her ordeal. The ship's captain tells her that Chillingworth has booked passage on the same ship. Chillingworth smiles at her across the square.

**Background:** Election Day was one of the few public holidays Puritans allowed; Hawthorne notes they were still English in their pleasures.

**Significance:** Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*How do celebrations show what a community values? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to public shame and private identity because.... Content note before we start: The narrator describes Native people in outdated, prejudiced language.*
**Prompt:** How do celebrations show what a community values?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to public shame and private identity because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: bondslave — a slave; one bound to serve; desperadoes — bold, reckless lawbreakers; galliard — lively and bold; jocularity — joking; fun; inquietude — restlessness; uneasiness. "bondslave": Origin: an English formation from bond + slave.*
**Words:** bondslave: a slave; one bound to serve · desperadoes: bold, reckless lawbreakers · galliard: lively and bold · jocularity: joking; fun · inquietude: restlessness; uneasiness

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Election Day was one of the few public holidays Puritans allowed; Hawthorne notes they were still English in their pleasures. Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Setting: Election Day: a holiday crowd, sailors, Indians and townspeople in the marketplace. Irony: Hester learns that Chillingworth has taken passage on the same ship. Characterization: Hester's face is like a mask; she expects to be free soon. Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "other occasions, for seven years past, Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth. Not more by its hue than" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth" slowly and put it in my own words: On the public holiday, Hester wears the same coarse gray garment she has worn for seven years. Next, craft. I notice the contrast between a festive day and her unchanging dull dress. The strongest word is "coarse": it shows the rough, humble clothing she has accepted as part of her penance. Then, effect. Why does the narrator stress Hester's plain gray clothes at the holiday? My answer: The narrator stresses Hester's plain gray clothes at the holiday because they make her almost invisible while the letter still stands out; secretly she is planning to escape, so her calm look hides a great change.*

> *Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth" slowly and put it in my own words: On the public holiday, Hester wears the same coarse gray garment she has worn for seven years. Next, craft. I notice the contrast between a festive day and her unchanging dull dress. The strongest word is "coarse": it shows the rough, humble clothing she has accepted as part of her penance. Then, effect. Why does the narrator stress Hester's plain gray clothes at the holiday? My answer: The narrator stresses Hester's plain gray clothes at the holiday because they make her almost invisible while the letter still stands out; secretly she is planning to escape, so her calm look hides a great change.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Chillingworth's smile across the square shows he still controls their fate. Expected link: irony; sin and guilt. Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity? Expected: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. (The shipmaster's news.)*

> *that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Chillingworth's smile across the square shows he still controls their fate. Expected link: irony; sin and guilt.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to public shame and private identity?
**Expected answer:** Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. (The shipmaster's news.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for setting, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the New England holiday? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XXI: The New England Holiday develops the idea of the New England holiday. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. When the text says "that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24), it shows this directly. The shipmaster reveals that "Chillingworth, he calls himself" will sail with them, and Hester sees him "smiling on her" across the square.*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for setting, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the New England holiday? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XXI: The New England Holiday develops the idea of the New England holiday. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. When the text says "that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24), it shows this directly. The shipmaster reveals that "Chillingworth, he calls himself" will sail with them, and Hester sees him "smiling on her" across the square.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: How do celebrations show what a community values? Ask: what does the holiday tell us about Puritan society?*
**Anchor question:** How do celebrations show what a community values?
**Facilitation:** Ask: what does the holiday tell us about Puritan society?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the New England holiday? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. (“that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you”, XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the New England holiday? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. (“that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you”, XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how setting shapes the New England holiday. Key takeaway: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Setting:** Election Day: a holiday crowd, sailors, Indians and townspeople in the marketplace.
- **Irony:** Hester learns that Chillingworth has taken passage on the same ship.
- **Characterization:** Hester's face is like a mask; she expects to be free soon.

### Themes and how they develop

- **public shame and private identity:** Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks.

### Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “other occasions, for seven years past, Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth. Not more by its hue than” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: “the child, as if speaking partly to herself. “In the dark nighttime he calls us to him, and holds thy hand and” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 12).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2) Hester's appearance on the holiday.
- “that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24) The shipmaster's news.
- “she beheld old Roger Chillingworth himself, standing in the remotest corner of the marketplace, and smiling on her” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 26) Chillingworth's smile.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan.
**Evidence:** “that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24)
**Reasoning:** The shipmaster reveals that "Chillingworth, he calls himself" will sail with them, and Hester sees him "smiling on her" across the square.

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **bondslave** (noun) | a slave; one bound to serve | *“Look your last on the scarlet letter and its wearer!”—the people’s victim and lifelong bondslave, as they fancied her, might say to them.* | “bondslave”: Origin: an English formation from bond + slave. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/bondslave#Etymology) |
| **desperadoes** (noun) | bold, reckless lawbreakers | *They were rough-looking desperadoes, with sun-blackened faces, and an immensity of beard; their wide, short trousers were confined about the waist by belts, often clasped with a rough plate of gold, and sustaining always a long knife, and, in some instances, a sword.* | |
| **galliard** (adjective) | lively and bold | *A landsman could hardly have worn this garb and shown this face, and worn and shown them both with such a galliard air, without undergoing stern question before a magistrate, and probably incurring fine or imprisonment, or perhaps an exhibition in the stocks.* | |
| **jocularity** (noun) | joking; fun | *All such professors of the several branches of jocularity would have been sternly repressed, not only by the rigid discipline of law, but by the general sentiment which gives law its vitality.* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **inquietude** (noun) | restlessness; uneasiness | *On this eventful day, moreover, there was a certain singular inquietude and excitement in her mood, resembling nothing so much as the shimmer of a diamond, that sparkles and flashes with the varied throbbings of the breast on which it is displayed.* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. How do celebrations show what a community values?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with hypocrisy and truth?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

**Literal / recall**

1. How is Pearl dressed? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In bright, airy finery.
2. What day is it? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Election Day
3. What does Hester feel? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That her ordeal will soon be over
4. Who has booked passage? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Chillingworth
5. Who tells Hester? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The ship's captain
6. What groups are in the crowd? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Native people, sailors and townspeople
7. Retell the three most important events of "XXI: The New England Holiday" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Election Day brings a festive crowd: Native people, sailors and townsfolk. Hester's face is calm, as if this were the last day of her ordeal. The ship's captain tells her that Chillingworth has booked passage on the same ship. Chillingworth smiles at her across the square.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XXI: The New England Holiday"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XXI: The New England Holiday" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: ""Look your last on the scarlet letter and its wearer!"—the people's victim and lifelong bondslave, as they fancied her, might say to them." What does "bondslave" mean here, and what is literally happening

in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: bondslave: a slave; one bound to serve.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Chillingworth smile? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He has blocked their escape.
2. What does "XXI: The New England Holiday" suggest about the New England holiday? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan.
3. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the irony in this chapter shape what we understand about the New England holiday? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2): Hester's appearance on the holiday. On irony: Hester learns that Chillingworth has taken passage on the same ship. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Betimes in the morning of the day on which the new Governor was to receive his office at the hands of the people, Hester Prynne and little Pearl came into the marketplace.", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "XXI: The New England Holiday", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Election Day brings a festive crowd: Native people, sailors and townsfolk. Hester's face is calm, as if this were the last day of her ordeal. The ship's captain tells her that Chillingworth has booked passage on the same ship. Chillingworth smiles at her across the square.
7. How does "XXI: The New England Holiday" build on "XX: The Minister in a Maze"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24): The shipmaster's news. Theme link: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "she beheld old Roger Chillingworth himself, standing in the remotest corner of the marketplace, and smiling on her" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 26): Chillingworth's smile.

On characterization: Hester's face is like a mask; she expects to be free soon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: "How do celebrations show what a community values?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with hypocrisy and truth? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2): Hester's appearance on the holiday. On characterization: Hester's face is like a mask; she expects to be free soon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. What does the holiday reveal about Puritan society? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24): The shipmaster's news. Theme link: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "she beheld old Roger Chillingworth himself, standing in the remotest corner of the marketplace, and smiling on her" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 26): Chillingworth's smile. Theme link: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2): Hester's appearance on the holiday. On characterization: Hester's face is like a mask; she expects to be free soon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Rewrite one moment of "XXI: The New England Holiday" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the New England holiday? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare

with you" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24): The shipmaster's news. Theme link: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "XXI: The New England Holiday": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "she beheld old Roger Chillingworth himself, standing in the remotest corner of the marketplace, and smiling on her" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 26): Chillingworth's smile. Theme link: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to nature and the individual against society: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2): Hester's appearance on the holiday. Theme link: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24): The shipmaster's news. On setting: Election Day: a holiday crowd, sailors, Indians and townspeople in the marketplace. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "XXI: The New England Holiday" treats the New England holiday with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "she beheld old Roger Chillingworth himself, standing in the remotest corner of the marketplace, and smiling on her" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 26): Chillingworth's smile. Theme link: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "XXII: The Procession" will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2): Hester's appearance on the holiday. Theme link: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the New England holiday? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: “that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24): The shipmaster's news. Theme link: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who has booked passage?
    A. Bellingham
    B. Chillingworth
    C. Wilson
    D. Pearl alone

    Key: B (Chillingworth)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “They were rough-looking desperadoes, with sun-blackened faces, and an immensity of beard; their wide, short trousers were confined about the waist by belts, often clasped with a rough plate of gold, and sustaining…”, what does “desperadoes” most nearly mean?
    A. bold, reckless lawbreakers
    B. never having happened before
    C. dressing in fine clothes
    D. unpredictable and odd

    Key: A (bold, reckless lawbreakers)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Hester feel?
    A. Afraid
    B. That her ordeal will soon be over
    C. Joyful
    D. Bored

    Key: B (That her ordeal will soon be over)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who tells Hester?
    A. The ship's captain
    B. Dimmesdale
    C. Pearl

D. Mistress Hibbins

Key: A (The ship's captain)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2: “Hester was clad in a _____ of coarse gray cloth”

   Key: garment

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 26: “she beheld old Roger _____ himself, standing in the remotest corner of the marketplace, and smiling on her”

   Key: Chillingworth

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “All such professors of the several branches of jocularity would have been sternly repressed, not only by the rigid discipline of law, but by the general sentiment which gives law its vitality.”, what does “jocularity” most nearly mean?

   A. joking; fun

   B. insistently, in a troubling way

   C. proof or confirmation

   D. being a sign of

   Key: A (joking; fun)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24: “that this physician here—_____, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you”

   Key: Chillingworth

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What day is it?

   A. The Sabbath

   B. Election Day

   C. Thanksgiving

   D. Christmas

   Key: B (Election Day)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2)

    A. Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.

    B. The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse."

    C. Hester's appearance on the holiday.

    D. The harshest woman in the crowd.

    Key: C (Hester's appearance on the holiday.)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Hester's appearance on the holiday.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “XXI: The New England Holiday”?

    A. Pearl

    B. The New England holiday

    C. An author answering his critics

    D. The procession

Key: B (The New England holiday)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24)

    A. His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.

    B. Pearl's dress.

    C. The shipmaster's news.

    D. Pearl's question.

    Key: C (The shipmaster's news.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks.

    A. Hypocrisy and truth

    B. Sin and guilt

    C. Nature and the individual against society

    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: D (Public shame and private identity)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XXI: The New England Holiday”? Hester learns that Chillingworth has taken passage on the same ship.

    A. Irony

    B. Metaphor

    C. Conflict

    D. Plot

    Key: A (Irony)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from an earlier chapter to “XXI: The New England Holiday”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “A landsman could hardly have worn this garb and shown this face, and worn and shown them both with such a galliard air, without undergoing stern question before a magistrate, and probably incurring fine or imprisonment,…”, what does “galliard” most nearly mean?

    A. carrying too heavy a load

    B. lively and bold

    C. without proper respect

    D. marked out as shameful

    Key: B (lively and bold)

18. [short · recall · DOK 1] How is Pearl dressed?

    Sample answer: In bright, airy finery.

19. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Chillingworth smile?

    Sample answer: He has blocked their escape.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24)

Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The shipmaster's news.

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “she beheld old Roger Chillingworth himself, standing in the remotest corner of the marketplace, and smiling on her” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 26)

    A. Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.

    B. The prison as an image.

    C. The letter's mysterious power.

    D. Chillingworth's smile.

    Key: D (Chillingworth's smile.)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XXI: The New England Holiday”? Election Day: a holiday crowd, sailors, Indians and townspeople in the marketplace.

    A. Setting

    B. Theme

    C. Metaphor

    D. Irony

    Key: A (Setting)

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The shipmaster reveals that "Chillingworth, he calls himself" will sail with them, and Hester sees him "smiling on her" across the square.

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “On this eventful day, moreover, there was a certain singular _____ and excitement in her mood, resembling nothing so much as the shimmer of a diamond, that sparkles and flashes with the varied throbbings of the breast on which it is displayed.” Word bank: bondslave, desperadoes, inquietude, galliard

    Key: inquietude

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What groups are in the crowd?

    A. Only soldiers

    B. Native people, sailors and townspeople

    C. Only children

    D. Only ministers

    Key: B (Native people, sailors and townspeople)

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line ““Look your last on the scarlet letter and its wearer!”—the people’s victim and lifelong bondslave, as they fancied her, might say to them.”, what does “bondslave” most nearly mean?

    A. the system of coats of arms

    B. a slave; one bound to serve

    C. a shield bearing a coat of arms

    D. shakily, nervously

    Key: B (a slave; one bound to serve)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “she beheld old Roger Chillingworth himself, standing in the remotest corner of the marketplace, and smiling on her” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 26). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Chillingworth's smile.
28. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24).
    Sample answer: The shipmaster reveals that "Chillingworth, he calls himself" will sail with them, and Hester sees him "smiling on her" across the square.
29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] What does the holiday reveal about Puritan society? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view.
30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The shipmaster's news.
31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Hester's appearance on the holiday.

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 4, 17, 8, 5, 2, 1, 18, 7, 19, 20, 11, 21, 22, 14, 15, 23 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 24, 25, 7, 5, 9, 26, 11, 12, 20, 13, 19, 27, 22, 28, 29, 30 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 24, 3, 2, 5, 25, 13, 20, 21, 12, 11, 27, 15, 28, 14, 29, 23 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 7, 2, 24, 5, 13, 12, 19, 21, 11, 27, 28, 22, 15, 23, 16, 30 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 24, 5, 2, 11, 19, 13, 20, 28, 27, 15, 14, 22, 30, 31, 23, 29 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 24, 5, 18, 19, 10, 20, 11, 22, 28, 27, 15, 14, 29, 30, 31, 16 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 5, 24, 21, 20, 12, 11, 27, 15, 22, 14, 28, 31, 29, 16, 30, 23 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 5, 24, 11, 10, 21, 12, 27, 22, 28, 15, 14, 29, 16, 30, 31, 23 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 5, 24, 11, 10, 21, 12, 14, 28, 22, 15, 27, 30, 16, 29, 23, 31 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 24, 5, 21, 12, 19, 11, 27, 15, 28, 14, 22, 23, 30, 31, 16, 29 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "XXI: The New England Holiday," how does Hawthorne show the New England holiday? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XXI: The New England Holiday, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the New England holiday? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XXI: The New England Holiday develops the idea of the New England holiday. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XXI: The New England Holiday (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the New England holiday. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XXI: The New England Holiday suggests about the New England holiday. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses setting in XXI: The New England Holiday to complicate the reader's understanding of the New England holiday. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XXI: The New England Holiday within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the New England holiday responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XXI: The New England Holiday alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the New England holiday follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XXI: The New England Holiday and its treatment of the New England holiday. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XXI: The New England Holiday as evidence for a larger claim about the New England holiday in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XXI: The New England Holiday as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the New England holiday. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *"Look your last on the scarlet letter and its wearer!"—the people's victim and lifelong bondslave, as they fancied her, might say to them.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "bondslave" most nearly mean?

   A. restlessness; uneasiness

   B. lively and bold

   C. joking; fun

   D. a slave; one bound to serve

2. *Betimes in the morning of the day on which the new Governor was to receive his office at the hands of the people, Hester Prynne and little Pearl came into the marketplace. It was already thronged with the craftsmen and other plebeian inhabitants of the town, in considerable numbers; among whom, likewise, were many rough figures, whose attire of deerskins marked them as belonging to some of the forest settlements, which surrounded the little metropolis of the colony.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "XXI: The New England Holiday"?

   A. The procession

   B. The pastor and his parishioner

   C. The New England holiday

   D. Hester on the scaffold

**SAT key:** 1. D (a slave; one bound to serve); 2. C (The New England holiday)

# Lesson 25: XXII: The Procession

**Focus:** the procession

**Objective:** Students will analyze how setting develops in “XXII: The Procession” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

The procession passes; Dimmesdale walks with strange energy and seems far from Hester. Mistress Hibbins tells Hester she knows the minister's secret. Hester stands by the scaffold listening to the sermon's tone through the meetinghouse walls. Pearl brings the captain's message: Chillingworth will bring the minister aboard.

**Background:** The meetinghouse served as church and town hall in Puritan Boston.

**Significance:** The lovers stand at opposite poles of public life.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Can you feel far from someone who is close by? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to public shame and private identity because....*
**Prompt:** Can you feel far from someone who is close by?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to public shame and private identity because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: illuminates — lights up; morions — open metal helmets worn by soldiers; honorary — given as an honor; centrifugal — pushing outward from a center; stomacher — a decorated panel on the front of a woman's bodice. “illuminates”: Origin of “illuminate”: Latin illūmināt-us. “morions”: Origin of “morion”: Middle French morion. “honorary”: Origin: Latin honōrārius. “centrifugal”: Origin: New Latin centrifugālis; earlier Latin centrum (“center”).*
**Words:** illuminates: lights up · morions: open metal helmets worn by soldiers · honorary: given as an honor · centrifugal: pushing outward from a center · stomacher: a decorated panel on the front of a woman's bodice

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*The meetinghouse served as church and town hall in Puritan Boston. The lovers stand at opposite poles of public life. Characterization: Dimmesdale marches in the procession with unusual energy; Hester feels he is far beyond her reach. Setting: The marketplace, the meetinghouse and the scaffold where Hester stands while he preaches. Irony: Mistress Hibbins tells Hester she knows the minister's secret, and Pearl reports the shipmaster's message. Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "affairs, the sound of military music was heard approaching along a contiguous street. It denoted the advance of the procession of magistrates" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 1).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest" slowly and put it in my own words: Hester tells Pearl they must not talk in the marketplace about what happens in the forest. Next, craft. I notice the two places stand for two worlds: the town's public law and the private freedom of the woods. The strongest word is "forest": it stands for the hidden, natural life where she and Dimmesdale were honest with each other. Then, effect. What does Hester mean by keeping the forest out of the marketplace? My answer: By keeping the forest out of the marketplace, Hester means their private plans from the forest must stay hidden in town; the line shows how secrecy divides private truth from public life.*

> *We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest" slowly and put it in my own words: Hester tells Pearl they must not talk in the marketplace about what happens in the forest. Next, craft. I notice the two places stand for two worlds: the town's public law and the private freedom of the woods. The strongest word is "forest": it stands for the hidden, natural life where she and Dimmesdale were honest with each other. Then, effect. What does Hester mean by keeping the forest out of the marketplace? My answer: By keeping the forest out of the marketplace, Hester means their private plans from the forest must stay hidden in town; the line shows how secrecy divides private truth from public life.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Mistress Hibbins hints at the minister's secret. Expected link: irony; hypocrisy and truth. Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity? Expected: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. (Mistress Hibbins to Pearl.)*

> *thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Mistress Hibbins hints at the minister's secret. Expected link: irony; hypocrisy and truth.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to public shame and private identity?
**Expected answer:** Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. (Mistress Hibbins to Pearl.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for characterization, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the procession? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XXII: The Procession develops the idea of the procession. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. When the text says “The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30), it shows this directly. Hester must stand in the marketplace while the minister preaches, the contrast the narrator draws: "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace!"*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for characterization, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the procession? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XXII: The Procession develops the idea of the procession. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. When the text says “The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30), it shows this directly. Hester must stand in the marketplace while the minister preaches, the contrast the narrator draws: "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace!"

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Can you feel far from someone who is close by? Ask: what does Hester hear in the sermon without understanding its words?*
**Anchor question:** Can you feel far from someone who is close by?
**Facilitation:** Ask: what does Hester hear in the sermon without understanding its words?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the procession? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. ("The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace", XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the procession? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. ("The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace", XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes the procession. Key takeaway: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Dimmesdale marches in the procession with unusual energy; Hester feels he is far beyond her reach.
- **Setting:** The marketplace, the meetinghouse and the scaffold where Hester stands while he preaches.
- **Irony:** Mistress Hibbins tells Hester she knows the minister's secret, and Pearl reports the shipmaster's message.

### Themes and how they develop

- **public shame and private identity:** Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit.

### Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "affairs, the sound of military music was heard approaching along a contiguous street. It denoted the advance of the procession of magistrates" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: "back to her former mood by the shimmer of

the sunshine on the weapons and bright armor of the military company, which" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 2).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9) Hester to Pearl: town against forest.
- "thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17) Mistress Hibbins to Pearl.
- "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30) The chapter's contrast.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life.
**Evidence:** "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30)
**Reasoning:** Hester must stand in the marketplace while the minister preaches, the contrast the narrator draws: "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace!"

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **illuminates** (verb) | lights up | *She made the sombre crowd cheerful by her erratic and glistening ray; even as a bird of bright plumage illuminates a whole tree of dusky foliage, by darting to and fro, half seen and half concealed amid the twilight of the clustering leaves.* | "illuminates": Origin of "illuminate": Latin illūmināt**us**. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/illuminate#Etymology) |
| **morions** (noun) | open metal helmets worn by soldiers | *The entire array, moreover, clad in burnished steel, and with plumage nodding over their bright morions, had a brilliancy of effect which no modern display can aspire to equal.* | "morions": Origin of "morion": Middle French morion. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/morion#Etymology) |
| **honorary** (adjective) | given as an honor | *But she was brought back to her former mood by the shimmer of the sunshine on the weapons and bright armor of the military company, which followed after the music, and formed the honorary escort of the procession.* | "honorary": Origin: Latin honōrārius. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/honorary#Etymology) |
| **centrifugal** (adjective) | pushing outward from a center | *At that distance they accordingly stood, fixed there by the centrifugal force of the repugnance which the mystic symbol inspired.* | "centrifugal": Origin: New Latin centrifugālis; earlier Latin centrum ("center"). (Liber et Libri origin note, |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/centrifugal#Etymology) |
| **stomacher** (noun) | a decorated panel on the front of a woman's bodice | *It was Mistress Hibbins, who, arrayed in great magnificence, with a triple ruff, a broidered stomacher, a gown of rich velvet, and a gold-headed cane, had come forth to see the procession.* | |
| **ministrations** (noun) | acts of care or service | *It might be spiritual, and imparted to him by angelic ministrations.* | |
| **intentness** (noun) | close, focused attention | *Muffled as the sound was by its passage through the church-walls, Hester Prynne listened with such intentness, and sympathized so intimately, that the sermon had throughout a meaning for her, entirely apart from its indistinguishable words.* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Can you feel far from someone who is close by?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature and the individual against society?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What does Hester hear of the sermon? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The tone and cadence, not the words.
2. How does Dimmesdale walk in the procession? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: With unusual energy
3. How does Hester feel? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That he is far from her
4. Who claims to know the secret? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Mistress Hibbins
5. Where does Hester stand during the sermon? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: By the scaffold

6. What message does Pearl bring? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Chillingworth will bring the minister aboard
7. Retell the three most important events of "XXII: The Procession" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The procession passes; Dimmesdale walks with strange energy and seems far from Hester. Mistress Hibbins tells Hester she knows the minister's secret. Hester stands by the scaffold listening to the sermon's tone through the meetinghouse walls. Pearl brings the captain's message: Chillingworth will bring the minister aboard.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XXII: The Procession"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XXII: The Procession" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "She made the sombre crowd cheerful by her erratic and glistening ray; even as a bird of bright plumage illuminates a whole tree of dusky foliage, by darting to and fro, half seen and half concealed amid the twilight of…" What does "illuminates" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: illuminates: lights up.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does Mistress Hibbins's talk unsettle Hester? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: She seems to know the forest meeting.
2. What does "XXII: The Procession" suggest about the procession? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The lovers stand at opposite poles of public life.
3. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the irony in this chapter shape what we understand about the procession? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: "We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9): Hester to Pearl: town against forest. On irony: Mistress Hibbins tells Hester she knows the minister's secret, and Pearl reports the shipmaster's message. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Before Hester Prynne could call together her thoughts, and consider what was practicable to be done in this new and startling aspect of affairs, the sound of military music was…", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "XXII: The Procession", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The procession passes; Dimmesdale walks with strange energy and seems far from Hester. Mistress Hibbins tells Hester she knows the minister's secret. Hester stands by the scaffold listening to the sermon's tone through the meetinghouse walls. Pearl brings the captain's message: Chillingworth will…

7. How does “XXII: The Procession” build on “XXI: The New England Holiday”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17): Mistress Hibbins to Pearl. Theme link: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30): The chapter's contrast. On characterization: Dimmesdale marches in the procession with unusual energy; Hester feels he is far beyond her reach. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can you feel far from someone who is close by?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature and the individual against society? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9): Hester to Pearl: town against forest. On characterization: Dimmesdale marches in the procession with unusual energy; Hester feels he is far beyond her reach. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. What does the contrast of pulpit and scaffold suggest? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17): Mistress Hibbins to Pearl. Theme link: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The lovers stand at opposite poles of public life.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the

marketplace” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30): The chapter's contrast. Theme link: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9): Hester to Pearl: town against forest. On characterization: Dimmesdale marches in the procession with unusual energy; Hester feels he is far beyond her reach. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “XXII: The Procession” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the procession? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17): Mistress Hibbins to Pearl. Theme link: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “XXII: The Procession”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30): The chapter's contrast. Theme link: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to women and independence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9): Hester to Pearl: town against forest. Theme link: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17): Mistress Hibbins to Pearl. On setting: The marketplace, the

meetinghouse and the scaffold where Hester stands while he preaches. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XXII: The Procession” treats the procession with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30): The chapter's contrast. Theme link: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9): Hester to Pearl: town against forest. Theme link: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the procession? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17): Mistress Hibbins to Pearl. Theme link: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It was Mistress Hibbins, who, arrayed in great magnificence, with a triple ruff, a broidered _____, a gown of rich velvet, and a gold-headed cane, had come forth to see the procession.” Word bank: honorary, morions, illuminates, stomacher
   Key: stomacher

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17: “thou shalt know _____ the minister keeps his hand over his heart”
   Key: wherefore

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What message does Pearl bring?

   A. Dimmesdale is ill

   B. Chillingworth will bring the minister aboard

   C. The ship has left

   D. The governor wants Hester

   Key: B (Chillingworth will bring the minister aboard)

4. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Hester hear of the sermon?

   Sample answer: The tone and cadence, not the words.

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30: "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the _____"

   Key: marketplace

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "It might be spiritual, and imparted to him by angelic _____." Word bank: morions, honorary, illuminates, ministrations

   Key: ministrations

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "At that distance they accordingly stood, fixed there by the centrifugal force of the repugnance which the mystic symbol inspired.", what does "centrifugal" most nearly mean?

   A. pushing outward from a center

   B. a reddish glow

   C. slowly decay into dust

   D. belonging to a small, inner circle

   Key: A (pushing outward from a center)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Muffled as the sound was by its passage through the church-walls, Hester Prynne listened with such _____, and sympathized so intimately, that the sermon had throughout a meaning for her, entirely apart from its indistinguishable words." Word bank: honorary, morions, intentness, illuminates

   Key: intentness

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "The entire array, moreover, clad in burnished steel, and with plumage nodding over their bright morions, had a brilliancy of effect which no modern display can aspire to equal.", what does "morions" most nearly mean?

   A. devilish

   B. slowly decay into dust

   C. open metal helmets worn by soldiers

   D. is right or necessary for

   Key: C (open metal helmets worn by soldiers)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "XXII: The Procession"?

    A. Hester and the physician

    B. A flood of sunshine

    C. The procession

    D. The Governor's hall

    Key: C (The procession)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17)
    A. Mistress Hibbins to Pearl.
    B. Dimmesdale's telltale gesture.
    C. The letter's mysterious power.
    D. Hester's refusal.

    Key: A (Mistress Hibbins to Pearl.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9)
    A. Hester's plea.
    B. The confession begins.
    C. The letter's "new sense."
    D. Hester to Pearl: town against forest.

    Key: D (Hester to Pearl: town against forest.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30)
    A. The chapter's contrast.
    B. The confession begins.
    C. Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.
    D. Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing.

    Key: A (The chapter's contrast.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XXII: The Procession”? Dimmesdale marches in the procession with unusual energy; Hester feels he is far beyond her reach.
    A. Conflict
    B. Theme
    C. Characterization
    D. Point of view

    Key: C (Characterization)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit.
    A. Hypocrisy and truth
    B. Nature and the individual against society
    C. Sin and guilt
    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: D (Public shame and private identity)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from an earlier chapter to “XXII: The Procession”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Hester feel?
    A. Happy

B. Calm

C. That he is far from her

D. Angry

Key: C (That he is far from her)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “But she was brought back to her former mood by the shimmer of the sunshine on the weapons and bright armor of the military company, which followed after the music, and formed the honorary escort of the procession.”, what does “honorary” most nearly mean?

A. keeps causing bitter pain

B. given as an honor

C. like a shifting series of dreamlike images

D. without proper respect

Key: B (given as an honor)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Hester stand during the sermon?

A. By the scaffold

B. In the front pew

C. At home

D. On the ship

Key: A (By the scaffold)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Dimmesdale walk in the procession?

A. Not at all

B. With unusual energy

C. On horseback

D. Weakly

Key: B (With unusual energy)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Mistress Hibbins to Pearl.

22. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Hester to Pearl: town against forest.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: The chapter's contrast.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30).

Sample answer: Hester must stand in the marketplace while the minister preaches, the contrast the narrator draws: "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace!"

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Mistress Hibbins to Pearl.

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9: "We must not always talk in the _____ of what happens to us in the forest"
    Key: marketplace

27. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Mistress Hibbins's talk unsettle Hester?
    Sample answer: She seems to know the forest meeting.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Hester to Pearl: town against forest.

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "She made the sombre crowd cheerful by her erratic and glistening ray; even as a bird of bright plumage illuminates a whole tree of dusky foliage, by darting to and fro, half seen and half concealed amid the twilight of…", what does "illuminates" most nearly mean?
    A. inflicted (revenge or harm)
    B. a small, close-fitting cap
    C. splash (with water or mud)
    D. lights up
    Key: D (lights up)

30. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in "XXII: The Procession"? The marketplace, the meetinghouse and the scaffold where Hester stands while he preaches.
    A. Setting
    B. Structure
    C. Characterization
    D. Allusion
    Key: A (Setting)

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: "The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Hester must stand in the marketplace while the minister preaches, the contrast the narrator draws: "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace!"

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] What does the contrast of pulpit and scaffold suggest? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view.

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 17, 18, 4, 19, 8, 5, 3, 20, 12, 21, 11, 22, 15, 23, 24, 25 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 1, 4, 18, 7, 26, 19, 22, 12, 27, 13, 11, 15, 23, 14, 25, 28 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 6, 7, 8, 29, 18, 27, 10, 13, 22, 21, 24, 15, 14, 30, 25, 31 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| HS Senior | 2, 29, 1, 6, 11, 13, 21, 27, 22, 15, 24, 14, 30, 31, 28, 25 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 26, 1, 17, 10, 12, 21, 11, 14, 23, 30, 24, 15, 25, 16, 31, 28 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 1, 3, 26, 11, 22, 21, 13, 24, 23, 15, 30, 14, 25, 28, 32, 16 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 1, 6, 21, 11, 27, 10, 14, 30, 23, 24, 15, 31, 28, 32, 25, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 1, 8, 11, 12, 27, 21, 24, 14, 15, 30, 23, 25, 31, 32, 16, 28 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 1, 6, 11, 27, 13, 12, 30, 24, 14, 15, 23, 16, 31, 32, 28, 25 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 1, 6, 12, 10, 11, 22, 24, 14, 15, 30, 23, 25, 31, 16, 32, 28 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "XXII: The Procession," how does Hawthorne show the procession? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XXII: The Procession, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the procession? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XXII: The Procession develops the idea of the procession. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XXII: The Procession (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the procession. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XXII: The Procession suggests about the procession. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses setting in XXII: The Procession to complicate the reader's understanding of the procession. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XXII: The Procession within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the procession responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XXII: The Procession alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the procession follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XXII: The Procession and its treatment of the procession. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XXII: The Procession as evidence for a larger claim about the procession in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XXII: The Procession as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the procession. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *But she was brought back to her former mood by the shimmer of the sunshine on the weapons and bright armor of the military company, which followed after the music, and formed the honorary escort of the procession.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “honorary” most nearly mean?

   A. close, focused attention

   B. a decorated panel on the front of a woman's bodice

   C. acts of care or service

   D. given as an honor

2. *Before Hester Prynne could call together her thoughts, and consider what was practicable to be done in this new and startling aspect of affairs, the sound of military music was heard approaching along a contiguous street. It denoted the advance of the procession of magistrates and citizens, on its way towards the meetinghouse; where, in compliance with a custom thus early established, and ever since observed, the Reverend Mr. Dimmesdale was to deliver an Election Sermon.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “XXII: The Procession”?

   A. The child at the brook-side

   B. The frame narrative and the found letter

   C. A flood of sunshine

   D. The procession

**SAT key:** 1. D (given as an honor); 2. D (The procession)

# Lesson 26: XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter

**Focus:** the revelation

**Objective:** Students will analyze how plot develops in "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

**Content note (death):** Dimmesdale dies on the scaffold after confessing. Discuss confession and grief; keep the focus on what the scene means.
**Student preview:** A character dies in this chapter.
**Suggested language:** "Is the ending just?"

Teacher only · spoilers

After his triumphant sermon, Dimmesdale, near collapse, calls Hester and Pearl to the scaffold. Chillingworth tries to stop him. Leaning on Hester, he confesses before the people and tears open his vestment. Chillingworth says he has escaped him. Pearl kisses him, and he dies, unsure whether he and Hester will meet again.

**Background:** Public confession before the congregation was a Puritan practice of repentance.

**Significance:** Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Is it ever too late to tell the truth? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to hypocrisy and truth because.... Content note before we start: A character dies in this chapter.*
**Prompt:** Is it ever too late to tell the truth?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to hypocrisy and truth because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the public confession the novel has waited for.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: apotheosized — raised to the level of a god; idolized; concentred — focused together on one point; undisclosed — not revealed; clangor — a loud, ringing noise; etherealized — made spiritual and unearthly.*
*"undisclosed": Origin of "undisclose": an English formation from un- + disclose.*
**Words:** apotheosized: raised to the level of a god; idolized · concentred: focused together on one point · undisclosed: not revealed · clangor: a loud, ringing noise · etherealized: made spiritual and unearthly

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Public confession before the congregation was a Puritan practice of repentance. Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Plot: The climax: after the sermon Dimmesdale mounts the scaffold with Hester and Pearl, confesses, bares his breast and dies. Characterization: Chillingworth tries to stop him: "Thou hast escaped me!" Symbolism: Pearl's kiss breaks "a spell"; her tears pledge that she will be "a woman in it." Watch for the scaffold: The third scaffold scene, now at noon, before the whole town.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" slowly and put it in my own words: As Dimmesdale climbs the scaffold to confess, Chillingworth cries that nowhere else on earth could he have escaped him. Next, craft. I notice the long, bitter build-up, "hadst thou sought the whole earth over," ending on "this very scaffold." The strongest word is "scaffold": the place of public shame is the one place where confession frees him. Then, effect. Why does Chillingworth say the scaffold was the only place Dimmesdale could escape him? My answer: By confessing publicly, Dimmesdale ends Chillingworth's power over him; the scene shows that the truth, not escape, is the only way out.*

> *Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" slowly and put it in my own words: As Dimmesdale climbs the scaffold to confess, Chillingworth cries that nowhere else on earth could he have escaped him. Next, craft. I notice the long, bitter build-up, "hadst thou sought the whole earth over," ending on "this very scaffold." The strongest word is "scaffold": the place of public shame is the one place where confession frees him. Then, effect. Why does Chillingworth say the scaffold was the only place Dimmesdale could escape him? My answer: By confessing publicly, Dimmesdale ends Chillingworth's power over him; the scene shows that the truth, not escape, is the only way out.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Dimmesdale asks whether confession is "better … than what we dreamed of in the forest." Expected link: theme; the forest's freedom against truth. Ask: How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth? Expected: The public confession the novel has waited for. (Dimmesdale to Hester.)*

> *Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Dimmesdale asks whether confession is "better ... than what we dreamed of in the forest." Expected link: theme; the forest's freedom against truth.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth?
**Expected answer:** The public confession the novel has waited for. (Dimmesdale to Hester.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for plot, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the revelation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter develops the idea of the revelation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. When the text says "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18), it shows this directly. Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken."*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for plot, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the revelation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter develops the idea of the revelation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. When the text says "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18), it shows this directly. Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Is it ever too late to tell the truth? Ask: why does Hawthorne refuse to describe what was on the minister's breast?*
**Anchor question:** Is it ever too late to tell the truth?
**Facilitation:** Ask: why does Hawthorne refuse to describe what was on the minister's breast?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the revelation? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. ("Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold", XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the revelation? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. ("Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold", XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how plot shapes the revelation. Key takeaway: the public confession the novel has waited for.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Plot:** The climax: after the sermon Dimmesdale mounts the scaffold with Hester and Pearl, confesses, bares his breast and dies.
- **Characterization:** Chillingworth tries to stop him: "Thou hast escaped me!"
- **Symbolism:** Pearl's kiss breaks "a spell"; her tears pledge that she will be "a woman in it."

**Themes and how they develop**

- **hypocrisy and truth:** the public confession the novel has waited for.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the scaffold:** The third scaffold scene, now at noon, before the whole town.

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18) Chillingworth's defeat.
- "Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21) Dimmesdale to Hester.
- "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33) Pearl's transformation.
- "People of New England" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 25) The confession begins.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth.
**Evidence:** "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18)
**Reasoning:** Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken."

## *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **apotheosized** (verb) | raised to the level of a god; idolized | *So etherealized by spirit as he was, and so apotheosized by worshipping admirers, did his footsteps, in the procession, really tread upon the dust of earth?* | |
| **concentred** (verb) | focused together on one point | *For an instant, the gaze of the horror-stricken multitude was concentred on the ghastly miracle; while the minister stood, with a flush of triumph in his face, as one who, in the crisis of acutest pain, had won a victory.* | |
| **undisclosed** (adjective) | not revealed | *It seemed, at this point, as if the minister must leave the remainder of his secret undisclosed.* | "undisclosed": Origin of "undisclose": an English formation from un- + disclose. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/undisclose#Etymology) |
| **clangor** (noun) | a loud, ringing noise | *Now was heard again the clangor of the music, and the measured tramp of the military escort, issuing from the church-door.* | |
| **etherealized** (verb) | made spiritual and unearthly | *So etherealized by spirit as he was, and so apotheosized by worshipping admirers, did his footsteps, in the procession, really tread upon the dust of earth?* | |
| **blacken** (verb) | damage (a reputation) | *Do not blacken your fame, and perish in dishonor!* | "blacken": Origin: an English formation from black + -en. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/blacken#Etymology) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Is it ever too late to tell the truth?
2. Where does plot appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with women and independence?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. What does Chillingworth say repeatedly? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Thou hast escaped me!
2. Where does Dimmesdale confess? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: On the scaffold
3. Who tries to stop him? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Chillingworth
4. What does he reveal? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His breast
5. What does Pearl do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Kisses him
6. What happens to Dimmesdale? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He dies
7. Retell the three most important events of "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: After his triumphant sermon, Dimmesdale, near collapse, calls Hester and Pearl to the scaffold. Chillingworth tries to stop him. Leaning on Hester, he confesses before the people and tears open his vestment. Chillingworth says he has escaped him. Pearl kisses him, and he dies, unsure whether he and Hester will meet again.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "So etherealized by spirit as he was, and so apotheosized by worshipping admirers, did his footsteps, in the procession, really tread upon the dust of earth?" What does "apotheosized" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: apotheosized: raised to the level of a god; idolized.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Hawthorne not describe what is revealed? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: To keep the meaning uncertain and spiritual.
2. What does "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter" suggest about the revelation? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth.
3. Find one example of plot in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
4. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the revelation? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18): Chillingworth's defeat. On characterization: Chillingworth tries to stop him:

"Thou hast escaped me!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Now was heard again the clangor of the music, and the measured tramp of the military escort, issuing from the church-door.”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: After his triumphant sermon, Dimmesdale, near collapse, calls Hester and Pearl to the scaffold. Chillingworth tries to stop him. Leaning on Hester, he confesses before the people and tears open his vestment. Chillingworth says he has escaped him. Pearl kisses him, and he dies, unsure whether he and…
7. How does “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter” build on “XXII: The Procession”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21): Dimmesdale to Hester. Theme link: the public confession the novel has waited for. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: “Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33): Pearl's transformation. On characterization: Chillingworth tries to stop him: "Thou hast escaped me!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is it ever too late to tell the truth?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does symbolism appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with women and independence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: “People of New England” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 25): The confession begins. On symbolism: Pearl's kiss breaks "a spell"; her tears pledge that she will be "a woman in it." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is the ending just? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place

so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18): Chillingworth's defeat. Theme link: the public confession the novel has waited for. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: "Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: "Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21): Dimmesdale to Hester. Theme link: the public confession the novel has waited for. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33): Pearl's transformation. On characterization: Chillingworth tries to stop him: "Thou hast escaped me!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the revelation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: "People of New England" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 25): The confession begins. Theme link: the public confession the novel has waited for. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18): Chillingworth's defeat. Theme link: the public confession the novel has waited for. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to sin and guilt: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: "Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21): Dimmesdale to Hester. Theme link: the public

confession the novel has waited for. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the plot in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: “Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33): Pearl's transformation. On plot: The climax: after the sermon Dimmesdale mounts the scaffold with Hester and Pearl, confesses, bares his breast and dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter” treats the revelation with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: “People of New England” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 25): The confession begins. Theme link: the public confession the novel has waited for. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “XXIV: Conclusion” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18): Chillingworth's defeat. Theme link: the public confession the novel has waited for. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the revelation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21): Dimmesdale to Hester. Theme link: the public confession the novel has waited for. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who tries to stop him?
   A. Chillingworth
   B. Pearl
   C. Wilson
   D. Hester

   Key: A (Chillingworth)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does he reveal?
   A. A letter
   B. A will
   C. A knife
   D. His breast

   Key: D (His breast)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Now was heard again the clangor of the music, and the measured tramp of the military escort, issuing from the church-door.”, what does “clangor” most nearly mean?
   A. speaking at length (about)
   B. one's deepest feelings
   C. a loud, ringing noise
   D. not saved from sin

   Key: C (a loud, ringing noise)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Do not _____ your fame, and perish in dishonor!” Word bank: apotheosized, undisclosed, concentred, blacken

   Key: blacken
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18: “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very _____”

   Key: scaffold
6. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Chillingworth say repeatedly?

   Sample answer: Thou hast escaped me!
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Dimmesdale confess?
   A. On the ship
   B. In the pulpit
   C. In the forest
   D. On the scaffold

   Key: D (On the scaffold)
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “So etherealized by spirit as he was, and so apotheosized by worshipping admirers, did his footsteps, in the procession, really tread upon the dust of earth?”, what does “apotheosized” most nearly mean?
   A. pure; not mixed with anything weaker
   B. based on guesswork

C. setting aside; declining to pursue

D. raised to the level of a god; idolized

Key: D (raised to the level of a god; idolized)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens to Dimmesdale?

   A. He is arrested

   B. He recovers

   C. He leaves on the ship

   D. He dies

   Key: D (He dies)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale to Hester.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “People of New England” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 25)

    A. His self-recognition.

    B. Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners.

    C. The confession begins.

    D. The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse."

    Key: C (The confession begins.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth's defeat.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter”?

    A. The interview in prison

    B. The revelation

    C. The minister in a maze

    D. The New England holiday

    Key: B (The revelation)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The public confession the novel has waited for.

    A. Sin and guilt

    B. Nature and the individual against society

    C. Hypocrisy and truth

    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: C (Hypocrisy and truth)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter”? Chillingworth tries to stop him: "Thou hast escaped me!"

    A. Theme

    B. Characterization

    C. Allusion

    D. Imagery

    Key: B (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken."

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21: “Is not this better … than what we _____ of in the forest”

    Key: dreamed

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33: “Pearl _____ his lips. A spell was broken”

    Key: kissed

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “So _____ by spirit as he was, and so apotheosized by worshipping admirers, did his footsteps, in the procession, really tread upon the dust of earth?” Word bank: concentred, etherealized, apotheosized, undisclosed

    Key: etherealized

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “For an instant, the gaze of the horror-stricken multitude was concentred on the ghastly miracle; while the minister stood, with a flush of triumph in his face, as one who, in the crisis of acutest pain, had won a…”, what does “concentred” most nearly mean?

    A. focused together on one point

    B. reasoned about life in a thoughtful, abstract way

    C. a source that never runs dry

    D. took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering

    Key: A (focused together on one point)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Hawthorne not describe what is revealed?

    Sample answer: To keep the meaning uncertain and spiritual.

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33)

    A. Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.

    B. The mirror in the armor.

    C. Pearl's transformation.

    D. The core of his hypocrisy.

    Key: C (Pearl's transformation.)

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21)

    A. The townspeople's suspicion.

    B. Dimmesdale to Hester.

    C. Hester's promise.

    D. The town's suspicion.

    Key: B (Dimmesdale to Hester.)

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18).

    Sample answer: Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken."

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is the ending just? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view.

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Pearl's transformation.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale to Hester.

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18)

    A. Pearl's question.

    B. His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.

    C. The rose-bush as hope.

    D. Chillingworth's defeat.

    Key: D (Chillingworth's defeat.)

29. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter”? The climax: after the sermon Dimmesdale mounts the scaffold with Hester and Pearl, confesses, bares his breast and dies.

    A. Plot

    B. Theme

    C. Point of view

    D. Characterization

    Key: A (Plot)

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18) shape its meaning? Consider a second,

competing reading.

Sample answer: Chillingworth's defeat.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how hypocrisy and truth develops from an earlier chapter to "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter". Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: the public confession the novel has waited for.

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 17, 6, 18, 2, 9, 19, 20, 5, 21, 12, 22, 23, 24, 14, 15, 25 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 5, 17, 1, 2, 7, 9, 10, 12, 22, 23, 11, 24, 15, 26, 16, 27 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 19, 3, 6, 4, 9, 12, 21, 28, 23, 13, 26, 14, 29, 24, 30, 25 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 19, 7, 1, 4, 13, 23, 28, 10, 12, 24, 29, 26, 14, 31, 30, 25 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 19, 20, 17, 13, 21, 12, 28, 29, 14, 24, 15, 26, 30, 16, 25, 27 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 19, 6, 18, 21, 28, 23, 13, 15, 14, 24, 26, 29, 31, 25, 30, 16 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 4, 19, 22, 11, 12, 21, 15, 24, 26, 14, 29, 16, 31, 30, 25, 27 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 4, 19, 22, 28, 13, 10, 15, 26, 14, 29, 24, 31, 27, 25, 30, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 19, 4, 21, 11, 10, 23, 24, 26, 29, 15, 14, 31, 27, 25, 16, 30 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 17, 19, 28, 21, 13, 12, 15, 14, 24, 29, 26, 25, 31, 16, 27, 30 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter," how does Hawthorne show the revelation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the plot you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the revelation? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the plot in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter develops the idea of the revelation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of

textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter (where it begins, turns and ends) and its plot shape the reader's understanding of the revelation. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter suggests about the revelation. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's plot and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses plot in XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter to complicate the reader's understanding of the revelation. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the revelation responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the revelation follows or bends those conventions, using the plot as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter and its treatment of the revelation. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's plot and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter as evidence for a larger claim about the revelation in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the revelation. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *It seemed, at this point, as if the minister must leave the remainder of his secret undisclosed.*

As used in the text, what does the word "undisclosed" most nearly mean?

A. made spiritual and unearthly

B. not revealed

C. damage (a reputation)

D. a loud, ringing noise

2. *Now was heard again the clangor of the music, and the measured tramp of the military escort, issuing from the church-door. The procession was to be marshalled thence to the town-hall, where a solemn banquet would complete the ceremonies of the day.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter"?

A. The revelation

B. Hester on the scaffold

C. The New England holiday

D. Pearl

**SAT key:** 1. B (not revealed); 2. A (The revelation)

# Lesson 27: XXIV: Conclusion

**Focus:** conclusion

**Objective:** Students will analyze how structure develops in “XXIV: Conclusion” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Common Core RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

**Critical voice:** “The sin of her seducer too, seems to be considered as lying not so much in the deed itself, as in his long concealment of it, and, in fact, the whole moral of the tale is given in the words--"Be true--be true," as if sincerity in sin were virtue, and as if "Be clean--be clean," were not the more fitting conclusion.” (Arthur Cleveland Coxe, clergyman and critic, *"The Writings of Hawthorne," Church Review (January 1851), pp. 489-511 (excerpt), excerpt*; public domain). Final-paper prompt: is concealment or the act itself Dimmesdale's real sin? Answer Coxe. *Objective:* Determine the novel's final moral ("Be true!"). *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1

Teacher only · spoilers

Witnesses disagree: most saw a scarlet letter in the minister's flesh, but some saw nothing. Chillingworth withers and dies within a year, leaving his fortune to Pearl, who goes abroad and seems to marry happily. Hester returns years later, wears the letter by choice and counsels troubled women. She is buried near Dimmesdale under one tombstone.

**Background:** King's Chapel burying ground in Boston contains graves from the colonial period; Hawthorne places the tomb there.

**Significance:** Hester makes the letter her own and its meaning changes.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Can a symbol of shame become something else? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to women and independence because....*
**Prompt:** Can a symbol of shame become something else?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to women and independence because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground."

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: escutcheon — a shield bearing a coat of arms; wilting — drooping and withering; unvalued — not valued or loved; necromancer — a sorcerer; heraldry — the system of coats of arms.*
**Words:** escutcheon: a shield bearing a coat of arms · wilting: drooping and withering · unvalued: not valued or loved · necromancer: a sorcerer · heraldry: the system of coats of arms

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*King's Chapel burying ground in Boston contains graves from the colonial period; Hawthorne places the tomb there. Hester makes the letter her own and its meaning changes. Structure: The conclusion offers several accounts of what was seen and withholds certainty. Characterization: Chillingworth withers and dies within the year, leaving his property to Pearl; Hester returns and wears the letter freely. Symbolism: The shared tombstone and its heraldic letter A. Watch for the scarlet letter: Hester resumes it "of her own free will."*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister's miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—"Be true! Be..." slowly and put it in my own words: Of the many lessons, the narrator chooses one: "Be true! Be true! Be true!" Next, craft. I notice the triple repetition, like a sermon's final cry. The strongest word is "true": it names the novel's central demand: honesty about oneself. Then, effect. What moral does the narrator draw from Dimmesdale's story? My answer: The narrator says that if you cannot show the world your worst, you should at least show some sign of it; Dimmesdale's ruin came from hiding, not only from sin.*

> *Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister's miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—"Be true! Be true! Be true* *(XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister's miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—"Be true! Be…" slowly and put it in my own words: Of the many lessons, the narrator chooses one: "Be true! Be true! Be true!" Next, craft. I notice the triple repetition, like a sermon's final cry. The strongest word is "true": it names the novel's central demand: honesty about oneself. Then, effect. What moral does the narrator draw from Dimmesdale's story? My answer: The narrator says that if you cannot show the world your worst, you should at least show some sign of it; Dimmesdale's ruin came from hiding, not only from sin.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: One account of the revelation. Look at the craft: Chillingworth withers and dies within the year, leaving his property to Pearl; Hester returns and wears the letter freely. Ask: How does this line connect to women and independence? Expected: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground." (One account of the revelation.)*

> *Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter* *(XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** One account of the revelation. Look at the craft: Chillingworth withers and dies within the year, leaving his property to Pearl; Hester returns and wears the letter freely.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to women and independence?
**Expected answer:** Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground." (One account of the revelation.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about conclusion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XXIV: Conclusion develops the idea of conclusion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Hester finally makes the letter her own. When the text says "Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence" (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. She returns because "here was yet to be her penitence," resuming the letter of her own will, and the narrator's one moral is "Be true! Be true! Be true!"*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about conclusion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XXIV: Conclusion develops the idea of conclusion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Hester finally makes the letter her own. When the text says "Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence" (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. She returns because "here was yet to be her penitence," resuming the letter of her own will, and the narrator's one moral is "Be true! Be true! Be true!"

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Can a symbol of shame become something else? Ask: is the ending hopeful? Compare the first scaffold scene with the tombstone.*
**Anchor question:** Can a symbol of shame become something else?
**Facilitation:** Ask: is the ending hopeful? Compare the first scaffold scene with the tombstone.

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about conclusion? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Hester finally makes the letter her own. ("Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence", XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about conclusion? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Hester finally makes the letter her own. ("Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence", XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how structure shapes conclusion. Key takeaway: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground."*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Structure:** The conclusion offers several accounts of what was seen and withholds certainty.
- **Characterization:** Chillingworth withers and dies within the year, leaving his property to Pearl; Hester returns and wears the letter freely.
- **Symbolism:** The shared tombstone and its heraldic letter A.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **women and independence:** Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground."

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the scarlet letter:** Hester resumes it "of her own free will."

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—“Be true! Be true! Be true” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4) The novel's moral.
- “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2) One account of the revelation.
- “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11) Why Hester returns.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Hester finally makes the letter her own.
**Evidence:** “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11)
**Reasoning:** She returns because "here was yet to be her penitence," resuming the letter of her own will, and the narrator's one moral is "Be true! Be true! Be true!"

## *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **escutcheon** (noun) | a shield bearing a coat of arms | *All around, there were monuments carved with armorial bearings; and on this simple slab of slate—as the curious investigator may still discern, and perplex himself with the purport—there appeared the semblance of an engraved escutcheon.* | |
| **wilting** (verb) | drooping and withering | *All his strength and energy—all his vital and intellectual force—seemed at once to desert him; insomuch that he positively withered up, shrivelled away, and almost vanished from mortal sight, like an uprooted weed that lies wilting in the sun.* | |
| **unvalued** (adjective) | not valued or loved | *Women, more especially—in the continually recurring trials of wounded, wasted, wronged, misplaced, or erring and sinful passion—or with the dreary burden of a heart unyielded, because unvalued and unsought—came to Hester's cottage, demanding why they were so wretched, and what the remedy!* | |
| **necromancer** (noun) | a sorcerer | *Others contended that the stigma had not been produced until a long time subsequent, when old Roger Chillingworth, being a potent necromancer, had caused it to appear, through the agency of magic and poisonous drugs.* | |
| **heraldry** (noun) | the system of coats of arms | *Letters came, with armorial seals upon them, though of bearings unknown to English heraldry.* | |
| **conjectural** (adjective) | based on guesswork | *As regarded its origin, there were various explanations, all of which must necessarily have been conjectural.* | |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Can a symbol of shame become something else?
2. Where does structure appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with sin and guilt?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What is the inscription? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: On a field, sable, the letter A, gules.
2. What do most witnesses say they saw? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A scarlet letter on his breast

3. What happens to Chillingworth? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He dies within a year
4. Who inherits his fortune? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Pearl
5. What does Hester do on her return? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Wears the letter by choice
6. Where is Hester buried? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Near Dimmesdale under one tombstone
7. Retell the three most important events of "XXIV: Conclusion" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Witnesses disagree: most saw a scarlet letter in the minister's flesh, but some saw nothing. Chillingworth withers and dies within a year, leaving his fortune to Pearl, who goes abroad and seems to marry happily. Hester returns years later, wears the letter by choice and counsels troubled women. She is buried near Dimmesdale under one tombstone.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XXIV: Conclusion"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XXIV: Conclusion" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "All around, there were monuments carved with armorial bearings; and on this simple slab of slate —as the curious investigator may still discern, and perplex himself with the purport—there appeared the semblance of an…" What does "escutcheon" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: escutcheon: a shield bearing a coat of arms.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does Hester return? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Boston is where her sin, sorrow and penitence belong.
2. What does "XXIV: Conclusion" suggest about conclusion? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Hester makes the letter her own and its meaning changes.
3. Find one example of structure in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
4. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about conclusion? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: "Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister's miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—"Be true! Be true! Be true" (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4): The novel's moral. On characterization: Chillingworth withers and dies within the year, leaving his property to Pearl; Hester returns and wears the letter freely. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "After many days, when time sufficed for the people to arrange their thoughts in reference to the foregoing scene, there was more than one account of what had been witnessed on the…",

why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “XXIV: Conclusion”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Witnesses disagree: most saw a scarlet letter in the minister's flesh, but some saw nothing. Chillingworth withers and dies within a year, leaving his fortune to Pearl, who goes abroad and seems to marry happily. Hester returns years later, wears the letter by choice and counsels troubled women…
7. How does “XXIV: Conclusion” build on “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2): One account of the revelation. On structure: The conclusion offers several accounts of what was seen and withholds certainty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11): Why Hester returns. On characterization: Chillingworth withers and dies within the year, leaving his property to Pearl; Hester returns and wears the letter freely. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can a symbol of shame become something else?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does symbolism appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with sin and guilt? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—“Be true! Be true! Be true” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4): The novel's moral. On symbolism: The shared tombstone and its heraldic letter A. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is the ending hopeful? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view comparing the first scaffold scene and the tomb.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2): One account of the revelation. Theme link: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground." Credit

any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Hester makes the letter her own and its meaning changes.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11): Why Hester returns. Theme link: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—“Be true! Be true! Be true” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4): The novel's moral. On characterization: Chillingworth withers and dies within the year, leaving his property to Pearl; Hester returns and wears the letter freely. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Rewrite one moment of “XXIV: Conclusion” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about conclusion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2): One account of the revelation. Theme link: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “XXIV: Conclusion”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11): Why Hester returns. Theme link: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this chapter to public shame and private identity: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—“Be true! Be true! Be true” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4): The novel's moral. Theme link: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women

will be on "surer ground." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the structure in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2): One account of the revelation. On structure: The conclusion offers several accounts of what was seen and withholds certainty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XXIV: Conclusion” treats conclusion with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11): Why Hester returns. Theme link: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. As the final chapter, does this ending resolve sin and guilt? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—“Be true! Be true! Be true” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4): The novel's moral. Theme link: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about conclusion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2): One account of the revelation. Theme link: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Structure:** look for how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where is Hester buried?
   A. In the forest
   B. In England
   C. By the sea
   D. Near Dimmesdale under one tombstone

   Key: D (Near Dimmesdale under one tombstone)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Women, more especially—in the continually recurring trials of wounded, wasted, wronged, misplaced, or erring and sinful passion—or with the dreary burden of a heart unyielded, because unvalued and unsought—came to…", what does "unvalued" most nearly mean?
   A. took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering
   B. not yet healed
   C. long spears with an axe blade, carried by guards
   D. not valued or loved

   Key: D (not valued or loved)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "All his strength and energy—all his vital and intellectual force—seemed at once to desert him; insomuch that he positively withered up, shrivelled away, and almost vanished from mortal sight, like an uprooted weed that…", what does "wilting" most nearly mean?
   A. drooping and withering
   B. too deep to be explored or understood
   C. a woman who founds something
   D. is right or necessary for

   Key: A (drooping and withering)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens to Chillingworth?
   A. He leaves on the ship
   B. He becomes governor
   C. He confesses
   D. He dies within a year

   Key: D (He dies within a year)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "All around, there were monuments carved with armorial bearings; and on this simple slab of slate—as the curious investigator may still discern, and perplex himself with the purport—there appeared the semblance of an…", what does "escutcheon" most nearly mean?
   A. one's deepest feelings
   B. forever, beyond death
   C. a shield bearing a coat of arms
   D. like a shifting series of dreamlike images

   Key: C (a shield bearing a coat of arms)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4: "Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister's miserable _____, we put only this into a sentence:—"Be true!

Be true! Be true”

Key: experience

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who inherits his fortune?

   A. The governor

   B. The church

   C. Pearl

   D. Hester

   Key: C (Pearl)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11: “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her _____”

   Key: penitence

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What do most witnesses say they saw?

   A. Nothing

   B. A scarlet letter on his breast

   C. A cross

   D. A wound

   Key: B (A scarlet letter on his breast)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2)

    A. Hester's freedom.

    B. One account of the revelation.

    C. Hester's question.

    D. The narrator's judgment.

    Key: B (One account of the revelation.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11)

    A. The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy.

    B. Chillingworth admits his part.

    C. Why Hester returns.

    D. The letter's mysterious power.

    Key: C (Why Hester returns.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Hester return?

    Sample answer: Boston is where her sin, sorrow and penitence belong.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—“Be true! Be true! Be true” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The novel's moral.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Why Hester returns.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11).
    Sample answer: She returns because "here was yet to be her penitence," resuming the letter of her own will, and the narrator's one moral is "Be true! Be true! Be true!"
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is the ending hopeful? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view comparing the first scaffold scene and the tomb.
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Hester do on her return?
    A. Wears the letter by choice
    B. Hides at home
    C. Remarries
    D. Throws it away

    Key: A (Wears the letter by choice)
18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2: “Most of the _____ testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter”
    Key: spectators
19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “As regarded its origin, there were various explanations, all of which must necessarily have been _____.” Word bank: wilting, escutcheon, conjectural, unvalued
    Key: conjectural
20. [short · recall · DOK 1] What is the inscription?
    Sample answer: On a field, sable, the letter A, gules.
21. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Others contended that the stigma had not been produced until a long time subsequent, when old Roger Chillingworth, being a potent necromancer, had caused it to appear, through the agency of magic and poisonous drugs.”, what does “necromancer” most nearly mean?
    A. a sorcerer
    B. focused together on one point
    C. in a way that cannot be held back
    D. changeable, unsteady moodiness

    Key: A (a sorcerer)
22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “XXIV: Conclusion”?
    A. Conclusion
    B. Pearl
    C. The forest walk
    D. Hester on the scaffold

    Key: A (Conclusion)
23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XXIV: Conclusion”? The conclusion offers several accounts of what was seen and withholds certainty.
    A. Structure
    B. Metaphor
    C. Imagery

D. Allusion

Key: A (Structure)

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how women and independence develops from an earlier chapter to “XXIV: Conclusion”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground."

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Letters came, with armorial seals upon them, though of bearings unknown to English _____.” Word bank: wilting, unvalued, escutcheon, heraldry
    Key: heraldry

26. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: One account of the revelation.

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—“Be true! Be true! Be true” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4)

    A. Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.

    B. The novel's moral.

    C. Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter.

    D. The cost of falseness.

    Key: B (The novel's moral.)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground."

    A. Sin and guilt

    B. Hypocrisy and truth

    C. Women and independence

    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: C (Women and independence)

29. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XXIV: Conclusion”? Chillingworth withers and dies within the year, leaving his property to Pearl; Hester returns and wears the letter freely.

    A. Characterization

    B. Plot

    C. Allusion

    D. Symbolism

    Key: A (Characterization)

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: One account of the revelation.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—“Be true! Be

true! Be true" (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: The novel's moral.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: "Hester finally makes the letter her own." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
Sample answer: She returns because "here was yet to be her penitence," resuming the letter of her own will, and the narrator's one moral is "Be true! Be true! Be true!"

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 17, 6, 18, 1, 4, 19, 20, 21, 13, 10, 22, 12, 14, 15, 23, 24 | recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 25, 3, 9, 1, 19, 7, 26, 22, 11, 13, 27, 15, 28, 29, 30, 16 | recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 20, 8, 19, 4, 18, 10, 13, 27, 26, 11, 23, 29, 15, 14, 31, 16 | recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 6, 25, 9, 20, 27, 26, 10, 12, 13, 23, 28, 14, 29, 16, 24, 32 | recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 25, 19, 20, 27, 10, 12, 11, 15, 14, 28, 23, 29, 32, 24, 31, 30 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Freshman | 25, 6, 4, 13, 26, 11, 10, 14, 15, 23, 28, 29, 24, 32, 16, 30 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4 |
| College Sophomore | 25, 19, 26, 22, 11, 27, 15, 28, 23, 14, 29, 32, 31, 16, 24, 30 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Junior | 25, 19, 10, 26, 13, 12, 28, 15, 14, 23, 29, 24, 31, 30, 32, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Senior | 8, 25, 13, 26, 11, 22, 23, 15, 29, 28, 14, 31, 30, 32, 24, 16 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| Graduate / PhD | 25, 19, 22, 10, 11, 13, 14, 23, 29, 28, 15, 30, 16, 24, 31, 32 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "XXIV: Conclusion," how does Hawthorne show conclusion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In XXIV: Conclusion, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of conclusion? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XXIV: Conclusion develops the idea of conclusion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XXIV: Conclusion (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of conclusion. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XXIV: Conclusion suggests about conclusion. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's structure and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses structure in XXIV: Conclusion to complicate the reader's understanding of conclusion. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XXIV: Conclusion within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of conclusion responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XXIV: Conclusion alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of conclusion follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XXIV: Conclusion and its treatment of conclusion. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's structure and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XXIV: Conclusion as evidence for a larger claim about conclusion in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XXIV: Conclusion as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of conclusion. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Women, more especially—in the continually recurring trials of wounded, wasted, wronged, misplaced, or erring and sinful passion—or with the dreary burden of a heart unyielded, because unvalued and unsought—came to Hester's cottage, demanding why they were so wretched, and what the remedy!*

   As used in the text, what does the word "unvalued" most nearly mean?

   A. based on guesswork
   B. the system of coats of arms
   C. not valued or loved
   D. a sorcerer

2. *After many days, when time sufficed for the people to arrange their thoughts in reference to the foregoing scene, there was more than one account of what had been witnessed on the scaffold.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "XXIV: Conclusion"?

   A. The physician probes the minister
   B. Conclusion
   C. The revelation
   D. The minister's vigil

**SAT key:** 1. C (not valued or loved); 2. B (Conclusion)

# Unit test

**The Scarlet Letter: unit test** · 90 minutes · 50 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

## Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

### *Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Much to the author’s surprise, and (if he may say so without additional offence) considerably to his amusement, he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented…”, what does “unprecedented” most nearly mean?

   A. never having happened before

   B. took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering

   C. publicly condemned

   D. insulting and mocking

   Key: A (never having happened before)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2: “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his _____ sketch without the change of a word”

   Key: introductory

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the _____”

   Key: Customhouse

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse, and quenched its last smoking ember in the blood of a certain venerable personage, against whom he is supposed to cherish a peculiar _____.” Word bank: disclaims, unprecedented, republish, malevolence

   Key: malevolence

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse, and _____ its last smoking ember in the blood of a certain venerable personage, against whom he is supposed to cherish a peculiar malevolence.” Word bank: quenched, republish, disclaims, unprecedented

   Key: quenched

6. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does the author call the sketch?

   Sample answer: His sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter.

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word.”, what does “republish” most nearly mean?

   A. publish again

   B. is right or necessary for

   C. a slave; one bound to serve

   D. a title for a married woman of ordinary rank (Mrs.)

   Key: A (publish again)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Much to the author’s surprise, and (if he may say so without additional offence) considerably to his amusement, he finds that his sketch of official life, _____ to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community…” Word bank: unprecedented, introductory, disclaims, republish

   Key: introductory

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What has angered Salem readers?

   A. The Customhouse sketch

   B. A sermon

   C. A newspaper article

   D. The novel's ending

   Key: A (The Customhouse sketch)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse, and quenched its last smoking ember in the blood of a certain venerable personage, against whom he is supposed to cherish a peculiar…”, what does “cherish” most nearly mean?

    A. without proper respect

    B. keep and nurse (a feeling) in one's heart

    C. a showy fake or performer who tricks people

    D. lack of clarity; blurriness

    Key: B (keep and nurse (a feeling) in one's heart)

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “Mother … the sunshine does not love you”

    A. X: The Leech and His Patient

    B. XVI: A Forest Walk

    C. XI: The Interior of a Heart

    D. XX: The Minister in a Maze

    Key: B (XVI: A Forest Walk)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Hester wait?

    A. In the forest

    B. At home

    C. By the scaffold

    D. At church

    Key: A (In the forest)

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The sportive sunlight—feebly sportive, at best, in the predominant pensiveness of the day and scene—withdrew itself as they came nigh, and left the spots where it had danced the drearier, because they had hoped to find…”, what does “pensiveness” most nearly mean?

    A. promising solemnly

    B. a poisonous plant

    C. restless turning movements

    D. deep, sad thoughtfulness

    Key: D (deep, sad thoughtfulness)

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: ““O, a story about the Black Man,” answered Pearl, taking hold of her mother’s gown, and looking up, half earnestly, half _____, into her face.”

    Word bank: straggled, humanize, scintillating, mischievously

    Key: mischievously

15. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Hester call the letter?

    A. A gift

    B. Her shame alone

    C. The Black Man's mark

    D. An angel's sign

    Key: C (The Black Man's mark)

16. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who is the Black Man?

    A. A minister

    B. The devil of local legend

    C. Chillingworth's servant

    D. A sailor

    Key: B (The devil of local legend)

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Pearl set forth, at a great pace, and, as Hester smiled to perceive, did actually catch the sunshine, and stood laughing in the midst of it, all brightened by its splendor, and scintillating with the vivacity excited by…”, what does “scintillating” most nearly mean?

    A. sparkling

    B. the quality of being believable

    C. serving as an introduction to what follows

    D. a complete change of appearance

    Key: A (sparkling)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “It straggled onward into the mystery of the primeval forest.”, what does “straggled” most nearly mean?

    A. fully satisfying

    B. carrying too heavy a load

    C. strengthened; given new energy

    D. wandered in a scattered, irregular way

    Key: D (wandered in a scattered, irregular way)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “She wanted—what some people want throughout life—a grief that should deeply touch her, and thus humanize and make her capable of sympathy.”, what does “humanize” most nearly mean?

    A. bordered or edged

    B. make more kind, gentle and human

    C. lacking curiosity (here 'not incurious' means quite curious)

    D. built or reinforced with heavy wooden beams

    Key: B (make more kind, gentle and human)

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22: “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This _____ letter is his mark”

    Key: scarlet

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Dimmesdale confess?

    A. On the ship

    B. In the pulpit

    C. In the forest

    D. On the scaffold

    Key: D (On the scaffold)

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Now was heard again the clangor of the music, and the measured tramp of the military escort, issuing from the church-door.”, what does “clangor” most nearly mean?

    A. speaking at length (about)

    B. one's deepest feelings

    C. a loud, ringing noise

    D. not saved from sin

    Key: C (a loud, ringing noise)

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “So _____ by spirit as he was, and so apotheosized by worshipping admirers, did his footsteps, in the procession, really tread upon the dust of earth?” Word bank: concentred, etherealized, apotheosized, undisclosed

    Key: etherealized

24. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Chillingworth say repeatedly?

    Sample answer: Thou hast escaped me!

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “So etherealized by spirit as he was, and so apotheosized by worshipping admirers, did his footsteps, in the procession, really tread upon the dust of earth?”, what does “apotheosized” most nearly mean?

    A. pure; not mixed with anything weaker

    B. based on guesswork

    C. setting aside; declining to pursue

    D. raised to the level of a god; idolized

    Key: D (raised to the level of a god; idolized)

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Do not _____ your fame, and perish in dishonor!" Word bank: apotheosized, undisclosed, concentred, blacken

    Key: blacken

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens to Dimmesdale?

    A. He is arrested

    B. He recovers

    C. He leaves on the ship

    D. He dies

    Key: D (He dies)

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who tries to stop him?

    A. Chillingworth

    B. Pearl

    C. Wilson

    D. Hester

    Key: A (Chillingworth)

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Pearl do?

    A. Kisses him

    B. Prays

    C. Runs away

    D. Screams

    Key: A (Kisses him)

30. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Preface to the Second Edition"?

    A. Hester on the scaffold

    B. An author answering his critics

    C. The procession

    D. Another view of Hester

    Key: B (An author answering his critics)

31. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse" (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Ironic exaggeration of the reaction.

32. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse" (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1)

    A. Hester's freedom.

    B. The harshest woman in the crowd.

    C. Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.

    D. Ironic exaggeration of the reaction.

    Key: D (Ironic exaggeration of the reaction.)

33. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community

immediately around him" (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse."

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4)

    A. Hester's freedom.

    B. Pearl's observation.

    C. Hawthorne refuses to revise.

    D. Nature's response.

    Key: B (Pearl's observation.)

35. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "XVI: A Forest Walk"?

    A. The forest walk

    B. The physician probes the minister

    C. The prison door and the rose

    D. The pastor and his parishioner

    Key: A (The forest walk)

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4)

    A. Hester to Pearl: town against forest.

    B. Pearl on the sunshine.

    C. The rose-bush as hope.

    D. The prison as an image.

    Key: B (Pearl on the sunshine.)

37. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Hester's answer.

38. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "People of New England" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 25)

    A. His self-recognition.

    B. Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners.

    C. The confession begins.

    D. The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse."

    Key: C (The confession begins.)

39. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18)

    A. Pearl's question.

    B. His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.

    C. The rose-bush as hope.

D. Chillingworth's defeat.

Key: D (Chillingworth's defeat.)

40. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale to Hester.

41. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Hawthorne not describe what is revealed?

    Sample answer: To keep the meaning uncertain and spiritual.

42. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position.

    A. Sin and guilt

    B. Nature and the individual against society

    C. Hypocrisy and truth

    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: D (Public shame and private identity)

43. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him”

    A. VII: The Governor’s Hall

    B. XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter

    C. Preface to the Second Edition

    D. XXII: The Procession

    Key: C (Preface to the Second Edition)

44. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4).

    Sample answer: Pearl says "the sunshine does not love you," and Hester tells her "This scarlet letter is his mark!"

45. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Pearl on the sunshine.

46. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter”? The climax: after the sermon Dimmesdale mounts the scaffold with Hester and Pearl, confesses, bares his breast and dies.

    A. Plot

    B. Theme

    C. Point of view

    D. Characterization

    Key: A (Plot)

47. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The public confession the novel has waited for.

    A. Sin and guilt

    B. Nature and the individual against society

    C. Hypocrisy and truth

    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: C (Hypocrisy and truth)

48. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him" (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse."

49. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: "The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Pearl says "the sunshine does not love you," and Hester tells her "This scarlet letter is his mark!"

50. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale to Hester.

51. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1: "he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an _____ excitement in the respectable community immediately around him"

    Key: unprecedented

52. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where and when is the preface signed?

    A. London, 1850

    B. Concord, 1849

    C. Salem, March 30, 1850

    D. Boston, 1640

    Key: C (Salem, March 30, 1850)

53. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4: "Mother … the _____ does not love you"

    Key: sunshine

54. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What avoids Hester?

    A. Sunshine

    B. The brook

    C. Pearl

    D. Birds

    Key: A (Sunshine)

55. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4: “It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of _____ on your bosom”

    Key: something

56. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18: “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very _____”

    Key: scaffold

57. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “For an instant, the gaze of the horror-stricken multitude was concentred on the ghastly miracle; while the minister stood, with a flush of triumph in his face, as one who, in the crisis of acutest pain, had won a…”, what does “concentred” most nearly mean?

    A. focused together on one point

    B. reasoned about life in a thoughtful, abstract way

    C. a source that never runs dry

    D. took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering

    Key: A (focused together on one point)

58. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “It seemed, at this point, as if the minister must leave the remainder of his secret undisclosed.”, what does “undisclosed” most nearly mean?

    A. making glad

    B. forever, beyond death

    C. not revealed

    D. the wish to do harm to others

    Key: C (not revealed)

59. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33: “Pearl _____ his lips. A spell was broken”

    Key: kissed

60. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does he reveal?

    A. A letter

    B. A will

    C. A knife

    D. His breast

    Key: D (His breast)

61. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does the preface exaggerate the town's anger?

    Sample answer: To make the critics look ridiculous.

62. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Pearl's observation.

63. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does the sunshine avoid Hester?

    Sample answer: Something on her bosom, the letter, keeps it away.

64. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter”?

    A. The interview in prison

B. The revelation

C. The minister in a maze

D. The New England holiday

Key: B (The revelation)

65. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33)

A. Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.

B. The mirror in the armor.

C. Pearl's transformation.

D. The core of his hypocrisy.

Key: C (Pearl's transformation.)

66. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Hawthorne refuses to revise.

67. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1).

Sample answer: He says the reaction "could hardly have been more violent" if he had burned down the Customhouse, then announces he will republish "without the change of a word."

68. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The forest as a world outside Puritan law.

A. Hypocrisy and truth

B. Public shame and private identity

C. Sin and guilt

D. Nature and the individual against society

Key: D (Nature and the individual against society)

69. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XVI: A Forest Walk”? Sunlight plays around Pearl but vanishes as Hester reaches for it.

A. Simile

B. Symbolism

C. Metaphor

D. Structure

Key: B (Symbolism)

70. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold”

A. XV: Hester and Pearl

B. XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter

C. XIV: Hester and the Physician

D. XII: The Minister's Vigil

Key: B (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter)

71. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter"? Chillingworth tries to stop him: "Thou hast escaped me!"

A. Theme

B. Characterization

C. Allusion

D. Imagery

Key: B (Characterization)

72. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18).

Sample answer: Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken."

73. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse" (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Ironic exaggeration of the reaction.

74. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how nature and the individual against society develops from an earlier chapter to "XVI: A Forest Walk". Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: the forest as a world outside Puritan law.

75. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chillingworth's defeat.

76. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What tone does the preface take?

A. Deeply sorrowful

B. Angry and violent

C. Ironic and amused

D. Fearful

Key: C (Ironic and amused)

77. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Hawthorne respond?

A. He rewrites the sketch

B. He republishes the sketch unchanged

C. He apologizes publicly

D. He leaves Salem

Key: B (He republishes the sketch unchanged)

78. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21: “Is not this better … than what we _____ of in the forest”

    Key: dreamed

79. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2)

    A. One account of the revelation.

    B. His vow.

    C. Hawthorne refuses to revise.

    D. The townspeople's suspicion.

    Key: C (Hawthorne refuses to revise.)

80. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1)

    A. Nature's response.

    B. Why Hester names her Pearl.

    C. The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse."

    D. Why Hester returns.

    Key: C (The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse.")

81. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth's defeat.

82. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Preface to the Second Edition”? He calls his satirical sketch harmless and the outrage "unprecedented excitement," exaggerating to mock his critics.

    A. Diction / vocabulary

    B. Hyperbole

    C. Tone / mood

    D. Irony

    Key: D (Irony)

83. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “XVI: A Forest Walk”? The forest path, dark and wild, with sunshine that flees from Hester.

    A. Personification

    B. Conflict

    C. Setting

    D. Structure

    Key: C (Setting)

84. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Pearl's transformation.

85. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Hawthorne right not to change a word? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned position weighing satire against fairness to real people.

86. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: He says the reaction "could hardly have been more violent" if he had burned down the Customhouse, then announces he will republish "without the change of a word."

87. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Pearl's observation.

88. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is the ending just? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view.

89. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken."

90. [short · recall · DOK 1] Where is Dimmesdale coming from?
    Sample answer: A visit to the Apostle Eliot among the Native converts.

91. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21)
    A. The townspeople's suspicion.
    B. Dimmesdale to Hester.
    C. Hester's promise.
    D. The town's suspicion.

    Key: B (Dimmesdale to Hester.)

92. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Preface to the Second Edition”? Hawthorne answers Salem's anger with mock surprise and amusement, refusing to apologize.
    A. Plot
    B. Setting
    C. Diction / vocabulary
    D. Tone / mood

    Key: D (Tone / mood)

93. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how hypocrisy and truth develops from an earlier chapter to “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: the public confession the novel has waited for.

94. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “As to enmity, or ill-feeling of any kind, personal or political, he utterly disclaims such motives.”, what does “disclaims” most nearly mean?

    A. denies having (a motive or intention)

    B. long spears with an axe blade, carried by guards

    C. in a way that cannot be held back

    D. pure; not mixed with anything weaker

    Key: A (denies having (a motive or intention))

95. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22)

    A. Hester's fear of him.

    B. Hester's answer.

    C. The letter isolates Hester.

    D. Anguish as his only truth.

    Key: B (Hester's answer.)

96. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Hester's answer.

97. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from an earlier chapter to “Preface to the Second Edition”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position.

98. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is the forest good or evil in the novel? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view.

99. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Child, what art thou” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Hester's question.

100. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

     Sample answer: Why Hester names her Pearl.

101. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

     Sample answer: People say "it meant Able," yet Hawthorne admits "The scarlet letter had not done its office," because Hester's life "had turned ... to thought."

102. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Can anyone wear two faces without losing the true one? Argue.

     Sample answer: A reasoned view.

103. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Pearl a realistic child or a symbol? Argue.

     Sample answer: A reasoned view with evidence for both.

104. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: Hester names her Pearl "as being of great price,—purchased with all she had," yet asks in fear "Child, what art thou?", and Pearl insists "I have no Heavenly Father!"

105. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how sin and guilt develops from an earlier chapter to “VI: Pearl”. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment.

106. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The letter's failure as a punishment.

107. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how women and independence develops from an earlier chapter to “XIII: Another View of Hester”. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women.

108. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy.

109. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.

110. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The changed meaning of the letter.

111. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how hypocrisy and truth develops from an earlier chapter to “XX: The Minister in a Maze”. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: the double face.

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50 | recall 29, inference 12, analysis 6, synthesis 3 |
| HS Freshman | 3, 2, 51, 5, 4, 52, 7, 1, 6, 15, 53, 14, 20, 13, 54, 18, 16, 55, 56, 57, 58, 29, 59, 60, 22, 27, 30, 31, 61, 32, 62, 37, 35, 63, 64, 65, 39, 40, 43, 66, 67, 44, 68, 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 74, 75 | recall 26, inference 12, analysis 9, synthesis 3 |
| HS Sophomore | 6, 76, 1, 3, 77, 7, 8, 53, 18, 20, 11, 54, 19, 78, 24, 56, 21, 28, 57, 31, 61, 32, 30, 79, 80, 36, 62, 35, 37, 63, 81, 39, 65, 38, 64, 66, 82, 42, 83, 68, 45, 84, 46, 72, 85, 86, 87, 49, 88, 89 | recall 19, inference 16, analysis 9, synthesis 6 |
| HS Junior | 3, 4, 6, 76, 52, 8, 90, 54, 53, 16, 55, 26, 21, 23, 78, 60, 31, 33, 32, 30, 61, 80, 62, 37, 63, 35, 34, 91, 39, 38, 81, 40, 42, 66, 43, 92, 83, 44, 69, 45, 47, 46, 84, 72, 73, 85, 49, 87, 93, 50 | recall 16, inference 16, analysis 12, synthesis 6 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| HS Senior | 94, 76, 2, 77, 7, 18, 55, 11, 13, 27, 23, 78, 25, 31, 79, 33, 80, 30, 32, 34, 95, 36, 37, 62, 91, 64, 40, 38, 65, 43, 66, 82, 92, 83, 44, 45, 68, 47, 71, 84, 72, 48, 85, 86, 96, 87, 74, 88, 93, 75 | recall 13, inference 16, analysis 12, synthesis 9 |
| AP | 8, 52, 76, 17, 13, 90, 24, 56, 58, 31, 32, 79, 80, 62, 95, 37, 35, 65, 64, 91, 40, 82, 67, 92, 43, 42, 66, 83, 44, 45, 68, 69, 46, 72, 47, 70, 84, 85, 73, 48, 86, 97, 96, 98, 49, 74, 50, 89, 88, 93 | recall 9, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 13 |
| College Freshman | 52, 3, 76, 11, 18, 14, 58, 27, 23, 31, 32, 79, 33, 62, 63, 34, 37, 40, 91, 65, 41, 82, 67, 43, 42, 92, 66, 44, 83, 69, 68, 45, 72, 71, 70, 46, 84, 86, 48, 85, 97, 73, 87, 98, 74, 96, 88, 93, 89, 50 | recall 9, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 13 |
| College Sophomore | 8, 9, 15, 19, 29, 26, 79, 80, 31, 32, 95, 36, 37, 35, 91, 39, 81, 64, 42, 82, 43, 67, 66, 92, 45, 44, 83, 69, 68, 70, 72, 84, 47, 46, 86, 73, 48, 97, 85, 99, 49, 74, 87, 98, 96, 88, 75, 89, 93, 50 | recall 6, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 16 |
| College Junior | 4, 2, 11, 20, 25, 21, 32, 79, 80, 37, 34, 95, 39, 41, 65, 66, 42, 92, 82, 67, 43, 68, 83, 44, 45, 69, 84, 70, 72, 46, 47, 73, 85, 48, 86, 97, 99, 100, 101, 74, 98, 96, 49, 87, 102, 88, 93, 89, 75, 50 | recall 6, inference 9, analysis 16, synthesis 19 |
| College Senior | 8, 20, 29, 33, 30, 31, 36, 34, 35, 38, 64, 39, 92, 43, 82, 42, 66, 67, 69, 68, 45, 83, 44, 84, 72, 47, 46, 70, 48, 73, 85, 86, 97, 103, 104, 105, 106, 107, 87, 74, 49, 96, 98, 108, 109, 93, 75, 50, 89, 88 | recall 3, inference 9, analysis 16, synthesis 22 |
| Graduate / PhD | 4, 16, 78, 32, 79, 95, 62, 40, 81, 42, 92, 67, 66, 43, 82, 69, 44, 68, 83, 45, 72, 46, 70, 84, 47, 85, 73, 86, 48, 97, 100, 105, 104, 99, 106, 101, 110, 49, 74, 87, 98, 96, 109, 102, 111, 89, 50, 75, 93, 88 | recall 3, inference 6, analysis 16, synthesis 25 |

# Final paper

**The Scarlet Letter: final paper (formal literary analysis)**. Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops sin and guilt across The Scarlet Letter. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in The Scarlet Letter and argue how its meaning changes over the novel and why that change matters to public shame and private identity.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in The Scarlet Letter. Argue whether the novel judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether The Scarlet Letter finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of hypocrisy and truth. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

**Length:** Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

**Evidence requirement:** at least 6 quotations from at least three sections, from the beginning, middle and end. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the chapter and paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

| Criterion | Points | Descriptor |
|---|---|---|
| Thesis | 20 | A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper. |
| Evidence | 25 | Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement. |
| Analysis | 30 | Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary. |
| Organization | 15 | Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument. |
| Style and conventions | 10 | Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format. |

**Critical voice:** "_The Scarlet Letter_ has the beauty and harmony of all original and complete conceptions, and its weaker spots, whatever they are, are not of its essence; they are mere light flaws and inequalities of surface." (Henry James, novelist and critic, *Hawthorne (English Men of Letters, 1879), Chapter V, Ch. V*; public domain). Closure: name one "light flaw" you found and argue it is not "of its essence." *Objective:* Closing lesson: evaluate the novel's lasting value. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.9, W.11-12.1

# Essay assignments

## Essay: Sin and guilt

**Scaffolded support** (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Scarlet Letter teaches about sin and guilt. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops sin and guilt in The Scarlet Letter. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops sin and guilt across The Scarlet Letter. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Scarlet Letter (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of sin and guilt. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of sin and guilt in The Scarlet Letter. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in The Scarlet Letter (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of sin and guilt, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Scarlet Letter's treatment of sin and guilt in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on sin and guilt in The Scarlet Letter that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on sin and guilt in The Scarlet Letter. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about sin and guilt in The Scarlet Letter, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on sin and guilt in The Scarlet Letter, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Public shame and private identity

**Scaffolded support** (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Scarlet Letter teaches about public shame and private identity. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops public shame and private identity in The Scarlet Letter. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops public shame and private identity across The Scarlet Letter. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Scarlet Letter (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of public shame and private identity. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of public shame and private identity in The Scarlet Letter. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in The Scarlet Letter (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of public shame and private identity, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Scarlet Letter's treatment of public shame and private identity in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on public shame and private identity in The Scarlet Letter that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on public shame and private identity in The Scarlet Letter. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about public shame and private identity in The Scarlet Letter, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on public shame and private identity in The Scarlet Letter, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Hypocrisy and truth

**Scaffolded support** (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Scarlet Letter teaches about hypocrisy and truth. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops hypocrisy and truth in The Scarlet Letter. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops hypocrisy and truth across The Scarlet Letter. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Scarlet Letter (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of hypocrisy and truth. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of hypocrisy and truth in The Scarlet Letter. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in The Scarlet Letter (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of hypocrisy and truth, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Scarlet Letter's treatment of hypocrisy and truth in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on hypocrisy and truth in The Scarlet Letter that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on hypocrisy and truth in The Scarlet Letter. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about hypocrisy and truth in The Scarlet Letter, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on hypocrisy and truth in The Scarlet Letter, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Nature and the individual against society

**Scaffolded support** (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Scarlet Letter teaches about nature and the individual against society. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops nature and the individual against society in The Scarlet Letter. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops nature and the individual against society across The Scarlet Letter. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Scarlet Letter (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of nature and the individual against society. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of nature and the individual against society in The Scarlet Letter. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in The Scarlet Letter (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of nature and the individual against society, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Scarlet Letter's treatment of nature and the individual against society in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on nature and the individual against society in The Scarlet Letter that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on nature and the individual against society in The Scarlet Letter. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about nature and the individual against society in The Scarlet Letter, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on nature and the individual against society in The Scarlet Letter, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Women and independence

**Scaffolded support** (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Scarlet Letter teaches about women and independence. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops women and independence in The Scarlet Letter. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops women and independence across The Scarlet Letter. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Scarlet Letter (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of women and independence. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of women and independence in The Scarlet Letter. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in The Scarlet Letter (a recurring element, structure and narration)

shape a complex understanding of women and independence, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Scarlet Letter's treatment of women and independence in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on women and independence in The Scarlet Letter that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on women and independence in The Scarlet Letter. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

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**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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